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Mayor again calls for taxes on large corporations

Johnson tight-lipped on specific plans as budget showdown looms

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

With his city budget pitch for next year looming, Mayor Brandon Johnson on Tuesday again argued large corporations must pay more taxes to help Chicago balance its books.

Johnson remained tight-lipped on his specific budget plans during a City Hall news conference, but hinted he may also propose higher taxes on cloud computing software and social media companies.

He called on aldermen and state legislators to clear the way for his renewed tax-the-rich push — a sign he is once again willing to wage a high-stakes public fight as City Hall crafts a spending package. Johnson is expected to unveil his budget proposal on Oct. 21, starting the clock for him and City Council opponents to pass something before the calendar flips to 2027, when all their seats are on the election ballot.

The mayor returned to a familiar refrain as he said there is a clear choice ahead: Ask Chicago families to do more with less, or challenge corporations benefiting from federal tax cuts to pay "their fair share."

"What remains to be seen is whether the corporate-aligned caucus will have the collective courage to choose the interests and priorities of Chicagoans, or choose to cower before the influence and campaign donations of corporations," he said, a reference to the bruising battle that ended in December with aldermen passing a 2026 spending plan against Johnson's wishes and without his proposed corporate head tax.

Johnson and aldermen face an $882 million budget gap for 2027, the mayor told reporters in early September.

See **BUDGET** on Page A11

Pope Leo XIV arrives at the Agostino Gemelli Polyclinic in Rome on Tuesday, where he was operated on to remove a lung nodule.
ALESSANDRA TARANTINO/AP

Pope Leo diagnosed with lung cancer, Vatican says

Surgery to remove lower lobe on his right side 'successful and there were no complications'

By Nicole Winfield and Colleen Barry
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ROME — Pope Leo XIV underwent surgery Tuesday that confirmed that he has lung cancer, and doctors removed the lower lobe of his right lung, the Vatican said.

Tests confirmed a diagnosis of lung adenocarcinoma, the Vatican said in a medical bulletin after the surgery. It said the diagnosis had been suspected by preoperative tests and was confirmed during surgery.

The statement made no mention of treatment going forward, and the Vatican said doctors were not currently speaking of chemotherapy or other therapies pending the results of other tests. The Vatican press office noted the medical statement spoke of the "radical" removal of the lobe as an indication that doctors removed all suspect tissue in hopes of removing any lingering traces of the cancer.

Leo's lymph nodes also would have been removed and tested, to determine if the cancer had spread, and there was no word yet on those test results.

"Adenocarcinoma is the most common (type of lung cancer), also with the most favorable prognosis," said Dr. Stephen Liu, a lung cancer expert at Georgetown's Lombardi Comprehensive Cancer Center. "While we know the diagnosis we now need to know the stage.

"We now need to know how big it is, how many spots in the lung are involved. Is it just one nodule, or more than one, and the lymph nodes, are they cancerous?" Liu said.

If the cancer has spread, more tests will be needed to determine what kind of therapy to pursue, he said. Options include chemotherapy, a combination of chemotherapy and immunotherapy or targeted therapy, which involves oral pills for specific cancers.

The 71-year-old was in the operating room for about three hours, the statement said. The surgery itself lasted about 90 minutes.

"The surgery was successful, and there were no complications," the statement said.

Leo had walked into Rome's

See **POPE** on Page A11

Brian Gumino, engineering manager at Richardson Electronics, opens the casing on a AMOGREENTECH battery used for electric locomotives on Monday in La Fox. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Taking a big step in battery storage

Expansion of operation helps state's clean energy goals, but more is needed

By John Lippert
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

To keep up with artificial intelligence, Illinois needs batteries big enough to keep its air conditioners running on hot summer nights and to replenish its electrical grid during winter storms lasting for days.

The state took a step in this direction Monday when Richardson Electronics said it would expand production of commercial-scale storage batteries at its factory in La Fox, a suburb west of Chicago.

Richardson, a diversified manufacturer of power products, expects to sell batteries worldwide. But company officials say they'll deploy many of their batteries in Illinois because of the state's hefty tax incentives for renewable power and for batteries that make solar and wind less intermittent.

When layered on top of each other, Illinois and federal tax incentives add up to almost the entire cost of one of Richardson's storage batteries, said Scott DuBois, director of the company's storage operations.

The battery, which the company plans to build at its La Fox site next summer, would be able to store 5 megawatts of power and will cost about $3 million. It will be the largest battery ever connected to the grid by an Illinois company, Richardson officials said.

Without more batteries, Illinois will be even more reliant on

See **BATTERY** on Page A4

ELECTION 2026 9TH CONGRESSIONAL DISTRICT

Biss aims to keep Dems' hold on deep-blue area vs. Elleson

Evanston's mayor running against pastor who has raised $0

By Olivia Olander
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Voters in Illinois' deep-blue 9th Congressional District may feel they already chose their next member of Congress in March's open Democratic primary. Democrats have held the North Side and north suburban seat since 1949, and except for a brief stretch, only two people have represented it in that time.

Still, Democratic nominee Daniel Biss, Evanston's mayor, is continuing to define what kind of Democrat he'll be in Washington. And Republican nominee John Elleson, a suburban pastor, keeps campaigning even though he isn't raising any money.

Endorsed by retiring U.S. Rep. Jan Schakowsky, Biss won a dramatic 15-way primary by walking a tightrope between his party's centrist and insurgent progressive wings. His closest rivals were moderate Democratic state Sen. Laura Fine and unconventional progressive political commentator Kat Abughazaleh.

Now, after party-dividing primary contests in nearby swing states like Wisconsin and Michigan, the second-term mayor is no more eager to be boxed in than he was during the primary.

See **ELECTION** on Page A7

INSIDE

Bedard 'pumped' to be back in lineup

Blackhawks center and captain Connor Bedard joined the lineup on Tuesday, returning weeks ahead of schedule from left shoulder surgery. **Sports**

Highly anticipated Hooligan opens

A "neo-Midwestern bistro" from Christian Hunter, a Michelin-award winning chef, opens in Logan Square. **Food & Health**

Blackhawks center Connor Bedard warms up on Tuesday.
CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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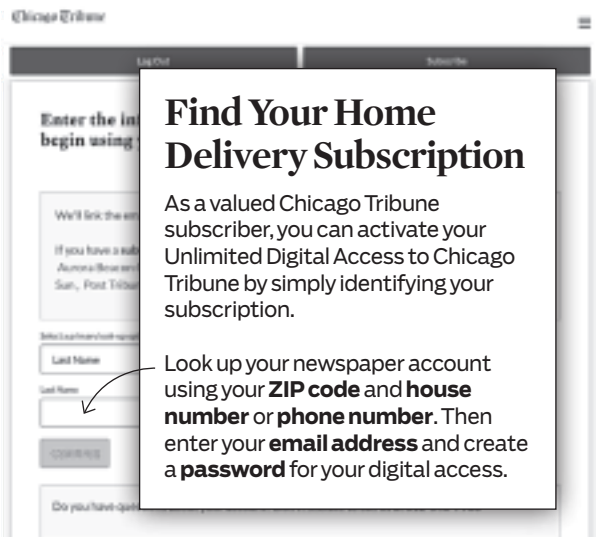

Tribune books

"He Had It Coming: Four Murderous Women and the Reporter Who Immortalized Their Stories" "Chicago The Musical" played on Broadway for more than 9,600 performances since it premiered on Nov. 14, 1996, yet not many people know the characters of Roxie Hart, Velma Kelly and others are inspired by real women. Their stories were captured by Tribune reporters. This book includes original newspaper clippings, Watkins' stories and a new analysis.

"Dinner at Home" Cooking at home doesn't have to be difficult, but it should always be delicious. JeanMarie Brownson, culinary director for Rick Bayless' Frontera Foods, helped readers put inventive, yet simple, dishes on the table through her Dinner at Home column for the Tribune. Her book includes everything you need to create spectacular food any day of the week.

"Capone: A Photographic Portrait of America's Most Notorious Gangster." Using many never-before-published photographs and newspaper clippings from the Tribune's archives, this coffee-table book chronicles the rise and fall of Al Capone.

"Gangsters & Grifters: Classic Crime Photos From the Chicago Tribune." This collection of photographs taken in the early 1900s through the 1950s features infamous criminals, small-time bandits, smirking crooks, pickpockets, hoodlums and wiseguys at crime scenes.

"Ask Amy: Advice for Better Living" For more than a decade, Amy Dickinson was the Tribune's signature general advice columnist, helping readers with questions both personal and pressing. This book, which collects columns from 2011 to 2013, is a testament to her empathetic counsel and practical common-sense tips.

"Culture Worrier: Reflections on Race, Politics and Social Change." Clarence Page's newest book commemorates the 30th anniversary of his column's first appearance in the Tribune. It is the first such collection of the Pulitzer Prize winner's columns, covering topics such as politics, social issues, pop culture, race, family, new media and prominent figures, as well as his personal life.

"10 Things You Might Not Know About Nearly Everything." You may never need to know the human body contains a half-pound of salt, but that's just one of the obscure facts you'll find about sports, history, religion, politics, arts and culture, food and leisure, and science and technology in this collection of columns from Mark Jacob and Stephan Benzkofer.

"Life Skills: How To Do Almost Anything" How do you give a good wedding toast? How do you fix a clogged drain? How do you bowl without hurting anyone? Questions like these make up this engaging do-it-yourself guide.

All Chicago Tribune print books are available online at chicagotribune.com/printbooks

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'Child sex ring' went on for decades at South Side parish, new lawsuits say

By Shun Graves
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Attorney Stephen Hart announces a series of lawsuits on Tuesday against the Archdiocese of Chicago for alleged abuse of minors by priests assigned to Holy Angels between 1969 and 2002 in Chicago. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

The Rev. George Clements helped propel the Black Catholic movement, created the "One Church, One Child" initiative urging adoption and, against church practice, adopted children himself.

Those headline-grabbing and sometimes polarizing moves served as cover for the late South Side pastor to orchestrate a "decades-long child sex ring" at his parish, according to a new series of lawsuits against the Archdiocese of Chicago.

"The charismatic local icon, civil rights leader, famed for his unprecedented adoption of four children, was an absolute imposter and probably the most prolific child molester in the history of the Archdiocese of Chicago," said Sean O'Malley, a lawyer at Hart McLaughlin & Eldridge, which announced the suits on Tuesday.

Installed as pastor of the now-former Holy Angels Parish in 1969 after a blistering campaign by his supporters, Clements served in that role until he departed 22 years later. It was during those years that the activist priest used the Holy Angels school as the setting for near-daily sexual abuse, according to the suits.

Altogether, the law firm said it has more than 100 clients alleging abuse by Clements or his associates. The children were as young as 5 at the time of the alleged abuse.

The lawyers announced suits for seven of them, though as of Tuesday evening, only two appeared to have been filed. They also allege that the archdiocese failed to take serious action because of the students' race and poverty.

Soon after gaining the reins of the parish, Clements picked a new principal, Paul Smith. Together, they implemented a disciplinarian regime at the school, and frequent corporal punishment became a pretext for pulling aside young boys for sexual abuse, the lawyers allege.

In 1972, another priest started living at Holy Angels' rectory. Much like Clements, the Rev. Kenneth Brigham had risen up the Catholic ladder on the South Side, but by then Brigham had departed his previous parish under the cloud of sexual abuse claims, according to the complaint.

The three men began to host small parties for students in the rectory, during which they would isolate the children and sexually abuse them, according to the claims.

Brigham left Holy Angels in 1978. But a "multidimensional sex ring operation" continued there, the lawyers allege.

In one example, Clements started abusing a sixth grade boy in the altar boys' changing area by groping him "under the pretext of arranging the victim's altar boy uniform," the complaint reads. Clements is accused of escalating the frequent abuse into making the boy perform oral sex.

It was a pattern repeated throughout the new claims with stunning regularity.

The grooming for one third grade boy escalated into Clements "ritualistically" performing oral sex on the boy for three years, according to the complaint. And after those years of abuse by Clements ended, the principal, Smith, began to molest him, the suit says.

The men also allegedly targeted children who didn't attend the school, but their methods sometimes diverged, according to the complaint: Clements offered one-on-one mentorship to young boys and proceeded to rape them; Smith would call on children to do chores for him, another pretext for abuse.

Clements departed Holy Angels in 1991, and in many ways the man who took his place reflected Clements' legacy. John Calicott quickly became beloved at Holy Angels and in Chicago's Black Catholic population. He also preyed on young boys, according to the complaint.

Unlike the men before him, however, Calicott faced a sexual abuse claim that became public. In 1993, a man accused Calicott of abusing him as a boy, starting in 1976. The claims made their way through the archdiocese's new policy for handling sexual abuse, and the archdiocese placed him on leave in 1994.

Although he had once acknowledged some misconduct, the archdiocese reinstated him the following year anyway. The Holy Angels congregation was overjoyed at his return, the Tribune reported at the time.

After the controversy, Calicott continued the abuse, "including casual genital fondling that Calicott performed openly and notoriously," the complaint reads. In 2002, under new guidelines adopted amid the global outcry over sexual abuse in the church, the archdiocese tried to remove him from Holy Angels.

Calicott appealed but failed. He died in 2024, according to the complaint. The other men have also since died.

Clements died in 2019, months after the archdiocese started investigating him over an abuse claim. The archdiocese settled an allegation against Clemens in 2022, the Tribune reported at the time.

Smith, the principal, was killed at home in a 1996 homicide, while Brigham died 10 years later.

The archdiocese did not address the latest claims directly when reached by the Tribune Tuesday, but said that many of the allegations it receives are from "decades ago" and that it does not tolerate "behavior that could pose a risk to children."

"The protection of children is one of our highest callings and a critical ministry of the church," the archdiocese wrote in a statement. "Our protocols and policies for child safety, adopted in 1992, have served as a national and global model. Prompt action is taken to report all allegations to law enforcement. Abuse survivors are connected to support and social services, including therapy at the archdiocese's expense."

U.of C. off-campus frat claims no member involvement with sexual assault report

By Kate Perez and Lila Hempel-Edgers
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A woman alleged she was sexually assaulted inside a bathroom over the weekend at an off-campus fraternity house near the University of Chicago, according to a police report, which also states that a group of three to five men were outside the door cheering while the incident was occurring.

The victim, who is not a university student, reported the assault at 2:10 a.m. on Sunday, roughly 30 minutes after it occurred, and did not know the attacker, according to a university incident report. The party was held at 5625 S. University Ave. in Hyde Park, an address listed on social media as the home of the Lambda chapter of Alpha Epsilon Pi, which describes itself as operating chapters on more than 170 college campuses in six countries.

According to the Chicago Police Department report, which was obtained and reviewed by the Chicago Tribune, the victim was dancing at a party when the offender asked her repeatedly to accompany him to his bedroom, which she refused. The report states that the victim "began feeling unwell" and experienced periods of blacking out, then left the dance floor to go to the bathroom.

The victim alleged that the offender followed her inside the bathroom, where she lost consciousness. Upon regaining consciousness, the victim alleged that parts of her clothing had been removed and she had been sexually assaulted. According to the report, a witness observed approximately three to five males standing outside the bathroom door, cheering and appearing to encourage the activity inside.

Tuesday afternoon, the University of Chicago issued a community alert stating that a "person of interest" had been identified and that the person was not a university student or affiliated with the university and has been banned from campus. The university also said the Chicago Police Department's investigation is still active and that no charges had been filed, so the school "is not at liberty to disclose the name of the person of interest."

"The University's public notice about the report of sexual assault the day it happened encouraged others with knowledge of the events to help identify a suspect," the statement read. "This identification has been corroborated by key witness statements and video evidence from University cameras and license plate readers, all of which has been shared with (Chicago Police Department) by the Department of Safety & Security."

The university issued an initial alert on Sunday after the incident, informing the campus community that a suspected attacker fled the fraternity house after another person intervened. Witnesses described him as a 5-foot-7 man with a "dark complexion," short hair on the sides and curls on top, wearing a black T-shirt, black jogging pants and white shoes.

Footage from nearby surveillance cameras showed a person matching that description running from the fraternity house. After receiving the report Sunday morning, university police contacted Chicago police and arranged medical care for the woman at the University of Chicago Medical Center.

In its initial alert, the university called the incident "deeply concerning" and said, "the safety and well-being of our students and all who come to our community is our highest priority." The U. of C. reiterated that message in a statement to the Tribune Monday.

"As noted in yesterday's message, the University remains committed to addressing sexual misconduct cases that occur, to imposing disciplinary consequences as warranted, and to continually improving efforts to prevent sexual misconduct," the university said. "In addition to the CPD's ongoing criminal investigation, the University is using tools at its disposal to gather information and, when possible, will initiate disciplinary proceedings. The University alerted the national office of the fraternity regarding this case."

Similarly, in a post on Instagram Monday, the fraternity wrote that it was "deeply disturbed" by the incident and condemned sexual violence. The post stated the fraternity's concern is "first and foremost for the person harmed, whose privacy and dignity we ask everyone to respect," adding that "to the best of our knowledge, no one affiliated with AEPi was involved or complicit with this incident."

In its post, AEPi wrote that it is working with authorities to provide Chicago police with additional details and that it initially learned of the incident when a sober monitor at the fraternity was alerted and called over by the victim's friend.

"We immediately responded and multiple members of the fraternity, including our risk manager, arrived at the scene, providing assistance to the victim. A member stayed with the victim until the necessary authorities arrived, only leaving after the police had asked him to do so," the post states. "The party was shut down immediately following our notice of the events. We will continue to support the investigation to the fullest extent and offer our support in any way possible."

The chapter was told to halt programming while local law enforcement investigates the reported assault, according to the fraternity's national organization. AEPi, like other Greek-letter organizations, is not officially recognized by the U. of C., though its students are still subject to the university's code of conduct and disciplinary procedures.

Specifically, the university's student handbook states that sexual misconduct violates campus community standards and is "unacceptable" even when it does not violate the law. It urges anyone who has experienced sexual misconduct to report the incident and seek medical care.

"Sexual misconduct can be devastating to the person who experiences it directly and can adversely impact family, friends, and the larger community," the handbook states.

The report comes as sexual violence on college campuses has been in the news.

Cornell University said Tuesday it is suspending parties and other social events at fraternities on campus for the rest of the academic year in the wake of outrage over the school's handling of a two-year-old sexual violence case that resurfaced last month. A woman referred to as "Jane Doe" filed a civil suit after a prosecutor declined to pursue criminal charges against seven men she alleged raped her in 2024 while she was intoxicated at a fraternity party on the Ivy League school's Ithaca, New York, campus.

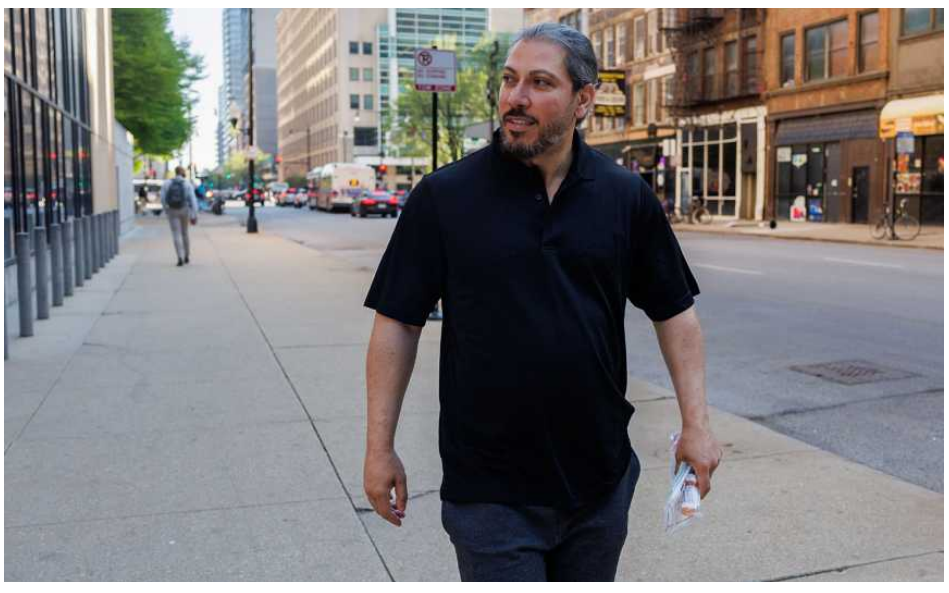
In its post, AEPi urged anyone with information about the incident or individuals involved to contact the Chicago Police Department's tip line, writing that "even a small detail may help investigators."

"Sexual violence has no place in our community," the post stated. "We are committed to cooperating with the investigation and supporting the victim in any way possible."

Accused Loretto Hospital fraudsters plead not guilty

Two linked to party in Dubai with Texas Senate candidate

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE



Sameer Suhail, the former Chicago medical supply company owner who fled to Dubai shortly before being indicted in a massive scheme to defraud Loretto Hospital, walks outside the Metropolitan Correctional Center in Chicago after getting released on April 22
ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Dr. Anosh Ahmed, former chief operating officer at Loretto Hospital, on April 30, 2020.
BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A day after a national news report linked them to Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton, a former executive at Chicago's Loretto Hospital and one of his top medical suppliers were arraigned on a superseding indictment alleging they stole almost $16 million from the small safety-net facility.

Anosh Ahmed, who served as chief financial officer at Loretto until 2021, and Sameer Suhail, a medical doctor who owned companies that did business with the hospital, each pleaded not guilty during a brief appearance before U.S. Magistrate Judge Maria Valdez.

Ahmed, 42, and Suhail, 49, each were charged in the third superseding indictment with counts of wire fraud, embezzlement, kickback conspiracy and money laundering. Ahmed also was charged separately with filing false tax returns. The allegations largely mirror those made in previous versions of the charges.

Their court appearance comes after the Wall Street Journal reported that Ahmed and Suhail had been captured on video partying with the scandal-plagued Paxton — who is running for U.S. Senate — and the married attorney general's girlfriend at a New Year's Eve 2024 celebration in Dubai. The report detailed a video taken by another partygoer that showed the group on a luxury high-rise balcony overlooking a fireworks display at the Burj Khalifa skyscraper to welcome 2025.

At the time, Ahmed and Suhail had been indicted in Chicago and were considered fugitives from U.S. justice. Ahmed was later hit with separate charges in Chicago alleging he ran a massive COVID-19 testing fraud scheme after he'd left Loretto and set up businesses in Texas.

The Wall Street Journal reported Ahmed has donated $190,000 to Paxton, including $25,000 days after he was indicted. Paxton, a longtime supporter of President Donald Trump who received the president's endorsement in the Republican primary, is currently locked in a battle for the Texas Senate seat with Democratic candidate James Talarico.

After the hearing at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Tuesday, Suhail's attorney, Adam Sheppard, called his client "an international man of mystery," but declined to comment directly on Paxton or the Journal's report.

"Dr. Suhail has many long-standing personal and professional relationships, including with prominent business and political figures," Sheppard said.

Ahmed's attorney declined to comment.

The 38-page superseding indictment alleged Ahmed and Suhail conspired with former Loretto CEO George Miller, executive Heather Bergdahl and others to steer millions of dollars in hospital vendor payments to medical supply companies they secretly controlled, often for services that were never rendered.

In one instance, Ahmed and Suhail billed the hospital $34,000 for four copier machines and related products and falsified paperwork showing they'd been delivered to Loretto, when in fact the machines went to "various properties" controlled by Suhail in Illinois and Ahmed in Texas, the indictment stated.

Miller was indicted in 2024 with conspiring to accept checks and money transfers from Suhail in exchange for the award of contracts and other hospital business to Suhail's companies. He allegedly accepted about $769,000 in bribes, prosecutors originally charged.

Both Miller and Bergdahl, Loretto's former chief transformation officer and close friend of Ahmed's, entered into pretrial diversion agreements earlier this year that will see conspiracy charges against them dismissed as long as they stay out of trouble for a year.

Those generous deals were reached after allegations of grand jury misconduct surfaced in May in the "Broadview Six" case against immigration protesters, which was handled by the same prosecutor who led the sprawling Loretto investigation.

The indictment followed a federal investigation initiated after Loretto came under fire for improperly doling out COVID-19 vaccinations soon after the shots became available. In 2021, following reporting by Block Club Chicago and WBEZ, Loretto admitted it had improperly vaccinated workers at Trump Tower in downtown Chicago and had also improperly given shots to Cook County judges at a time when the vaccines were still scarce.

Miller, who was CEO of Loretto during that period, was first suspended and later left the hospital amid the fallout in 2022.

Both Ahmed and Suhail had left the country and were living in Dubai by the time the indictment came down, and warrants were issued for their arrests. Ahmed was taken into custody while traveling in Serbia last December and was brought back to the U.S. after eventually dropping his extradition fight.

Suhail returned voluntarily earlier this year.

Ahmed's lead attorney, former U.S. attorney Dan Webb, has told judges in both cases they were working on a plea deal that would resolve the matters short of trial.

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BATTERY

from Page A1

dirty, expensive electricity imports from other states and more likely to delay the natural gas power plant closures it's planned for years to clean the air.

"We are depending on out-of-state resources to essentially keep the lights on," said Matthew Tomc, vice president of regulatory policy and energy supply for Ameren, which serves customers in downstate Illinois.

"There are many states building new generation, but it's not built yet. So there are reliability issues first and foremost," Tomc said. "And it raises the risk that you have price spikes seasonally, namely in the summer, right when you're trying to meet those capacity requirements."

Tomc's not alone in sounding the alarm.

PJM Interconnection, the regional grid that includes northern Illinois, 12 other states and the District of Columbia, could face 13 days of service interruptions a year by 2030 in a worst-case scenario, Pennsylvania regulators said last month.

PJM's longstanding goal has been to have just one day of service interruptions every 10 years.

Prices already are climbing. Commonwealth Edison customers in northern Illinois pay an average residential bill of $141 per month, according to Heatmap News and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. That's up just 4% since 2021, partly because PJM imposed price caps last year.

Ameren customers downstate pay an average of $224, up 51% in five years. The downstate area is part of the Midwest Independent System Operator grid or MISO, which also serves 14 other states from Mississippi to North Dakota as well as Manitoba.

To blunt further increases, Richardson and its supplier Gotion, a Chinese-owned company with a $2 billion factory in Manteno, Illinois, start with 4,500 battery cells, each about the size of a college textbook.

For their biggest batteries, they will then stack, weld and seal the battery cells, cooling equipment and electronic controls inside a metal box resembling a 20-foot shipping container.

DuBois wouldn't give a precise estimate for how big Richardson's battery business will get. But he said he expects exponential growth.

Gil Quinones, ComEd's chief executive, is thinking big, too. "If the majority of our residential, commercial and industrial customers put in batteries, that's going to be a big win for the state," Quinones said.

"It could increase the capacity utilization for the grid we've already paid for, and have a chance to really put downward pressure on prices for everybody," Quinones said.

Because Richardson sees itself as an engineering specialist rather than a high-volume manufacturer, it will focus on customized storage systems for so-called microgrids. These are clusters of solar and wind operators that can either supply electricity directly to nearby users or buy and sell power as a group into the regional grid.

One of the company's first orders, for example, came from a microgrid serving seven remote communities in Alaska.

Illinois needs more batteries to unlock the full potential of its growing wind and solar capabilities, according to consultants to the Illinois Power Agency and other state regulators in a report last month.

Illinois will need 50 gigawatts of installed solar and wind capacity by 2050 to get close to its goal of using only non-carbon sources to generate electricity by then, the agencies said.

But regional grid operators still regard wind and solar as too intermittent. As a result, the state will be able to count only about 6 gigawatts of its renewable output as the baseload power electricity grids need to operate around the clock.

With additional batteries, Illinois could make its solar panels more productive and reliable by, for example, storing the power they generate during the day and then pumping it into the grid or nearby homes and businesses after the sun goes down.

In addition to more batteries, the Ameren service area downstate will need 9 gigawatts of out-of-state imports by 2045, according to the Sept. 24 consultant report to the IPA.

That's more than half the Ameren area's total requirement of 16 gigawatts of round-the-clock power in 2045.

The ComEd service area will need 4 gigawatts of out-of-state imports, or about 13% of its baseload requirement.

The imports will include power produced by new natural gas plants that Illinois ratepayers will help build in other states. Illinois can't build these plants because of the state's clean air rules.

Texas, with 18 gigawatts of installed, utility-scale battery storage capacity, and California, with 16 gigawatts, already are far ahead of Illinois, which has just 102 megawatts (or 0.1 gigawatts), according to Cleanview, a market research company based in Henderson, Colorado.

Illinois needs to quickly deploy more power sources of all kinds, since its total installed electricity capacity will have to double by 2050 to keep up with artificial intelligence, consultants for the IPA and other agencies reported on Sept. 24.

For Richardson Electronics, the batteries becoming indispensable components of clean power stations are just one part of a diverse product portfolio.

Arthur Richardson founded the company in 1947 to sell surplus military vacuum tubes to the fledgling television and radio industries. His son Edward took over in 1974 and continued adding engineering and technical support that the company still views as its greatest strength.

Edward's mother, Florence, worked at the company until she was 95 years old. Edward, who's now 84, said in an interview he's trying to beat his mother's record.

Today, Richardson makes components for everything from synthetic diamond and semiconductor manufacturing to CT medical scanners, microwave tubes, wind turbines and battery-powered locomotives.

This diverse portfolio generated $229 million in revenue for Richardson in the fiscal year that ended in May, the company said in a news release.

But it leaves Richardson with a factory that, from the inside, looks more like Santa's workshop than one big assembly line.

Endless white corridors separate the different business units. Workers using the ancient art of glass blowing to make vacuum tubes sit a few feet away from others making customizable visual displays for hospitals and airports.

It all looks chaotic. But Richardson insists that cross-pollination is one of the company's great strengths. The battery packs Richardson developed for railroad locomotives, he said, resemble and lay the groundwork for its utility-scale storage batteries, he said.

At 80 gigawatt-hours of battery-storage production capacity per year, industry leader Tesla already dwarfs what Richardson is planning. But even for Richardson, these battery-storage opportunities could generate an additional $1 billion in revenue, said Bobby Brooks, a Northland Securities stock analyst in Minneapolis.

For its utility-scale batteries, Richardson "is targeting smaller municipal, utility and data center applications ..., a niche market that larger competitors often ignore," Brooks wrote in a July 28 report.

As things stand now, Illinois could face shortages and even bigger price increases as soon as 2028, the IPA and other agencies reported in December.

The agencies will issue a draft of an Integrated Resource Plan on Nov. 16, just one day before regulators return to Springfield to talk about, among other things, whether and how to regulate electricity and water use at data centers.

The Integrated Resource Plan will cover not just how much electricity the state will need, but also how to generate it through new nuclear, fossil-fuel, renewable, and geothermal projects, how to incentivize it through long-term purchasing contracts, and how to ship it via additional transmission lines.

The plan could include more efficiency programs, like curtailing data center operations on hot days and paying residential customers to insulate their attics. But conservation won't be the main thrust.

"For Illinois to meet its broader decarbonization goals across sectors, we need to be in a growth mode here. The system needs to get bigger," said Nathan Miller, a consultant helping regulators develop the Integrated Resource Plan, on a Sept. 24 webcast.

"You can't just skinny and shimmy and reduce load to keep the system small."

The Integrated Resource Plan will spark a year-long debate not just over the agencies' conclusions but also over their research methods and assumptions.

For example, Scott Bernstein, co-founder of the environmental group Center for Neighborhood Technology, worries the agencies are basing their computer models on weather trends using only data collected from 1990 through 2024.

This methodology could underestimate El Niño's potential impact, Bernstein said. El Niño is a periodic Pacific Ocean warming trend that experts say could bring intense heat throughout the Northern Hemisphere in the summer of 2027, and more wildfires to the western U.S.

Since the state deregulated its electricity markets in 1997, agencies like the Illinois Commerce Commission have lacked the authority to impose higher rates to fund new power plants and efficiency programs. Last year, the legislature restored some of the agency's authority to build long-term procurement contracts into the rates customers are paying.

Tomc said he understands why clean air advocates don't want to delay closing natural gas power plants. But he said the state needs to seriously consider this option.

Such a delay would set back Gov. JB Pritzker's environmental aspirations.

In their Sept. 24 report, consultants for the IPA and other agencies analyzed delaying 23 gigawatts of fossil-fuel plant closings scheduled since Pritzker championed the Climate and Equitable Jobs Act in 2021.

These delays could affect an original list of up to 87 different fossil-fuel plants, or about a third of the state's total installed generating capacity.

About a third of the delays already have happened because PJM, the regional grid operator, has requested them, or because natural gas plants in Elwood and elsewhere have been sold to municipal electricity coops to which CEJA restrictions don't apply.

The precise air quality impact is hard to gauge since regulators could decide to simply stretch out rules that limit some natural gas plants to 30 hours of operation per year, as opposed to canceling the restraints altogether.

But delays in natural gas closings could dwarf the renewable progress Pritzker says has been made. In a Sept. 23 news release, he said he'd brought 2.4 gigawatts of renewable power online in Illinois since 2021.

The prospect of delayed natural gas closures brings back painful memories for activists like Mayra Mendez, executive director of Clean Power Lake County.

Mendez spent nine years pressing for the 2022 shutdown of an NRG Energy coal plant on the lakefront in downtown Waukegan, partly because studies showed a third of the city's children were then suffering from asthma.

Delaying the closing of a natural gas plant in nearby Zion will mean more harmful emissions in an area that still gets an 'F' or failing grade from the American Lung Association for lung-scarring ozone pollution, she said.

Mendez supports the so-called POWER Act, which, among other things, would speed up grid connections for data centers that build their own clean power stations when investing in Illinois.

"The state of Illinois has a duty to put guardrails on these data centers," Mendez said. "There should be no economic growth on the backs of communities that have suffered industrial burdens for many, many years."

Even if Illinois delays its natural gas plant closings, the state will need more batteries, and Richardson is rushing to provide them.

In May, the company agreed to provide engineering and marketing support for both utility- and neighborhood-scale batteries made by Gotion. Going forward, Gotion will act as one of three battery suppliers for Richardson.

Even with Gotion's low-cost batteries, Richardson couldn't begin to compete without hefty tax incentives and other subsidies.

These include a 40% federal tax credit for batteries made in former coal-reliant areas like Kane County, three different kinds of state subsidies and rebates from ComEd for providing distributed generation.

By 2045, the downstate Ameren area will need 8 gigawatts of batteries capable of supplying the grid for four hours to provide reliable service, consultants for the IPA and other state agencies said last month.

ComEd's northern Illinois service area, meanwhile, will need 12 gigawatts of four-hour battery storage by 2045, the consultants said.

But batteries also run intermittently, so the ComEd service area can count only about 8 gigawatts of its battery capacity as baseload, or round-the-clock, power, according to the report.

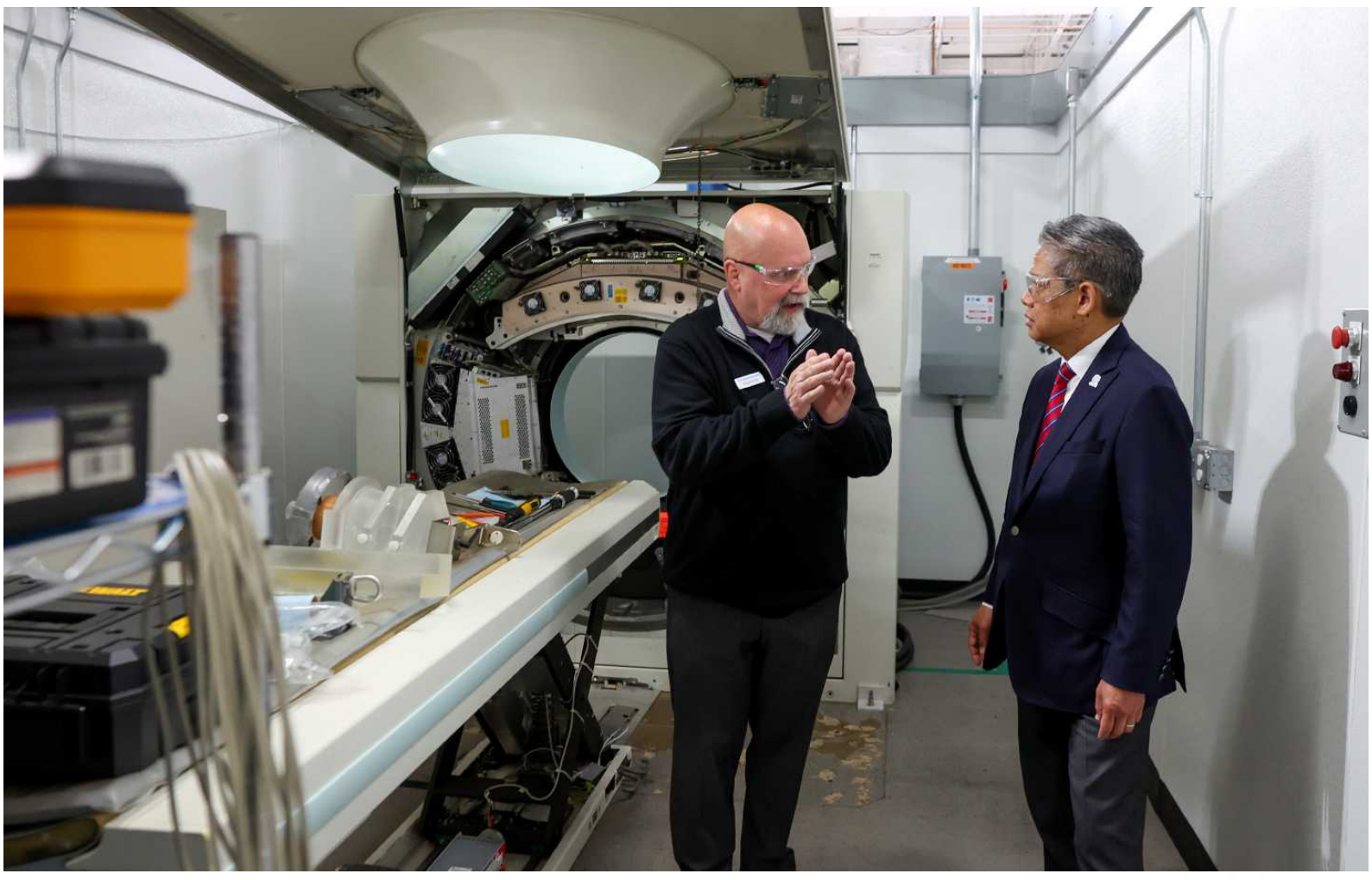
Bloomberg New Energy Finance, a New York-based research group, predicts global battery-storage deployments will grow 41% in 2026 to 158 gigawatts as the average price falls by 31%. Long-term utility-scale batteries, or those lasting six hours or more, will contribute just 2 gigawatts of that total, mostly in China, since the technology is still in its infancy.

In the U.S., high costs and restrictions on Chinese-made components are slowing battery-storage growth, according to BNEF. Battery storage systems cost $219 per kilowatt-hour in the U.S. compared to $73 in China, BNEF said.

Richardson, the company's chief executive, said he's eager to help Illinois and the rest of the U.S. play catch-up. By boosting Illinois, he could help double the size of his company.

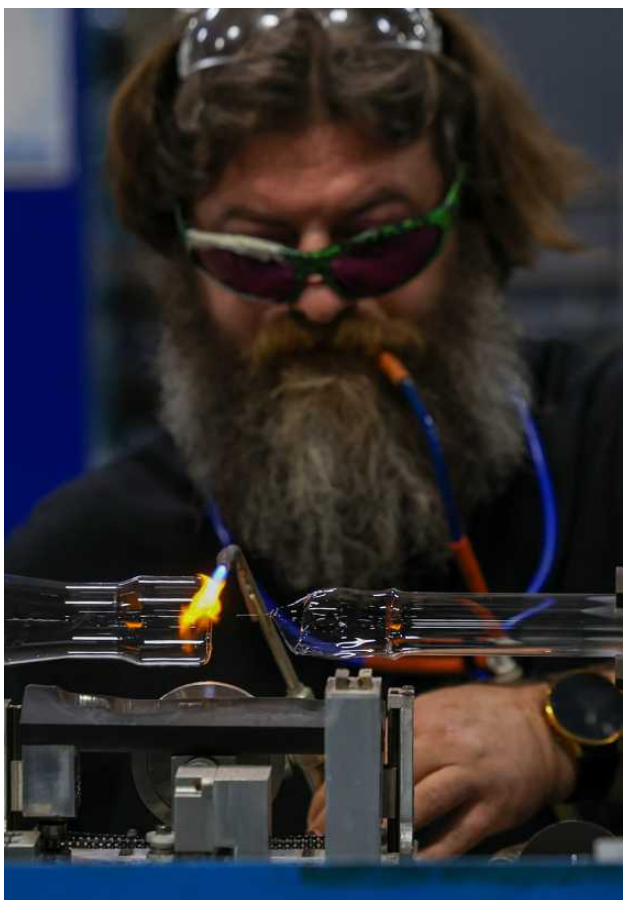
"What we want to do is to grow about 15% a year. If we put that on top of where we are, in five years it'd be $500 million (in annual revenue). I'd be quite happy with that."

John Lippert is a freelancer.



Greg Kinney, executive vice president of operations, talks about the testing of Computed Tomography CT scan tubes with Gil Quinones, the CEO of ComEd, right, during a tour of Richardson Electronics on Monday in La Fox. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

Angel Cervantes, left, and Omar Buitron, right, put together filter boxes at Richardson Electronics on Monday in La Fox.



Glassblower Pat King makes glass tubes at Richardson Electronics on Monday in La Fox.

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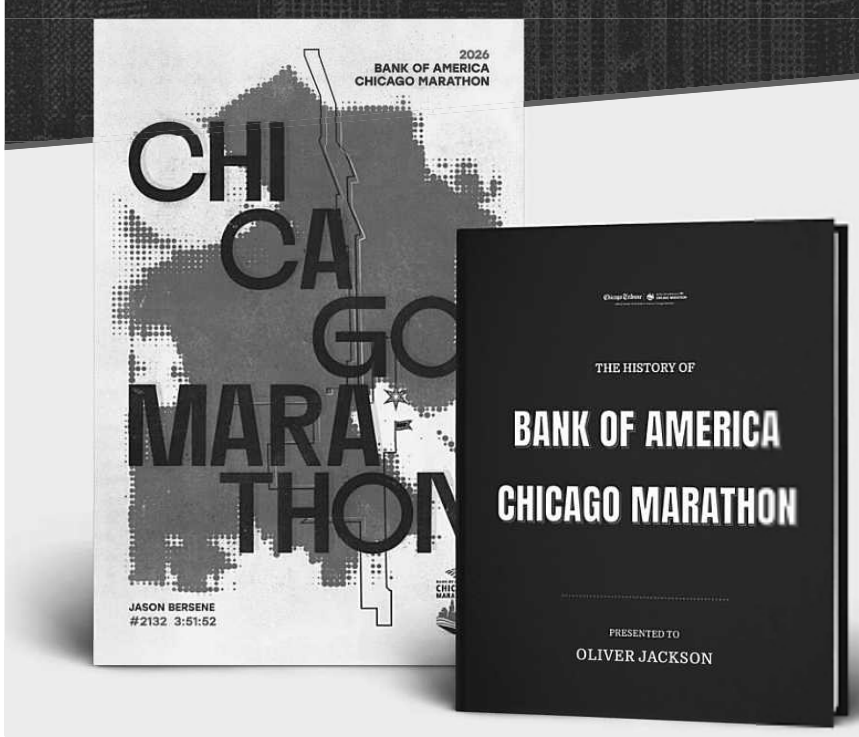

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Billionaire donor gives $150K to school board president candidate

By Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Jessica Biggs attends a forum for Chicago Board of Education president candidates at Malcolm X College on Oct. 5. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Billionaire Democratic donor Michael Sacks donated $150,000 to school board president candidate Jessica Biggs, the largest individual contribution to date in the November race, state records show.

Sacks, who served as an adviser to former Mayor Rahm Emanuel, has become a lightning rod for criticism from the progressive Chicago Teachers Union and its allies, who have decried the influence of the ultrawealthy in the race.

The donation, made Oct. 2, came the same day Biggs received a $100,000 contribution from Paul Finnegan, a philanthropist and private equity executive.

Three candidates are running for Chicago's first elected school board president: Biggs, a current elected school board member; former CTU deputy political director Hilario Dominguez; and attorney Victor Henderson.

The race is drawing heavy spending from CTU, other unions and pro-school choice groups opposed to CTU's influence, all looking to shape the 21-member body that oversees Chicago Public Schools.

Sacks, the CEO of asset management firm GCM Grosvenor, has long been a behind-the-scenes fixture in Chicago politics. He chaired the local host committee for the Democratic National Convention in Chicago in 2024, and has also helped advance various Democratic causes in Illinois, including gun control and evidence-based school funding.

Last month, Sacks contributed $3.4 million to the independent expenditure committee affiliated with Common Ground Collective — a group that has opposed the influence of CTU and Mayor Brandon Johnson, a former union organizer. The super PAC has spent more than $2.6 million in the school board races so far, including more than $1.7 million on mailers and digital ads targeting CTU-backed candidates.

In a statement addressing his contribution to Biggs, Sacks cited his support for other Democratic lawmakers.

"I've been proud to support Democratic women running for office in Chicago, including Cook County Board President Toni Preckwinkle and State's Attorney Kim Foxx, and I'm equally proud to join the Chicago Federation of Labor, SEIU, former CPS CEO Janice Jackson and broad coalition of labor unions and elected officials" backing Biggs, Sacks said through a spokesperson.

Still, Sacks has come under increasing scrutiny from CTU, which denounced his "mind-boggling spending" in an email last month. Union leadership has blamed him for policies they say hurt Black and Latino neighborhoods, including the 2013 mass school closures under Emanuel's administration. Sacks has repeatedly said he opposes school closures.

"It doesn't just create an uneven playing field, it undermines the very values of democracy that so many have fought for," Crystal Gardner, the union's political director, said in a statement last month criticizing his spending.

Finnegan, the chairman of Madison Dearborn Partners, declined to comment. He has also donated to candidates in several district-level races and gave $419,000 to Common Ground's super PAC in May.

To date, Biggs has raised about $729,000 this year, though more precise figures will be available later this week, when quarterly campaign finance reports are due. In a statement, Biggs pointed to her union endorsements and "the board coalition we've built in this campaign."

"I'm also grateful to the hundreds of individual donors who have invested in my vision for a CPS focused on student success, not political games," Biggs said.

Common Ground has not contributed directly to Biggs' campaign, but its affiliated super PAC has spent just over $1 million on ads targeting Dominguez, who is endorsed by CTU. The Illinois Network of Charter Schools, a pro-school-choice group, also spent $450,000 on an ad opposing Dominguez.

Dominguez has raised $963,000, almost entirely from CTU. So far, the union has put the bulk of its resources behind the former organizer. CTU spent $4.3 million in the 2024 election, more than any other group, according to a Chalkbeat analysis. Union leadership attempted to raise member dues earlier this year, in part to bolster political spending.

Henderson has no major endorsements and has largely self-funded his campaign, raising $671,000, including $501,000 in loans.

LEGAL NOTICE

VOTE EARLY OCTOBER 19 - NOVEMBER 2, 2026

Official notice is hereby given, by Cook County Clerk Monica Gordon, that EARLY VOTING for the Gubernatorial Election being held on Tuesday, November 3, 2026 will be held at the following locations: This notice applies only to SUBURBAN Cook County.

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★

M - F	Oct. 19-23	9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
M - F	Oct. 26 - Nov. 2	9 a.m. to 7 p.m.
SAT	Oct. 24 and Oct. 31	9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
SUN	Oct. 25 and Nov. 1	10 a.m. to 4 p.m.

●

M - F	Oct. 19 - Nov. 2	9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
SAT	Oct. 24 and Oct. 31	9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
SUN	Oct. 25 and Nov. 1	10 a.m. to 4 p.m.

Mail Ballot Drop Boxes and grace period registration offered at all Early Voting locations.

North of Eisenhower Expressway (I-290)

★ **Arlington Heights Village Hall**
33 S. Arlington Heights Rd.
Arlington Heights, IL 60005

● **Barrington Hills Village Hall**
112 Algonquin Rd.
Barrington Hills, IL 60010

● **Bellwood Village Hall**
3200 Washington Blvd.
Bellwood, IL 60104

● **Des Plaines Public Library**
1501 Ellinwood St.
Des Plaines, IL 60016

● **Elk Grove Village - Village Hall**
901 Wellington Ave.
Elk Grove Village, IL 60007

● **Elmwood Park - Parks & Recreation Department**
2 W. Conti Pkwy.
Elmwood Park, IL 60707

★ **Evanston - Robert Crown Community Center**
2100 Ridge Ave.
Evanston, IL 60201

● **Franklin Park Village Hall**
9500 Belmont Ave.
Franklin Park, IL 60131

● **Glenview Village Hall**
2500 E. Lake Ave.
Glenview, IL 60025

● **Hoffman Estates Village Hall**
1900 Hassell Rd.
Hoffman Estates, IL 60169

● **Maywood Courthouse - Whitcomb Building - *NEW***
1311 Maybrook Sq.
Maywood, IL 60153

● **Maywood Public Library District**
121 S. 5th Ave.
Maywood, IL 60153

● **Melrose Park Village Hall**
1000 N. 25th Ave.
Melrose Park, IL 60160

● **Morton Grove - American Legion Memorial Civic Center**
6140 Dempster St.
Morton Grove, IL 60053

● **Mount Prospect Village Hall**
50 S. Emerson St.
Mount Prospect, IL 60056

● **Niles Village Hall**
1000 Civic Center Dr.
Niles, IL 60714

● **Norridge - Estelle Sieb Community Center - *NEW***
7774 W. Irving Park Rd.
Norridge, IL 60706

● **Northbrook Village Hall**
1225 Cedar Lane
Northbrook, IL 60062

● **Oak Park Village Hall**
123 Madison St.
Oak Park, IL 60302

● **Palatine Public Library - *NEW***
700 N. North Ct.
Palatine, IL 60067

● **Park Ridge - Centennial Activity Center - *NEW***
100 S. Western Ave.
Park Ridge, IL 60068

● **Rolling Meadows Courthouse**
2121 Euclid Ave.
Rolling Meadows, IL 60008

● **Schaumburg - Trickster Art Gallery**
190 S. Roselle Rd.
Schaumburg, IL 60193

● **Skokie Courthouse**
5600 W. Old Orchard Rd.
Skokie, IL 60077

● **Skokie - Oakton College**
7701 N. Lincoln Ave.
Skokie, IL 60077

● **Streamwood Village Hall (Rear Garage)**
351 E. Irving Park Rd.
Streamwood, IL 60107

● **Wheeling - Chamber Park - *NEW***
131 N. Wolf Rd.
Wheeling, IL 60090

● **Wilmette - Park District Community Rec. Center**
3000 Glenview Rd.
Wilmette, IL 60091

★ **County Clerk's Main Office**
69 W. Washington, Pedway
Chicago, IL 60602

South of Eisenhower Expressway (I-290)

● **Alsip Village Hall**
4500 W. 123rd St.
Alsip, IL 60803

● **Berwyn - Pavek Recreation Center**
6501 31st St.
Berwyn, IL 60402

● **Bridgeview Courthouse**
10220 S. 76th Ave.
Bridgeview, IL 60455

● **Brookfield Village Hall**
8820 Brookfield Ave.
Brookfield, IL 60513

● **Burbank - Prairie Trails Library District**
8449 S. Moody Ave.
Burbank, IL 60459

★ **Calumet City Public Library**
660 S. Manistee Ave.
Calumet City, IL 60409

● **Calumet Township Community Center**
12633 S. Ashland Ave.
Calumet Park, IL 60827

● **Cicero Community Center**
2250 49th Ave.
Cicero, IL 60804

★ **Cicero PSO Building**
5410 W. 34th St.
Cicero, IL 60804

● **Crestwood Civic Center**
13820 S. Cicero Ave.
Crestwood, IL 60445

● **Harvey - Gloria Taylor Hall**
14821 Broadway Ave.
Harvey, IL 60426

● **Lemont Township Community Center**
16300 Alba St.
Lemont, IL 60439

● **Lynwood - Senior Youth Center**
21460 Lincoln Hwy.
Lynwood, IL 60411

● **Township of Lyons**
6404 Joliet Rd.
Countryside, IL 60525

● **Lyons Village Hall**
4200 S. Lawndale Ave.
Lyons, IL 60534

● **Markham Courthouse**
16501 S. Kedzie Ave.
Markham, IL 60428

● **Matteson Community Center**
20642 Matteson Ave.
Matteson, IL 60443

● **Oak Forest City Hall**
15440 S. Central Ave.
Oak Forest, IL 60452

★ **Oak Lawn Public Library**
9427 S. Raymond Ave.
Oak Lawn, IL 60453

★ **Orland Park Civic Center**
14750 S. Ravinia Ave.
Orland Park, IL 60462

● **Palos Heights Recreation Center**
6601 W. 127th St.
Palos Heights, IL 60463

● **Park Forest Village Hall**
350 Victory Dr.
Park Forest, IL 60466

● **Prairie State College**
202 S. Halsted St.
Chicago Heights, 60411

● **Stickney-Forest View Library**
6800 43rd St.
Stickney, IL 60402

● **South Holland - Thornton Township Hall - *NEW***
333 E. 162nd St.
South Holland, IL 60473

● **Steger - Elmer Joyce Memorial Fire Station**
3320 Emerald Ave.
Steger, IL 60411

● **Tinley Park Village Hall**
16250 S. Oak Park Ave.
Tinley Park, IL 60477

● **Universal School**
9210 S. Octavia Ave.
Bridgeview, IL 60455

Six Flags Great America roller coaster closed after Georgia death

By Joseph States
PIONEER PRESS

Six Flags has shut down nine roller coasters in its parks across the country, including the Raging Bull in Gurnee, after one person died and several others were injured at Six Flags Over Georgia on Monday.

The incident at Six Flags Over Georgia is under investigation by the Cobb County Police Department major crimes unit, The Associated Press reported.

According to a Six Flags Entertainment Corp. spokesperson, attractions at parks similar to the one in Austell, Georgia, were closed "out of an abundance of caution."

While park officials did not identify the roller coaster involved in the incident, local TV stations showed video of passengers being evacuated from the Goliath. Despite the name, the Georgia coaster is not the same as the wooden roller coaster Goliath at Six Flags Great America in Gurnee. It is instead an all-steel "hyper coaster" — meaning it has a drop of at least 200 feet.

All nine of the coasters Six Flags announced would be temporarily shut down are also considered hyper coasters. Park officials have not said when the rides may reopen.

Raging Bull stands at 202 feet tall and more than 5,000 feet long, according to the Six Flags website. Introduced in 1999 and manufactured by the same company behind Georgia's Goliath, the 300-second ride feels "just like a bull trying to shake you off his back."

Beyond the Raging Bull, other rides shut down include another Goliath at Six Flags Magic Mountain in California, Nitro at Six Flags Great Adventure in New Jersey, Leviathan and Behemoth at Canada's Wonderland in Ontario, Fury 325 and Thunder Striker at Carowinds in North Carolina, and Orion and Diamondback at Kings Island in Ohio.

Officials did not confirm how the rider died, nor how the others were injured or their medical conditions after the incident at Six Flags Over Georgia.

"We are deeply saddened by the guest incident at our park today," the spokesperson said, adding that the company is providing support to guests and staff who were impacted.

Goliath, which was opened in 2006, reaches a top speed of 70 mph with a height of 200 feet, according to the park's website. During about 3 ½ minutes, riders "navigate through razor-sharp turns and soar over colossal hills," the website says.

Lisa Cupid, Cobb County Board of Commissioners chairwoman, said the next of kin of the rider killed have been notified.

"I cannot imagine the horror the patrons and employees witnessed today, and my heart aches for the family who lost a loved one," Cupid said. "We are all grappling with how something so devastating could happen at a place that has given generations of families such happy memories."

OTHER INCIDENTS

The death would be at least the seventh at the Georgia park, including one in 2006 in which a man had a likely heart attack on the Goliath coaster, according to the Doan Law Firm, which tallies amusement park accidents and represents victims.

It also comes less than two weeks after Six Flags Magic Mountain in Southern California announced the retirement of its famous X2 roller coaster following lawsuits alleging serious brain injuries caused by the ride. The park settled one wrongful-death lawsuit from the family of a 22-year-old man who died after riding the coaster in 2022.

Locally, Raging Bull has been connected with at least one death. In 2003, an 11-year-old girl collapsed and later died after riding the coaster, although it was ultimately determined she had died from a heart condition. She had been seeing a cardiologist and had an enlarged heart, officials testified during a coroner's inquest.

And in 2017, Superman: Ultimate Flight was temporarily shut down after a 50-year-old Chicago man collapsed after exiting the ride, later dying at a hospital of a "natural death," according to the Lake County coroner's office. Despite the closure of Raging Bull, Six Flags Great America will remain open through its usual fall festivities before closing for the winter on Nov. 1.

The Associated Press contributed to this report.

ELECTION

from Page A1

Evanston Mayor Daniel Biss, left, and the Rev. John Elleson pose at a 9th Congressional District candidate forum at the Skokie Public Library on Sept. 24. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE**

Asked on Sept. 29 at a Chicago Tribune Editorial Board meeting about the divisions between candidates who might identify as a "normie Democrat" versus a democratic socialist, Biss responded: "I'm going to plant my flag as a normie leftist. How about that?"

And asked where he stood on the fight between those factions, he added: "I oppose it. I actually mean that seriously."

Biss, 49, noted that he sits on the progressive side of many policy issues but also believes in a big-tent party.

A former assistant math professor at the University of Chicago and former state senator, Biss ran for governor in 2018, losing the Democratic primary to now-Gov. JB Pritzker.

Since the 9th District primary, Biss has pitched himself as someone with big ideas for government who's also willing to stand with protesters in the street against President Donald Trump's administration. Trump's agenda, including immigration enforcement in the Chicago region, has been his main foil.

At a League of Women Voters forum at the Skokie Public Library in late September, Biss, as he has done before on the campaign trail, called the administration's actions an "emergency." In what may be a signal of less voter interest in the general election contest than in the Democratic primary, only about 100 people attended the forum, a few dozen of whom were high school students attending for their government or U.S. history classes.

"We are seeing masked men abduct people off our streets," Biss said at the forum, referencing a September incident in which federal agents briefly detained and injured an Evanston man, a U.S. citizen, after mistaking him for someone else, according to the city's police. Police said they requested an ambulance, the Pioneer Press reported.

Like many progressive candidates in Illinois this year, Biss has called for abolishing U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement. In his interview with the editorial board, he questioned the need for a "quasi-military" interior law enforcement agency to handle what are mostly civil immigration matters.

"It's obscene, and it makes a mockery of the core principles of what this country claims to be about," Biss said of immigration enforcement in the Trump era.

Elleson, a 64-year-old resident of Arlington Heights, has made his career as a pastor and leads nearby Lakewood Chapel. He has never held public office, and in 2018, as the Republican nominee in the same district, he lost to Schakowsky 73% to 27%.

A supporter of many of Trump's policies, including ending taxes on tips, Elleson tells voters he's "running for the forgotten." Although the national debt has risen by more than $11.5 trillion during Trump's two terms, Elleson said it must be tackled, suggesting he would cut waste in defense funding and prioritize Social Security for the elderly over people who use it as an "unemployment check." He also said he would like to "take a look at" Medicare and other drivers of spending.

Elleson says he's "not into the socialism thing," suggesting that lower taxes will incentivize hard work, and he worries Biss could be pulled further left in Congress.

He has repeatedly invoked Sheridan Gorman, the Loyola University Chicago student authorities say was killed in March by José Medina, a Venezuelan national who the federal government has said was living in the U.S. unlawfully. Her case has become a lightning rod for conservative politicians opposed to so-called sanctuary city laws. Medina, who is in custody as he awaits trial, faces 18 felony counts, including murder, and he has pleaded not guilty.

On immigration, Elleson told the voter forum that if people are "breaking the law, they shouldn't be here," but he also said he personally supports individual undocumented immigrants in his congregation, including by writing letters on their behalf to immigration courts.

"They always ask you for letters, as a pastor — how you could turn that down?" Elleson said in an interview. "They're usually people of color, different nationality, and I like that. I do. And they're good people. They're the kind of people that you want in the United States."

"But when it comes to government, you gotta have laws," he said.

Elleson hasn't reported raising any money for his campaign and said he isn't soliciting contributions because voters may be struggling financially, and because it is difficult for a Republican to win the district.

Beyond the seat's long Democratic history, the district's boundaries give the party an enormous advantage, making it difficult for any Republican to break through. Schakowsky won by 37 points in her last election; she first won the seat in 1998, and late U.S. Rep. Sidney Yates held it for nearly a half century before that, with a brief gap in the 1960s.

Biss raised $115,000 from April through June, far less than the more than $2.5 million he raised during the competitive primary. He had about $262,000 on hand at the beginning of July, according to the latest federal records. New filings are due Oct. 15.

Leaning into many voters' skepticism of artificial intelligence and data centers, Biss has also put forward a multipart plan to regulate the industry. He has called for a national moratorium on data center construction and said he opposes a small proposed data center in Evanston. That goes further than Pritzker, who has urged lawmakers to pass stricter regulations but has not pushed for an all-out pause.

"It's exciting that states — and local governments, even — across the country are doing a whole bunch of stuff on data centers, but what that does is it points to the need for federal action, and without that, I think we're going to have state and local actors in a kind of lose-lose competition with each other," Biss said in an interview earlier this month.

Biss has also called for export controls on chips, a "regime of inspectors" in AI labs and stronger disclosure of "unsafe things" occurring in those labs.

Elleson said he is concerned about competition with China in the AI race and that data centers should supply their own electricity, though he said at the forum that he didn't know what guardrails for AI companies would be most suitable.

On healthcare, Biss supports "Medicare for All" but — given the costs associated with that policy — has suggested expanding it in steps in the meantime, such as by opening it to younger age groups. He has also called climate change an emergency.

Elleson has said Medicare should be primarily for older Americans and has suggested that immigrants are straining healthcare resources.

"Medicare for All — I think we really need to think about that. I'm for immigrants, I really am, our church — we have a lot of them," Elleson said. "When I saw ER rooms full, and someone tried to go in there that's paid taxes all their life, and would leave after eight, nine hours later because they didn't get access, they didn't get care, because it was full of other people — now, I'm for, like I say, all of them — but I don't think that's right."

If elected, Biss said, he's eyeing a seat on the Energy and Commerce Committee, where Schakowsky is currently a member, because of its overlap with healthcare, climate and consumer protection issues.

The American Israel Public Affairs Committee loomed large in the Democratic primary. Biss and other candidates criticized Fine, the state senator, for support from AIPAC associates. The issue became a hot-button one in races nationwide, but it carried more salience in the 9th District, which has long been represented by a Jewish member of Congress, a tradition Biss, who is Jewish, would continue.

"I believe what I believe really strongly on this issue, and I care deeply about it," Biss said when asked whether he had burned bridges in Congress by taking a hard line during the primary against AIPAC, which supports military aid to Israel. Members of Congress are increasingly thinking twice about automatically supporting Israel militarily without restrictions, he said.

"It's really obvious that things are changing dramatically on this issue ... and they should change," he said.

On redistricting, Biss has said Democrats should match Republicans' push for partisan gerrymandering. Nine states have new House districts ahead of the midterms since Trump urged changes to benefit Republicans and some Democrat-led states followed suit, with Republicans poised to net up to nine new seats from the changes, according to The Associated Press.

"I hate partisan gerrymandering. We should ban it nationally," Biss wrote in his Substack newsletter in May.

"But," he continued, bolding the word, "If Republicans are playing by one set of rules while Democrats force themselves to play by another, that's not a functional democracy."

Elleson has faced scrutiny in past campaigns. He was charged in a 2001 Hawaii felony theft case that was later dismissed and expunged, the Daily Herald reported earlier this year. Elleson said the case stemmed from his work at a faith-based rehabilitation program and involved pooling food stamp benefits for clients as a group rather than individually.

A court agreement at the time, shared by Elleson with the Tribune, said the rehab program he led would pay $49,000 in restitution and that neither Elleson nor his wife personally benefited from the food stamp overpayments.

"It was never anything personally I did wrong," he said in his recent interview. "I was never, never accused of taking any money."

During Elleson's 2018 campaign, an ad that aired on CNN in the Chicago area showed popular Texas televangelist Joel Osteen in a video encouraging viewers to visit Elleson's church, followed by an on-screen message that Elleson was running for Congress, the Tribune reported then. A spokesperson for Osteen's church said at the time that Osteen had not endorsed Elleson and didn't know about the commercials, the Tribune reported. Elleson declined to comment on the ad last week.

Elleson acknowledges the general assessment that the 9th District is a tough race for a Republican to win.

"OK, we know that, but that doesn't mean you're not serious," he said. "Serious is how hard you work and what you've done."

Biss, for his part, said that in a time when politicians are becoming too risk-averse, he won't worry about reelection.

"I'm not going to be cautious. I'm not going to be looking over my shoulder and wondering if my next reelection is going to be a little more uncomfortable if I do this complex, imperfect thing that moves the country forward on balance," Biss told the Tribune Editorial Board. "I'm going to be focused on helping our government get unstuck."

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EDITORIALS

Illinois House endorsements in districts 78, 80, 81, 83, 84, 85, 97, 98, 101, 104, 111, 112, 114, 118

Today, the editorial board turns its attention to contested races in the Illinois House of Representatives. This is our fourth and final batch of endorsements; we are endorsing statewide.

78TH DISTRICT

State Rep. Camille Lilly is the Democratic incumbent representing this West Side and west suburban district. Lilly has served as a representative for more than 16 years. She is a reliable rank-and-file Democrat.

Randolph Jemison

It was encouraging to see this election contested. We endorsed her Libertarian opponent in 2020, the last time she was challenged. We found ourselves impressed by Lilly's opponent, Julian-Jahleel Randolph Jemison, a 29-year-old University of Chicago graduate. He comes off as open-minded while having a limited government bent. ""My concern is whether government is using existing revenue effectively and whether additional taxation is actually necessary to achieve the intended result," he told us, noting separately that he's not automatically opposed to all taxes and fees. This will be an uphill battle, a fresh perspective that is skeptical of the status quo is what Springfield needs.

Julian-Jahleel Randolph Jemison is endorsed.

80TH DISTRICT

State Rep. Anthony DeLuca, 56, is the incumbent Democrat in this south suburban district. DeLuca is a former mayor of south suburban Chicago Heights, and we applauded him for introducing legislation in the spring to prohibit municipalities from taxing companies based on the number of workers they employ (see: head tax).

DeLuca

We thanked DeLuca at the time for attempting to rein in Mayor Brandon Johnson's worst impulses, and we remain grateful for the initiative. He's a moderate Democrat and has consistently shown he is willing to think independently. "I will not support higher taxes and throwing more money at a broken system in need of reform, because if we did, it would be a short-term fix without long-term reform and financial stability," he told us in response to our question as to whether he'd support a millionaire tax, though he did signal openness to the idea.

This November, DeLuca again squares off against Republican Adam Beaty, his 2024 opponent. We like Beaty's law enforcement background, especially given the focus on Illinois' public safety challenges and the needed reforms to electronic monitoring. Still, we see no reason to change our endorsement of DeLuca.

Anthony DeLuca is endorsed.

81ST DISTRICT

State Rep. Anne Stava, 40, is a progressive Democrat who has represented this west- and southwest-suburban district since 2019. We admired her for refusing in 2019 to vote for disgraced former House Speaker Michael Madigan, showing an independent streak worthy of respect. But we do not agree with her tax views, namely her support of a millionaire tax and a graduated income tax.

Stava

Laura Hois, 67, is a longtime Downers Grove resident who gives us every reason to believe she would be a strong fiscal conservative if elected. We align with Hois' instincts on taxes and spending. But her anti-woke positioning is a tough sell in a part of Chicagoland that votes reliably Democrat. Stava is certainly to our left on some important policies, but Hois is too conservative for this district.

Anne Stava is endorsed.

83RD DISTRICT

State Rep. Matt Hanson is the Democratic incumbent representing this Fox River Valley district that includes all or parts of Batavia, Geneva, Aurora and Oswego. We appreciate his support for a school cell phone ban bill, which Gov. JB Pritzker signed in July.

Hanson

The GOP challenger, Jesse Rodriguez, 63, is a lifelong Aurora resident with a compelling personal story. A Navy veteran with experience in the insurance business, Rodriguez takes a thoughtful approach to ethics reform, opposes tax hikes and supports tax-credit education scholarships. He goes too far by supporting a return to cash bail, which we consider a settled issue, and we differ with his views on gun rights.

We endorsed Hanson in the 2024 primary and continue our support.

Matt Hanson is endorsed.

84TH DISTRICT

The House seat for the west suburban 84th District is open after state Rep. Stephanie Kifowit decided not to run for reelection. Vying to become her Democratic successor is Saba Haider, a DuPage County Board member who has a business providing wellness services, and has vowed to "make billionaires and corporations pay their fair share in taxes."

Scopa

Brian Scopa, 48, is a retired Navy commander whose critique of Illinois government can be summed up by this memorable line he shared with us: "We pay luxury taxes for economy services."

He distinguishes himself from the more tough-on-crime wing of his party. We were particularly interested in his views on public safety. "We don't need to return to cash bail to reform the shortcomings of the SAFE-T and Pre-Trial Fairness act," he told us. We think he'd bring good common sense and fiscal restraint to Springfield.

Brian Scopa is endorsed.

85TH DISTRICT

The race for the 85th District, which covers much of Will County, is a rematch from 2024. And 2022. Democratic incumbent state Rep. Dagmara "Dee" Avelar once again will take on Republican candidate Chris Metcalfe.

Avelar

We haven't heard much from either candidate. Avelar supported Pritzker's unsuccessful graduated income tax proposal in 2020 and tends to be to the left of this board on issues. On gerrymandering, Metcalfe proposed in 2024 that "only RECTANGLES be allowed for districts," per a Chicago Sun-Times questionnaire response. While we also enjoy a good rectangle, this is not a serious solution. In spite of our misgivings about Avelar's fiscal policy instincts, she is the more viable candidate.

Dagmara "Dee" Avelar is endorsed.

97TH DISTRICT

The race for disgraced former state Rep. Harry Benton's 97th District seat is one of the most closely watched Statehouse races in the 2026 election.

Shanahan

Democratic state Rep. Jessica Dixon Heitman, 43, was appointed to fill the seat after Benton resigned. She's a lobbyist and the granddaughter of the late U.S. Sen. Alan Dixon, and has received much criticism as the Democratic Party's hand-selected candidate. She also has faced scrutiny over her time working in Benton's office, where she worked as a contract employee alongside the young female staffer who reported inappropriate behavior by Benton. "We don't just need to change the culture in Springfield. We need stronger laws and a process people can trust," she told us. She signaled openness to House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch's millionaire tax and opposition to a constitutional amendment for pension reform.

Her opponent, Republican Gabby Shanahan, 35, is a smart, tough fiscal conservative who earned our endorsement when she last ran for this seat in 2024, losing a close race to Benton. She's solid on ethics reform and empowering the legislative watchdog, and does not mince words when it comes to her opponent, pointing out that Dixon Heitman has received hundreds of thousands of dollars from Speaker Welch's political operation, which spent about $1.4 million supporting Benton's 2024 reelection.

Shanahan's platform addresses the need to improve the electronic monitoring system while supporting policies that enable people convicted of crimes to find meaningful work once they've served their time, a sensible position. Most importantly, she's an opponent of new taxes, vowing instead to address the steep burden taxpayers here face. Illinois needs a clean break from Benton.

Gabby Shanahan is endorsed.

98TH DISTRICT

Republican Nona Parker, 66, is a Joliet-based pastor running on an anti-tax hike platform. "Illinois government must work as hard at restoring public trust as it does to raise taxes!" she told us. Hard to argue with that, though we found her positions on other issues decidedly less fully baked. Meanwhile, we have been critical of incumbent state Rep. Natalie Manley for voting for higher taxes.

Nona Parker is endorsed.

101ST DISTRICT

In the race to represent this southern Illinois district, we've endorsed Republican state Rep. Chris Miller in the past. But his attendance at the Jan. 6, 2021, rally in Washington, his subsequent characterization of that day as a peaceful demonstration and his reluctance to acknowledge Joe Biden's 2020 election victory give us heartburn, even five-plus years later.

Miller

Running against Miller is Democrat Douglas Fagan, 53. The positions Fagan shared with us raise serious concerns about his readiness to serve in the General Assembly, as he offered almost no actionable proposals on pensions, ethics, public safety or transportation.

Miller is certainly a staunch fiscal conservative. We hope the presence of a Democratic challenger, after two uncontested election cycles, serves as a tempering influence for Miller, and that he sticks to Illinois' many challenges rather than turning his attention toward D.C.

Chris Miller is endorsed.

104TH DISTRICT

Incumbent Republican state Rep. Brandun Schweizer, 44, is a former Marine who was appointed in 2023 to represent this east-central Illinois district, which covers parts of Vermilion and Champaign counties. Schweizer has been a principled, service-oriented state lawmaker. We appreciate his sensible approach to criminal justice. "Whether someone remains in custody should not depend solely on the size of their bank account, but it should depend on the danger they pose to victims, law enforcement and the community," he told us. While we appreciate his fiscal restraint and opposition to tax hikes, we were disappointed by his opposition to a constitutional amendment on pensions. He did, however, acknowledge the benefit of tradeoffs on this front, saying, "a negotiated solution of shared sacrifice would be good for the state, but difficult in this supercharged political climate."

His opponent, Mary Catherine Roberson, works as director of constituent services in Danville for U.S. Rep. Robin Kelly; this clearly has given her a window into taking care of folks in the district. We don't like her apparent opposition to the federal tax-credit program for K-12 scholarships, and we differ on some other issues.

Brandun Schweizer is endorsed.

111TH DISTRICT

Republican state Rep. Amy Elik of Alton has represented this Metro East district since 2021. A certified public accountant with a fiscally conservative approach to government, Elik has earned our enthusiastic endorsements in the past. We appreciate her commitment to financial accountability.

Elik

Her Democratic challenger, Alton Alderwoman Rosetta "Rosie" Brown, 65, brings local government experience and a thoughtful approach to public safety. But we found her difficult to pin down on fiscal matters, particularly pension reform and the proposed millionaire tax. Elik remains our choice.

Amy Elik is endorsed.

112TH DISTRICT

Democratic incumbent state Rep. Katie Stuart, 55, has held this seat since 2017, representing a district that covers much of Metro East, including her hometown of Edwardsville. She's done good work protecting working mothers and stiffening drug laws and has won our endorsement in the past.

Ford

Her opponent, Republican Jimmy Ford, 51, is a longtime repo man. About a decade ago, he made national headlines when he repossessed an elderly couple's car, then raised thousands of dollars to pay it off and bring it back to them. He's one of the more interesting candidates about whom we've written. He's a small business owner, a perspective that can only improve the balance of power in Springfield. Ford is highly regarded by House Republican leadership. We admire his authenticity and think he could be a breath of fresh air for this district.

Jimmy Ford is endorsed.

114TH DISTRICT

Republican Rep. Kevin Schmidt has represented this Metro East district since pulling off a shocking upset in 2022, unseating Democrat LaToya Greenwood.

Schmidt

Schmidt is a chiropractor focused on bringing jobs and investment to his district.

His Democratic opponent, George McClellan Jr., is a former assistant chief of the East St. Louis Fire Department and a longtime nurse. He strikes us as a credible challenger with substantial experience in public service and a focus on jobs and affordable health care. Yet Schmidt has the advantage of legislative experience and a clearly articulated commitment to fiscal restraint.

Kevin Schmidt is endorsed.

118TH DISTRICT

Republican State Rep. Scott Doody, 63, was appointed in June to fill this southern Illinois House seat after former State Rep. Paul Jacobs was appointed to the 59th District Senate seat.

He's now running for a full term against Democrat Homer "Chip" Markel.

Doody is a reasonable Republican, acknowledging that "not all aspects" of the SAFE-T Act are bad, and urges dialogue with "attorneys, law enforcement and victims to amend it so it works for all of Illinois." Doody, a former radio host, also supports school choice and opposes a millionaire tax, two notches in his favor. We were impressed by Doody ahead of the Republican primary when he told us he "always prided (himself) on being a conservative voice, but one that was willing to think independently."

Markel is a former AFSCME member who in 2022 ran for U.S. House in the 12th District against U.S. Rep. Mike Bost. We prefer Doody for this seat.

Scott Doody is endorsed.

OPINION

Bears coach Mike Ditka drives a cart, circa 1988. **CHICAGO TRIBUNE ARCHIVE**

How I got 'Iron Mike' Ditka to talk about an erectile dysfunction drug

By Bob Brody
SPECIAL TO THE TRIBUNE

In 2003, the pharma firms GlaxoSmithKline and Schering-Plough, poised to launch the new erectile dysfunction drug Levitra, signed a celebrity spokesperson. To carry out the marketing strategy designed to persuade men to seek treatment without feeling unduly self-conscious, the companies recruited a "brand ambassador" who would fit the bill as a model of masculinity.

Enter Mike Ditka, a legendary player for the Chicago Bears who as head coach led the team to the 1985 Super Bowl championship and who died recently at age 86. The rationale behind the partnership was simple. If the growling macho "Iron Mike," who was 6-foot-3 and 230 pounds in his prime, could upend a tradition of male stoicism in response to erectile dysfunction, surely any man could.

Our public relations agency landed the $7 million account for Levitra. Viagra had come along five years earlier, an immediate pioneering blockbuster. Cialis also debuted in 2003, so Levitra faced competition.

To get the story we would pitch to the media, we had to interview Ditka about his experiences with erectile dysfunction. Our agency, whose staff was overwhelmingly female, decided, with admirable discretion, that the assignment should go to a man.

That man turned out to be me.

I'd interviewed celebrity spokespeople for our public health campaigns before, including athletes ranging from Nolan Ryan and Joe Montana to Dorothy Hamill, Alonzo Mourning and Caitlyn Jenner. But I'd never asked anyone questions about a health issue quite this intimate.

How, I wondered, would I approach this mythic tough guy and notoriously ferocious competitor about this most private and delicate of matters? After all, I'd seen Ditka play football. He was the NFL Rookie of the Year and appeared in five Pro Bowls. He could run opponents over without losing a step. He once said, "I just like to hit." He added that if he got knocked down, he would "go back and hit the other guy harder."

In short, he scared me.

Would I just stammer, "So, Mr. Ditka, please tell us, when did you discover you could, um, no longer, you know, do it?" What if he took offense and threatened to snap my neck?

In short order, the big moment came. Our Levitra account team gathered in a conference room and dialed the phone number for Ditka. I introduced myself and told him he was on speakerphone with several colleagues of mine listening in.

Ditka said he welcomed the chance to tell his story and invited us to ask him anything we wanted. So I asked him as innocent a first question as I could muster. "Please tell us, Mr. Ditka, how this all started."

And without hesitation, or even the need for another question, Ditka proved to be a perfect gentleman and told us his whole story about erectile dysfunction. He matter-of-factly recounted how he noticed that when he felt amorous toward his wife, he had some difficulty performing his husbandly duties. At first he tried to brush it off, but then it happened again, and he suspected he might have a problem.

But he resisted seeing a doctor about it, he told us. Finally he made an appointment, and a diagnosis of erectile dysfunction led to a prescription for Levitra. And that, evidently, made all the difference for him in the bedroom.

Our promotion of Levitra involved heavy-duty media coverage and a TV commercial featuring Ditka during the 2004 Super Bowl. The key message delivered throughout was typical for so many of our pharma initiatives: Talk to your doctor and ask what to do.

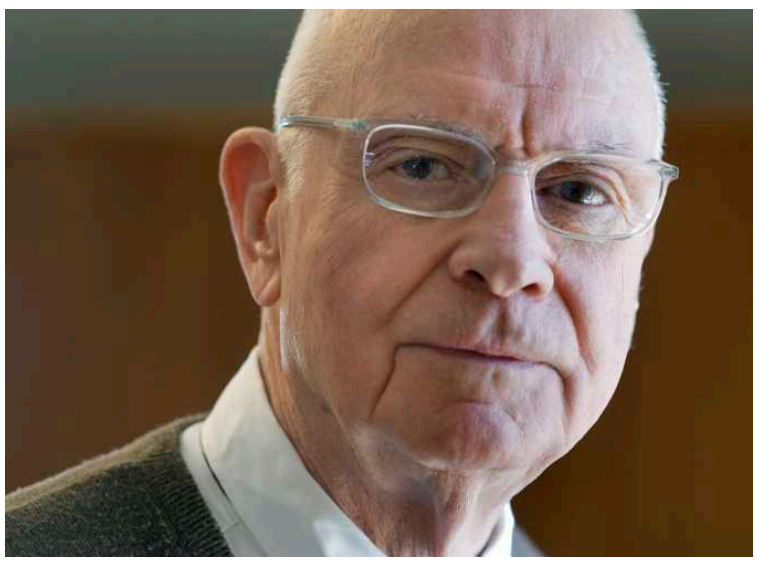
Because Ditka had done just that, millions of men confronting the same stigma followed his example. And his championship spirit nearly prevailed. But a 15% spike in new prescriptions right after the Super Bowl ads proved short-lived. Levitra never climbed higher than third place in its three-way showdown.

That outcome was out of character for him. Ditka never settled for third place in anything.

Bob Brody, a consultant and essayist, is author of the memoir "Playing Catch with Strangers: A Family Guy (Reluctantly) Comes of Age."

We need Congress to ponder the long term with a new future-focused group

By John T. Shaw
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE



Former Indiana U,S. Rep. Lee Hamilton, who was co-chair of the Iraq Study Group, in his office at the Woodrow Wilson Center in Washington on Nov. 24, 2006. **PETE SOUZA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Lee Hamilton of Indiana served in the U.S. House of Representatives for nearly 35 years and came to believe the most frustrating aspect of congressional service was that members "never have time to put their feet up on their desks, look out the window, and think about the long-term challenges coming down the road."

It may seem highly aspirational, even implausible, to expect Congress to consider the future in a sustained and systematic way. This is, after all, an institution that frequently has trouble passing stopgap spending bills and conducting routine legislative business.

However, it was not that long ago that some in Congress actually considered emerging trends, anticipated problems and developed future-focused policies. They even created institutions to think and act strategically.

Government needs to revive this practice. To that end, I propose that our lawmakers create a 21st Century Institute for the Future to foster an awareness of, and then plan for, the extraordinary challenges barreling toward us.

Congress has an inherent short-term time horizon. Frequent elections, impatient constituents and the unrelenting pressure of the news cycle do not provide rewards for gazing into crystal balls or enacting visionary policies whose benefits may only be evident years later.

But half a century ago, many lawmakers viewed their responsibilities differently. Perhaps they were inspired by America's cultural fascination with the future as exemplified by the bestselling book "Future Shock" by Alfred Toffler and prominent futurist groups such as the Club of Rome.

Congress created the Congressional Budget Office, Congressional Research Service and Office of Technology Assessment in the 1970s to examine an array of issues, often with a long-term lens. The House of Representatives even enacted a rule in 1974 that required its committees to undertake futures research within their jurisdictions.

Going further, lawmakers created the Congressional Clearinghouse for the Future in 1976 to study economic, demographic and technological developments. At one point, the clearinghouse had a bipartisan and bicameral membership of about 100 lawmakers. Once a month, they hosted an off-the-record discussion called "Dialogues on America's Future" with experts such as Toffler, anthropologist Margaret Mead and economist John Kenneth Galbraith. U.S. Rep. Al Gore Jr. of Tennessee was the co-chair of the clearinghouse and argued that it gave lawmakers a crucial perspective as they drafted and reviewed legislation.

In 1984, Gore and Republican Sen. John Heinz of Pennsylvania created the Congressional Institute for the Future as a nonprofit partner to the clearinghouse. Their reason is as compelling now as it was then. "Powerful institutional incentives in our nation—particularly in Congress—limit the focus of the national debate to short-term priorities and crisis management," they wrote. "For policymakers, the budget cycle, the end of the fiscal year, the next election, and day-to-day crises demand attention. Schedules are so filled with meetings on one short-term problem after another that many leaders scarcely have time to consider the challenges the nation may face tomorrow."

The Institute for the Future became a forum for members of Congress and business and academic leaders to discuss rising trends, problems and opportunities. The institute published reports, hosted conferences, sponsored speakers and commissioned public opinion polls. It studied global trade, the U.S. federal budget and disruptions triggered by the information age.

Unfortunately, this future focus dwindled and largely disappeared in the following decades as key leaders departed Congress, and their successors pursued other interests.

The Congressional Budget Office still publishes an annual long-term budget forecast, and reports by the Congressional Research Service and Government Accountability Office often offer long-range perspectives. Some congressional committees hold hearings that explore topics that look beyond the issue of the day. But few lawmakers think past the next election and their own political survival.

I suggest that a dozen congressional Democrats and a dozen Republicans create a 21st Century Institute for the Future. It could be housed in the Congressional Management Foundation, a respected nonprofit organization devoted to improving congressional management practices. This new institute should assemble and organize future-focused studies by government agencies, think tanks and the private sector — building a Future of America library.

Institute members would meet monthly for briefings from experts and hold quarterly roundtable discussions, reprising the "Dialogues on America's Future" series. They would examine broad demographic and technological changes and also delve into specific issues such as the federal budget, immigration, climate mitigation, income inequality and public health. A small staff would draft background papers for all members of Congress, and lawmakers would craft policy proposals that focus beyond the horizon.

This initiative's impact would be both intangible and tangible. It would encourage an institutional mind shift from the immediate to the enduring. More concretely, it would encourage lawmakers to explore the long-term consequences of issues that will profoundly shape the future of the United States.

I do not expect this idea to spawn a Congress bustling with futurists. However, it could incubate a cadre of thoughtful lawmakers who consider our long-range needs, goals and opportunities and urge their colleagues to join them.

And there is a bonus benefit — people who are concerned about the future tend to make more conscientious decisions about the present.

John T. Shaw is a professor at Marquette University's Les Aspin Center for Government in Washington, D.C. His most recent book is "The Education of a Statesman: How Global Leaders Can Repair a Fractured World."

OPINION

Trump throws a lifeline to Putin

By Joel R. Levin and Mariya Dmytriv-Kapeniak
SPECIAL TO THE TRIBUNE

The per-gallon price for diesel fuel is displayed on a pump at a Buc-ee's on Monday in Johnstown, Colorado.
DAVID ZALUBOWSKI/AP

On Friday, President Donald Trump shocked the world by easing sanctions on Russia to allow the sale of Russian diesel fuel to the United States and global markets. He boasted that his action would dramatically reduce the price of diesel fuel for Americans and the rest of the world. Trump's action is a shameful betrayal of Ukraine and our allies that will have little, if any, effect on the price of diesel but will help finance Russia's war machine and reward a ruthless autocratic regime that continues to murder Ukrainian civilians every week.

Ironically, Trump's action comes in the wake of newly authorized sanctions that have the potential to throttle the Russian war machine. Less than a month ago, he signed into law the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which imposes mandatory sanctions and tariffs on countries buying Russian oil and natural gas. The bipartisan act passed the Senate by an overwhelming 86-11 margin, reflecting the broad support for sanctions in the United States. Under the act, the administration is required by law to announce the mandated sanctions and tariffs on Oct. 18.

The easing of existing sanctions less than 10 days before additional sanctions are scheduled to go into effect is a sign of weakness and only will embolden Russian President Vladimir Putin. Despite the clear mandate of the Lindsey Graham Act, Trump has given up whatever leverage he might have had to bring the war to an end with stiff sanctions under the new law by rewarding Putin with the easing of existing sanctions. Trump's continuing criticism of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and praise of Putin only give Putin further confidence the United States is not serious about imposing more severe sanctions.

Trump's reward to Putin comes in the wake of weeks of Russian bombardment of civilian targets in Ukraine resulting in the daily murder of civilians and destruction of civilian infrastructure. In a further sign of weakness, Trump has responded to these murders with deafening silence, thereby conveying to Putin he will not be held to account if he continues his targeting of Ukrainian civilians. And, not surprisingly, that is exactly what happened — the day after the easing of sanctions, 20 people, including three children, were killed when Russian aerial bombs hit residential buildings in the southern Ukrainian city of Zaporizhzhia. Putin's war crimes will now continue unabated.

The Ukrainian people have demonstrated incredible bravery, courage and resilience since the Russian invasion. Ukraine now faces daily horrific bombings and does not have sufficient air-defense capability to protect its people. This is a time when we should be doing everything possible to increase pressure on Russia to end this war. Instead, by Trump's inexcusable action, the United States will now be helping to finance Russia's war against Ukraine and will thereby be complicit in Russia's war crimes.

Trump's action needs to be condemned in the strongest possible terms. We should not be lending support to the authoritarian aggressor in this war, nor should we be threatening to halt intelligence sharing and arms shipments to Ukraine if it doesn't cease attacks on Russian oil refineries. We should be supporting Ukraine's defense of democracy, sovereignty and freedom. The action taken by Trump is a betrayal of Ukraine and our allies, defies logic, weakens our standing in the world and is detrimental to our country's national security interests.

Trump needs to rescind this deplorable action and move swiftly to implement the Lindsey Graham Act.

Joel R. Levin is a former federal prosecutor who has been active in Ukraine-related advocacy. Mariya Dmytriv-Kapeiak, a Chicago-based physician, is president of the Illinois division of the Ukrainian Congress Committee of America.

Voice of the People

A simple deal for the Bears

The state legislature continues to fumble the Bears stadium deal. The Bears have asked for certainty for property taxes plus infrastructure and utility improvements. The legislature has offered neither.

My proposal: The Bears finance and build their stadium, and property taxes are frozen at what Arlington Park was paying, plus annual inflation. The government provides all the requested infrastructure improvements financed by a bond issue that is repaid through an amusement tax on ticket sales.

Everyone wins.
— Rhys Read, Des Plaines

It's a privilege to be here

On Sunday, over 55,000 people from all over the country and the world participated in the Bank of America Chicago Marathon. They occupied thousands of hotel rooms, ate thousands of restaurant meals, participated in one of the premier athletic events in the world and had a great time in our wonderful city. We who live here are so lucky to live in and enjoy Chicago every day.

On the other hand, on several other Sundays each fall, about the same number of folks come to Soldier Field to watch the Bears. They drive in, tailgate or buy their food in the stadium and then leave after the game.

The Bears should feel privileged to call Chicago their home, but they don't.
— Mark Johnson, Chicago

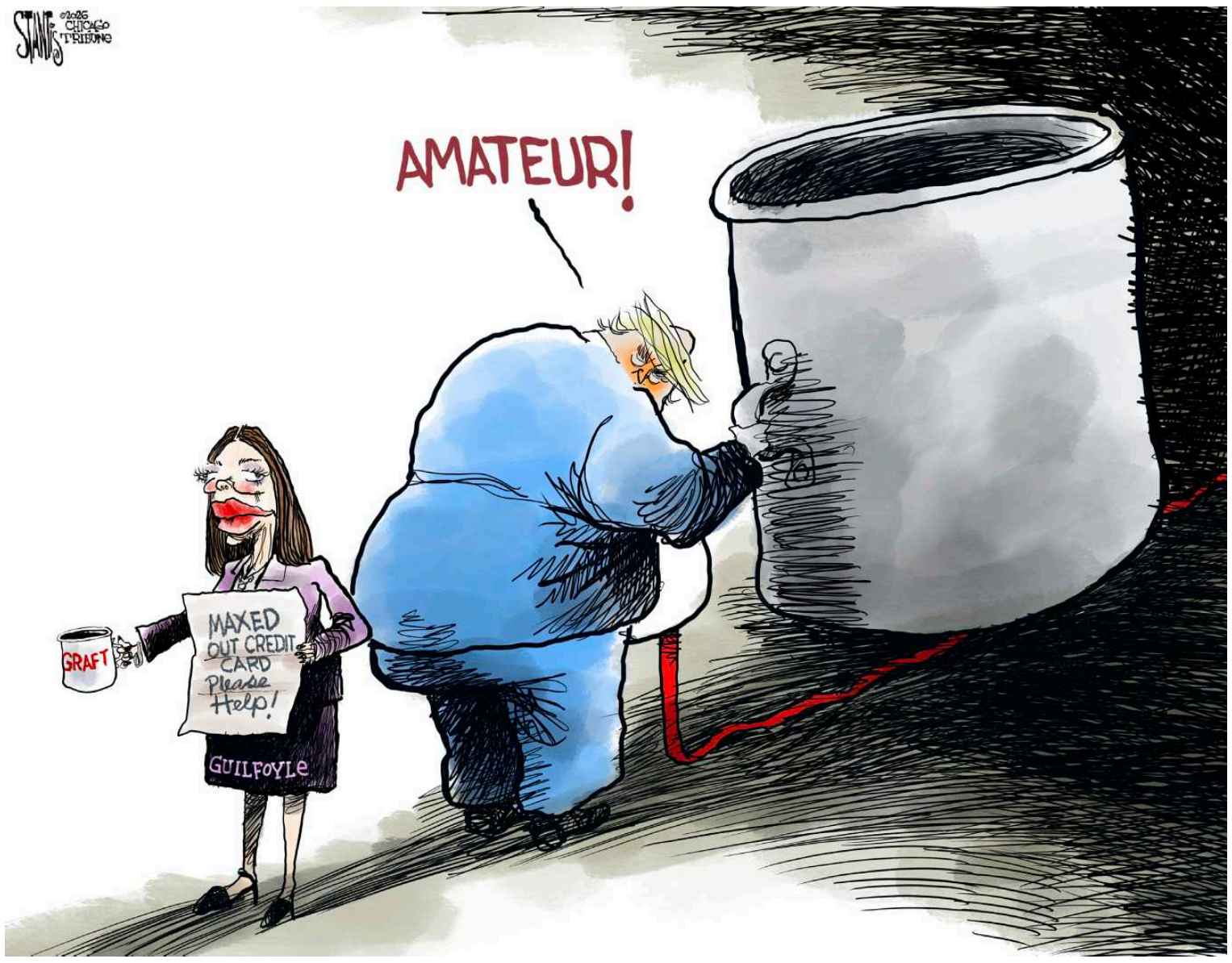
Homeowners need a break

It is entertaining to watch local politicians bend over backward to keep the Chicago Bears gracing Chicagoland. The latest proposal to exempt this multi-billion-dollar sports enterprise from paying property taxes is a slap in the face to everyday taxpayers. This move would only continue to shift this heavy financial burden onto local businesses and individual homeowners, many of whom have recently received notices of increases of more than 10% in their property assessments.

Illinois already ranks among the states with the highest property taxes in the nation, yet substantive efforts to relieve this burden remain entirely lacking. Other states have taken protective action. For instance, Florida's constitution limits annual increases in assessed homestead values to no more than 3%. Similarly, California law restricts annual assessment increases to a maximum of 2% (or the rate of inflation, whichever is lower), regardless of how much actual market value rises.

Meanwhile, Illinois homeowners are left entirely exposed to skyrocketing assessments. With elections right around the corner, politicians who wish to stay in office need to wake up and take real action to reduce this ever-increasing tax burden instead of handing out tax breaks to billionaires while bleeding local residents dry.
— Al Zvinakis, Lemont

SCOTT STANTIS



Pritzker waited a month

Regarding the article "FEMA rejects Illinois disaster aid request for August storms" (Oct. 9): I did not see anywhere in the article that Gov. JB Pritzker waited a month to apply for those funds. The storms affecting Illinois occurred Aug. 11 to 16. Pritzker did not apply for Federal Emergency Management Agency funds until Sept. 15, a month later.

Compare that to Indiana Gov. Mike Braun, who applied for disaster funding on Aug. 20.
— Patricia Bonk, Midlothian

Platform for Blagojevich

I find it astonishing that ousted Illinois Gov. Rod Blagojevich continues to receive national television exposure, particularly on Fox News, as though his disgraceful record in public office were merely an unfortunate misunderstanding.

I remember a very different Blagojevich.

My late mother, Judy Baar Topinka, challenged him for governor in 2006. I witnessed the personal attacks, ridicule and vilification directed at a woman who devoted her life to serving Illinois. Political disagreement is legitimate. Attacking someone's character for political advantage is something else entirely.

Blagojevich was impeached, removed from office by a unanimous 59-0 Illinois Senate vote and convicted of federal corruption offenses. Presidential clemency cannot rewrite history or erase the betrayal of public trust.

My mother believed public office was a responsibility, not a personal possession. She worked across party lines, respected political opponents and understood that serving people mattered more than personal publicity.

Television networks have every right to interview Blagojevich. But giving him a national platform without confronting his record does a disservice to viewers and to the people of Illinois.

This is not about Republicans or Democrats. It is about character, integrity and accountability.

My mother spent her life earning the public's trust. Blagojevich squandered his.

Illinois should never forget the difference.
— Joseph Baar Topinka, New Braunfels, Texas

Rep. Bost is unfit for office

I read the Tribune Editorial Board's endorsement of Mike Bost with great concern ("Tribune endorsements for US Congress in 11th, 12th, 13th, 14th, 15th, 16th, 17th districts," Oct. 6).

In fact, many voters in his Southern Illinois district despise him. I went to a local meet-and-greet several years ago and observed him speaking to unemployed coal miners at a time when mines were closing. He was disrespectful and condescending. Those men were hurting, and I left appalled and angry. He was filmed at another event, yelling at a veteran.

Bost has been a no-show for several public appearances.

Although the endorsement will likely stand, please, investigate with care. This man is unfit to hold office.
— Julia Pfeiffer, Marion, Illinois

Why no Divvy senior discount?

Regarding the Oct. 7 letter by Jim Merrell ("Keep Divvy's success rolling"), while I agree with what he wrote, I have a nagging bone to pick with the Divvy folks.

For years, I've held an annual Divvy membership, and when I've asked why Divvy does not offer a senior discount, like all other transportation agencies do in the region, I get no answer. Why, I wonder?

They say they offer a D4E (Divvy for Everyone). That's all well and good, but many seniors like me don't qualify for D4E.

If I can get a senior discount on the CTA, Metra and Pace, why not Divvy?
— Dave Gudewicz, Third Lake

Open enrollment returns

As daylight wanes and fall is in the air, there are so many welcome traditions that we all anticipate: the warmth of woolen sweaters, the scent of pumpkin spice, the excitement of college football, the delightful charm of trick-or-treaters and, of course, the return of Medicare open enrollment commercials.
— Mark Woodward, Chicago

Bombarded by same ads

I am probably not the only Chicago-area resident who is sick and tired of seeing and hearing a barrage of injury lawyer ads on TV and radio.

Rarely does a commercial break pass without at least one. I think I have them all memorized now.

Please — enough is enough! If someone needs an injury lawyer, they will call.
— Rick Kyle, Wheaton

Note to readers

With Halloween coming, we'd like you to share your most memorable experience related to the holiday, either as a child or as an adult. A costume that you've never forgotten? A trip to a haunted house that scared you silly? Neighbors who went above and beyond to make things fun for the kids? Send a letter, of no more than 400 words, by Friday, Oct. 23 to letters@chicagotribune.com. Be sure to include your full name and your city/town.

For online-exclusive letters, go to www.chicagotribune.com/letters. Email your letter submissions, 400 words or less, to letters@chicagotribune.com. Include your full name, address and phone number.

BUDGET

from Page A1

Mayor Brandon Johnson presides over the City Council meeting at Chicago City Hall on Sept. 29. **ANTONIO PEREZ/ CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

In the last week, Johnson has met with groups of aldermen to discuss what key changes might balance the budget. The conversations have not included specific, detailed proposals, but Johnson has asked council members to present their own ideas and push Springfield for a bigger slice of state tax revenue.

The mayor's administration also raised the possibility of implementing a new tax on package deliveries, according to several sources familiar with the discussions.

But for such a tax, Chicago would need special permission from state legislators to move ahead, a daunting obstacle given his past failures in the capital that likely puts a laundry list of his desired revenue-raisers out of reach. During his recent discussions with aldermen, Johnson said he would not rely on revenue from taxes not yet approved by Springfield, sources said.

The mayor failed to convince aldermen last year to support his marquee $33-per-employee monthly head tax on businesses with over 500 workers, one of the few corporation-aimed taxes the city actually has the power to implement.

Johnson, who has struggled to win support for his demands from the General Assembly and Gov. JB Pritzker, acknowledged Tuesday that his hands are tied. And he tried carefully to tie his long-running calls for higher taxes on the rich and corporations to city services that he said might otherwise be cut.

"Standing up in this moment in a bold fashion to protect working people, to make sure that trees are trimmed, that potholes are filled, that mental health support services are provided," he said. "The people of Chicago have given me a mandate to do that, but the state of Illinois, of course, has preemption. It takes that authority away."

The mayor also called on Springfield to restore funding to Chicago from its local government distributive fund to previous rates, a move he said would generate $264 million for the city.

The General Assembly will meet late next month and in early December for its fall veto session, where the Johnson administration could have one last opportunity to convince legislators to change laws and clear the way for otherwise preempted new taxes and fees.

As City Hall begins to iron out its next budget, it now faces a heightened challenge in fulfilling this year's spending plan. The city planned to generate around $70 million by refinancing old debt to close an $85 million budget gap, but was only able to generate $36 million in savings, according to Johnson's administration.

Comptroller Michael Belsky said the shortcoming was not tied to recent credit downgrades.

"The lower savings is unequivocally and directly related to higher-than-expected interest rates, driven by macroeconomic forces like the war in Iran," he said in a statement. "What changed has been the market."

The decision by Johnson opponents to rely on "speculative revenue projections" created the shortfall, mayoral spokesperson Allison Novelo said in an apparent reference to the City Council's approval of a $90 million sale of old debt owed to the city and untested taxes on augmented reality advertising.

While Johnson has repeatedly said the two policies backed by a majority of aldermen have not generated revenue because they are unworkable, his council opponents have accused him of intentionally blocking their effective implementation.

The city remains on track to close its 2026 budget gap, in part because the administration is cashing in on $33.2 million in unpaid taxes by two of its biggest companies thanks to heightened enforcements, Novelo said.

POPE

from Page A1

Gemelli hospital through the main entrance earlier in the day and waved to dozens of well-wishers who had gathered to greet him.

The Vatican said the surgery would be performed by a team led by Gemelli's chief thoracic surgeon, Dr. Stefano Margaritora.

The surgery got under way as medical staff recited the Rosary prayer in the hospital chapel Tuesday, according to two people familiar with the plans who spoke on condition of anonymity.

"Let us join together in prayer, asking the Lord to sustain our bishop, Pope Leo, and to comfort all those who are hospitalized here," said the Vicar of Rome, Cardinal Baldassare Reina, at the start of the prayer.

The American pontiff has offered a rare level of transparency about the first publicly disclosed major health problem of his 17-month papacy.

Leo revealed the discovery of the small, localized nodule during his Sunday noon prayer and announced that he would have it removed.

The Vatican on Monday canceled all Leo's audiences through Oct. 20.

While Gemelli has a specific papal apartment that past popes have used, complete with a private chapel on the 10th floor, Leo will be staying in a nearby room since the papal apartment is undergoing renovations, according to the Vatican press office.

There was no word on whether Leo would be able to keep his planned trip to South America next month.

Oncologists often advise patients not to fly for three weeks after surgery — which would give the pope just the interval needed to make his planned Nov. 6-17 trip to Uruguay, Argentina and Peru, depending on his recovery.

The current itinerary for the trip is ambitious and the longest of his papacy to date, calling for Leo to clock just over 19,000 miles on a dozen flights and two helicopter rides, and a significant altitude change in Peru.

A lung nodule is a small abnormal area measuring less than 1.2 inches that sometimes appears on a CT scan of the chest or abdomen. Often, the scans are done to investigate trauma or a lung infection, unrelated to a lung cancer screening.

A nodule can be benign or malignant, and oftentimes surgical removal is recommended both to establish whether it is cancer and to treat a malignancy while it is still localized.

The nodule was discovered during regular checks, the Vatican has said.

This is believed to be the second hospitalization for Leo, who is known to be sporty and in good shape, with weekly tennis games and swimming.

As a young missionary priest, he came down with typhoid fever in 1985, soon after arriving in Chulucanas, Peru.

The illness and hospitalization were a cathartic moment for him to decide to stay in the poverty and discomfort of Peru after living in relative comfort in Rome — a decision that ultimately paved the way to his papacy, according to an interview Leo gave to Elise Ann Allen in 2025 for "Pope Leo XIV: The Biography."

According to the book, Leo said he prayed to God to let him die rather than suffer the "horrible" pain of the fever.

"Obviously, I survived; I recovered, but it turned out to be a very significant moment for me, because it was like, 'Well, you've already dealt with the illness; you already see what the needs are here — the order, the Augustinians, the church are telling you, We need you here; go for it.' I never looked back."

Chicago Daily Tribune

ON OCT. 14 ...

In 1066, Normans under William the Conqueror defeated the English at the Battle of Hastings.

In 1644 William Penn, the Quaker leader who founded the American Commonwealth of Pennsylvania, was born in London.

In 1890 Dwight Eisenhower, 34th president of the United States, was born in Denison, Texas.

In 1912 former President Theodore Roosevelt, campaigning for the presidency on the Bull Moose ticket, was shot in the chest by a New York saloonkeeper in Milwaukee; Roosevelt gave his scheduled speech anyway.

In 1944 German Field Marshal Erwin Rommel committed suicide rather than face execution for allegedly conspiring against Adolf Hitler.

In 1947 Air Force test pilot Chuck Yeager broke the sound barrier as he flew the experimental Bell X-1 rocket plane over Edwards Air Force Base in California.

In 1964 civil rights leader Martin Luther King Jr. was named winner of the Nobel Peace Prize.

In 1977 singer-actor Bing Crosby died near Madrid; he was 74.

In 1980 Republican presidential nominee Ronald Reagan promised that, if elected, he would name a woman to the U.S. Supreme Court. (He later nominated Judge Sandra Day O'Connor of Arizona.)

In 1986 Elie Wiesel, the Auschwitz concentration camp survivor who devoted his life to promoting human rights and reminding the world about the Nazis' atrocities, won the Nobel Peace Prize.

In 1987 18-month-old Jessica McClure of Midland, Texas, captured the nation's attention when she fell 22 feet down an abandoned well. (Hundreds of volunteers would work 58 hours before pulling her out.)

In 1991 Myanmar opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi was named winner of the Nobel Peace Prize.

In 2003 during Game 6 of the National League Championship Series, Cubs fan Steve Bartman inadvertently deflected a foul ball away from the outstretched glove of Chicago outfielder Moises Alou; the Florida Marlins, down 3-0 at the time, rallied to win the game and went on to win Game 7 and advance to the World Series, where they defeated the New York Yankees.

In 2013 professors Eugene Fama and Lars Peter Hansen of the University of Chicago and Robert Shiller of Yale University shared the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences.

In 2017 a powerful bomb blast in Somalia's capital killed more than 350 people in the country's deadliest single attack.

Chicago Tribune Death Notices

Chicago Tribune extends our condolences to the families and loved ones of those who have passed.

chicagotribune.com/deathnotice

Death Notices

Brandl, Jr., John

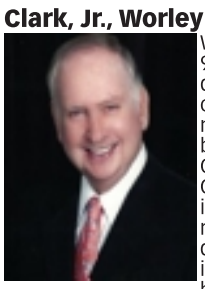
John Henry Brandl, Jr., age 86, of Sun City West, AZ, formerly of Northbrook, IL, passed away on October 5, 2026. Beloved husband of the late Angelika Marie "Angie" Brandl; loving mother of John (Lynn) and Ann Brandl; cherished Opa of Jack and Sam. John was born on October 26, 1939, the son of John Henry Brandl and Violet Ann (Paletti) Brandl. He was the second youngest among three siblings – Paul, Mary Jane, and Jerry – who grew up in Winnetka, IL. A visitation will be held on Friday, October 16, 2026, starting at 4:30 p.m. at Kelley & Spalding Funeral Home, 1787 Deerfield Road, Highland Park, IL. A prayer service is planned for 7 p.m. In lieu of flowers, please give to a charity of your choosing. More information is posted at KelleySpaldingFuneralHome.com.

KELLEY & SPALDING FUNERAL HOME & CREMATORY

Canzona, John "Jack"

Jack Canzona passed away on October 8, 2026, from Parkinson's disease. Son of Lucille and Joseph Canzona, Jack earned a Psy. D. from National Louis University and served patients in need at Christ, Holy Cross, and Oak Forest Hospitals. In 1991, Jack's faith led him to adopt his son, Mark. With Mark, Jack celebrated family traditions, enjoyed Motown music, and movies. Share memories with Mark and register interest in a celebration of life at: rememberingjackcanzona@gmail.com.

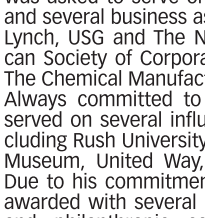
Clark, Jr., Worley "H"



Worley "H" Clark, Jr., age 94, of Hinsdale, Illinois, died peacefully at home on October 4, 2026. He is now reunited with his beloved wife of 69 years, Callie Anne Coughlin Clark, who preceded him in death. "H" was the ultimate family patriarch. His deep devotion to his family was the cornerstone of his life. He is survived by his daughters, Caryl Lynne Smith (Brian) and Cindy Anne Mancillas (Kurt); his cherished grandchildren, Kelsey Lynne Smith, Kendall Anne Mancillas, and Dylan Clark Mancillas; and several nieces and nephews. His life was defined by an incredible 80-year love affair that began on his very first day of fourth grade in Big Stone Gap, Virginia, where he met his soulmate, Callie Anne. The childhood sweethearts married in 1955, launching a lifetime of shared adventures. "H" attended Northwestern University before transferring to North Carolina State to study engineering. His time with the Sigma Phi Epsilon fraternity at N.C. State instilled a lifelong commitment to leadership, loyalty, and service to others. Together, "H" and Callie Anne passionately championed education, endowing numerous college scholarships to lift up future generations at N.C. State, Wake Forest and Mountain Empire Community College. "H" possessed a brilliant business mind, rising from a sales engineer in 1960 to eventually serve as the President, CEO, and Chairman of Nalco Chemical Company. His leadership expanded a massive global expansion. "H" and Callie Anne travelled extensively around the globe during this time; each trip an adventure and an opportunity to promote international business relations. As an innovative leader, "H" was asked to serve on twelve corporate boards and several business associations such as Merrill Lynch, USG and The Northern Trust; The American Society of Corporate Executives (ASCE) and The Chemical Manufacturers Associations (CMA). Always committed to giving back, "H" proudly served on several influential Chicago boards, including Rush University Medical Center, The Field Museum, United Way, and the Brookfield Zoo. Due to his commitment to giving back, "H" was awarded with several honors from the business and philanthropic communities. The Trustee Medal of Honor, Rush University Medical Center; Outstanding Corporate Director in the United States class of 2007; Chemical Industry Gold Medal, Society of Chemical Industry; the Distinguished Engineering Alumnus Award, N.C. State; Outstanding Civilian Service Medal, Department of the Army; are a few of the honors he received. After retiring from the corporate world, "H" joyfully fulfilled a childhood dream by becoming a true cowboy. He and Callie Anne purchased a working cattle ranch in Big Timber, Montana. The "H" Clark Ranch became a treasured sanctuary where he felt most at home in his jeans, cowboy hat, and boots, surrounded by family and friends. "H" was a Southern gentleman; a generous mentor and sage advisor who loved nothing more than holding court with his family and friends, offering wisdom (solicited or not). He will be forever remembered for his dry wit, unshakeable integrity, and deep devotion to those he loved. He will be forever loved "a bushel and a peck." Funeral services will be held in Hinsdale, Illinois. In lieu of flowers, please consider a memorial contribution to The Woman's Board Endowed Fund for Research and Clinical Trials at Rush University Medical Center, https://thewomansboard.org/product/memorial-contribution/ Arrangements by Brian Powell Funeral Directors of Hinsdale. For more information 630-703-9131 or www.powellfuneraldirectors.com.

POWELL FUNERAL DIRECTORS

Folmer, Joann Laura Wilczewski



Joann L. Folmer (nee Wilczewski) 92 of Antioch, IL; beloved wife of the late Matthew Folmer; loving mother of Joseph Folmer, Judy Coughenour, and the late Peter; cherished grandmother of: Raymon (Julie) Coughenour, Robert (Kelly) Coughenour, Louise Coughenour, John Coughenour, and Mary Coughenour; treasured great grandmother of: Khloe, Sophie, Evan, Maddie, Kayden, and Kennedy; dear sister of Trudy (Denny) Knauf and the late Corky Wilczewski. Visitation 1pm until 6pm Saturday October 17, 2026, at the STRANG FUNERAL HOME 1055 Main St. (Rte. 83) Antioch, IL 60002, with prayer service at 5pm. In lieu of flowers donations to Wounded Warrior Project, appreciated. INFO 847-395-4000 or www.strangfh.com.

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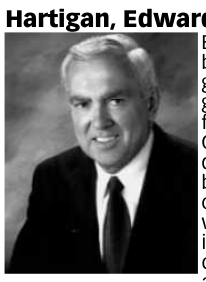
Chicago Tribune

Death Notices

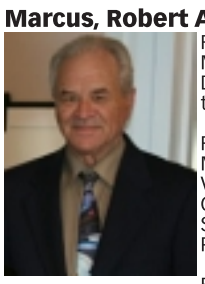
Hartigan, Edward Gerard "Ed"



Edward Gerard Hartigan, beloved husband, father, grandfather, great-grandfather, brother and friend, passed away on October 9, 2026, just three days after his 87th birthday. Born in Chicago on October 6, 1939, Ed was a man of remarkable intellect, boundless curiosity, and an appreciation for the finer things in life. A graduate of Wauconda High School and Loyola University Chicago, he built a long and distinguished career that spanned education, scientific research, and business leadership. He began his professional life as a teacher, went on to become a scientific researcher and inventor, earning 18 patents, and ultimately established himself as a successful marketing business executive. He retired in 2003 as Senior Vice President for ITT Educational Services. Throughout his career, he combined analytical rigor with creativity, innovation, and an ability to bring people and ideas together. Ed's life took him to several corners of the world, including Chicago, Boston, London, and Indianapolis. Wherever he lived, he embraced new experiences, new perspectives, and the opportunity to learn. An avid international traveler, he particularly cherished exploring the world alongside his beloved wife, Louise. Their travels reflected Ed's enduring curiosity and his appreciation for different cultures, traditions, and ways of life. A passionate patron of the arts, Ed served as President of the Indianapolis Opera Board, supporting an art form he deeply admired. He was equally enthusiastic about reading, fine wine, and memorable meals shared with family and friends. A loyal Chicago sports fan, he remained devoted to both the Chicago Cubs and the Chicago Bears, faithfully following the triumphs, disappointments, and enduring traditions of his hometown teams. Above all, Ed treasured his family. He is survived by his beloved wife of 64 years, Louise (née Kittmann); his daughter, Laura O'Connor, and her husband, Terry; and his son, Jeffrey Hartigan, and his wife, Leslie. He was a proud grandfather to Mallory Hartigan and her fiancé, Ryan; Bridgette Procida and her husband, John; Quinlan Hartigan and his wife Madeline; and Jack O'Connor and his fiancé, Matthew. He was a loving great-grandfather to Margot Hartigan, whose presence brought another special joy to the family. He is also survived by his sisters, Norine Keese and Mary Beth Byrne and her husband Greg Byrne. He is preceded in death by his parents James Edward Hartigan and RoseMary (Palese). Ed will be remembered for his extraordinary professional accomplishments, his love of learning, his enthusiasm for travel and the arts, his appreciation of good food and wine, and, most importantly, the love and devotion he gave to those closest to him. His life was richly lived, shaped by discovery, achievement, adventure, and enduring relationships. He leaves behind a legacy that extends well beyond his many professional contributions: a family enriched by his love, a world made better through his talents and service, and countless memories of a life lived with curiosity, distinction, and heart. He will be deeply missed and lovingly remembered by all who had the privilege of knowing him. A memorial visitation will be held at St. Anne's Catholic Church, 120 Ela St, Barrington, IL 60010 on Tuesday, October 20, at 9:00 AM. Service will begin at 10:30 AM.
To leave an online condolence for the family, visit www.davenportfamily.com. For information, please call 847-381-3411.

Davenport Family Funeral Home

Marcus, Robert A. "Bob"



Robert Anthony "Bob" Marcus
December 29, 1948 – September 29, 2026

Robert Anthony "Bob" Marcus, 77, of Tierra Verde, Florida, and Glen Carbon, Illinois, died on September 29, 2026, in St. Petersburg, Florida.

Bob was born in Chicago on December 29, 1948, to Robert George and Angeline (Kulig) Marcus, and grew up in the city's Roseland neighborhood. He attended St. Salomea School and Mendel Catholic High School in Chicago, earned a degree in biology from St. Joseph's College in Rensselaer, Indiana, and went on to receive a Master of Public Administration from DePaul University.

Bob met the love of his life, Nancy Ann Olesek, at a dance, where she tested whether he knew Polish by telling him, "Daj mi buzi" ("Give me a kiss"). They were married on June 12, 1971, at St. Columba Church in Hegewisch, and shared 55 years of marriage. Bob was devoted to Nancy and took wonderful care of her, always at her side when she needed him most.

Bob served as a federal agent with the U.S. Department of the Treasury for over 30 years. Following his retirement from the federal government, he became a licensed boat captain and held a Florida private investigator's license. He was also a motorcycle safety instructor with the Motorcycle Safety Foundation, teaching riders in Virginia, Illinois, and Florida, and a member of the Blue Knights Law Enforcement Motorcycle Club in Illinois, Virginia, and Florida. Always generous and quick to help others, Bob was a faithful blood donor, giving more than 250 times and over 30 gallons in his lifetime.

He loved fishing, boating, and motorcycle riding, but nothing delighted him more than his six grandchildren, who knew him as Papa. He was amazed by their personalities and their humor, and impressed by everything they accomplished.

He is survived by his wife, Nancy; his daughter, Michelle (Adam) Brzyski of Chesterfield, Missouri; his son, the Honorable Robert (Karen) Marcus of Glen Carbon, Illinois; his grandchildren, Adam, Jacob, Grace, and Olivia Brzyski and Caroline and Robert Marcus; his sister, Mary Ann (Bill) Bennett of Orland Park, Illinois; his brother-in-law and sister-in-law, Paul and Terry Olesek of Schererville, Indiana; many cousins, nieces, nephews, great-nieces, and great-nephews; and his lifelong friend, Pete Host of Orland Hills, Illinois, whose friendship began at Mendel Catholic High School.

He was preceded in death by his parents, Robert and Angeline, and his brother, Philip Joseph Marcus.

A private family service will be held.

Niedospial, Marie Witowski

Marie Niedospial (nee Witowski), beloved wife of the late Henry "Hank" Niedospial; loving mother of Danette, Dean, Dale, David and Daralyn (Donald); most wonderful Busia of Sarah Jo, Joe, Jack (Hannah), Paige, Kayla (Kyle), Brooke, Carks, Karly, Danielle and Evan; cherished Great Busia of Brooklyn Marie, Charlotte and Finnegan Henry; dearest sister of the late Benny, Bernice, Josie, Helen, Stella, Wally, Stasia, Edek and Milcia; cherished sister-in-law of Casey and the late Lillian and Marion; outstanding Auntie Mania to many nieces and nephews. Visitation Sunday 2-8 P.M. at Lawn Funeral Home, 7732 W. 159th St. Orland Park, IL. Lying in State Monday 9 A.M. until time of Funeral Mass 10:00 A.M. at SS. Cyril & Methodius Parish, 608 Sobieksi St. Lemont, IL. Interment Resurrection Cemetery. Funeral info: (708) 429-3200

Death Notices

Olesinski, Nina

Nina M. Olesinski, 76, of Chicago, passed away Thursday morning, October 8, 2026 with her family at her side. Born April 1, 1950 in Chicago to the late Onufry and the late Anna Hubej, Nina was the beloved wife of the late Raymond; dear sister to Valentina (Orest) Zasadney; fond aunt of Natalie (Nathan) Hartung, Elena, Alex, and Evelyn; cousin of Dr. Frank & Fran Matheu of West Bend, Wisconsin and Ellis & Connie Matheu of Park Ridge, Illinois; dear neighbor of Kevin & Lisa Flanagan. Nina obtained her Bachelor's, Master's and Ph.D. in Nursing at the University of Illinois at Chicago and went on to become a faculty member of the UIC College of Nursing. She was a long time parishioner of St. Nicholas Ukrainian Catholic Cathedral. Nina will be dearly missed by her family and friends. Visitation Friday, October 16, 2026 11 a.m. at Muzyka & Son Funeral Home, 5776 W. Lawrence Ave., Chicago, until time of Funeral Service at 12 Noon. Interment St. Nicholas Ukrainian Catholic Cemetery, Chicago, IL. In lieu of flowers, memorials to PAWS Chicago, www.pawschicago.org, or a charity of your choice. For more information, please call (773) 545-3800 or visit www.MuzykaFuneralHome.com.

Muzyka & Son

Sheridan, William J.

William J. Sheridan, Jr., age 78, passed away on September 30, 2026, in Austin, Texas. He was preceded in death by father, William J. Sheridan, Sr., mother, Irene C. Sheridan and sister, Mary Florence Sheridan. He was the father of Nicholas J. Sheridan (Hannah Horwick), and the brother of Mark F. Sheridan (Suzanne), Gregory R. Sheridan (Connie), Clement Sheridan (Barbara), Irene S. Brewick (Charles), Robert C. Sheridan (Beverly Pekala) and James M. Sheridan (Kathleen). He is survived by many nieces and nephews.

Bill was born in Oak Park, Illinois, graduated from Fenwick High School (Oak Park, IL) in 1965, Fairfield University (Fairfield, CT) in 1969 and the University of Illinois Law School (Urbana, IL) in 1972. Bill was admitted to the Illinois State Bar in 1972 and the New Mexico State Bar in 2008. He was a practicing attorney for many years at Katten Muchin Rosenman, LLP, at Finger, Hochman & Delotte, P.C. and later retired as a sole practitioner. Bill was an adjunct professor at John Marshall Law School teaching Estate Taxation.

He had a great love for the Bulls, Bears, White Sox, the Fighting Illini and all things sports. He loved to read and was known for his sense of humor, funny antics and zest for learning. He was beloved by family, friends and clients.

A private Celebration of Life ceremony will be held later this year.

Turen, Patricia A.

Patricia Ann Turen, nee Howe, age 82, passed away surrounded by her loved ones and after watching the bears game and listening to Neil Diamond. She was a longtime resident of Villa Park, Illinois. Beloved wife of 50 years to the late Eero Turen; loving mother of Eero "Terry" (Amy) Turen II; dear daughter of the late Armella and the late Edward Howe; treasured grandmother of Savannah (Vincent) Cruz; fond sister of Edward (the late Joan), John (the late Mary), Robert (Kathy), the late James (Cathy), and Michael (Marie) Howe; loving aunt to many nieces and nephews; best friends for over 60 years with Pam Lavoy. Patricia was a lifelong Chicago Bears fan, owning a PSL and season tickets. She was a member of the National Imperial Glass Collectors Society and Museum in Bellaire, Ohio, Fox Valley and Northern Illinois Collectors and Imperial Enthusiasts. She was very active and volunteered for school district #48 when her son went to school there. She held membership of many different local clubs, such as, The Community Women's Club of Villa Park, Lombard Lioness, Villa Park Historical Society and Museum, St Pius X Medical Missions, St Pius X CCW, St Pius X VIP, she sewed Pink Elephants and Heart Pillows for Elmhurst Hospital and volunteered for the Pink Elephant Resale shop for Elmhurst Hospital. She greeted patrons at the West Entrance of Elmhurst Hospital, and she volunteered in their volunteer office. She Enjoyed traveling with her husband. Visitation Sunday, Oct. 18, 2-7 PM at Steuerle Chapel, 15 W. Park Blvd. (Parking at 350 S. Ardmore) Villa Park, IL 60181. in state Monday, 9:30 AM until time of Funeral Mass 10 AM, at St. Pius X Catholic Church, 1025 E. Madison St. Lombard, IL 60148. Interment Abraham Lincoln National Cemetery. In Lieu of flowers, memorials to the Villa Park Historical Society are appreciated. Funeral info: 630-832-4161 or www.steuerlefh.com.

Death Notices

Vogel, Margaret Therese

Margaret Therese Vogel (nee Flanagan) passed away October 6, 2026. Margaret was predeceased by her beloved husband, Frank A. Vogel. Devoted mother to Frank A. (Susan) Vogel, Thomas P. Vogel, Colonel (Ret.) US Army, and Daniel J., Colonel (Ret.) US Army (Amanda) Vogel. Cherished and loving grandma to Frankie and Luke Vogel, and Caroline and Molly Vogel. Margaret was preceded in death by parents Jim and Annie Flanagan, brothers Jim, Tom, and Edward, and sisters Kay (late Tom) Howe, Anna Marie (late Richard) Hackett, Mary P. Carey, and Betty Flanagan. Survived and loved by siblings, Eileen (late Hon. Nello) Gamberdino and Kevin (Terri) Flanagan. Fond sister-in-law of Paul Vogel, and aunt of many nieces and nephews in the Flanagan and Vogel Families.

A career educator since 1961, Marge taught hundreds of students at Our Lady of Mount Carmel, Wentworth and Goodlow elementary schools.

Visitation is Saturday, October 17, 2026 from 10:00 AM to 11:00 AM. Mass of Christian Burial is at 11:00 AM at Marian Village Chapel, 15624 Marian Drive, Homer Glen, IL 60491. Inurnment at Holy Sepulchre Catholic Cemetery, Alsip, IL.

In lieu of flowers, memorials may be made to Misericordia Heart of Mercy, 6300 N. Ridge Ave., Chicago 60660-1099. Services entrusted to Cremation Society of Illinois 800-622-8358

Cremation Society of Illinois

Walsh, John H Jack

John H. "Jack" Walsh, 91, passed away peacefully on October 3, 2026, surrounded by his loving family at Alexian Brothers Hospice in Elk Grove Village, IL.

Jack is survived by his loving wife, Ann "Renie" Walsh; his sister, Helen (the late Steve) Stefely; his children: Patricia (Dan) Healy, Kathleen (John) Gray, Eileen (Kevin) Kelleher, Timothy Walsh, Russell (Connie) Head, Thomas Head, and Lori Head; along with 15 grandchildren and four great-grandchildren.

A funeral mass celebrating Jack's life will be held Monday, October 19, 2026, at 10:00 a.m., at Queen of the Rosary Catholic Church, 750 W. Elk Grove Boulevard, Elk Grove Village, IL 60007.

In lieu of flowers, donations to Misericordia and/or the Alexian Brothers Hospice would be appreciated.

For a more complete obituary please visit www.grovememorialchapel.com

Every life story deserves to be told.

Share your loved one's story at placeanad.chicagotribune.com

Chicago Tribune

Honor a Loved One with a Death Notice in Chicago Tribune

It's a final farewell; a sign of love and respect; an homage to a loved one's life. Placing a Death Notice shows you care, and is now more efficient than ever before with our **NEW Self-Service** tool.

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- Enhance your notice by uploading photos and graphics
- Immediate, printable proof of notice

Includes print listing in the **Death Notice section of the Chicago Tribune,** an online notice with guestbook on chicagotribune.com.

Chicago Tribune

Visit: chicagotribune.com/deathnotice

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Farms and Ranches For Sale

Mazon $899,900 60444-6257
4700 E Grand Ridge Rd Farm
10 acre horse property in Grundy County. Full listing in For Sale By Owner. 815-592-1067

Assumed Name

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation To the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in The State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook **County.**
File No. M26002019 on the
Date: 09/15/2026
Under the Assumed Name of: **Luxe Soles**
with the business located at:
15600 Calypso Ln Orland Park, IL 60462

The true name and residence Address of the owner is: **Lisa Lopez Delgadillo**
15600 Calypso Ln Orland Park, IL 60462

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation To the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in The State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook **County.**
File No. M26002030 on the
Date: 09/18/2026
Under the Assumed Name of:
MARKETPLACE DEALS
with the business located at:
852 E Sayles Dr, Palatine IL 60074
The true name and residence Address of the owner is: **Adin John Rehberger**
852 E Sayles Dr, Palatine

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation To the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in The State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook **County.**
File No. M26002041 on the
Date: 09/24/2026
Under the Assumed Name of: **VALDEZ TAX AND INSURANCE**
with the business located at:
2405 S Laramie Ave
Cicero, IL 60804
The true name and residence Address of the owner is: **SALVADOR CORREA**
2402 S 50TH AVE
Cicero, IL 60804

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation To the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in The State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook **County.**
File No. M26002070 on the
Date: 10/05/2026
Under the Assumed Name of: **Daisy and Olive Music Company**
with the business located at:
4544 N Mobile Ave, Chicago, IL 60630
The true name and residence Address of the owner is: **Alexandra Sulack**
4544 N Mobile Ave, Chicago, IL 60630

Take Notice

TO: Marian Radgowski, Occupant, Richard S Radgowski, Czeslawa Radgowski, Richard S Radgowski Maria Szpak, Richard S Radgowski, Marian Radgowski, Christopher Radgowski, Occupant, Occupant, Cook County Clerk TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002700 FILED 10/5/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of: Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 01/11/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0004577 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessment of (Municipality) N/A and special assessment number N/A Warrant No. N/A Inst. No. N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available).: 4516 S Karlov Avenue, Chicago, Illinois, 60632 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 19-03-413-039-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on March 15, 2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before March 15, 2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this county in Room 1704, Richard J. Daley Center, 50 W. Washington St., Chicago, Illinois 60602 on March 24, 2027, at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY Redemption can be made at any time on or before March 15, 2027, by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Room 434, 118 North Clark Street, Chicago, Illinois. For further information contact the County Clerk: Address: 118 North Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, IL Telephone and/or Email Address: 312-603-5645 / tax.redemption@cookcountyil.gov CLARK & RANDOLPH, LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: 10/5/2026
10/12, 10/13, 10/14/2026 158545

Legal Notice

LEGAL NOTICE
CITY OF NAPERVILLE
BIDS AND
REQUESTS FOR PROPOSALS (RFP)
AVAILABLE ONLINE
All City of Naperville formal bids, RFP's and competitive solicitations are posted at OpenGov.com, the City's electronic bidding platform and procurement software provider. A link to the City's OpenGov solicitation page is accessible by visiting the Procurement page of the City's website at:

www.naperville.il.us/government/city-finances/purchasing-and-bids.

All prospective bidders, their authorized agents, and interested parties are invited to view upcoming opportunities and download available documents. General procurement questions may be sent by email to: lanev@naperville.il.us

10/7, 10/14, 10/21, 10/28/2026 139867

LEGAL NOTICE
STATE OF ILLINOIS
COUNTY OF COOK
In the matter of the revision of the assessment of Real Property for 2026:
NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN, pursuant to the provisions of Section 14-35 of the Illinois Property Tax Code (35 ILCS 200/14-35) that the Assessor of Cook County will sit for the purpose of reviewing the proposed 2026 assessment of Real Property located in the following township(s) or taxing district(s) in Cook County.
NORTH CHICAGO
Identified also as Area(s) 14,17 under the Permanent Real Estate Index Numbering System of Cook County.
The last date within which applications for revisions of assessment (Real Estate Assessed Valuation Appeals) may be filed for consideration at such sitting is November 24, 2026.
Such sitting will be held at the office of the Assessor of Cook County, Room 301, in the County Building, 118 North Clark Street, Chicago, Illinois 60602, and will continue thereafter from day to day as necessary until all such revisions in said township(s) or taxing district(s) have been completed.
Done by the Assessor of Cook County this 14th day of October, 2026.
FRITZ KAEGI
ASSESSOR OF COOK COUNTY
10/14/26 163738

NOTICE

METROPOLITAN WATER RECLAMATION DISTRICT OF GREATER CHICAGO

CONTRACT 25-RFP-20
PROCURE AND IMPLEMENT A NEW COMPUTERIZED MAINTENANCE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (CMMS)
Notice is hereby given that the bid opening for the above-cited contract has been changed from Friday, October 16, 2026, to **Friday, October 30, 2026.** Further information is included in Addendum 3 dated October 12, 2026 which has been posted to **www.mwrd.org**.

Darlene A. LoCascio
Director of Procurement
and Materials Management
Chicago, Illinois Pub: 10/14/26
Tribune #163737

NOTICE OF MEDICAL PRACTICE CLOSURE: Dr. Jeffrey Meisles, Dr. Ryon Hennessy, and Dr. Daryl O'Connor are announcing the closure of Orthopedic Specialists, S.C. as of November 16, 2026. The doctors are continuing to practice in the area and can care for your orthopedic needs. Please visit www.orthopedicspecialists.net for their new practice locations and contact information. Dr. Tipirneni is also continuing to practice in the area, and his practice location and contact information can be found on the www.orthopedicspecialists.net website. You can also contact your health insurer or primary care provider for an orthopedic or pain management referral. If you wish to have a copy of your records sent to you or to another provider or facility you may submit a request to our records custodian, Morgan Records via email: Medical@MorganRecords.com, or by phone: (833) 888-0061.
October 14, 2026 - 163891

Legal Notice

Legal Notice

Legal Notice

NOTICE
INVITATION TO BID TO
METROPOLITAN WATER RECLAMATION DISTRICT OF GREATER CHICAGO

Sealed proposals, endorsed as above, will be submitted back to the District via an electronic upload to the Bonfire Portal only, from the date of the Invitation to Bid, up to 11:00 A.M. (Chicago time), on the bid opening date, and will be opened publicly as described in the Invitation to Bid by the Director of Procurement and Materials Management or designee at 11:00 AM on the stated bid opening date below for:

CONTRACT 27-021-11
FURNISH AND DELIVER UNLEADED GASOLINE TO VARIOUS LOCATIONS FOR A ONE (1) YEAR PERIOD

Estimated Cost Group A: $310,000.00 Bid Deposit Group A: NONE
Estimated Cost Group B: $98,800.00 Bid Deposit Group B: NONE
Total: $408,800.00
Bid Opening: October 27, 2026

CONTRACT 27-022-11
FURNISH AND DELIVER DIESEL FUEL TO VARIOUS LOCATIONS FOR A ONE (1) YEAR PERIOD

Estimated Cost: $330,000.00 Bid Deposit: NONE
Bid Opening: October 27, 2026

****

The above is an abbreviated version of the Notice- Invitation to Bid. A full version which includes a brief description of the project and/or service can be found on the District's website, www.mwrd.org; the path is as follows: Doing Business ➡ Procurement and Materials Management ➡ Contract Announcements.

Specifications, proposal forms and/or plans may be obtained from the Department of Procurement and Materials Management by downloading online from the District's website at www.mwrd.org (Doing Business ➡ Procurement & Materials Management ➡ Contract Announcements). No fee is required for the Contract Documents. Any questions regarding the downloading of the Contract Document should be directed to the following email: contractdesk@mwrd.org or call 312-751-6643.

All Contracts for the Construction of Public Works are subject to the Illinois Prevailing Wage Act (820 ILCS 130/1-et.seq.), where it is stated in the Invitation to Bid Page.

The Metropolitan Water Reclamation District of Greater Chicago reserves the right to reject any or all Proposals if deemed in the public's best interest.

Metropolitan Water Reclamation District of Greater Chicago
By Darlene A. LoCascio
Director of Procurement and Materials Management

Chicago, Illinois October 14, 2026 Tribune # 161877

CHICAGO ACCUWEATHER

Meteorologists Larry Mowry, Cheryl Scott, Jaisol Martinez, Tracy Butler and Greg Dutra

AccuWeather Outlook: A shower in places this morning; otherwise, mainly cloudy and cooler. Breezy downtown. Partly to mostly cloudy tonight with late-night showers; cloudy downtown.

Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday	Monday
Day 66°	Day 62°	Day 56°	Day 58°	Day 64°	Day 63°
Night 58°	Night 49°	Night 39°	Night 43°	Night 52°	Night 50°
Not as warm; a morning shower in places	Periods of rain and a thunderstorm	Partly sunny and stiff winds	Plenty of sunshine	Mostly sunny	A little morning rain; mostly cloudy
Winds: NE 8-16 mph	**Winds:** E 7-14 mph	**Winds:** NW 12-25 mph	**Winds:** WSW 6-12 mph	**Winds:** SSW 8-16 mph	**Winds:** SW 6-12 mph
POP: 50%	**POP: 95%**	**POP: 0%**	**POP: 0%**	**POP: 5%**	**POP: 60%**

Chicago forecast

Wednesday Conditions

	8 a.m.	10 a.m.	Noon	2 p.m.	4 p.m.	6 p.m.	8 p.m.
AccuWeather.com UV Index™	0	1	1	1	1	0	0
RealFeel Temperature®	62°	64°	63°	61°	59°	56°	56°

Wednesday Activities

	8 a.m.	10 a.m.	Noon	2 p.m.	4 p.m.	6 p.m.	8 p.m.
Golfing Index	7	6	6	8	8	7	6
Fishing Index	1	2	5	8	3	4	4

The higher the **AccuWeather.com UV Index** number, the greater the need for eye and skin protection. **0-2** Low, **3-5** Moderate, **6-7** High, **8-10** Very High, **11+** Extreme. The patented **AccuWeather.com RealFeel Temperature** is an exclusive index of effective temperature based on eight weather factors. **Golf and Fishing Indexes: 0-2**: Poor; **3-4**: Fair; **5-6**: Good; **7-8**: Very Good; **9-10**: Excellent.

Chicago almanac

Tuesday temperatures

O'Hare through 4 p.m.

	Average	Record
Tuesday high: **80°**	64°	88° (1975)
Tuesday low: **70°**	46°	25° (1988)

Local temperatures

through 6 p.m. Tuesday

Location	High	Low	Average High	Average Low
Aurora	79°	63°	65°	42°
Gary	84°	70°	65°	46°
Kankakee	86°	66°	66°	44°
Lansing	81°	65°	65°	45°
Midway	79°	70°	65°	48°
Romeoville	79°	69°	65°	45°
Valparaiso	84°	67°	67°	45°
Waukegan	78°	68°	62°	44°

Tuesday Precipitation

	2026	2025	Normal
Tuesday*	0.00"	0.00"	0.11"
Month to date	1.41"	1.36"	1.46"
Year to date	36.08"	24.27"	31.36"

*24-hour period ending 4 p.m. Tuesday

Pollen as of 10/13

Trees	Grass	Weeds	Mold
Absent	Absent	Moderate	Very High

Source: Loyola Medicine via NAB

Air Quality Index

Tuesday's reading: **Moderate**

Wednesday's forecast: **Good**

Primary pollutant: **Particulates**

Source: AirNow.gov

Cosmos

Sun and moon

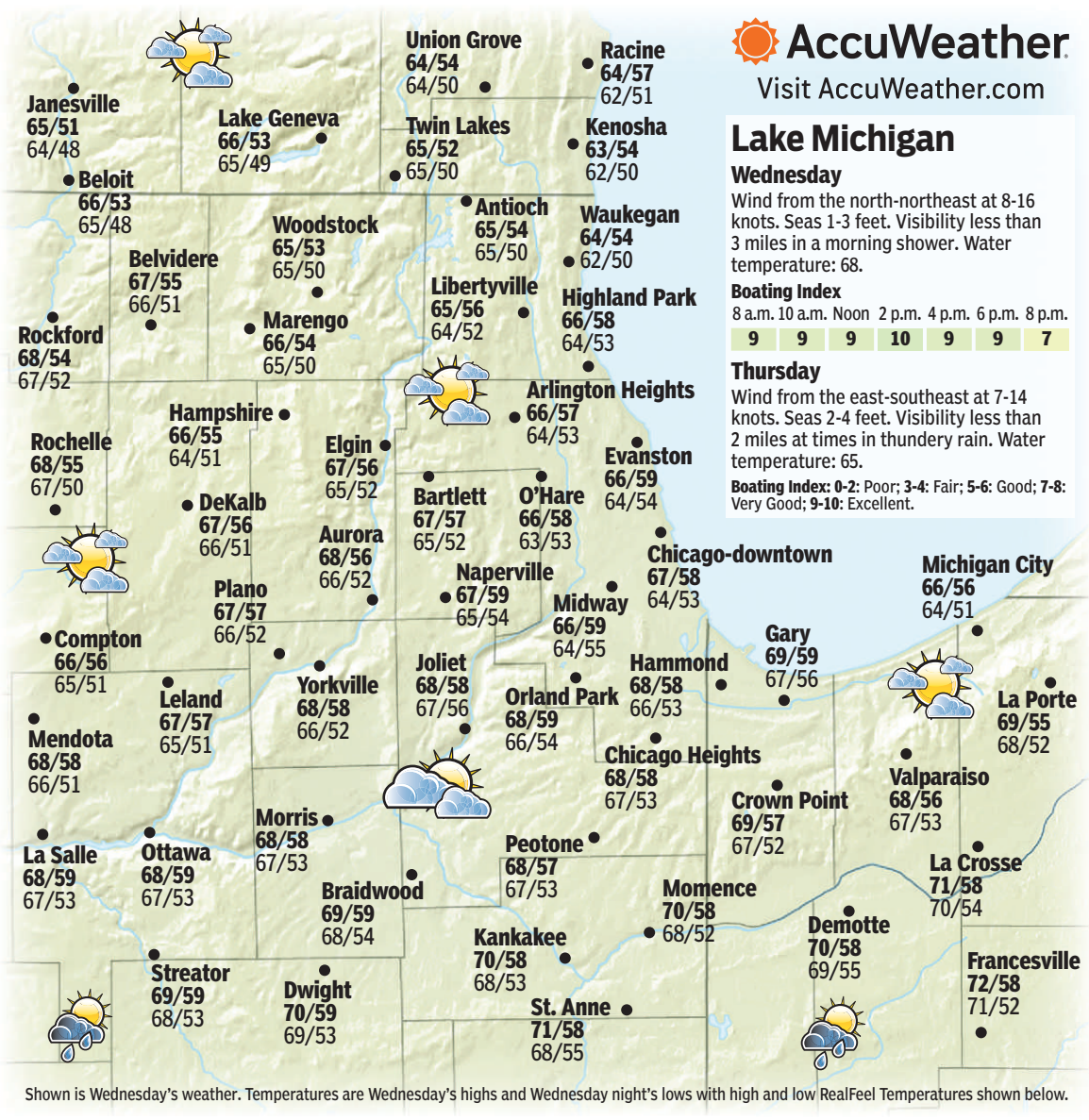
	Wed.	Thu.
Sunrise	7:02 a.m.	7:03 a.m.
Sunset	6:11 p.m.	6:09 p.m.
Moonrise	11:24 a.m.	12:22 p.m.
Moonset	8:05 p.m.	8:53 p.m.

First	Full	Last	New
Oct 18	Oct 25	Nov 1	Nov 9

Wednesday's Planet Watch

	Rise	Set
Mercury	9:20 a.m.	6:58 p.m.
Venus	8:36 a.m.	6:06 p.m.
Mars	12:51 a.m.	3:23 p.m.
Jupiter	1:58 a.m.	3:54 p.m.
Saturn	5:53 p.m.	6:11 a.m.

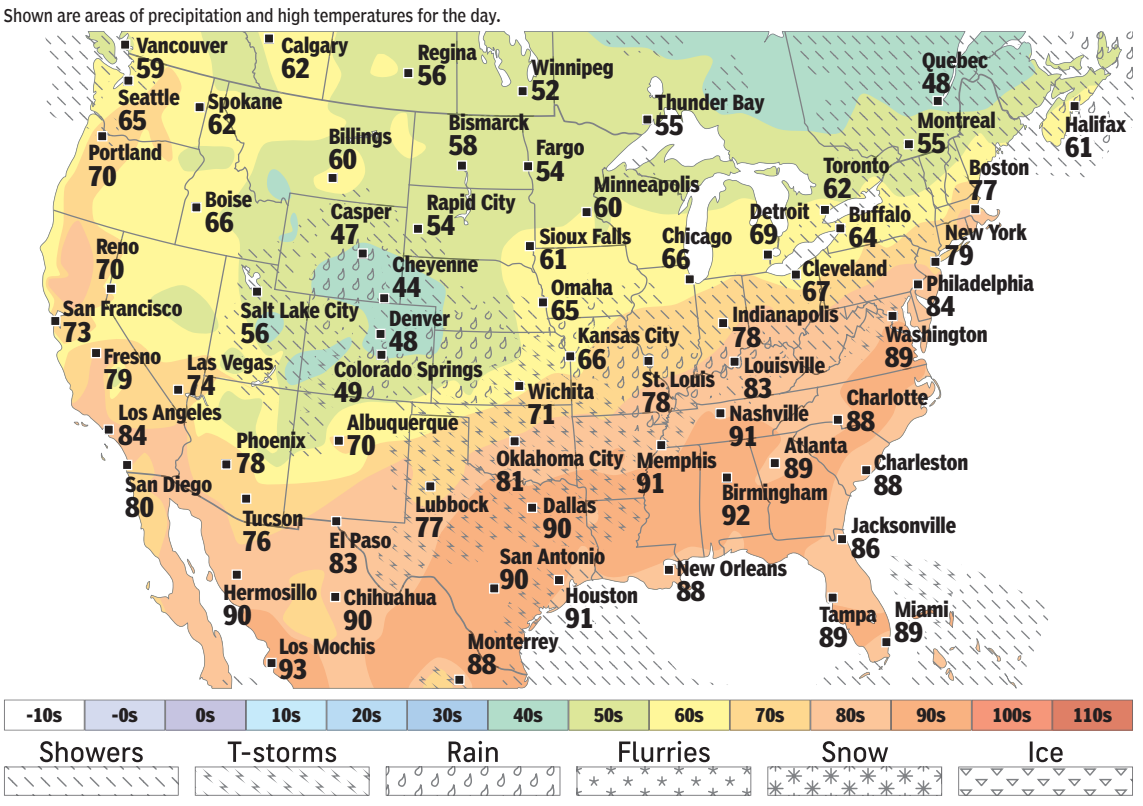
Best viewing times today: Venus: not visible Mars: 6:30 a.m. Jupiter: 6:30 a.m. Saturn: 6:40 p.m. Mercury: 6:40 p.m.



Shown is Wednesday's weather. Temperatures are Wednesday's highs and Wednesday night's lows with high and low RealFeel Temperatures shown below.

National forecast

Shown are areas of precipitation and high temperatures for the day.



AccuWeather
Visit AccuWeather.com

Lake Michigan

Wednesday

Wind from the north-northeast at 8-16 knots. Seas 1-3 feet. Visibility less than 3 miles in a morning shower. Water temperature: 68.

Boating Index

8 a.m.	10 a.m.	Noon	2 p.m.	4 p.m.	6 p.m.	8 p.m.
9	9	9	10	9	9	7

Thursday

Wind from the east-southeast at 7-14 knots. Seas 2-4 feet. Visibility less than 2 miles at times in thundery rain. Water temperature: 65.

Boating Index: 0-2: Poor; **3-4**: Fair; **5-6**: Good; **7-8**: Very Good; **9-10**: Excellent.

Weather history

On Oct. 14, 1988, record cold was widespread across the East. Augusta, Ga., dropped to a low temperature of 31 degrees, while Asheville, N.C., had a low of 25 degrees. Pittsburgh, Pa., fared little better at 26 degrees.

Weather Trivia™

Q: Where is most of the world's fresh water contained?

A: 70 percent is stored in Antarctic ice

Do you have a weather question for the ABC 7 team? Submit them at **abc7chicago.com/weather** or send them to:

Ask ABC 7 Weather Team
190 N. State Street
Chicago, IL 60601

Regional cities

City	Wed. Hi/Lo/W	Thu. Hi/Lo/W
Illinois		
Carbondale	80/68/r	89/51/t
Champaign	77/62/sh	76/49/t
Decatur	76/61/sh	78/50/t
Moline	69/57/sh	65/44/r
Peoria	70/58/sh	72/44/t
Quincy	70/63/sh	75/43/t
Rockford	68/54/pc	62/43/r
Springfield	75/62/sh	77/44/t
Sterling	70/56/pc	63/45/r
Indiana		
Bloomington	78/65/r	78/54/t
Evansville	80/69/r	87/55/t
Fort Wayne	72/55/pc	65/53/t
Indianapolis	78/62/sh	74/52/t
Lafayette	75/62/sh	72/50/t
South Bend	69/54/pc	61/49/r
Wisconsin		
Green Bay	61/48/pc	56/45/r
Kenosha	63/54/pc	60/47/r
La Crosse	64/51/pc	57/45/r
Madison	64/50/pc	59/43/r
Milwaukee	62/54/c	61/47/r
Wausau	60/43/pc	54/41/r
Michigan		
Detroit	69/51/pc	61/54/r
Grand Rapids	66/47/c	58/50/r
Marquette	51/40/c	50/42/r
Sault Ste. Marie	54/38/c	50/46/pc
Traverse City	57/41/c	58/49/r
Iowa		
Ames	66/55/c	58/43/r
Cedar Rapids	66/54/sh	61/42/r
Des Moines	65/57/sh	60/41/r
Dubuque	66/53/c	58/41/r

National cities

City	Wed. Hi/Lo/W	Thu. Hi/Lo/W
Abilene	93/73/t	81/52/t
Albany, NY	66/48/c	58/43/pc
Albuquerque	70/45/s	70/46/s
Amarillo	73/53/t	67/41/c
Anchorage	42/36/c	44/38/c
Asheville	84/56/s	85/58/pc
Aspen	46/33/r	47/22/c
Atlanta	89/64/s	89/65/s
Atlantic City	82/59/pc	66/61/pc
Austin	91/69/t	91/67/s
Baltimore	87/60/t	63/59/r
Billings	60/37/c	56/35/s
Birmingham	92/61/s	90/61/s
Bismarck	58/41/c	53/29/c
Boise	66/40/s	72/45/s
Boston	77/52/pc	62/49/s
Brownsville	93/75/t	90/74/pc
Buffalo	64/48/c	59/53/pc
Burlington, VT	57/44/c	54/41/s
Charleston, SC	88/64/s	87/64/s
Charleston, WV	84/66/t	77/68/t
Charlotte	88/61/s	87/65/pc
Chattanooga	90/64/s	89/61/s
Cheyenne	44/35/sh	48/29/r
Cincinnati	81/63/t	76/58/t
Cleveland	67/51/sh	66/60/r
Colorado Spgs	49/39/r	50/32/pc
Columbia, MO	76/67/r	80/45/t
Columbia, SC	90/60/s	91/62/s
Columbus, OH	78/57/sh	68/60/t
Concord	73/46/c	59/39/s
Corpus Christi	92/74/t	91/73/s
Dallas	90/71/t	88/61/pc
Daytona Beach	85/70/pc	86/72/pc
Denver	48/40/r	50/32/pc
Duluth	53/40/s	52/38/pc
El Paso	83/57/s	80/49/s
Fairbanks	41/29/c	43/28/sf
Fargo	54/40/s	57/36/c
Flagstaff	55/31/s	57/39/s
Fort Myers	90/73/s	91/74/t
Fort Smith	89/72/t	91/59/t
Fresno	79/52/s	86/55/s
Grand Junction	51/42/sh	61/38/s
Great Falls	55/32/s	54/39/s
Harrisburg	81/55/t	66/59/pc
Hartford	77/49/pc	64/46/pc
Helena, MT	54/34/s	54/29/s
Honolulu	88/75/s	87/75/sh
Houston	91/71/t	90/69/s
Int'l Falls	51/35/s	52/36/c
Jackson, MS	95/61/s	92/64/s
Jacksonville	86/65/s	87/65/s
Juneau	49/43/sh	50/46/r
Kansas City	66/62/r	72/42/r
Las Vegas	74/59/s	80/63/s
Lexington	84/68/r	82/62/t
Lincoln	62/55/sh	58/42/r
Little Rock	90/70/t	91/64/s
Los Angeles	84/61/s	93/66/s
Louisville	83/70/r	85/61/t
Macon	92/58/s	90/58/s
Memphis	91/70/pc	94/65/s
Miami	89/79/t	90/77/t
Minneapolis	60/47/pc	55/43/r
Mobile	90/64/s	87/65/s
Montgomery	90/59/s	90/61/s
Nashville	91/69/t	91/66/pc
New Orleans	88/69/s	88/73/s
New York City	79/56/pc	64/56/s
Norfolk	89/68/s	74/66/pc
Oklahoma City	81/69/t	75/49/t
Omaha	65/56/c	58/41/r
Orlando	88/71/sh	89/72/s
Palm Beach	89/79/s	89/78/t
Palm Springs	85/63/s	88/71/s
Philadelphia	84/59/t	69/59/pc
Phoenix	78/60/s	89/70/s
Pittsburgh	73/53/sh	65/62/sh
Portland, ME	69/46/pc	61/43/s
Portland, OR	70/50/pc	79/52/s
Providence	78/51/pc	63/50/s
Raleigh	92/64/s	91/67/pc
Rapid City	54/43/c	58/27/c
Reno	70/40/s	72/41/s
Richmond	92/68/s	72/62/pc
Rochester	63/47/sh	56/48/pc
Sacramento	80/45/s	87/52/s
St. Louis	78/70/r	83/50/t
Salem, OR	72/45/pc	78/44/s
Salt Lake City	56/41/sh	64/40/pc
San Antonio	90/73/t	87/67/s
San Diego	80/57/s	87/63/s
San Francisco	73/52/s	80/57/s
San Juan	89/79/r	89/78/r
Santa Fe	63/37/t	67/36/s
Savannah	88/63/s	88/64/s
Seattle	65/49/pc	72/50/s
Shreveport	92/66/t	91/69/s
Sioux Falls	61/48/pc	57/39/r
Spokane	62/35/s	67/39/s
Syracuse	63/44/c	58/49/pc
Tallahassee	91/61/s	89/62/s
Tampa	89/73/s	88/76/t
Topeka	66/62/t	72/42/r
Tucson	76/53/s	86/69/s
Tulsa	80/72/t	80/50/t
Washington, DC	89/62/t	64/60/r
Wichita	71/66/t	71/43/r
Wilkes-Barre	76/51/sh	64/54/pc
Yuma	82/65/s	89/72/s

World cities

City	Wed. Hi/Lo/W	Thu. Hi/Lo/W
Acapulco	89/75/r	88/77/r
Algiers	81/57/s	84/59/s
Amsterdam	64/51/c	68/56/pc
Ankara	64/51/sh	63/51/sh
Athens	65/61/sh	71/52/pc
Auckland	70/60/r	64/51/sh
Baghdad	106/83/pc	106/79/pc
Bangkok	89/78/t	91/79/r
Barbados	87/80/t	87/79/sh
Barcelona	79/64/pc	75/64/c
Beijing	72/46/pc	81/48/pc
Beirut	81/73/pc	82/70/s
Berlin	63/42/pc	63/43/c
Bermuda	82/75/s	82/74/pc
Bogota	69/49/r	69/50/r
Brussels	65/51/pc	71/56/pc
Bucharest	60/39/pc	61/43/pc
Budapest	59/41/c	63/34/pc
Buenos Aires	65/56/pc	63/54/sh
Cairo	90/70/s	84/68/s
Cancun	89/75/t	86/77/r
Caracas	90/79/r	92/77/r
Casablanca	89/61/s	89/61/s
Copenhagen	59/47/c	58/53/c
Dublin	63/56/c	61/43/sh
Edmonton	58/26/s	53/27/c
Frankfurt	68/43/c	63/41/pc
Geneva	71/46/s	71/45/pc
Guadalajara	83/61/t	81/60/t
Havana	91/74/r	91/75/r
Helsinki	50/46/r	53/48/c
Hong Kong	89/80/s	89/80/pc
Istanbul	68/57/r	62/54/r
Jerusalem	81/64/pc	75/61/pc
Johannesburg	79/57/c	83/60/pc
Kabul	64/50/pc	69/50/s
Kingston	90/80/r	91/80/sh
Kyiv	57/42/pc	54/44/c
Lima	82/72/s	81/73/s
Lisbon	87/63/s	85/64/s
London	67/57/pc	71/53/pc
Madrid	81/55/s	80/53/s
Manila	93/79/r	94/78/t
Mexico City	76/55/pc	76/56/pc
Monterrey	88/72/t	87/66/t
Montreal	55/40/sh	55/44/s
Moscow	48/44/r	50/47/r
Munich	63/42/r	65/43/pc
Nairobi	84/63/s	80/61/r
Nassau	88/78/sh	90/79/t
New Delhi	92/73/pc	89/70/t
Oslo	58/42/s	59/51/c
Ottawa	55/38/sh	54/41/s
Panama City	90/74/r	92/76/t
Paris	69/49/s	74/55/c
Prague	62/39/pc	60/39/c
Rio de Janeiro	82/73/t	80/72/t
Riyadh	99/76/pc	99/75/pc
Rome	76/53/c	76/52/s
Santiago	71/48/r	73/50/t
Seoul	67/51/s	72/60/pc
Singapore	92/80/sh	90/79/pc
Sofia	54/35/c	57/39/c
Stockholm	49/35/r	51/48/pc
Sydney	64/55/pc	65/58/sh
Taipei	86/73/pc	83/73/s
Tehran	86/68/pc	86/68/s
Tokyo	81/65/t	71/63/s
Toronto	62/45/sh	55/51/pc
Trinidad	89/78/s	89/78/s
Vancouver	59/47/c	62/47/s
Vienna	65/43/pc	64/41/pc
Warsaw	56/44/sh	57/39/pc
Winnipeg	52/41/s	49/33/c

Weather(W): **s**-sunny, **pc**-partly cloudy, **c**-cloudy, **sh**-showers, **t**-thunderstorms, **r**-rain, **sf**-snow flurries, **sn**-snow, **i**-ice. **POP**: Probability of Precipitation.

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NAPERVILLE

'We decided we want our voices to be heard'

Nurses at Endeavor Health Edward Hospital seek to unionize

By Carolyn Stein and Lisa Schencker
NAPERVILLE SUN

Nurses at Endeavor Health Edward Hospital have filed a petition with the National Labor Relations Board to hold a union election — part of a broader effort by nurses across the health system to organize.

"We decided we want our voices to be heard," said Elizabeth Garcia, who has worked as a nurse at Edward Hospital for 22 years. "We think that our experience of knowing our patients, advocating for our patients, allows us to have a seat on the table, and that's basically what we want to get out of this."

If successful, 1,000 nurses at Edward Hospital would be represented by the National Nurses Organizing Committee, an affiliate of National Nurses United.

Edward Hospital is not the only Endeavor Health facility with unionization efforts underway. Thousands of nurses across the nine-hospital Endeavor Health system have been in discussions to unionize for months, with National Nurses Organizing Committee and Teamsters Local 743.

Endeavor nurses are hoping to unionize because of unsafe staffing levels, heavy workloads and pay that hasn't kept up with inflation and the cost of living, said David Bernt, organizing director of Teamsters Joint Council 25, which represents workers across Illinois and Northwest Indiana.

Nurses at the other Endeavor hospitals have not yet filed any petitions to hold union elections with the National Labor Relations Board, Bernt said.

Endeavor said in a statement this week, in response to questions about the unionization efforts, that it "respects the federally-protected rights of our nurses to make an informed choice about union representation."

"We also recognize the challenges in providing safe, seamless patient care when a union acts as the intermediary between our nurses and the hospital leadership," Endeavor said in the statement. "One of our greatest strengths is our nurses' ability to work together directly and collaboratively with their leaders and care teams to achieve nursing excellence in service to our patients and communities."

See **NURSES** on Page B3

Mike Ditka, former head coach for the Chicago Bears, is swarmed by the press as he leaves Halas Hall after his firing on Jan. 5, 1993.
ROD LAMKEY/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Ditka made The Score the talk of the town

Coach made the fledgling station his on-air home and center of city's sport talk universe

Robert Channick
CHICAGO MEDIA REPORT

Mike Ditka, the late Hall of Fame Bears player and coach, had a notorious love/hate relationship with the media throughout his football career and beyond.

But Da Coach not only drew microphones, cameras and notepads at every turn, he essentially made The Score, then a fledgling daytime-only AM station, his on-air home and the center of Chicago's sports talk universe during his waning days with the Bears.

"It was huge," said Tom Shaer, the former Chicago sportscaster and inaugural morning host on WSCR-AM. "It was a game-changer."

Ditka was among Shaer's first guests when The Score hit the airwaves Jan. 2, 1992, and by August, WSCR became the radio home of "The Mike Ditka Show," broadcast every Monday from his Rosemont restaurant during what would be his last season as coach of the Bears.

The show ran in the afternoon because The Score launched as a daytime-only station at 1160-AM that had to shut down at night to avoid interfering with distant signals. It nonetheless frequently made waves, such as Ditka threatening to "whip your ass" when "Neil from Northlake" called him a crybaby during a November broadcast.

"I was co-hosting that thing, and it was really insane," Shaer told the Tribune. "It was really crazy."

The Bears fired Ditka on Jan. 5, 1993, after a 5-11 season, and Shaer was at Halas Hall in his dual role as a Channel 5 sportscaster when the axe fell. He remembered the hauling away of Ditka's golf cart on a flatbed as the symbolic end of an era in Bears history.

Meanwhile, The Score became the platform for Chicago fans to mourn the departure of Da Coach for days on end.

"It was like an Irish wake," Shaer said.

Ditka remained on The Score for several years, doing a weekly 90-minute show and making regular appearances on Shaer's morning show until he landed a short-lived coaching gig in January 1997 with the New Orleans Saints.

Bidding an emotional farewell to listeners during Shaer's show, Ditka reflected on the magnitude of his run in Chicago, which created both a Super Bowl-winning team and a media powerhouse.

"If you win in a city as great as Chicago ... then you become more than you should be," Ditka said.

SCHWINN DOCUMENTARY MIDWEST PREMIERE

A Chicago story that has nothing to do with Fire, Med or P.D. will be making its Midwest debut at the Chicago Film Festival next weekend.

"No Hands: The Wild Ride of the Schwinn Bicycle Company" will premiere Oct. 24 at the AMC NewCity 14 and Oct. 25 at the Chicago History Museum, a prelude to a national theatrical and streaming release early next year.

"We marked Chicago as the place we wanted to play this film from day one," said Daniel Clarke, 37, the director, who will be at both Chicago showings to discuss his first full-length film. "It's obviously a Chicago story and really part of the fabric of the Schwinn Bicycle Company."

Narrated by Lance Armstrong, the documentary traces the remarkable rise and fall of Chicago-based Schwinn, the family-owned company that built a two-wheeled empire before spinning into bankruptcy in the 1990s.

From 1950s-era cruisers to the Sting-Ray of the '60s and '70s, Schwinn was once the largest bike manufacturer in the U.S. with more than 1 million two-wheelers produced annually at its peak. By the new millennium, Schwinn was out of the family's hands and just another brand.

See **MEDIA** on Page B2

Cortland Street Bridge expected to reopen by the end of 2028

By Talia Soglin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

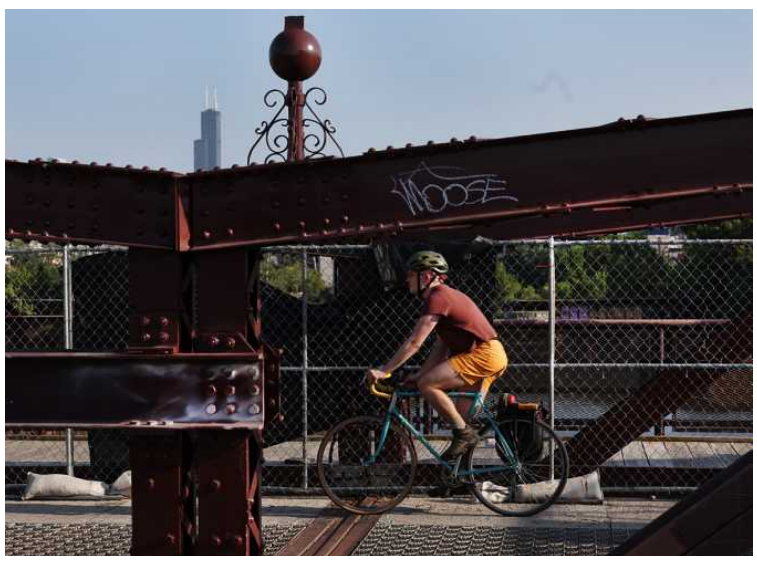
Construction work on the Cortland Street Bridge, which has been closed to vehicle traffic for more than a year, could be completed around the end of 2028, the Chicago Department of Transportation said Tuesday.

Department spokesperson Erica Schroeder said the timeline was "significantly shorter" than other approaches the city had considered to try to fix the historically significant but structurally challenged 124-year-old North Side bridge.

The commitment seems to have assuaged some concerns from North Side aldermen, who, frustrated by what seemed to be the indefinite closure of the historic bridge and the mess of resultant traffic in their wards, had proposed taking the unusual step of stripping the structure of its landmark designation in order to speed up the process of getting a functional bridge at Cortland Street.

Members of the City Council's zoning committee Tuesday deferred a vote on a measure that would have removed the city landmark status of the bridge, which is said to be the oldest example of Chicago's iconic trunnion bascule bridge style.

Ald. Brian Hopkins, 2nd, said during Tuesday's meeting that he had been assured by the CDOT that work on the bridge could be completed by the end of 2028.



A cyclist rides on the Cortland Street Bridge over the Chicago River on Sept. 2, 2026. The bridge has been closed to vehicles for more than a year. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

"We asked the Department of Transportation to do everything possible to work within the current landmark designation," said Hopkins, who added he was not giving up on the idea of repealing the landmark status in the future.

"We don't want to interfere with the sensitivity of this moment, where CDOT is completing their scope of work, dealing with federal agencies who may not be in favor" of the removal of the designation, he said as he moved to defer a vote on the ordinance.

When CDOT first closed the bridge to vehicles last year, officials estimated the bridge would be closed for two years at most.

But this summer, the department said it had discovered the bridge was actually in worse shape than previously thought.

CDOT suggested at the time that fixing the bridge could take a year-and-a-half to two years of construction alone — not counting design work or state or federal review processes. Hopkins said Tuesday he had been told previously that fixing the bridge could take as long as five years.

Schroeder said CDOT had "developed an alternative rehabilitation approach that can be completed under the existing construction contract while maintaining the bridge's historic character and addressing structural conditions identified during bridge assessments."

Actual construction work is expected to begin by the end of this year and would last about two years once it starts, she said. The new timeline is "significantly shorter than other alternatives that would have required restarting design and environmental and historic-preservation review," she said.

The City Council has not repealed the status of a city landmark since the 1980s, when the McCarthy Building was stripped of its historic status to pave the way for the Block 37 development downtown.

Preservation advocates have railed against the possibility of the city taking such action again, arguing the move could be a slippery slope that would threaten Chicago's rich architectural heritage.

And CDOT had warned this summer that removing the bridge's landmark status would not, in fact, allow the city to immediately replace it.

Because Illinois has designated Chicago's bascule bridges as eligible for the National Register of Historic Places, the project would still be subject to certain state and federal environmental and historic preservation reviews, even if its city historical status was revoked, CDOT said.

Hopkins acknowledged that wrinkle Tuesday, saying the "issue is much more complicated than it appears at the surface," he said.

Hopkins and fellow North Side aldermen Scott Waguespack, 32nd, and Timmy Knudsen, 43rd, had sponsored the measure set to go before the zoning committee on Tuesday.

While the bridge is closed to city buses — causing a circuitous reroute of the #73 CTA bus — and to cars, it is open to cyclists and pedestrians.

Some cyclists have rejoiced at the bridge's lack of cars.

One idea proposed has been to keep the bridge open to pedestrian and bike traffic and build an adjoining bridge, or nearby bridge, for cars.

But CDOT has more or less poured cold water on that idea, saying this summer it would require "multiple years of right-of-way negotiations as well as design and construction."

The Cortland Street Bridge is one of three North Side bridges currently closed to vehicle traffic, the others being at Lake Street downtown and at Chicago Avenue on the Near North Side.

Earlier this year, aldermen at their wits' end with concurrent bridge closures and the traffic disasters left in their wake passed an ordinance requiring CDOT to notify the City Council and brief its members on any bridge closures slated to last more than a month.

Big banks post strong Q3 profits, but issue warning

JPMorgan CEO points to rates, inflation as trouble spots in US

By Ken Sweet
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Wall Street's biggest banks reported another strong quarter Tuesday, as the U.S. consumer continues to pay their bills and businesses keep investing heavily in AI.

But even as JPMorgan Chase, Citigroup, Wells Fargo and Goldman Sachs reported higher profits from a year ago, they warned about the long-term impact of higher interest rates as well as the impact higher prices could have on consumer if inflation is not brought under control.

JPMorgan posted a $15.3 billion profit in the third quarter, or $5.57 a share, up from $14.4 billion or $5.07 a share, in the same period a year earlier. The results missed analysts' expectations, with Wall Street looking for the bank to earn $5.93 a share.

It was a rare earnings miss for JPMorgan and its CEO, Jamie Dimon. The last time the bank missed analysts' expectations was nearly three years ago. The investment banking division of JPMorgan was to blame this quarter, as its fixed income trading desks saw a slowdown in activity compared to both earlier this summer as well as last year.

"The U.S. economy continued to be fueled by strong business investment and ongoing consumer spending," Dimon said in a statement. "However, large fiscal deficits, sticky inflation, elevated asset prices, rising interest rates and geopolitical conditions continue to shift under the surface."

The big banks typically kick off the quarterly earnings season, and this is a key one for the stock market given that robust corporate profits have helped propel the S&P 500 to record levels. Analysts expect companies in the S&P 500 to deliver overall growth of nearly 30% in earnings per share from a year earlier, according to data provider FactSet. If they're correct, it would be the third consecutive quarter of growth that exceeds 25%.

Goldman Sachs, whose third-quarter profits rose sharply due to a sharp rise in stock-trading revenue, also reported that its bond trading activity slowed last quarter. The bank posted a profit of $5.29 billion, or $17.01 a share, compared to $4.1 billion, or $12.25 a share, a year earlier.

The bond market saw significant levels of volatility and turmoil this summer, as investors became increasingly worried about government spending and inflation. The yield on cornerstone financial instruments like 10-year and 30-year Treasurys rose to levels not seen in years. Higher diesel, technology and food prices gave the Federal Reserve reason to raise interest rates last month, despite pressure from the White House to not do so.

Citigroup said its third-quarter profits jumped 40% from a year ago, beating Wall Street expectations. The bank posted higher revenue from investment banking and wealth management, while the bank's credit card division profits were flat.

Wells Fargo posted a profit of $5.95 billion, or $1.87 a share, beating Wall Street forecasts. The San Francisco-based bank has seen its profits climb steadily in recent quarters after federal bank regulators removed the asset cap that had been imposed for several years after the bank's sales practices scandal nearly a decade ago.

Mark Mattei stands among his bike collection in the attic of his home in Lincoln Park on Dec. 3, 2025. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Stalled US home sales rose 1.5% in September

By Alex Veiga
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Sales of previously occupied U.S. homes rose in September from the previous month, but slowed compared to a year ago, the latest sign the housing market remains stalled as rising mortgage rates and home prices discourage prospective homebuyers.

Existing home sales rose 1.5% last month from August to a seasonally adjusted annual rate of 3.99 million units, the National Association of Realtors said Tuesday. One of the factors in the monthly increase is that sales in August were revised lower.

Sales fell 2.2% compared with September last year. The latest sales tally is slightly above the 3.98 million pace economists were expecting, according to FactSet.

Home sales have been mostly hovering close to a 4 million annual pace going back to 2023, far short of the historic norm that is closer to 5.2 million. September is the second month in a row that the annual sales pace has remained below 4 million.

The U.S. median sales price increased 1.3% from a year earlier to $417,500, an all-time high for the month of September based on data dating to 1999, NAR said. Home prices have risen on an annual basis for 39 months in a row. "This is a very tough market out there," said Lawrence Yun, NAR's chief economist.

The housing market has been in a slump since 2022, when mortgage rates began to climb from pandemic-era lows. Sales of previously occupied homes were essentially flat last year, stuck at a 30-year low.

The average rate on the benchmark 30-year mortgage hit 7.4% last week, its highest level in nearly three years.

All told, unsold home inventory rose 1.9% last month from August and climbed 4.6% from September last year, NAR said.

Business briefs

IMF BUMPS UP 2026 OUTLOOK FOR GLOBAL ECONOMY TO 3.1%

BANGKOK — The International Monetary Fund on Tuesday slightly upgraded its outlook for the world economy for this year, while warning of growing risks from rising debt, including the financial frenzy around artificial intelligence.

The IMF says it expects the global economy to grow at a 3.1% pace this year. That's up from its July forecast for 3.0% growth and well below the 3.5% expansion in 2025. Growth in 2027 should rebound to 3.4%, it said in its latest Economic Outlook.

The report, released as world economic and financial leaders gathered in Thailand for the fall meetings of the IMF and World Bank, predicts that growth in the United States will remain steady at 2.3% in 2026 and 2027.

Advanced economies will grow 2.1% this year, up from 2.0% in 2025, and then slow to 1.9% next year, it said. — *Associated Press*

KROGER TO OUST 3K CORPORATE WORKERS AS FIRM EMBRACES AI

Grocery store chain Kroger said it will lay off 3,000 corporate employees over the next three years as it ramps up its use of artificial intelligence to streamline operations.

"Technology is reshaping what's possible," CEO Greg Foran wrote to employees Monday. "The way work gets done is changing across every industry; we must adapt and take advantage of technology." Kroger last month outlined its AI strategy, meant "to improve the customer experience, make work easier for associates and produce better business outcomes."

Cincinnati-based Kroger is the largest standalone U.S. supermarket chain with 409,000 workers and over 2,700 stores operating under various brands, including Ralphs, King Soopers, Smith's and Fred Meyer.

Kroger named former Walmart executive Foran CEO in February. — *Associated Press*

CYBERATTACK HITS HUNDREDS OF FRENCH SUPERMARKETS

PARIS — A cyberattack hit refrigeration systems in at least 380 supermarkets in France this week, according to several major food retailers.

The attack targeted systems made by Danfoss, a Danish refrigeration business, the company said. Some 300 shops from the Intermarché and Netto chains were affected, as well as 80 from Coopérative U.

Groupe Casino, another major retailer, said 5% of the stores in its Monoprix chain had been affected, although it was not immediately clear how many stores that represented.

No one has claimed responsibility for the attack, and prosecutors said they had yet to identify any suspects.

In some stores, the attack forced workers to throw out food that required refrigerating, according to staffers and photographs from several supermarkets. — *The New York Times*

MEDIA

from Page B1

Three years in the making, the documentary is based on a 1996 book of the same name by Chicago authors Judith Crown and Glenn Coleman, who will also be at next week's premiere.

Clarke interviewed a number of Chicagoans for the movie, including Schwinn family members and former employees. He also featured Mark Mattei, a retired Chicago bike shop owner whose Lincoln Park home was a veritable Schwinn museum.

Mattei, who passed away in the spring, was integral to the film, Clarke said.

"There's no way we could have even made this film without Mark," said Clarke, who plans to honor Mattei in the credits before the film goes into full distribution.

The film, which premiered in April at the Boulder International Film Festival, will wrap up the festival circuit in Chicago next week. Clarke said the response has been enthusiastic from moviegoers, many of whom owned Schwinn bicycles as kids, according to theater surveys.

Clarke is hoping the film will resonate with a wider audience when it goes nationwide next year.

"I feel like we did right by the history of Schwinn, and I think it's an incredibly iconic American brand that influenced our culture in mind-blowing ways," Clarke said. "And I'm really proud to have codified that in our own creative way."

WBBM TOPS RADIO RATINGS AGAIN

For the second month in a row, WBBM-AM 780 and 105.9 FM, Audacy's all-news combo, was the top-rated radio station in Chicago, narrowly besting sister station WXRT-FM 93.1 in September.

WBBM nonetheless fell nearly a full point to a 5.5 share among listeners 6 and older in the latest ratings from Nielsen. Audacy-owned rock station WXRT lost some ground as well, but maintained its No. 2 ranking with a 5.4 share.

The Mix, WTMX-FM 101.9, Hubbard's adult contemporary station, held steady at third with a 5.2 share, according to Nielsen.

Rounding out the top 10 were WLIT-FM 93.9 (adult contemporary); WDRV-FM 97.1 (rock); WUSN-FM 99.5 (country); WVAZ-FM 102.7 (urban); WKSC-FM 103.5 (contemporary hits); WBEZ 91.5 FM (NPR) and WGN-AM 720 (news/talk).

Meanwhile, 104.3 The Score grew its audience during Jarrett Payton's first month as co-host of the sports station's morning show. WSCR-AM 670 and 104.3 FM jumped to a 3.0 share, tied with MeTV FM at No. 11 among Chicago stations in September.

Payton replaced longtime Score morning co-host Mike Mulligan, grabbing the mic next to former Tribune sportswriter David Haugh on Aug. 31.

MORNING SHOW HOST TO EXIT AT WBEZ

A prominent local voice on WBEZ-FM 91.9 will be leaving next month after six years at the NPR station.

Sasha-Ann Simons, who hosts "In the Loop," a daily one-hour talk show that airs weekdays at 9 a.m., will end her run on Nov. 6. WBEZ plans to keep "In the Loop" on the air with interim hosts as it searches for a permanent replacement for Simons, the station said.

"We, as well as many, many listeners, will miss Sasha-Ann tremendously," Melissa Bell, CEO of Chicago Public Media, said in a news release.

Simons joined WBEZ in December 2020 to host the two-hour midday talk show "Reset," replacing Jenn White, who left for the nationally syndicated 1A. In 2024, WBEZ cut "Reset" to one hour and the following year hit the reset button entirely, replacing it with 1A, which is distributed by NPR.

WBEZ launched a new morning show lineup in September 2025 with Simon's "In the Loop" at 9 a.m., followed by "Say More" with Mary Dixon and Patrick Smith from 10 to 11 a.m, creating the only fully local two-hour programming block on the station's weekday schedule.

"Leading 'Reset' and now 'In the Loop' has been one of the great privileges of my career," Simons said in the news release. "I am truly thankful for the Chicagoans who welcomed me into their lives and trusted me with their stories, questions and hopes for this city."

As for Simons' post-WBEZ plans, we remain out of the loop for now.

CHICAGO PUBLIC MEDIA LAUNCHES CHICAGO.COM

A long-dormant piece of digital real estate is finally open for browsing.

Chicago Public Media has launched its new website, chicago.com, looking to create a digital platform and online community to share news, local events and "less toxic" social engagement, according to a news release.

The phased rollout starts with five pilot communities — Avondale, Bronzeville, Edgewater & Andersonville, Evanston and South Shore — where registered users can connect through a community newsletter, events calendar and online discussion moderated by a local steward.

More than 5,000 people have signed up to participate in the five pilot communities as the site — dubbed a digital "experiment" by Chicago Public Media — goes fully live this week.

"We're putting an early version into the world, inviting people in, and starting to learn what is useful, what needs to change and how the platform can become a trusted piece of civic infrastructure over time," Chicago Public Media CEO Melissa Bell said in a news release.

Beyond its civic aspirations, chicago.com will serve as a news aggregation site, primarily platforming the work of the Sun-Times and NPR station WBEZ-FM 91.5, which joined together under the nonprofit banner of Chicago Public Media in 2022.

The site also includes food and drink guides, as well as a how-to section with useful tips on everything from filing a pothole claim to perusing the city's restaurant inspection reports.

A gift from the Chicago Community Trust, the chicago.com site remains a "work in progress that will be built and refined alongside the people who use it," according to Chicago Public Media.

DITKA, THE TV PITCHMAN

The death of Ditka last week brought back memories of the Hall of Fame tight end, Super Bowl-winning coach and quintessential Chicago Bear, immortalized in "SNL" skits and the collective unconscious of a city as "Da Coach."

But as successful as Ditka was on the football field, he may have been even more prolific as a TV pitchman, endorsing dozens of products over the years.

Ditka sold everything and anything, including cars, underwear, rustproofing, erectile dysfunction drugs, hot dogs, hair spray and toilet tissue. So prodigious was his commercial output that in 1989, then-Bears President Michael McCaskey asked him to curtail his paid endorsements.

While his coaching career ended in 1999 after a brief run with New Orleans Saints, Ditka's commercial profile endured, with ads for everything from Blu-Emu and CarShield to the Medicare Helpline still running nationally last month, according to media tracking firm iSpot.

In a January 2019 interview with the Tribune, done by phone from a golf course near his Florida home, Ditka not only stood by his ubiquitous commercial endorsements, he encouraged a playoff-bound Bears team to do likewise — before their season ended with the "double-doink" wild-card loss to the Eagles.

"There's a lot of things I probably should have done, a lot of things I shouldn't have done," Ditka said between golf shots. "I'm not going to apologize to anybody."

DAILY HERALD FORMS UNION

The National Labor Relations Board has certified the formation of the Daily Herald News Guild, creating the first editorial union in the northwest suburban newspaper's 150-year history.

Employees voted 15-0 to form the union Oct. 1, and achieved formal certification by the NLRB last week.

The unionization effort at the Daily Herald took root after the employee-owned newspaper's June 22 sale to Tribune Publishing, gaining momentum in the wake of Aug. 10 layoffs of seven editorial and five business positions, according to Kevin Schmit, associate sports editor and a member of the organizing committee.

Send tips about Chicago media moves and news to rchannick@chicagotribune.com.

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Market Roundup

DOW 51,670.10 -180.45 -0.35%

NASDAQ 27,204.38 -41.52 -0.15%

S&P 500 7,805.45 -1.79 -0.02%

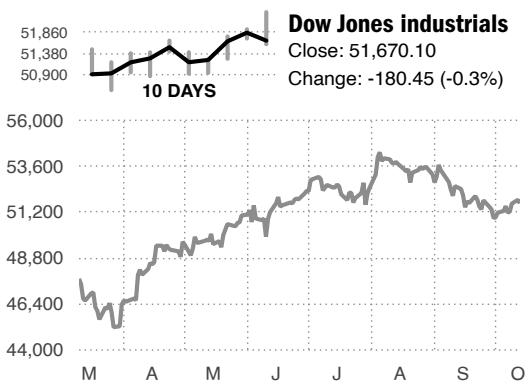
EURO 1.1198 0.0041 0.37%

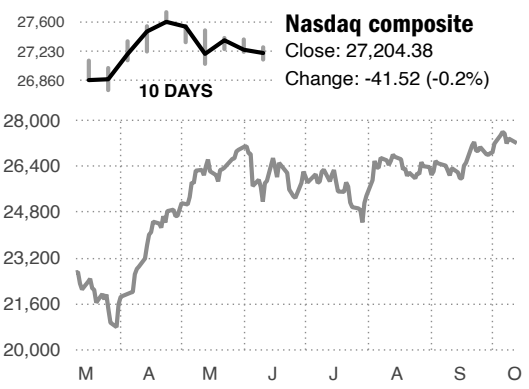
CRUDE OIL 94.14 0.40 0.43%

GOLD 4,152.90 -12.90 -0.31%

6-MO T-BILLS 4.35 0.02 0.46%

30-YR T-BONDS 5.56 -0.04 -0.64%





StocksRecap

	NYSE	NASD
Vol. (in mil.)	4307	3396
Pvs. Volume	3716	3123
Advanced	1418	1214
Declined	1189	2229
New Highs	49	118
New Lows	91	390

	HIGH	LOW	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	WK	MO	QTR	YTD
DOW	52,317.32	51,587.67	51,670.10	-180.45	-0.35%	▲	▲	▲	+7.50%
DOW Trans.	19,885.34	19,606.49	19,810.47	+51.39	+0.26%	▲	▲	▲	+14.13%
DOW Util.	1,069.74	1,047.24	1,066.92	+7.26	+0.69%	▲	▲	▲	-0.11%
NYSE Comp.	24,065.56	23,901.68	23,985.00	-5.72	-0.02%	▲	▲	▲	+9.00%
NASDAQ	27,277.23	27,121.57	27,204.38	-41.52	-0.15%	▼	▲	▲	+17.05%
S&P 500	7,814.15	7,786.11	7,805.45	-1.79	-0.02%	▼	▲	▲	+14.02%
S&P 400	3,668.66	3,631.43	3,658.71	+3.60	+0.10%	▼	▲	▲	+10.70%
DOW Total	76,871.97	76,554.18	76,758.70	-48.37	-0.06%	▼	▲	▲	+13.71%
Russell 2000	2,801.98	2,774.46	2,783.37	-11.11	-0.40%	▼	▼	▼	+12.15%

LOCAL STOCKS

NAME	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	YTD CHG	LO	HI	DIV
ANI Pharmaceuticals Inc.	70.84	-2.75	-3.7%	-8.10	69.58	97.00	...
AbbVie Inc.	274.36	-6.76	-2.4%	+45.87	190.75	283.43	6.92
Abbott Laboratories	102.61	+.79	+0.8%	-22.68	81.97	133.34	2.52
Acco Brands Corp.	4.57	+.03	+0.7%	+.84	2.81	4.65	0.30
Allstate Corp., The	236.40	+3.80	+1.6%	+28.25	188.08	277.22	4.32
AptarGroup Inc.	119.21	+.26	+0.2%	-2.75	103.23	146.91	1.92
Archer Daniels Midland Cc	83.20	+2.78	+3.5%	+25.71	55.58	88.75	2.08
Baxter International Inc.	24.89	+.11	+0.4%	+5.78	15.73	30.00	0.04
Boeing Co.	186.49	-3.01	-1.6%	-30.63	176.77	254.35	...
Brunswick Corp.	62.48	+.34	+0.5%	-11.76	59.06	90.25	1.76
CDW	151.98	+8.21	+5.7%	+15.78	97.12	161.10	2.52
CF Industries Holdings Inc	117.25	+2.67	+2.3%	+39.91	75.42	141.96	2.40
CME Group Inc.	278.03	+.79	+0.3%	+4.95	218.31	329.16	5.20
CNA Financial Corp.	46.73	+.07	+0.2%	-1.01	41.53	55.71	1.92
Century Aluminum	34.16	-0.80	-2.3%	-5.02	25.40	70.43	...
Chicago Rivet & Machine (	11.50	+.52	+4.7%	-2.41	8.50	15.00	0.12
ConAgra Brands Inc.	13.70	+.02	+0.1%	-3.61	12.53	20.32	0.70
Deere & Co.	650.00	+17.39	+2.7%	+184.43	433.48	721.22	6.48
Distribution Solutions Grp	35.07	+.01	+0.0%	+7.68	19.02	35.30	...
Dover Corp.	192.48	+1.60	+0.8%	-2.76	158.97	237.54	2.10
Enova International Inc.	174.99	-1.84	-1.0%	+17.79	103.02	267.45	...
Equity Lifestyle Propert. In	58.94	-0.25	-0.4%	-1.67	57.46	69.00	2.17
Exelon Corp.	42.34	+.22	+0.5%	-1.25	39.73	50.65	1.68
Federal Signal Corp.	114.24	-0.54	-0.5%	+5.65	101.18	134.51	0.60
First Indust.Realty Trust In	59.86	-0.18	-0.3%	+2.59	51.02	69.88	2.00
First Mid Bancshares Inc.	48.85	-0.35	-0.7%	+9.85	34.16	53.36	1.00
Fortune Brands Innovatior	39.05	+.47	+1.2%	-10.97	32.34	64.84	1.04
FreightCar America Inc.	6.29	+.01	+0.2%	-4.78	6.06	14.90	...
Fuel Technologies Inc.	1.61	-0.04	-2.4%	+.05	1.17	3.45	...
GATX Corp.	166.72	+.56	+0.3%	-2.88	150.42	205.56	2.64
Gallagher & Co., Arthur J.	232.90	-1.02	-0.4%	-25.89	190.75	304.03	2.80
Grainger Inc., W.W.	1325.10	+18.37	+1.4%	+316.05	906.52	1419.91	9.96
Groupon Inc.	18.47	+.01	+0.1%	+.86	9.17	29.90	...
Hub Group Inc.	26.38	-0.23	-0.9%	-16.23	25.64	53.26	0.50
Huron Consulting Group In	176.43	+3.10	+1.8%	+3.52	84.88	186.78	...
Hyatt Hotels Corp.	162.92	+1.74	+1.1%	+2.60	134.18	206.86	0.60
IDEX Corp.	237.19	+1.42	+0.6%	+59.25	159.27	243.80	2.92
Illinois Tool Works Inc.	266.32	+1.21	+0.5%	+20.02	238.82	303.16	6.88
Ingredion Inc.	97.26	+1.04	+1.1%	-13.00	93.72	123.49	3.32
JBT Marel Corp.	106.61	-0.12	-0.1%	-44.06	103.26	170.19	0.40
JPMorgan Chase & Co.	331.43	-2.87	-0.9%	+9.21	279.10	366.50	6.60
John B. Sanfilippo & Son I	66.51	-0.85	-1.3%	-4.09	59.07	92.08	...
Jones Lang Lasalle Inc.	298.32	+.22	+0.1%	-38.15	259.83	393.84	...
Kemper Corp.	27.70	+.09	+0.3%	-12.84	22.69	50.52	1.28
Knowles Corp.	36.58	+.06	+0.2%	+15.15	20.57	42.93	...
Kraft Heinz	22.43	-0.02	-0.1%	-1.82	21.04	28.09	1.60
LKQ Corp.	22.18	+.08	+0.4%	-8.02	21.17	37.13	1.20
Lifeway Foods Inc.	22.60	+.02	+0.1%	-1.63	17.31	32.71	...
Littelfuse Inc.	415.03	+1.19	+0.3%	+162.11	233.36	500.57	3.00
MYR Group Inc. (Del.)	309.09	-4.09	-1.3%	+90.59	190.14	503.56	...
McDonald's Corp.	235.81	+.16	+0.1%	-69.82	229.20	341.75	7.72
Methode Electronics Inc.	15.12	-0.12	-0.8%	+8.48	4.88	20.38	0.20
Middleby Corp	106.46	+1.09	+1.0%	-13.14	89.15	148.20	...
Mondelez International Inc	61.50	-0.29	-0.5%	+7.67	51.20	66.65	2.08
Morningstar Inc.	204.37	+.07	+0.0%	-12.94	141.49	227.51	2.00
Motorola Solutions Inc.	449.01	+2.68	+0.6%	+65.69	359.36	494.85	4.84
NISOURCE Inc.	41.49	+.26	+0.6%	-0.27	38.42	49.21	1.20
Northern Trust Corp.	167.48	-1.73	-1.0%	+30.89	121.12	193.89	3.20
Oil-Dri Corp. of America	87.38	+2.05	+2.4%	+38.44	45.61	107.00	0.90
Old Republic Intl Corp.	38.15	+.08	+0.2%	-7.49	36.65	46.76	1.26
Old Second Bancorp Inc.	24.80	-0.04	-0.2%	+5.30	16.65	26.06	0.28
OneSpan Inc.	18.20	+.35	+2.0%	+5.36	10.07	18.82	0.52
Packaging Corp. of Americ	231.65	+3.83	+1.7%	+25.42	191.50	259.98	6.00
Paylocity Holding Corp.	158.11	+2.08	+1.3%	+5.61	93.27	160.73	...
Portillo's Inc.	4.56	+.29	+6.8%	+.02	3.29	6.69	...
Richardson Electronics Lt	21.28	+.54	+2.6%	+10.40	9.37	23.15	0.24
Ryan Specialty Holdings Ir	37.85	+.60	+1.6%	-13.78	29.28	58.94	0.52
Stepan Co.	62.01	+1.21	+2.0%	+14.65	41.82	68.00	1.58
Suncoke Energy Inc.	10.22	+.16	+1.6%	+3.02	5.52	10.68	0.48
Telephone & Data Systems	34.74	-0.05	-0.1%	-6.26	31.51	49.12	0.16
Titan International Inc.	6.98	+.13	+1.9%	-0.85	6.37	11.70	...
Tootsie Roll Industries Inc.	37.65	-0.06	-0.2%	+1.02	34.44	45.06	0.36
TransUnion	67.49	+1.42	+2.1%	-18.26	60.96	89.12	0.50
US Foods Holding Corp.	97.91	+.21	+0.2%	+22.59	69.88	111.42	...
Ulta Beauty Inc.	579.27	+11.53	+2.1%	-25.74	443.60	714.97	...
United Airlines	103.23	-1.21	-1.2%	-8.59	84.64	138.77	...
Ventas Inc.	83.85	+.31	+0.4%	+6.47	67.46	101.60	2.08
Wintrust Financial Corp.	142.79	-1.41	-1.0%	+2.97	119.61	167.22	2.20
Yunhong Green CTI Ltd.	2.67	-0.03	-1.1%	-0.96	2.38	6.13	...
Zebra Technologies Corp.	386.57	-1.55	-0.4%	+143.75	199.05	390.80	...

Commodities

Natural gas rose 3.66% to $3.28. Silver fell 1.63% to $59.16, while platinum decreased 1.31% to $1657.40. Unleaded gas dropped 1.26% to $3.25.

FUELS	CLOSE	PVS.	CHG	%YTD
Crude Oil (bbl)	94.14	93.74	+0.40	+64.0
Heating Oil (gal)	4.72	4.74	-0.02	+134.0
Natural Gas (mm btu)	3.28	3.17	+0.12	-10.9
Unleaded Gas (gal)	3.25	3.29	-0.04	+89.5
METALS	**CLOSE**	**PVS.**	**CHG**	**%YTD**
Aluminum (ton)	3,127.75	3,134.25	-6.50	+7.6
Copper (lb)	6.68	6.70	-0.02	+18.6
Gold (oz)	4,152.90	4,165.80	-12.90	-4.0
Platinum (oz)	1,657.40	1,679.40	-22.00	-18.5
Silver (oz)	59.16	60.14	-0.98	-15.6
AGRICULTURE	**CLOSE**	**PVS.**	**CHG**	**%YTD**
Lumber (1,000 bd ft)	546.50	539.50	+7.00	-14.3
Cattle (lb)	2.25	2.25	+0.00	-3.0
Coffee (lb)	2.91	2.87	+0.04	-15.9
Corn (bu)	4.83	4.83	+0.00	+9.6
Cotton (lb)	80.60	80.54	+0.06	+25.3
Orange Juice (lb)	1.51	1.49	+0.02	-31.1
Soybeans (bu)	12.84	12.88	-0.04	+24.6
Wheat (bu)	6.69	6.72	-0.03	+32.0

Foreign Exchange

Taiwan Dollar led gains with 0.72%, while Swedish Krona fell most at -0.67%. Mexican Peso rose 0.61%, and Indian Rupee declined 0.62%.

MAJORS	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	6MO AGO	1YR AGO
British Pound (GBP/USD)	1.3256	+.0047	+.35%	1.3501	1.3334
Canadian Dollar	1.4215	-.0067	-.47%	1.3791	1.4031
Euro (EUR/USD)	1.1198	+.0041	+.37%	1.1755	1.1570
Japanese Yen	158.262	-.3190	-.20%	159.35	152.24
Mexican Peso	18.3497	+.1106	+.61%	17.299	18.448
EUROPE/AFRICA/MIDDLE EAST					
Israeli Shekel	3.0748	+.0024	+.08%	3.0439	3.2878
Norwegian Krone	9.5065	-.0559	-.58%	9.4222	10.081
South African Rand	16.4515	-.0564	-.34%	16.364	17.297
Swedish Krona	9.9550	-.0676	-.67%	9.1688	9.5034
Swiss Franc	.8323	-.0018	-.21%	.7835	.8037
ASIA/PACIFIC					
Australian Dollar	1.4318	-.0047	-.33%	1.4088	1.5341
Chinese Yuan	6.6920	+.0000	+.00%	6.8303	7.1275
Hong Kong Dollar	7.8478	+.0007	+.01%	7.8314	7.7801
Indian Rupee	95.0904	-.5883	-.62%	94.599	88.664
Singapore Dollar	1.2794	-.0007	-.05%	1.2725	1.2984
South Korean Won	1329.23	-4.170	-.31%	1477.2	1426.1
Taiwan Dollar	32.1600	+.2286	+.72%	31.624	30.682

Interestrates

The yield on the 10-year Treasury note fell to 5.22%. Yields affect interest rates on mortgages and other consumer loans.

	PRIME RATE	FED FUNDS
YEST	7.00	3.88
6 MO AGO	6.75	3.63
1 YR AGO	6.75	3.63

TREASURIES	LAST	PVS	NET CHG	WK	MO	QTR	1YR AGO
3-month T-bill	4.19	4.16	+0.03	▲	▲	▲	3.70
6-month T-bill	4.35	4.33	+0.02	▲	▲	▲	3.70
1-year T-bill	4.48	4.47	+0.01	▲	▲	▲	3.69
2-year T-note	4.79	4.79	0.00	–	▲	▲	3.78
5-year T-note	5.00	5.02	-0.02	▼	▲	▲	3.91
10-year T-note	5.22	5.24	-0.03	▼	▲	▲	4.32
30-year T-bond	5.56	5.60	-0.04	▼	▲	▲	4.94

CONSUMER RATES	NAT'L AVG	WK AGO	6MO AGO	1YR AGO
72 month new car loan	5.74 –	5.74	6.17	6.37
Money Market Account	0.45 ▼	0.45	0.42	0.44
1 year cd	2.10 ▲	2.07	1.88	1.96
$30K Home equity loan	7.33 ▲	7.31	7.10	8.16
30 year fixed mortgage	7.51 ▲	7.36	6.40	6.39
15 year fixed mortgage	6.85 ▲	6.75	5.79	5.71

NURSES

from Page B1

At Edward Hospital, Garcia said that one of the main issues she and her co-workers are facing is staffing and retention levels. Garcia works as a nurse in the intensive care unit, where staffing levels are typically two-patients-to-one-nurse or sometimes one-patient-to-one-nurse for very critical patients, she said.

"(When) a patient's so sick, it consumes all your time and sometimes you need help," she said.

However, Garcia said she does not always get to maintain that one-to-one staffing level for patients that need critical care due to not having enough nurses, which she said creates an unsafe working environment.

Sometimes, she said she will be given three patients to take care of because that third patient has been downgraded and should be transferred to another unit but the other unit is full and no one is available to take on that other patient.

Edward Hospital in Naperville on June 27, 2016.
PHIL VELASQUEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

"When you're being tripled, you're taking care of three family members, three people's loved ones and still hold it to your critical care standards," she said. "It's hard to turn off critical care standards ... and it does take away time from your ICU patients."

Those kinds of working environments also discourage nurses from staying at Edward Hospital, Garcia said.

In addition to improved staffing levels, Garcia noted that her and her colleagues also want better compensation.

"I think we would want to just get overall improved compensation, improved benefits, that would be nice," Garcia said. "But what we're really fighting (for) here is for safer working conditions, safer ratios. We love our community. I've been in this community for 22 years and I'm very passionate about it. I'm like a mama bear when it comes down to my patients and my community."

The petition to unionize for Edward Hospital nurses was filed on Thursday, but a date for a union election has not yet been set, Garcia said. As for nurses at other Endeavor Health hospitals, Bernt was unable to provide a timeline for filing petitions, but he said, "We believe we have enough support to move forward."

Teamsters Local 743 has already, however, filed charges against Endeavor with the National Labor Relations Board, after the union said two nurses were fired from Endeavor Health Evanston Hospital earlier this year because of their union activities.

Endeavor did not comment directly on the alleged firings.

Tricia Poreda, a critical care resource nurse at Endeavor, said nurses across the system feel demoralized by staffing changes in recent years. As part of her job, Poreda floats between Endeavor's Evanston, Glenbrook, Skokie and Highland Park hospitals.

"They've been running staffing so lean that we're not able to accommodate any extra emergent situation or deterioration in a patient," Poreda said. "It leaves nurses providing care that is not up to the standard of care for patients."

Endeavor nurses also experienced pay cuts in 2025, she said.

In 2024 and 2025, Endeavor saw operating losses of $494 million and $33.9 million, respectively, according to financial statements. Much of the 2024 operating loss was attributable to $453 million in expenses to settle patients' claims alleging one of Endeavor's former doctors sexually abused them, Endeavor said in a financial disclosure in late 2024. The financial statement did not name the doctor, but as of early 2025, Endeavor had settled more than 75 lawsuits filed by patients who alleged they were sexually abused by former obstetrician/gynecologist Dr. Fabio Ortega.

Poreda said she personally saw a $9 an hour pay cut. She said the cuts made nurses feel "undervalued and disrespected."

Endeavor said in a statement Tuesday it "increased pay opportunity for our nursing team members twice in 2026 — as a part of our annual merit pay process in April and, most recently, through an across the board base pay adjustment in October for Endeavor direct care clinical nurses. On average, these nurses received a 6% increase in compensation this year."

Unionization efforts for nurses have also taken place recently in other Chicago area hospitals.

Over the past year, National Nurses Organizing Committee has organized nearly 3,000 nurses in the Chicago area, including at Olympia Fields Hospital, Rush University Medical Center and Saint Mary of Nazareth Hospital. The National Nurses Organizing Committee now represents 9,000 nurses in the Chicago area.

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Guilfoyle out amid ethics controversy

White House issues resignation demand to envoy to Greece

By Matthew Lee
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kimberly Guilfoyle has vowed to "vigorously defend" herself against claims of misconduct. **ARIS MESSINIS/GETTY-AFP 2025**

WASHINGTON — The White House publicly asked for U.S. Ambassador to Greece Kimberly Guilfoyle's resignation Tuesday as she faced mounting accusations of improper conduct, and she announced within two hours that she was quitting, ending days of talk and speculation about her professional fate. Guilfoyle insisted that she would "vigorously defend" herself.

President Donald Trump's administration had said earlier Tuesday that it had asked Guilfoyle to leave her post after she faced severe criticism over allegations she engaged in improper and possibly illegal conduct before and during her tenure in Athens.

That revelation came in response to a question to freshly minted White House press secretary Katie Zacharia at her first media briefing Tuesday morning. Zacharia said Guilfoyle "has been a wonderful asset to the team, and we wish her well."

"She went to Greece. She was doing a good job, but we didn't like what we were reading," Trump said just after Guilfoyle's resignation, which was posted on her X account. He said he had not spoken to her but "she will not be there."

Guilfoyle's departure comes after its possibility was previewed to The Associated Press over the weekend and Trump registered his unhappiness Monday at reports about her alleged conduct. Those comments came a day after the AP, citing a senior U.S. official, reported that Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio were "extremely pissed off" by Guilfoyle's reported conduct.

In a series of stories dating to late last month, The Wall Street Journal has reported questionable conduct by Guilfoyle, including an alleged threat to a host country official, accepting improper gifts and services, and offering to use her influence inside the Republican administration in return for the payment of a large credit card bill.

Guilfoyle addressed the accusations in her resignation post on X, saying, "These allegations are false, and I intend to vigorously defend my name, my reputation, and my integrity."

"I have dedicated my professional life to fighting for justice, standing up for what is right, and defending the values that make America exceptional," she said. "I will not allow false accusations to define my decades of public service."

In a statement released late Sunday, Guilfoyle's lawyers denied that she had done anything wrong and claimed that the money she was seeking from a Trump donor was payment for services — public appearances and speaking engagements that predate her ambassadorial nomination — that had not been paid.

The lawyers, David Schwartz and Jesse Binnall, also rejected allegations of impropriety related to Guilfoyle's travel on private planes, saying that before every such trip she "sought, obtained and followed State Department guidance and followed the Department's travel regulations."

They did not immediately return calls Tuesday.

After defending Guilfoyle following the first report, Rubio declined to comment publicly on the growing allegations. Last week, Rubio said: "Our ambassador has been a strong ambassador here."

But after another report appeared later, Rubio — speaking Thursday before leaving Athens — berated journalists for asking about the allegations. He said that he didn't know if they were true and that he would not respond if he could not confirm them.

"You guys walk around thinking that because some source told you something and you reported it, it's the gospel. It's not the gospel. It's not the gospel for me. That's not the way we do things," Rubio said at the foot of his plane as Guilfoyle, who was there to see him depart, looked on.

A second U.S. official, who also spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss personnel matters, said the State Department's inspector general was looking into the allegations, which first began surfacing in the Journal late last month and have since multiplied.

The top two Democrats on the House Foreign Affairs and Senate Foreign Relations committees, Rep. Gregory Meeks of New York and Sen. Jeanne Shaheen of New Hampshire, as well as the ranking member on the House Committee for Oversight and Government Reform, Rep. Robert Garcia, D-Calif., have called for an investigation into Guilfoyle.

Since late September, the Journal has detailed numerous accounts of questionable conduct by Guilfoyle. Its first report said that she had told guests at a reception that the United States could undermine the Greek government if it chose to, promoted the business interests of one particular Greek construction and energy company, and allowed its lobbyist into private diplomatic meetings.

The Journal reported — citing text messages — that Guilfoyle had asked a Trump donor to pay a $100,000 credit card bill just before her confirmation hearing, promising him access to administration officials if he did.

Another report, from the British tabloid The Daily Mail, said that Guilfoyle had alienated staff at the U.S. Embassy in Athens and had pushed the bounds of behavior appropriate for the top representative of the U.S. government to Greece.

Guilfoyle is a former Fox News Channel host and California prosecutor who was married to Democrat Gavin Newsom when he was San Francisco's mayor, before he became California's governor. She later was engaged to Trump's son Donald Trump Jr.

Poll: Many think Trump profiting off presidency

US adults say leader prioritizing wealth, not helping people

By Bernard Condon and Amelia Thomson-Deveaux
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Eric Trump, right, is executive vice president of the Trump Organization, which has struck eight foreign deals in the first year of his father's second term. **ALTAF QADRI/AP 2025**

NEW YORK — Most Americans think Donald Trump is profiting off the presidency in unethical or illegal ways and is focused more on his wealth than helping people like them, a new AP-NORC poll finds.

As Trump's family business pulls in record money from new ventures helped by his policies, the survey from Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research finds that when it comes to allegations that Trump is profiting from the presidency, about 6 in 10 U.S. adults believe he is either illegally profiting or doing something unethical but not illegal. Only about 2 in 10 think the Republican president is doing nothing wrong, while a similar share say they don't know enough to say.

At the same time, just over half of Americans say Trump has prioritized his personal financial interests "a lot" since returning to the White House, while only about one-quarter say he puts the same emphasis on the country as a whole. Few U.S. adults, about 1 in 10, say he's focused "a lot" on people like them.

Trump derided the issue of conflicts of interest at the start of his second term, telling The New York Times that "I found out that nobody cared." Unlike in his first term, he's lifted a self-imposed ban on his family striking private-sector deals overseas and started several new crypto businesses.

The poll results suggest that most U.S. adults think growing his personal fortune has been a focus for Trump in his second term, at least to some extent. Only about one-quarter of U.S. adults say he's prioritizing his personal business interests "only a little" or "not at all," including less than half of Republicans.

The White House has repeatedly dismissed accusations that Trump and his family business are benefiting financially from his office as a fake problem, stating categorically that he has zero conflicts and acts only in the interest of the country.

In a required federal disclosure of his financial holdings that Trump filed in June, he reported taking in more than $1 billion from new crypto businesses after he loosened regulation on the industry.

One of his biggest crypto ventures got a half-billion-dollar investment after he was elected from a United Arab Emirates business tied to the royal family. It also got help from a cryptocurrency company founded by a Chinese billionaire in trouble with the law in the U.S.

On the real estate side of the business, the Trump Organization has struck eight foreign deals in the first year of his presidency, including many in authoritarian or one-party states with influence over private business and eager to keep Trump happy, U.S. tariffs low or the U.S. military protecting it — or all three.

Overall, about 4 in 10 U.S. adults say Trump is doing something illegal, while about 2 in 10 think he's doing something unethical but not illegal. Democrats are especially likely to believe he has broken the law, with about 8 in 10 saying that.

Oscar Delgado, a 50-year-old Democrat who voted for Trump in 2024 because he thought he could improve things, now accuses Trump of "turning greedy."

"He's not putting the country first," said Delgado, who lives in Lansing, Michigan, and works in a Ford metal stamping factory. "I wanted a change, but I didn't expect this change."

Independents and Republicans are much less convinced than Democrats that Trump is breaking the law. Only about 3 in 10 independents and about 1 in 10 Republicans say he's doing something illegal. About 2 in 10 independents and a similar share of Republicans think his behavior is unethical but not illegal.

Most Republicans think he is doing nothing wrong or say they don't know enough to judge.

"His family has probably benefited, but I don't think he has," said Republican Audra Pelsue, 52, dismissing Trump critics as too angry to see straight. "It's Trump derangement syndrome."

Pelsue, a manager at a laundry machine maker from Syracuse, New York, sees a double standard among Trump critics, pointing to what she says was insufficient outrage over President Joe Biden's son.

"Look at Hunter Biden!" she said, referring to his position as director at Ukrainian energy company Burisma when his father, a Democrat, was vice president. "It was OK for Biden kids to benefit, but it's not OK for Trump's?"

Just over half, 56%, of U.S. adults say Trump has put "a lot" of emphasis on his personal businesses since taking office again, while a similar share, 54%, say this about the business interests of his friends and family.

In contrast, only about one-quarter of Americans say he's prioritized the country as a whole "a lot" since returning to the White House, and even fewer, about 1 in 10, say he's focused "a lot" on people like them.

Ex-gang leader gets 40 years to life in prison for role in Shakur's '96 killing

By Jessica Hill
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Davis

LAS VEGAS — Duane "Keffe D" Davis was sentenced Tuesday to 40 years to life in prison for orchestrating the murder of rap icon Tupac Shakur who was gunned down off the Las Vegas Strip over 30 years ago.

Davis, 63, was convicted in August of first-degree murder with the use of a deadly weapon. He is the only person ever charged in the death of Shakur, whose popularity was peaking at age 25.

Prosecutor Marc DiGiacomo said Tuesday that whatever sentence the court imposes, Davis is "guaranteed to die" behind bars.

The killing went unsolved for years until Davis, a former leader of the South Side Compton Crips, gave interviews and published his role in the shooting in his 2019 tell-all memoir.

DiGiacomo said Davis was trying to profit off a killing that he committed, and for that he does not deserve the minimum sentence.

"In my mind he deserves the maximum possible," DiGiacomo said.

Davis spoke briefly in court, telling Judge Carli Kierny he wants items back that police took from his house, including his pictures. Asked if there was anything else he wanted to say, Davis said: "No, I'm good."

Davis' lawyer, Michael Sanft said he plans to appeal the verdict. Sanft said prosecutors waited too long to bring the case.

On the night of Sept. 7, 1996, Shakur was in the passenger seat of a black BMW with music mogul Marion "Suge" Knight when a white Cadillac pulled up at a red light, and shots erupted. Shakur was shot multiple times and died six days later, while Knight survived.

Shakur is considered one of the most influential and versatile rappers of all time and had a burgeoning film acting career at the time of his death.

In his memoir, Davis explained how Shakur and his entourage beat up Davis' nephew hours before the shooting in Las Vegas. He said he sought retaliation, and that he was in the passenger seat of the Cadillac and passed the gun to the backseat, where shots were fired. Davis had spoken to police years before but avoided prosecution because of an agreement he made with law enforcement.

During the weekslong trial, prosecutors relied on Davis' statements he made to law enforcement and documentarians. They argued Davis orchestrated the shooting, which was the result of a rivalry between the South Side Compton Crips and Mob Piru. Davis' defense attorney pointed to a lack of physical evidence that connected his client to the crime, and portrayed Davis as a liar trying to make money.

Europe allies recoil from diesel deal

US plan to buy fuel from Russia stokes diplomatic dilemma

By Michael D. Shear and Jeanna Smialek
THE NEW YORK TIMES

President Donald Trump prepares to depart on Saturday from Joint Base Andrews, Md. **ALEX KENT/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

European and British officials were stunned by President Donald Trump's unexpected announcement that he had made a deal with President Vladimir Putin to purchase Russian diesel fuel, which had been subject to U.S. sanctions. But they were in a bind on how to respond.

The arrangement, which President Volodymyr Zelenskyy of Ukraine called "a gift" to Putin, directly undercuts years of effort by dozens of countries — including the United States — to cut Russia off from the money that fuels Putin's war of aggression in Ukraine.

Energy experts have said that the diesel agreement, if it goes ahead, could send some $4 billion of American money into the Russian economy.

Trump's announcement Friday afternoon of his "highly successful discussion" with Putin was all the more shocking in Europe as it came after Russia conducted several brutal strikes in Ukraine, killing 22 people including three babies in an apartment block Wednesday and at least 30 people in a bus Thursday.

For European leaders, the dilemma over the past three days has been familiar: How to support Ukraine in a moment of acute diplomatic peril, without triggering Trump's ire?

Complicating their response is the fact that Europe as a whole depended heavily on Russia for energy before 2022. And despite cutting purchases significantly since the invasion of Ukraine, several European nations continue to buy Russian natural gas — which does not yet face full sanctions — amid growing energy insecurity and limited supply.

Hungary and Slovakia, which have had pro-Russian governments in recent years, have continued to import Russian oil.

Both Trump and Russian officials highlighted the imports of Russian fuel to European nations over the past four years in the aftermath of the diesel announcement.

As European leaders scrambled for a response, they stopped short of directly criticizing the American president and coalesced around a single diplomatic message: We are not changing our own approach to Russia, and we stand by Ukraine.

On Saturday, Britain announced that Prime Minister Andy Burnham had spoken to Zelenskyy, noting that he had begun the call "by recognizing the last 24 hours had been difficult for Ukraine" — an oblique reference to Trump's intervention — and had "reiterated his complete solidarity." The statement added that Burnham would meet with Zelenskyy in the coming days.

A spokesperson for the German chancellor, Friedrich Merz, told reporters that the government was "standing by the sanctions decisions against Russia and is working together with its European partners on further sanctions."

Kaja Kallas, the European Union's top diplomat, began her comments to reporters Monday with a conciliatory nod to the United States, before saying that the bloc was "continuing our path" of trying to keep Russia from enriching itself by blocking the sale of oil and gas on the global market.

"The U.S. is our biggest ally, but our message is clear," she said while entering a meeting of foreign affairs ministers in Luxembourg. "If we want to end this war, the only way we can do this is by putting more pressure on Russia."

Margus Tsahkna, the minister of foreign affairs for Estonia, was more blunt.

"We have had this kind of turbulence and also pressure from President Trump's side to Ukraine before," he said. "So we need to focus on what we can do."

Trump responded to the European reaction on his TruthSocial site Monday afternoon.

"The European Union paid Russia 250 Billion Dollars for Energy, and the Fake News Media doesn't want to get near that story," the president wrote, possibly referring to European purchases of Russian oil since Russia invaded. "I made the right choice for the American People — ALWAYS, AMERICA FIRST!"

Since early 2022, the EU as a whole has imported about $266 billion worth of Russian oil, coal and gas, according to a tracker led by the Center for Research on Energy and Clean Air, a research group.

But the bulk of those imports were in the first year after the war began, as Europe worked to cut its long-standing reliance on Russian energy. Since then, the bloc has imposed sanctions and implemented phaseouts, and the EU's fossil fuel imports from Russia now stand at about $52 million of energy imports per day, a fraction of the nearly $895 million it imported on the peak day in 2022.

Russian natural gas, which is harder to replace than oil because of tight global supplies and because it is transported via pipelines or specialized terminals, has continued to flow to nations including Belgium, France and Spain. But Europe is tapering those remaining imports, and it is set to prohibit new long-term liquefied natural gas contracts from early next year.

Petras Katinas, a researcher at the Royal United Services Institute, a think tank, said Europe had moved quickly to phase out Russian energy in some cases, as in the case of oil, while moving more slowly than many supporters of Ukraine would prefer in the case of natural gas.

But he said that overall, Europe had gone from being very dependent on Russian energy to cutting it rapidly, and he argued that European leaders were not being hypocritical in criticizing Trump's diesel move.

"The drop is huge," he said of Europe's Russian energy use.

NEWS BRIEFING

Cornell bans parties at frat houses for school year after assault suit

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Cornell University suspended parties at fraternity houses until next year and is giving state police a role in investigating reports of sexual assault on campus in the school's latest response to outrage over its handling of a gang rape allegation.

The measures announced Tuesday by Cornell President Michael Kotlikoff include a suspension of all parties and social events at Interfraternity Council houses through the end of the 2026-27 academic year and a new "zero tolerance" policy that would immediately suspend chapters for violations.

Cornell has more than 20 active Interfraternity Council fraternities. It's unclear whether the restrictions extend to off-campus parties.

The university president also committed to adding a case manager to the school's Office of Civil Rights to help those who report sexual misconduct on the Cornell campus navigate the process, and to working with New York State Police to allow its criminal investigators — who are independent of Cornell — to investigate allegations.

Crimes reported on Cornell's campus are generally investigated by campus police, a department that has full law enforcement powers but is controlled by the university.

The campus police force operates independently from municipal police in Ithaca, New York, where the university is located. Its officers investigated the 2024 gang rape allegations and presented their initial findings to the Tompkins County district attorney, who declined to prosecute within weeks of the woman making her first report to police.

New York's governor removed the district attorney from the case this month after a public outcry over the lack of charges.

The investigation is now being led by New York Attorney General Letitia James, while Cornell has hired former Deputy U.S. Attorney General Sally Yates to conduct an independent review of the university's response.

In a lawsuit filed in September, a woman alleged she was drugged and sexually assaulted by multiple fraternity members after attending a party at the Chi Phi house in October 2024.

Bank of America fine: The U.S. Treasury Department said Tuesday that it's imposing $1.2 billion in fines on Bank of America for allegedly violating anti-money laundering and sanctions laws.

The fines on America's second-biggest bank amount to the third-largest in the department's history.

Treasury said Bank of America also reached an $11.6 million settlement with the department's Office of Foreign Assets Control over "apparent violations of numerous sanctions programs, including on Iran, Russia, narcotics, and global terrorism."

The latest action is the third-largest penalty ever issued by the Treasury Department, behind a roughly $4 billion settlement in 2023 with Binance, the world's largest cryptocurrency exchange, and an approximately $3 billion settlement with Canada-based TD Bank the following year.

DC golf course: U.S. District Judge Ana Reyes on Tuesday ordered a halt to tree-cutting at the East Potomac Golf Course until Oct. 26, putting a further pause on work at the historic D.C. course that has been part of President Donald Trump's plans to remake the city.

Reyes issued the order one day after a tense three-hour hearing in Washington in which she harshly criticized the government for having deceived her with its actions over the holiday weekend.

At the Monday hearing, Reyes ordered a 24-hour pause that could be extended to 14 days if necessary.

The pause was limited to one day while the government tried to find a key Trump administration official to discuss why a massive tree-cutting at the park needed to occur over the holiday weekend, with little notification to plaintiffs in a lawsuit trying to halt renovation plans or the judge.

The judge also ordered during that period the government "must provide the court and plaintiffs three business days' written advance notice prior to making any irreparable modification to any permanent form or feature of the East Potomac Golf Course."

The DC Preservation League and two local golfers are the plaintiffs in the lawsuit.

Deadly derailment: A local takes photographs of a derailed passenger train Tuesday in central Pakistan. Police said five people died and 35 others were injured. The train was traveling from the southern city of Karachi to the northwestern city of Peshawar when it derailed in Sher Shah city in Punjab province, a Pakistan Railways spokesman said. **ASIM TANVEER/AP**

Mass shooter trial: Jury selection began Tuesday in the federal hate crime trial of a man who admitted to killing 10 Black people in a massacre at a New York supermarket in 2022, a case that could lead to a rare death sentence.

Payton Gendron is already spending life in prison after pleading guilty to state murder charges and tearfully renouncing his white supremacist views. He now faces a trial in federal court arising from the same mass shooting. The stakes are high: If convicted, the 23-year-old could face the death penalty.

The attack at the Tops Friendly Market in Buffalo is believed to be the deadliest hate-motivated shooting targeting Black people in the U.S. by a lone gunman in the past century.

Gendron has pleaded not guilty to dozens of hate crime and gun charges, though his defense lawyers openly predicted a conviction when speaking to prospective jurors Tuesday.

Pacific storms: The death toll from Hurricane Simon and the remnants of Tropical Storm Rachel rose to six Tuesday after heavy rains triggered flooding and landslides along Mexico's Pacific coast, authorities said.

Hurricane Simon continued moving slowly off Mexico's Pacific coast as a Category 1 storm, bringing heavy rain to Nayarit and Sinaloa states, where authorities remained on alert for rising rivers and flooding. Over the weekend, the hurricane brought heavy rain to the southern state of Guerrero, killing one person.

But the worst damage was reported farther north, in the coastal city of Ensenada, Baja California, where flooding caused by Rachel's remnants killed at least five people.

Meanwhile, Tropical Storm Trudy formed in the Pacific and is forecast to become a major hurricane in the next few days, the National Hurricane Center in Miami said.

Drone strikes off Bulgaria: Drones struck two ships in the Black Sea off Bulgaria on Tuesday, sinking one and prompting emergency rescue operations, Prime Minister Rumen Radev said.

The Guinea-Bissau-flagged cargo ship Dignity sank after it was hit by a military strike.

Five sailors were rescued, while a search for the other 11 crew members continued, Varna district Gov. Mario Smrkov said.

Rescuers evacuated all 15 crew members from the Ukrainian-operated coastal freighter Chelsea 3, sailing under the Maltese flag, with five receiving treatment for minor injuries, Radev said in a video posted to social media.

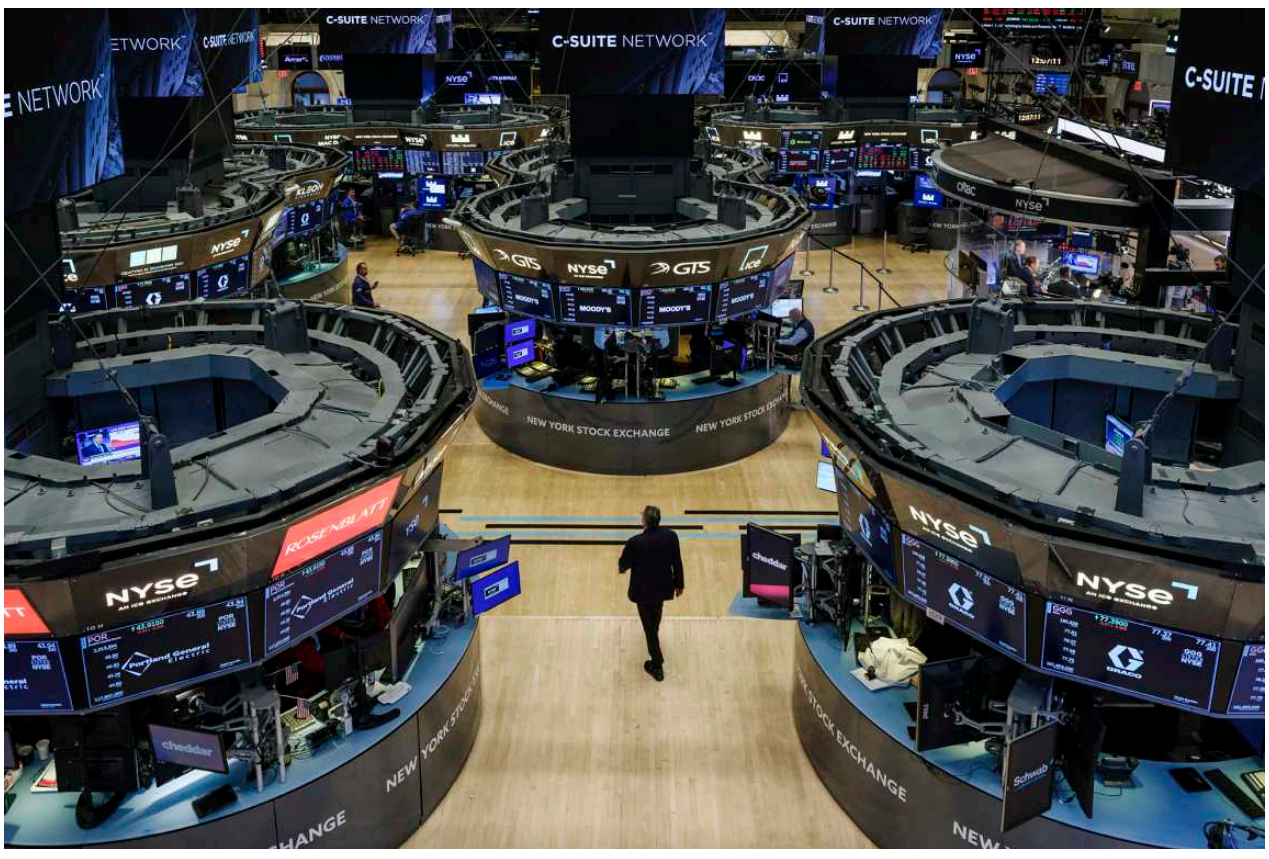
The crew, which included seven Ukrainian citizens and eight Azerbaijani citizens, reported the ship was hit by three drones. The strikes on the two ships happened 20 miles and 21 miles from the Bulgarian coast.

Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha blamed Russia for the attacks in a post on X.

Democrats tie corruption to high costs

Candidates deliver closing message to voters in midterms

By Carl Hulse
THE NEW YORK TIMES



The New York Stock Exchange is seen Sept. 28 in the city's Manhattan borough. A vow to ban congressional stock trading is part of the Democratic Party's anti-corruption agenda. **KARSTEN MORAN/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

WASHINGTON — Democrats who have spent months emphasizing the high cost of living in their fight to win control of Congress are increasingly invoking corruption in Washington to sharpen that message in the closing weeks of the campaign, blaming self-dealing by politicians for driving up prices.

Armed with research showing that voters have grown numb to the idea that politicians cannot be trusted, Democrats are using the message to stoke anti-incumbent sentiment as Republicans attempt to defend their slim House and Senate majorities. Their claim is that rampant corruption in Congress and the administration is directly costing average citizens who are paying more for necessities like groceries, gas and medicine while those in power get rich through insider knowledge, pay-to-play schemes and the backing of billionaires and powerful corporations.

That message is taking center stage in political ads, speeches and debates in some of the most competitive races in the country.

"You aren't the problem and neither are your fellow Americans," Sen. Jon Ossoff, a Democrat running for reelection in Georgia, says in a campaign video. "Corruption is why things don't work for the American people."

Democrats are using the message in multiple competitive House and Senate contests, with candidates pointing to increases in the net worth of lawmakers and administration officials and vowing to embrace an anti-corruption agenda, including banning congressional stock trading and ending the revolving door between lawmakers on Capitol Hill and lobbyists on K Street.

Democratic candidates also are hitting Republican members of Congress with accusations of protecting enablers of convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, after the GOP had to be forced into taking up and passing legislation directing the Justice Department to release files in his case.

It is yet another way that Democratic leaders are trying to yoke Republican candidates to President Donald Trump. Multiple accounts have shown Trump's family and others connected to the government enriching themselves during his presidency through cryptocurrency trading, peddling influence, securing lucrative real estate deals with foreign entities and negotiating pardons.

The Democratic candidate in Pennsylvania's 7th Congressional District, a firefighter named Bob Brooks, has an ad declaring that he has "never seen a dumpster fire" like Washington, where "corporate PACs and Big Tech" back lawmakers, "and your paycheck goes up in smoke."

In Virginia's 1st District, Democratic county prosecutor Shannon Taylor released an "accountability agenda" that she said was aimed at pursuing "elected officials who are looking out for themselves while raising our costs and hurting our community."

And in Kentucky's 6th District, where the two parties are vying for an open seat, a recent ad for Democratic Navy veteran and former federal prosecutor Zach Dembo promises that he will take on health insurance companies denying care "and go after corruption in both parties."

Democratic leaders, increasingly confident of their chances of grabbing the House majority, see the anti-corruption theme as a significant element of their platform, one they say they intend to deliver on if they take control of the House, Senate or both.

Rep. Hakeem Jeffries of New York, who is in line to be speaker should his party win the House, has repeatedly said Democrats intend to "hold the crooks accountable" if their candidates prevail. In a meeting with reporters last week, he called corruption "an incredibly important theme" for Democratic House candidates.

"The reality facing the American people is that the cost of living is way too high, and Donald Trump, along with his Republican sycophantic members of Congress, have actually decided not to do anything about it because so many of them are so focused on enriching themselves, their family members, their friends and their donors," Jeffries said. "There is a cost to corruption."

Accusations of corruption and political misconduct have been a staple of congressional campaigns for decades, though the emphasis has shifted from election to election. In the 1990s, Republicans recaptured the House after 40 years by successfully branding the entrenched Democratic majority as corrupt, citing multiple scandals such as rampant abuse of overdrafts at the House bank. In 2006, Democrats regained power by accusing the Republican majority of fostering a "culture of corruption" with various scandals, including one involving a lawmaker who sent sexual messages to teenage House pages.

But Democrats say their research, including in focus groups, uncovered a unique aspect to the corruption issue in recent months. In those discussions, voters blamed a "rigged system" for the high costs they were facing. Internal surveys revealed that voters favored taking on the corrupt system even more than other Democratic priorities, such as bringing down healthcare costs.

Public polling showed similar results. A mid-August Reuters/Ipsos survey found that more than 60% of Americans believe that corruption influences the decisions made by the federal government and that the president and his family had inappropriately profited from cryptocurrency.

A narrow majority said corruption was worse under the Trump administration than under other recent presidencies. The poll found that the view that corruption plays an undue role in the government spanned all ideologies.

Sen. Chuck Schumer, the New York Democrat and minority leader deeply involved in Senate campaign strategy, credited Ossoff for the way he has distilled the issue. He said Democratic strategists have been circulating Ossoff's message on how corrupt practices contribute to high costs.

"When you tie the two together," Schumer said of corruption and high costs, "the sum becomes greater than the parts."

Democrats also like the message because it unites their party all along the ideological spectrum, steering clear of the divisions between more progressive and moderate candidates that have complicated races this year.

Still, the focus raises a potential challenge for Democrats if they succeed in their push to take over Congress. Under any scenario, they would still have to work with the Trump administration on legislation to reduce costs, while simultaneously conducting inquiries into the corruption allegations that are fueling their campaigns.

Jeffries said Democrats could do both. "We certainly have a steadfast commitment to continuing to make significant and decisive progress on addressing the affordability crisis," he said. "But at the same time, recognize that we have to visit accountability upon those individuals who've been stealing from the American people."

A truck loaded with firewood drives Tuesday through a neighborhood in Aden, Yemen. A Saudi-led strike hit a fuel facility in Houthi-controlled Sanaa. **ABDULNASSER ALSEDDIK/AP**

Saudi-led coalition strikes fuel facility in Yemen, Houthis say

By Fatma Khaled
ASSOCIATED PRESS

CAIRO — A coalition of forces in Yemen led by Saudi Arabia carried out new airstrikes Tuesday on the Houthi rebel-held Yemeni capital of Sanaa, the Houthi-run broadcaster Al Masirah and residents said.

The strikes marked a fresh escalation in the widening Middle East crisis and came shortly after a coalition spokesman urged residents to evacuate the area for their safety. Witnesses reported hearing explosions in Sanaa hours after the coalition struck the al-Suhaba fuel facility west of the city.

In a rare statement earlier, the coalition had urged civilians in the Houthi-controlled capital to leave the Yemeni Oil Co. site, on a hill overlooking the capital, and nearby storage areas ahead of a possible strike.

Houthi officials appeared to have anticipated the attack there. The oil company said its storage facilities were empty and that a Saudi strike would not affect oil reserves or supplies for residents. Still, witnesses in the city said lines of cars formed at some gas stations amid fears of a shortage.

Shortly after the warning, Houthi military spokesman Brig. Gen. Yahya Saree said on Telegram that any Saudi attack on Sanaa would be met with a "firm and painful" response in the Saudi capital, Riyadh.

It was unclear whether the Tuesday strike was a signal of military escalation or a measured response to recent deadly attacks on the Riyadh airport.

The warning and the attack show "the Saudis' aims of upping the ante and striking deep in the heart of Houthi-controlled territory while attempting to control the narrative by presenting themselves as more careful and humanitarian actors than the Houthis," said Adam Baron, a fellow at the Washington-based New America institute.

"It may be a warning — or it may be a sign of things to come," he said.

The back-and-forth threats come as Saudi Arabia is scrambling to determine how its air defenses failed to intercept a barrage of missiles and drones fired by the Houthis, including an attack on Riyadh's international airport Saturday that killed at least 13 people and wounded more than 300 others.

The latest conflict between the Saudis and the Houthis began last month after the rebels seized key areas along the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a critical waterway for the transport of Gulf oil and other goods at the southern end of the Red Sea off Yemen.

The Saudi-led coalition, backing forces aligned with Yemen's internationally recognized government, has been trying to retake them.

Saudi Arabia's Cabinet on Tuesday warned the Houthis they would "face consequences" for their repeated attacks on the kingdom.

"The Kingdom will not allow any threat to its security or to freedom of maritime navigation in the Red Sea and Bab al-Mandab Strait," the Cabinet said in a statement carried by Saudi state-owned Al-Ekhbariya television.

On Tuesday, Yemen's interior ministry said in a statement on X that Houthi strikes over the past day on Taiz, a major city in the country's southwest, had killed six people and injured 18 amid ongoing battles in the region.

A commander with the Saudi-backed forces said rebels had fought through fierce resistance to reach the edges of Taiz, and some had entered the city.

The fight was now critical for Taiz, which has long been a sought-after prize, he said.

Police, witnesses detail horror after rider fell from Ga. coaster

By Mike Stewart, Kate Brumback and Russ Bynum
ASSOCIATED PRESS

A ride is seen Tuesday at Six Flags Over Georgia, about 15 miles northwest of Atlanta. A man was thrown from a roller coaster, hit patrons and died Monday. **MIKE STEWART/AP**

MABLETON, Ga. — A 42-year-old man killed while riding a roller coaster at Six Flags over Georgia was thrown from his seat and struck other patrons before landing below the ride, police said Tuesday.

Visitors to the Atlanta-area park watched in horror as he fell out of the coaster Monday, prompting Six Flags to temporarily close nine similar roller coasters nationwide.

Investigators and park officials have not said how the man came out of his seat.

"It was horrific to watch," said Summer Bates, who was at the park with her husband and three children. "One thing I think that will stick with us is the sound of his body coming down."

Bates said she and her family rode the Goliath roller coaster earlier in the day. The park's tallest coaster, which towers over its entrance at 200 feet, has lap bar restraints that pull down over the riders' legs and waist. There are no seat belts.

"My older two children rode on the cart ahead of us," she said. "I noticed they kept trying to push theirs down tighter. I assured them that they were OK. But once my husband, youngest child and I loaded our cart and headed up the incline, I quickly understood why my older two were messing with theirs. It just didn't feel secure and tight."

The man who died was Hassan Jihad Ibn Kariem, according to Cobb County police. Officials have not released any other information about those who were injured when they were struck by the man.

Kariem worked as the information technology manager at a public charter school in Atlanta and before that was the school's technology teacher, according to an online resume.

Logan Conner said he was on Goliath with his fiancée when he saw the man come out of his seat.

"The man started levitating in the air sideways," he told NBC. "We made direct eye contact with him."

The park in Mableton, just northwest of Atlanta, already was scheduled to be closed Tuesday.

One of Goliath's other trains could be seen on the ride's first hill Tuesday, seemingly where it stopped after the man fell from another train.

Six Flags Entertainment Corp. said it temporarily shut down nine similar roller coasters at six of its theme parks in the U.S. and Canada. Those parks were already scheduled for seasonal midweek closures Tuesday and Wednesday.

The rides that were closed included a second coaster named Goliath at Six Flags Magic Mountain in Southern California; Raging Bull at Six Flags Great America in Illinois; Nitro at Six Flags Great Adventure in New Jersey; Fury 325 and Thunder Striker at Carowinds in North Carolina; and the rides Leviathan and Behemoth at Canada's Wonderland in Ontario, Canada.

Six Flags did not immediately respond Tuesday to questions asking why those rides were shut down or what would be done before they reopen.

Georgia's Office of Insurance and Safety Fire Commissioner, which oversees ride inspections, is "conducting an in-depth and comprehensive review," said Garrison Bennett, a spokesperson.

Bolliger & Mabillard, the Swiss company that manufactured the coaster and many others worldwide, said it is "actively investigating the incident and will not comment further until we have a better understanding of what happened."

"We are deeply saddened by this tragic accident," the company said in a statement. "Our thoughts are with the family and those affected."

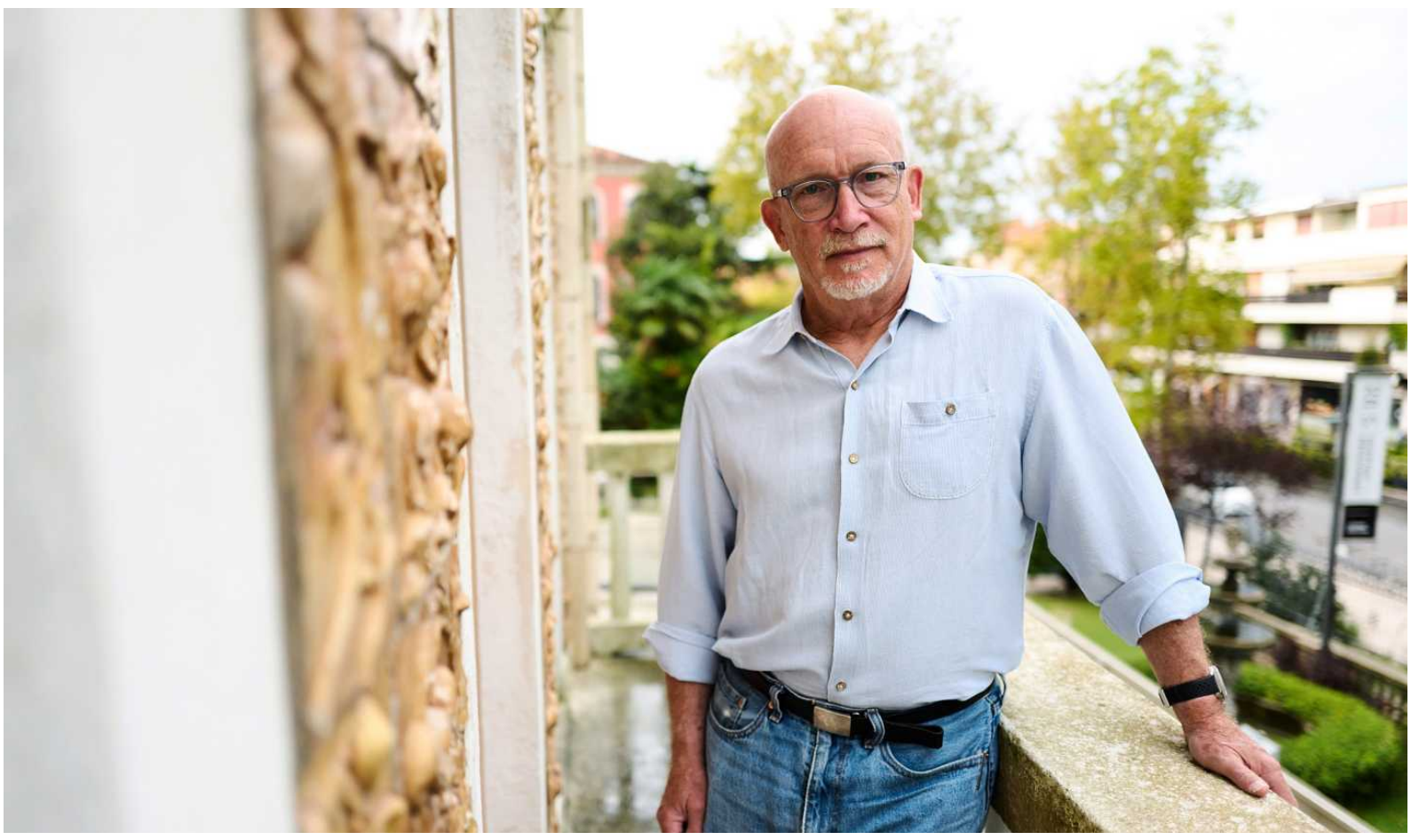
Operating for two decades in Georgia, the Goliath uses a steep drop to reach top speeds of 70 mph — focusing on sheer velocity and downhill plunges rather than turning riders upside down through loops or corkscrews.

The latest death comes less than two weeks after Six Flags Magic Mountain announced the retirement of its X2 roller coaster following lawsuits alleging riders suffered serious brain injuries. The California park settled one wrongful-death lawsuit with the family of a 22-year-old man who died after riding the coaster in 2022.

Gibney leans into Musk's war of words

Platforms refuse to run ads for film, but director posts often

By Lindsey Bahr
ASSOCIATED PRESS



Filmmaker Alex Gibney, seen Sept. 9 at the Venice film festival in Italy, helmed a lengthy documentary on Elon Musk. **SCOTT A GARFITT/INVISION**

VENICE, Italy — Elon Musk has called filmmaker Alex Gibney a lot of names leading up to the theatrical release of the documentary "Musk," which is playing in select theaters in New York and Los Angeles and expands nationwide on Friday.

Over the past few weeks, Musk has posted on X that Gibney is an "idiot," a "horrible human," a "shill for the far left," and a "tinfoil hat crackpot" with "zero credibility." When the documentary was announced three years ago, he called it a "hit piece."

After its premiere at the Venice film festival last month, Musk wrote that dog feces are "worth more respect than Gibney." The wealthiest person in the world has reportedly not yet seen the film and did not respond to a request for comment from The Associated Press.

The documentary is facing more than a war of words from Musk, however. The film's distributor, Bleecker Street, has not been able to run paid advertisements on several major social media platforms. As of Sept. 25, YouTube, Meta, TikTok and X had all refused. YouTube, where the trailer had been available through regular channels, and Meta have since reversed course, saying that it had been flagged for "political content."

There are also concerns about whether "Musk" will eventually land on HBO as originally planned in the aftermath of the Skydance merger, the new entertainment giant created by Paramount's takeover of Warner Bros. Discovery. CEO David Ellison's father, Larry Ellison, is friendly with Musk.

"Would Musk be able to call Larry or David and say, you know, don't put this doc on? Yeah," Gibney said in an interview with the AP. "We live in that world now, particularly a world that's become so transactional in the political realm ... it's literally pay to play."

There have been threats of lawsuits from Musk's camp as well. But Gibney is also leaning into it, posting regularly on X from his own account and through a newly created one called @musk filmfacts, which is actively dispelling false narratives and highlighting suspicions of suppressed content. Recently, Gibney wrote on X that his film is "about a 'free-speech absolutist' who has threatened a lawsuit to try to stop the film from being seen."

The Oscar winner learned from making his Scientology documentary "Going Clear: Scientology and the Prison of Belief" that the best way to fight back is to "not let them get inside your head."

"We also have a lawyer who's really, really good," he said. "Because, of course, we vet this stuff very carefully."

Gibney spent nearly four years making the film, a sweeping portrait of the power and influence of the world's richest man, charting his rise from his early days in Silicon Valley through SpaceX, Tesla and DOGE, the Musk-led Department of Government Efficiency that overhauled the federal workforce last year.

It runs nearly four hours and features on-camera interviews with Musk's family, including his father, Errol Musk, his first wife and another mother of one of his children, as well as journalists, business associates, former friends, colleagues and government officials.

The project became a "runaway story," said Gibney, who was finalizing a two-hour cut when Musk endorsed Donald Trump following the 2024 assassination attempt on Trump in Butler, Pennsylvania. HBO leadership encouraged Gibney to keep going.

"I started out doing the film because it was about 21st-century power," Gibney said. "I didn't have a sense at that time that he was literally going to accrete the power of a kind of shadow president. ... But that's what he did, so we had to follow that story where it went."

Musk did not sit for an interview, so Gibney and his team did something a little unconventional: They made a computer-generated Musk that speaks directly to the camera. The image might be a visual effect, both flattering and a bit uncanny, but the voice and the words it says are all Musk's own, taken directly from recordings of things he's said in interviews and at public appearances.

One of the sticking points for Musk and his supporters has to do with "space lasers" and the 2024 U.S. presidential election.

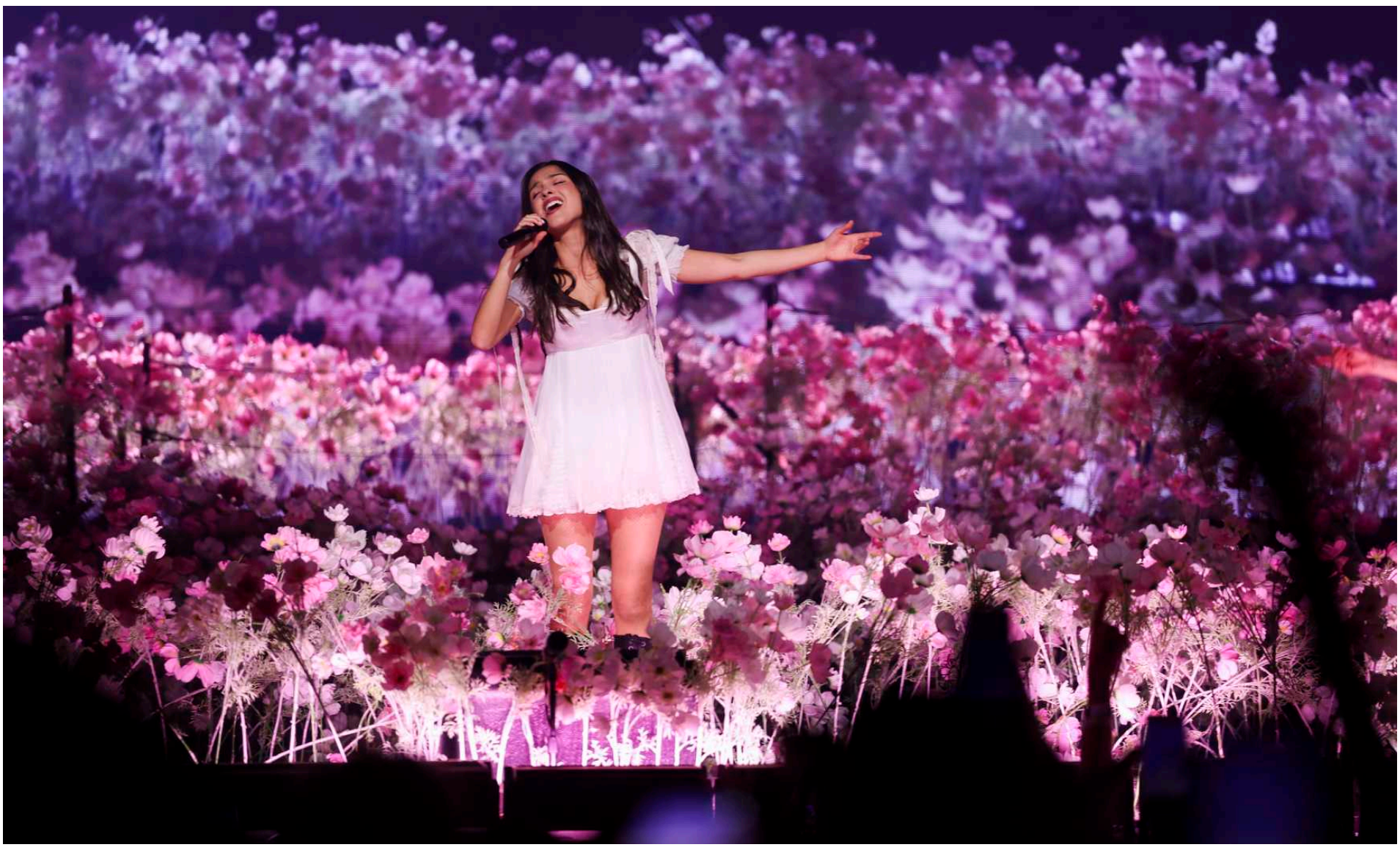
The source is a text exchange between Musk and Ashley St. Clair, the mother of one of Musk's children who provided the messages. Musk writes to her about feeling optimistic about Trump's chances, and how he has "10,000 lasers in space right now." Its inclusion in the documentary has provided ammunition for Musk supporters and his lawyers to discredit the film, pointing to an unfounded conspiracy theory about SpaceX's Starlink satellites interfering in the election. But neither the film, nor St. Clair, make that claim. It simply presents his text messages and lets the audience decide what to make of it.

St. Clair also provides an audio recording of Musk associate Jared Birchall trying to negotiate an NDA with her, on which parental support would be contingent, after she gave birth to a child with Musk. She said she turned down some $40 million to maintain her right to speak freely.

With attentions fractured in modern life, Gibney hopes there is some benefit in synthesizing information into a narrative. He's also quick to credit the journalists whose work they draw upon.

The runtime might be longer than your average movie, but it's an engaging watch. For the first 45 minutes, he said, "you're kind of rooting for Elon."

"He's trying to get those rockets up in the air. Fails three times. He's got that critical fourth launch, and you see those incredible images of the reusable rockets. It's Elon at his best," he said. "But then you have to ask the question, what happened?"



Olivia Rodrigo performs at the United Center on Oct. 11. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

REVIEW OLIVIA RODRIGO AT UNITED CENTER

In a sea of flowers, kicking her way toward what's next

By Christopher Borrelli | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The best thing about Olivia Rodrigo, at 23, top of the world, is that age. She's full of uncertainty and doe-eyed confidence. She's pure promise eager to be fulfilled, but maybe a bit timid still. There's a self-aware cringe in her best songs; she knows she's far from the first to sing about what she sings about. But there's also a steamrolling disregard for anyone who might think it's not worth singing. All of this is present, right now, bursting. She played a sold-out United Center on Sunday on her "Unraveled Tour," and I wish I went on the second night, Monday, mainly because Rodrigo is evolving fast — every hour counts.

Workers place and adjust flowers on the stage before Rodrigo performs.

Really, there's nothing I don't like about her.

Except her music, and I like her music, just not as much as her taste, her lyrics, her excellent band, her enthusiasm for showing love to the artists who inspired her, and the career peak you suspect is right around the corner. Her smart new album, "You Seem Pretty Sad for a Girl So in Love," which plays like a wise step right before a bolder breakthrough, veers so lovingly into '80s new wave and '90s alt rock (The Cure, Gang of Four, New Order, Smashing Pumpkins), it's like someone playing you great new (old) songs they just heard, thrilled at fresh possibilities. You want to make her a mix of PJ Harvey and Kim Gordon's Sonic Youth songs and return a year later to hear what stuck. She's already writing lines so twisted — "Sometimes at a low point I even wish for tragedy / Cause I know he'll come over and take real good care of me" — that Tom Waits could take notes. On "Purple," which began with Rodrigo curled in a fetal ball on stage, she sang "I melt with you ..." and it was sincere, a surrender and a retro wink, all at once.

Rodrigo is big on motifs, and so the show, like the new album, is conceptual.

Growth, decline, renewal, rinse, repeat — the seasons of our life.

Take the remarkable stage: Rodrigo reimagined the big impersonal concert arena setting as a warm meadow. Not a handful of flowers for effect, a striking sea of pink and white faux flowers that coat every inch of the stage, the back of the stage, where the band stands, and down the catwalks extending far into the United Center. ("How is she going to walk in that?" I heard more than a couple of people wonder before the music started.) Then, throughout the two-hour show, she tore at this artful meadow, skipped through it, joyfully kicked at stalks of flowers with her combat boots. This is the first concert I have attended that required a grounds crew — every handful of songs, a dozen gardener/roadies would rush onto the stage in the dark and rearrange and reset any fallen flora.

It's also a sorta organic extension of Rodrigo.

Like the flowers on that stage, she seems real, but there's lots of theater involved. Rodrigo began as a child star on the Disney Channel, and hammy theater-kid broadness is never far off. On the other hand, like a great torch singer, you absolutely believe she's in the moment: "Maybe I'm too emotional," she snarled bitterly, tearing down a flowerbed.

Her subject, of course, is young love, messy relationships, but there's such a bracing immediacy, and naïveté, to her best songs, it's like processing the ups and downs and confusion of romance in real time. She saved "Drivers License," for instance, her blockbuster debut, for the end of the night, and as familiar as its lyrics are — she let the audience sing stretches unaided — its key image, Rodrigo circling the street of a former flame, not understanding how anyone could move on, has lost no power. On "Cigarette Smoke" — a showcase live for how painfully vulnerable Rodrigo can let herself sound — a regretful, resentful lover simply waits for the exact second when "memories turn dark."

The peppy, post-punk Rodrigo isn't dead — she spends nearly as much time in the audience as Springsteen — but increasingly it's the least interesting thing about her. She's favoring the kind of surging operatic grandiosity Billy Corgan would appreciate. She sounds willing to risk something. On her closer, a rocker with a touch of robotic Devo chanting in the chorus, she repeated, "These days, I've got expectations." On paper, it's another song about finding a good guy, but in concert, it's about the future.

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CHICAGO THEATER REPORT

'Purpose' returns, new Broadway shows in town

The company of "The Who's Tommy" on Broadway in New York. **MATTHEW MURPHY AND EVAN ZIMMERMAN**

Chris Jones

The entire Broadway cast and creative team of Branden Jacob-Jenkins' Pulitzer Prize and Tony Award-winning play "Purpose" is returning to Chicago — to rehearse for the show's Los Angeles premiere at the Geffen Playhouse. The show, loosely based on the family of the Chicago civil rights leader Rev. Jesse Jackson, originated at the Steppenwolf Theatre and has several of that company's actors in the cast, along with other Chicago-based artists on the creative team led by director Phylicia Rashad. Hence the decision to work here rather than in New York or Los Angeles, as would be typical. Geffen artistic director Tarell Alvin McCraney is also a former Chicago writer and actor.

The cast at the Geffen Playhouse, as on Broadway, will be made up of Alana Arenas, Glenn Davis, Jon Michael Hill, LaTanya Richardson Jackson, Harry Lennix, Nija Okoro and Kara Young.

NEW SHOWS ON THE WAY

Speaking of Steppenwolf, the company will present a Woolly Mammoth Theatre Company touring production titled "ha ha ha ha ha ha ha," as created and performed by Julia Masli and directed by Kim Noble, from Jan. 13 to Feb. 7, 2027. The blurb, as we say in the trade, is: "hahahahahaha-hahahaha hahahahahahaha hihihi hahahahahahaha hoho hahahhahaha hehe hahahahahahahahahaha." It's an intriguing solo comedy turn from Masli, an award-winning Estonian clown.

Broadway in Chicago has announced some new touring productions

See **REPORT** on Page B10

A new documentary on the rock band Linkin Park features members Joe Hahn, from left, Emily Armstrong and Mike Shinoda, seen Sept. 25. **BIRDIE THOMPSON/INVISION**

CELEBRITIES

Film tracks band's emotional return

FROM NEWS SERVICES

For years after the death of frontman Chester Bennington, members of Linkin Park weren't sure if the band would — or should — continue to exist.

The new documentary "Linkin Park: Unshatter" takes fans inside the uncertainty, grief and creative risk behind their return, including raw footage of early recording sessions, conversations and experimentation that eventually led to Emily Armstrong joining the group.

Formed in 1996, Linkin Park became one of the defining rock bands of the 2000s by fusing alternative metal, hip-hop and electronics. The band skyrocketed to global fame with its diamond-certified 2000 debut, "Hybrid Theory," followed by "Meteora," built around the distinctive interplay of Mike Shinoda's rapping and Bennington's soaring vocals.

After Bennington died by suicide in 2017, following the release of "One More Light," the band faced an uncertain future. Linkin Park returned in 2024 with Armstrong as co-lead vocalist, releasing "From Zero" and embarking on a new run of world tours.

In an interview alongside Armstrong and DJ and creative director Joe Hahn, Shinoda says he never wanted to predetermine what a return would look like — or even whether it would still be Linkin Park.

When Shinoda met Armstrong in 2019, he had a feeling she was someone the others needed to meet.

"I was like, 'Oh, I got it. She has to meet the band. Like I have to introduce them because she's cool. I love how she sings.' I had a gut feeling that would have to happen," he said.

For Armstrong, watching the footage in the documentary offered a glimpse at how much she was taking in during those early encounters with the group.

"I feel like I look a lot more confident than I actually was. There was so much going on in my head, having to step up to the plate, right? When you're doing that, there's so many adjustments that are happening," she said.

"It definitely was a creative risk, and we knew that to begin with, I think," she said. "We don't know if people are going to take to it, but we know that we love it."

Hahn said the process of making music again was also part of the band's healing. "I think we were able to lean on each other and be open just to start healing, and then with that you give each other encouragement, too, like, 'Hey, you're good at this. ... Don't worry about that, we'll figure that part out later.' "

Actor Mitte dies: Actor and disability rights advocate RJ Mitte, who brought a lifetime of experience with cerebral palsy to fictional family struggles in an essential role on "Breaking Bad," died Monday, authorities and his representatives said. He was 34.

A cause of death wasn't provided, but an autopsy will be performed.

Mitte played Walter White Jr., the son of Bryan Cranston's chemistry teacher-turned-meth dealer Walter White on nearly every episode of the five seasons of the AMC show.

Cranston said he is in "deep despair" for the loss of his "sweet son."

Oct. 14 birthdays: Singer Cliff Richard is 86. Singer Justin Hayward is 80. Actor Greg Evigan is 73. Singer Thomas Dolby is 68. Actor Lori Petty is 63. Actor Steve Coogan is 61. Singer Karyn White is 61. Actor Jon Seda is 56. Singer Natalie Maines is 52. Singer Usher is 48. Actor Ben Whishaw is 46. Comedian Jay Pharoah is 39. Actor Max Thieriot is 38.

Boys' heartbreaking stories affect teacher more than past students

R. Eric Thomas
ASKING ERIC

Dear Eric: I have been a teacher for 19 years. I have seen a lot.

As a mandated reporter, I have had to make the call to the authorities with some frequency. I have also had other children who had prior abuse, and I was always a shoulder to cry on when needed. I have felt intense sadness at times, as when a student's sibling was murdered. I tried my best to comfort him.

I never let these instances interfere with my attitude on life or my job. I was always able to move on and not let it get me down. I always seemed to be able to see the silver lining and think this is a hard thing they are going through, but these kids are going to get through and at the end of this trial be stronger and able to help others through.

However, this last year broke me. I don't know any other way to describe it. Those rose-colored glasses I managed to keep on through 19 years of hearing horror stories and teaching some very traumatized kids just shattered to pieces.

This past year, I had two second grade students that changed everything. Their stories are horrific and heartbreaking, but I am not sure why these two boys affected me more than all the others I've taught.

I am angry and sad. I keep finding myself not wanting to ever go back to teaching. I feel like I am still mourning a loss that was never my loss.

When I try to talk to my husband, he keeps getting irritated telling me to get over it and to let it go. I realize I am being irrational, but I can't seem to shake this off.

— No More Rose-Colored Glasses

Dear Glasses: First, you're not being irrational, and your husband's irritation is inappropriate.

You're dealing with incredibly traumatic things, and as a teacher and mandatory reporter, you're often having to receive distressing information while immediately pivoting to care and action.

It doesn't sound like your school system is providing you with the time and resources to adequately process what you're hearing. You may have been able to compartmentalize for years, but the feelings you're dealing with have to go somewhere.

It's said that a good therapist always has a therapist, and although you're not a therapist, as a teacher you have been called on to step into a similar role at times. There is a cost to that.

Please consider talking to a trained professional about your experience and the feelings it has brought up. You may also consider taking a leave of absence from teaching, to give yourself time to heal and regroup.

There is nothing wrong with taking a step back to care for yourself. One can't pour from an empty cup. You do incredibly important, vital work. You owe it to yourself to take time to recover.

Dear Eric: I bought a friend tickets to a concert she had mentioned wanting to go to. I didn't ask her about it because I wanted it to be a surprise.

I gave her the tickets for her birthday, and she looked surprised and annoyed. I said, "What?" She told me her boyfriend already gave her tickets to the concert.

Well, I got mad about that. I don't really like her boyfriend, first off. Second, she and I had talked about the concert. Now she's saying that she'd actually asked her boyfriend to get the tickets for her.

I'm really annoyed about the whole thing. I get that she likes this guy, even though I don't see why. But I went out of my way to make a nice plan for us, and it's not like the tickets were cheap.

Should I insist she go with me instead?

— Concert Conflict

Dear Concert: Insisting of any kind, about anything, is just going to add more tension to this situation. And it doesn't seem like the situation actually warrants tension.

Sure, you don't like your friend's boyfriend, but his intentions seem good, as were yours, so you're not really in conflict.

You did a nice thing for your friend. And it's unfortunate that that nice thing coincided with a nice thing her boyfriend did for her, at her request.

But the best thing to do is defer to her wishes. If she wants to go with her boyfriend, it's not a knock against you.

There will be other opportunities to celebrate with your friend. And, in a case like this, it really is the thought that counts.

Consider inviting another friend to join you at the concert. This friend could even pay for their ticket, so you wouldn't be out so much money.

Or, if the ticketing service's policies allow it, you can list the tickets for resale.

Send questions to eric@askingeric.com or P.O. Box 22474, Philadelphia, PA 19110. Follow him on Instagram and sign up for his weekly newsletter at rericthomas.com.

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Pierre's hero takes flight in 'Lanterns' finale

Creators craft arc to let character claim ring on own terms

By Tracy Brown
LOS ANGELES TIMES

From the first time Tom King and DC Studios' James Gunn talked about a Green Lantern show, they envisioned John Stewart as the kind of hero who could generate excitement and change the tide of any battle upon his arrival.

"The idea was to build a character as compelling and impactful as, say, Thor in the Marvel universe," says King, the "Lanterns" co-creator, during a recent video call. "Someone who arrives in a movie with a thunderclap, and ... the audience screams when they arrive because you're in love with that character ... not just the power set they have, but the integrity of that character."

That hero officially takes flight in the recent "Lanterns" finale.

Episode 8 of the HBO Max superhero crime drama, titled "Dirt and Stars," sees John Stewart (Aaron Pierre) take up the mantle as Earth's latest Green Lantern. After solving the mystery of his predecessor Hal Jordan's (Kyle Chandler) death, Stewart claims Jordan's power ring as his own, recites his oath and jets off toward his next adventure. (A second season has not been announced, but the character will appear in Gunn's upcoming "Superman" sequel, "Man of Tomorrow.")

Co-created by King, Damon Lindelof and Chris Mundy, "Lanterns" introduces Jordan as a grizzled, veteran member of the Green Lantern Corps, intergalactic space cops who are armed with a special ring that allows them to manifest objects and manipulate energy.

Stewart is a new Green Lantern recruit, but when an investigation into the whereabouts of a killer alien robot on the run goes awry, they go their separate ways.

Aaron Pierre stars as John Stewart in the superhero crime drama "Lanterns." **HBO MAX**

"One of the cool things about the canonical Green Lanterns is that, technically speaking, there's only one ring delegated to this particular sector in which Earth fell," says Lindelof of one of the show's central conflicts.

The creative team knew from the jump that Stewart would be the one to bear that ring at the end of the season, but the idea that Stewart would be a child prodigy whose parents preordained his path to become the next Green Lantern developed over time.

"We (decided) the first part of John's life is going to be (about) coming to terms with the fact that he doesn't really want the ring — or he doesn't want the ring on those terms," Lindelof says. "Then there would have to be some period of time where he was living his dream. ... Then and only then would he be able to wipe the slate clean, as it were, and gravitate back toward a healthy way to want the ring."

In the comics, Green Lanterns are known for their oaths, which they recite when recharging their rings or to reaffirm their commitment to the group. In "Lanterns," Stewart creates his own version that acknowledges his journey and perspective on becoming a Green Lantern.

"We talked a lot about it in the room, but the feeling was that he was changing the relationship with the Guardians in that moment," Mundy says, referring to the immortal aliens that created the Green Lantern Corps.

The Guardians had once considered Stewart an ideal replacement for Jordan because he was willing to blindly follow orders, but by the time he claimed Jordan's ring, it's clear Stewart has no plans to be affiliated with the Guardians or the Green Lantern Corps in that way, and the writers wanted his oath to reflect that.

"We wanted John to take (the role) on his terms," Mundy says. "Even though Hal didn't train him as well as he should have trained him, he taught him lessons that nobody else would have taught him. ... (Including) how you need to be your own person even as you're working for this organization."

Besides his unconventional path to becoming a Green Lantern, Stewart is in possession of a unique lantern for recharging his ring that was forged by Sinestro, Jordan's disgraced mentor.

The "Lanterns" showrunner remained coy when asked whether this lantern's more ominous origins could lead to any unintended consequences for Stewart.

"It's rife with possibility, is what I will say," Mundy says.

These separate interviews with Mundy, Lindelof and King have been edited for clarity and length.

Q: Because the "real" Hal is killed in 2026, his relationship with John is left unresolved. Can you address that lack of proper closure for them?

Mundy: We talked about this thing as a love story between these guys in a certain way, but one of them has to die in order for them to truly come together. Even over the course of the Halogram being in the show, he never called John "Junior" ever. He always called him "trainee." Until the last moment when he says ... "I love you, too, Junior." There's something very bittersweet about the fact that the two people we spent all that time with don't fully have their moment together.

Q: Why was it important to show more of 2026 Hal Jordan's life before his death in the finale?

Lindelof: The only flavoring that we get of him directly (before this) is in the diner scene, when John comes for his apology and doesn't get one. Only toward the very end of that scene after John has hit Hal, and Hal says, "Don't let anybody know that you were here," is there a flash that something has changed in this guy. It's one thing for Kerry to tell us that they were in love, or to hear Hal's "buttercup" voicemail, but I think that the audience needed to see it and experience it. Hal is not a changed man in 2026, but he's an evolved man. And there's real tragedy inherent in all of the decisions that he's making because we know that all of those decisions basically lead him to be a corpse in the stands at a football game. The subtle differences by which Kyle plays older Hal versus Halogram Hal is really on sharp display in the finale.

Q: With Noah being a Manhunter, it turned out that he and John were dealing with similar questions around lineage and legacy and nature versus nurture. How did the exploration into these themes evolve during the show's development?

King: The basic idea (was) that John had been one of these kids who had been told, "You're going to be this when you grow up." Like a Tiger Woods or Michael Jackson-esque child. We started talking about what that's like — to be a prodigy, to be forced into (something). The idea that you're kind of programmed by your parents. And then we were talking about Manhunters. The problem with Manhunters is they've been programmed to do this one thing, and they can't defy their programming (to eradicate mankind). That's why they had to eventually be erased. Then we started talking about the parallel of programming and overcoming programming, and what makes you human, what doesn't, that parallel came first.

Q: With both Hal and John, so much of their intergenerational trauma is tied to their fathers. But with Noah and John, you also see just how big of a role their mothers have played in shaping them. How did that aspect come about?

L: I think this all came from Vanessa Baden Kelly. We had written the pilot, where John's father is shooting the apple off of his head, and then when Vanessa came on shortly thereafter, she's like, "Where's mom?" It is one of those moments where you realize it, particularly because we were three men, but also inside of the canon of these superheroes, it's always a dad. So the idea was having Bernadette really be the mastermind of John's upbringing as a way to provide a simultaneous salve for her husband's shame about being afraid about losing out on the opportunity. I think that Kerry is an equally fierce mother. Obviously, she loves Hal. But when you watch it a second time after you've seen the finale, you realize that there's guilt there as well because of what she did to him, all in the name of her son. John starts to reframe what Bernadette did as something for him, as opposed to something for her — in a lot of ways, it was a selfless act. She's doing it knowing that her child will hate her, but that he'll be the Earth's Green Lantern, and there's going to be an aspirational quality to that for generations to follow.

REVIEW '4000 MILES' ★★★

Never flashy, play by A Short Leap Theatre lets the humanity come through

By Emily McClanathan
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Layke Fowler and Marssie Mencotti in "4000 Miles" by A Short Leap Theatre at the Den Theatre. **ALEX ALBRECHT PHOTOS**

IF YOU GO
When: Through Oct. 24
Where: The Den Theatre, 1331 N. Milwaukee Ave.
Running time: 1 hour, 50 minutes
Tickets: $36.75 (pay-what-you-can available at the door) at 773-697-3830 and ashortleaptheatre.com

For those lucky enough to have living, loving extended family members, there's something deeply comforting about knowing there are people, whether near or far, to whom you can turn when things get tough. This sense of relief is palpable in the opening scene of Amy Herzog's 2011 play, "4000 Miles," in which a troubled 21-year-old man shows up at his grandmother's Manhattan apartment in the middle of the night. After popping in her hearing aids and dentures, she insists that he sleep in her guest room — but first he needs to shower away his stink, she bluntly declares.

Amanda Hays and Josh Leeper co-direct a heartwarming production of Herzog's Pulitzer Prize finalist for A Short Leap Theatre Company, an ensemble now in its second season. Marssie Mencotti gives a fabulous performance as Vera, a nonagenarian who sometimes loses her words and her keys, but never her spicy attitude. Playing her grandson, Leo, Layke Fowler demonstrates range as a character who maintains a capacity for empathy amid his own grief yet also makes choices that hurt his loved ones.

The play's title refers to the distance Leo has traveled on a cross-country bicycle trip from Seattle, a journey that he started with his best friend, Micah, but finished alone. When he arrives in New York, he's not only mourning that loss (details of which are revealed gradually) but also on thin ice with his girlfriend, Bec (Erin Minervini), who recently moved to the city for college. Back in his hometown of St. Paul, his immediate family is upset with him, too, as the outdoorsy hipster doesn't own a cell phone and has remained unreachable during his solo trek.

Fowler and Erin Minervini in "4000 Miles."

His grandmother's home, envisioned as a tidy, cozy space by scenic designer Will Hughes, becomes a haven for Leo as he tries to get back on his feet. Meanwhile, Vera is grieving her own losses; a longtime widow, she's recently become the last surviving member of the friend group she was closest to throughout her 80s.

A family drama that's neither explosive nor schmaltzy, Herzog's play relies on witty dialogue and gently paced character development for its charm. Her script provides many comedic gems for Vera, including one scene where she gets high with Leo and another where she regales Bec with tales of her first husband's affairs. Mencotti nails the delivery each time.

Leo, in addition to extensive stage time with Vera, shares a couple of scenes with Bec, portrayed by Minervini as a down-to-earth young woman who's compassionate yet unafraid to be assertive about her own needs. In contrast, Mollie Peery makes a brief but hilarious appearance as Amanda, an unapologetically wealthy, self-described slut who comes home with Leo one night.

Carina Lastimosa's costume designs enhance all four characters in this show, but they're especially effective at capturing Amanda's rich hot-girl vibe, with her lacy pink minidress and platform sandals. Amanda isn't written as a simple caricature, though; when she spots Communist literature on Vera's bookshelves, she alludes to her Chinese American family's painful history.

China is also the birthplace of Lily, Leo's adopted sister, who appears in a brief voice-over performed by Peery. Leo and Lily have a complicated relationship, including a fairly shocking incident in their recent past. This side plot, while underdeveloped, adds another layer to Leo's messy situation.

As my first encounter with A Short Leap's work, "4000 Miles" impressed me with its quality acting and design work. At its current run time, this production would benefit from adding an intermission and/or speeding up some of the longer scene transitions, but these are pretty minor pacing issues.

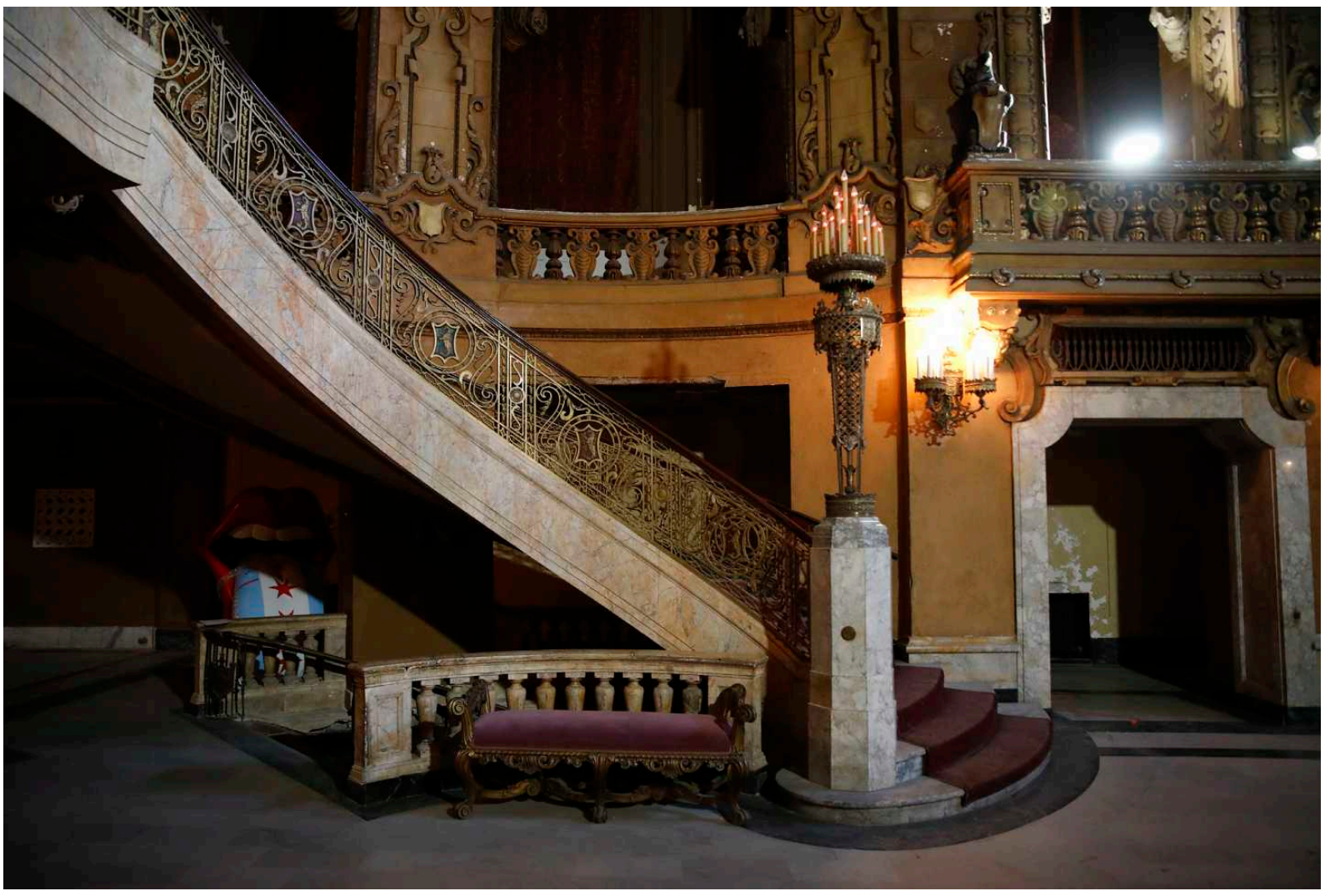
An apt pick for a theater company that espouses community-oriented values, Herzog's play celebrates the healing power of human connection without veering into overt sentimentality. Leo can be selfish and rude at times, and Vera has her own flaws, but it's hard not to hope they'll both be ok in the end. This show will make you want to hug your grandma, or whoever plays a nurturing role in your life. After all, it's no small thing to find a warm bed waiting at the end of a long and lonely journey.

REPORT

from Page B8

coming to town in 2027. They include "All Things Equal" (Jan. 26-28 at the Broadway Playhouse), a piece by Rupert Holmes about former Supreme Court Justice Ruth Bader Ginsburg, and the tour of "The Who's Tommy" (Feb. 16-28 at the Cadillac Palace Theatre). This is the same production that tried out at the Goodman Theatre before moving to Broadway. Thereafter, Chicago audiences can see "Mamma Mia!" (March 9-28 at the Auditorium Theatre), "The Bodyguard" (April 6-18 at the Nederlander Theatre), "Hadestown" (April 27-May 2 at the Auditorium), "The Lion King" (June 3 to Aug. 1 at the Cadillac Palace Theatre), "Heathers the Musical" (June 8-20 at the CIBC Theatre) and, of course, the previously reported pre-Broadway engagement of "The Princess Bride" at the Nederlander Theatre from July 19-Aug. 22.

By the way, nothing to officially report, but my spidey sense is that this will be the last Chicago engagement of "The Lion King" in its current touring form. So keep that in mind.



The lobby of the Uptown Theater in Chicago in 2018. **JOSÉ M. OSORIO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

A MARVIN HAMLISCH MUSICAL

The Chicago-based producer Holly Weis is developing a new musical, "Marvin Makes Music," based on Marvin Hamlisch's autobiographical children's book about growing up in New York as a musical prodigy. Caitlin Collins and Matthew Lowy are working on the adaptation and the Chicago director Scott Weinstein is attached. Weis has been working closely with Hamlisch's widow, Terre Blair Hamlisch. Workshops and backers' auditions are in the cards, working towards six performances next June in collaboration with The Public Theater at Joe's Pub in New York. Northwestern University's American Music Theatre Project has also been involved.

SARAH SIDDONS PRIZE

Tony Award-winning actress Victoria Clark ("The Light in the Piazza" and "Kimberly Akimbo") will receive the long-lived Sarah Siddons Society Award at the group's annual benefit on Nov. 9 at The Arts Club of Chicago. The program in tribute is slated to include performances by Marta Bady, Lillian Castillo, Marya Grandy and Heidi Kettenring under the co-direction of Christopher Chase Carter and Christopher Pazdernik, with music direction by Linda Madonia. The annual event raises money for scholarships for Chicago-area theater students.

NEW TITLES ON THE WAY

Longtime songsmiths and performers Will Clinger and Bill Larkin will perform their show "Sophomoric Songs" at the Stars and Garters Theater on Clark Street from Nov. 5-14. They promise "funny, sometimes ribald, never enlightening songs from their respective repertoires." Kevin Theis directs. Clinger was the longtime host of the TV show "Wild Chicago." Larkin can currently be heard tinkling the keys at the Redhead Piano Bar, a retro outpost.

Chicago professor and lawyer Spencer Weber Waller has a fascinating new book out, "Power and Greed: Monopolies, Mergers, and Cartels on the American Stage," a look at the colorful characters who created what we now know as commercial American theater. Chicago, once a headquarters of Vaudeville's Orpheum Circuit, features prominently in Waller's fascinating story.

UPTOWN NEWS

Don't forget. This weekend's Open House Chicago offers a chance to see inside the Uptown Theatre, guaranteed to blow you away! And, I hope, to instill in you a new commitment to the restoration of that grand old place.

TimeLine Theatre has announced the cast for its upcoming Chicago premiere of Laura Wade's dark comedy "Home, I'm Darling." The show, directed by Mechelle Moe, will feature Janet Ulrich Brooks, Brandon Dahlquist, Claire Kaplan, Gloria Imseih Petrelli, Maya Rowe and Elliot Sagay. Most of those performers are making their TimeLine debuts. The show opens Nov. 18.

COURT CAMPAIGN

Court Theater has announced a humanistic initiative for America@250 called "Now is the Time: Artists Go to Work," slated to include programming throughout the fall at various venues. There are several co-sponsoring institutions for the workshops, conversations, lectures and debates, culminating in Court's upcoming production of "Tituba."

'FAWLTY TOWERS LIVE'

Finally, from the erudite to the ridiculous, "Fawlty Towers Live! The Dining Experience" (those who need to know, know) is coming to Chicago for four nights only. The show will be at the Crowne Plaza Chicago West Loop from Nov. 18-21. This will be the first time, to the best of my knowledge, that anything theatrical has been seen there, beyond at least a memorable game-show themed sting designed to catch criminals on the lam that I once happened to witness by walking through the door at the wrong time. But that is a long story for a barroom or another column.

CHRIS JONES RECOMMENDS

"Theater of the Mind" in an open run by the Goodman at the Reid Murdoch Building; "Pandemonium, Please Hold" in an open run on the Second City Mainstage; "Vape! The Grease Parody" through Jan. 3 at Apollo Theater; "Sunday in the Park with George" by Kokandy Productions through Nov. 29 at Chopin Theatre; "Come From Away" through Oct. 25 at Marriott Theatre in Lincolnshire; "Jekyll & Hyde" through Nov. 8 at the Broadway Playhouse; "Play On!" through Oct. 18 in The Yard at Chicago Shakespeare Theater on Navy Pier; "Kowalski" through Nov. 8 at Lookingglass Theatre in the Water Tower Water Works; "The Front Page" through Oct. 25 at Northlight Theatre in Evanston; "Topdog/Underdog" through Nov. 1 at Steppenwolf Theatre; "Don Giovanni" through Nov. 1 at Lyric Opera of Chicago.

Chris Jones is a Tribune critic.
cjones5@chicagotribune.com

What to watch

WEDNESDAY

October 14, 2026

All times Central. Start times can vary based on cable/satellite provider. Confirm times on your on-screen guide.

Scrubs

ABC, 7 p.m.

In the new episode "My Chief," J.D. (Zach Braff) discovers that Turk (Donald Faison) made a costly mistake and has to decide whether to report it or let it slide.

The Floor

FOX, 7 p.m.

A millionaire champion takes the Floor by surprise before a David vs. Goliath battle reduces the champion to tears in the new episode "The Quiet Achiever." Rob Lowe hosts.

Pawn Stars

History, 7 p.m.

In the new episode "Fangs for the Memories," Rick Harrison checks out some basketball cards that reheat the Magic Johnson and Larry Bird rivalry; he and Chum take a field trip to look at some high-end watches; and rare books expert Rebecca Romney sinks her teeth into a first printing of *Dracula*.

Nature

PBS, 7 p.m. ■ Season Premiere

Join Elmo and the *Sesame Street* gang on a once-in-a-lifetime African safari adventure in this episode presented in collaboration with Sesame Workshop. After adopting an orphaned elephant online, Elmo, Abby and Nina travel to Kenya to meet the young elephant and the keepers who care for her. They'll also see some of nature's most iconic wildlife, including lions, zebras, giraffes and hippos.

Abbott Elementary

ABC, 7:30 p.m.

Gregory (Tyler James Williams) juggles the demands of his two roles, while Jacob and Melissa (Chris Perfetti and Lisa Ann Walter) struggle to compromise in the new episode "Check-Ins."

'The Lowdown'

FX

The Lowdown

FX, 8 p.m. ■ Season Premiere

When Ethan Hawke's Lee Raybon, Tulsa's "truthstorian," returns for Season 2 of Sterlin Harjo's unique noir, he's getting a bit too much praise for the murder mystery his investigative journalism solved in Season 1. Lee is having "an existential crisis about the meaninglessness of 'success,'" says Hawke. "He has a desire to blow it up." He distracts himself by helping public defender Ginger (Betty Gilpin) locate a missing client. "Lee is an unreliable friend, but he's the only friend shehas," Hawke notes. Also exciting: Actor Tommy Lee Jones steps in as Hawke's on-screen father, Lee Raybon Sr.

Chicago Fire

NBC, 8 p.m.

In the new episode "Rattle the Cage," Violet and Novak (Hanako Greensmith and Jocelyn Hudon) grow suspicious of a mental health facility after treating an escaped patient.

NOVA

PBS, 8 p.m.

NOVA presents this fascinating five-part series about evolution. Each episode is rooted in the remarkable story of a different animal and uses it as a jumping-off point to chronicle how Earth's inhabitants — including humans — have changed over eons. The premiere, "Brain Power," traces the development of the brain, following the dolphin from 3 billion years ago to becoming one of the smartest animals alive today. It's all enhanced by cinematic photography and animations of long-lost ancestors.

Chicago P.D.

NBC, 9 p.m.

A significant turning point in Atwater's (LaRoyce Hawkins) life prompts him to make a decision about his future in the new episode.

Secrets of the Dead

PBS, 9 p.m.

Built between the 11th and 15th centuries, Great Zimbabwe was one of the most prominent ancient civilizations of the African continent. It was the thriving capital of a massive trading empire, but for hundreds of years, Great Zimbabwe was dismissed by European explorers. The archaeological discoveries revealed in this new episode, "Africa's Golden City," show the true scope of the ancient city's global importance.

CATCH A CLASSIC

Monty Python Triple Feature

TCM, beginning at 7 p.m.

Spend the evening with the Monty Python troupe and three of its feature films. The 1975 film **Monty Python and the Holy Grail (pictured)** sends King Arthur and his knights on a wildly silly quest. **Monty Python's Life of Brian** (1979) follows a man born next door to Jesus who is repeatedly mistaken for the Messiah. The night ends with **Monty Python's The Meaning of Life** (1983), an irreverent series of sketches about life, death and nearly everything in between.

EMI FILMS

MOVIES YOU'LL LOVE

'Adventureland'

ABBOT GENSER

Forrest Gump (1994, Comedy-drama) Tom Hanks, Robin Wright **Paramount, 5 p.m.**

Little Fockers (2010, Comedy) Robert De Niro, Ben Stiller **TNT, 5 p.m.**

In the Grey (2026, Action) Jake Gyllenhaal, Henry Cavill **Starz, 6:15 p.m.**

Halloween (2018, Horror) Jamie Lee Curtis, Judy Greer **SYFY, 6:30 p.m.**

Christine (1983, Horror) Keith Gordon, John Stockwell **AMC, 7 p.m.**

Escape Room (2019, Horror) Taylor Russell, Logan Miller **VH1, 7 p.m.**

The Spirit of Halloween (2026, Romance) Meghan Ory, Valentina Capetola **Hallmark, 7 p.m.**

Addams Family Values (1993, Comedy) Anjelica Huston, Raul Julia **Freeform, 7:55 p.m.**

Ocean's Eleven (2001, Comedy-drama) George Clooney, Matt Damon **Paramount, 8:30 p.m.**

Big Lies in a Small Town (2022, Suspense) Rhonda Dent, Kristina Paras **LMN, 9 p.m.**

Trick 'r Treat (2007, Horror) Anna Paquin, Brian Cox **BBC America, 9 p.m.**

Adventureland (2009, Comedy-drama) Jesse Eisenberg, Kristen Stewart **VH1, 9:30 p.m.**

Gone in 60 Seconds (2000, Action) Nicolas Cage, Angelina Jolie **FX, 10 p.m.**

From the editors of TV Weekly and tvinsider.com

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TV NEWS

Lady Violet anchors new prequel

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Dearest gentle "Bridgerton" viewers — rejoice, for a new prequel series about Lady Violet is headed to Netflix.

The streaming service and Shondaland announced recently that an untitled spinoff about the early life of the future matriarch of the Bridgerton clan is in the works.

Shonda Rhimes and Nicholas Nardini will write and serve as showrunners on the limited series, which will tell the story of Lady Violet's romance with her future husband, Viscount Edmund Bridgerton.

The show will be the second spinoff set in the expanding world of the popular Regency romance following the 2023 prequel series "Queen Charlotte: A Bridgerton Story," which explored the early days of the eponymous queen's marriage to King George III.

Portrayed by Ruth Gemmell in the flagship series, Lady Violet is the mother of the eight Bridgerton siblings whose individual adventures in (and around) the marriage mart are the focus of the show.

A younger version of the character, played by Connie Jenkins-Greig, also appeared in the "Queen Charlotte" prequel. The cast of the untitled prequel has not yet been announced.

Based on the popular book series by Julia Quinn, "Bridgerton" has been a hit with audiences since premiering in 2020. The first four seasons have chronicled the steamy happily-ever-afters of the eldest Bridgerton siblings — Daphne, Anthony, Colin and Benedict.

The fifth season of the series, which will follow the love story of Francesca Bridgerton (Hannah Dodd) and Michaela Stirling (Masali Baduza), is now in production in London.

Ruth Gemmell portrays Lady Violet in "Bridgerton." A new prequel series will center on the character. **NETFLIX**

'Crazy Rich Asians' series in works: "Crazy Rich Asians" will officially be back on screen, with some familiar faces joining for the ride.

HBO announced recently that it had ordered an original drama series of the same name based on author Kevin Kwan's book series eight years after director Jon M. Chu's "Crazy Rich Asians" film adaptation marked a watershed moment for Asian representation in the industry.

The series will see stars Constance Wu and Henry Golding reprise their roles as lovebirds Rachel Chu and Nick Young; Ronny Chieng as Nick's cousin Eddie Cheng; and Oscar winner Michelle Yeoh as the hard-to-please Young family matriarch, Eleanor.

Although not exactly the movie sequel some fans were hoping for, the series will pick up after the events of the 2018 film and will be based on Kwan's books, HBO announced. Adele Lim, who co-wrote Chu's 2018 film, will serve as showrunner and will executive produce the series alongside Kwan, Chu and "Crazy Rich Asians" movie producers Nina Jacobson and Brad Simpson.

The "Crazy Rich Asians" series could fill the void left by the onetime promise of a "Crazy Rich Asians" sequel. Prospects of a sequel crumbled in 2019 when The Hollywood Reporter broke news that Lim left the sequel over pay disparity.

Sheridan shuts down '6666' rumors: Taylor Sheridan has many irons in the fire, but there's one he's quenching into a bucket of water.

In February 2021, Paramount announced a new scripted series about the historic Four Sixes Ranch. The show, which had a working title of "6666," was announced as part of Sheridan's new slate of Paramount+ programming.

It was apt timing to reveal the show, since "Yellowstone" viewers would soon see Jimmy (Jefferson White) be sent to the Guthrie, Texas, ranch in Season 4, which premiered that November.

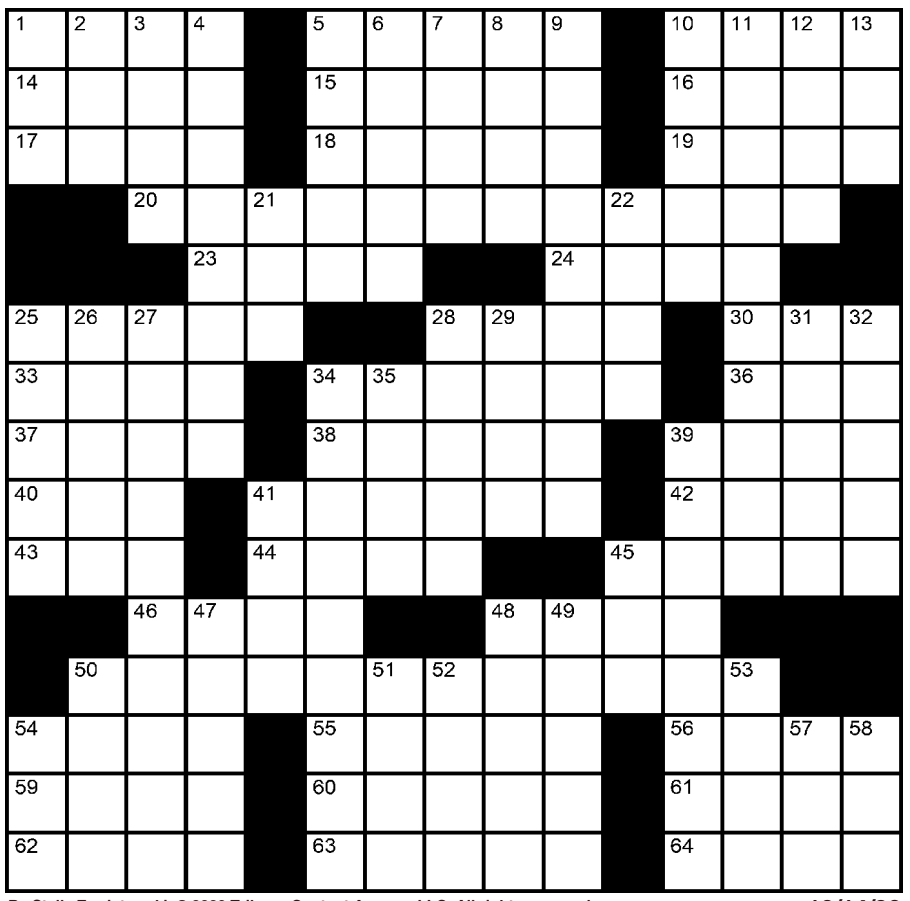
The show announcement also came about a year before Sheridan and a group of investors purchased the ranch for more than $300 million in early 2022.

However, since then, there hasn't been a ton of news about "6666" until recently. "There's never going to be one," Sheridan said. "I would never fictionalize that ranch."

Sheridan continued that if he was to make a show about the ranch, he would have to trivialize and fictionalize a place where real people work and raise their families.

"I could never do that to them," Sheridan said. "I could never do that to the cowboys who've dedicated themselves and everybody that works on that ranch."

Crossword



By Stella Zawistowski. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC. All rights reserved. 10/14/26

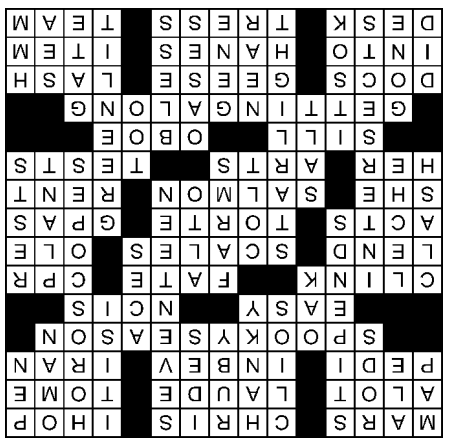
ACROSS

1 Roman god of war
5 Actor Pine
10 Popular breakfast chain
14 Often: 2 wds.
15 Magna cum __
16 Big book
17 Spa service, for short
18 Conglomerate that owns Budweiser
19 Tehran's country
20 Leadup to Halloween: 2 wds.
23 Not hard
24 Mark Harmon show
25 Sound of glasses touching
28 Destiny
30 EMT's skill: Abbr.
33 Loan
34 Piano exercises
36 Grand __ Opry
37 Book after John
38 Rich cake
39 School stats: Abbr.
40 "That's all __ wrote"
41 Pink-fleshed fish
42 Tenant's payment
43 "Slide" singer
44 Branch of learning
45 Examinations
46 Place for a flowerpot
48 Woodwind instrument
50 Working together well: 2 wds.
54 Medical pros, for short
55 "Silly" birds
56 Hit with a whip
59 Really liking
60 Brand of briefs
61 Object
62 Office furniture
63 Lock of hair
64 Mets, Nets, or Jets

DOWN

1 Diagram of streets
2 Bitter beer
3 Fishing poles
4 Regular payments
5 Advertising awards
6 __-panky
7 Red gemstone
8 __ of March
9 "Edge of __" (Stevie Nicks song)
10 "C'est moi": 3 wds.
11 Astrology forecasts
12 Yemen neighbor
13 Writing tool
21 Sturdy tree
22 Las Vegas team
25 Hostile encounter
26 Milk, in Spanish
27 Crosses
28 Raises crops
29 Choral voice
31 Factory
32 Takes a breather
34 Nighttime illumination
35 Young male horse
39 Gave the go-ahead to
41 Common seasoning
45 Overly
47 "No worries": 2 wds.
48 Desert refuges
49 "__ this mess"
50 Disappeared
51 Opposite of far
52 Unit of heredity
53 Fence opening
54 "__ you see that?"
57 Manatee's home
58 "Let's see..."

Solutions



Horoscopes

If October 14 is your birthday: You should be able to look forward to a better fourth quarter than you experienced in the first three quarters of 2026. Assess your beliefs carefully this month, let go of any that aren't creative of the life you want. As October rolls to November, a nice new income stream could flow in, bringing enhanced creativity with it.

Aries (March 21-April 19): Today the stars begin their upward slide toward the biggest jackpot days remaining in 2026 later this month.

Taurus (April 20-May 20): Major progress could be made in projects and tasks as Universal stars are supporting efforts much more strongly. A plan for financial increase could be life-changing if you can garner enough cooperation.

Gemini (May 21-June 20): A key relationship could enter smooth and protected waters for at least the next few days. Searches for creative solutions could be productive now.

Cancer (June 21-July 22): Small efforts could yield big results for the next couple of days — things could resolve more favorably that you imagined.

Leo (July 23-Aug. 22): Creativity could be dramatically enhanced for a few days — one solution could just drop into your lap from the cosmic muse.

Virgo (Aug. 23-Sept. 22): A surprise could unfold at home; it's likely to be positive and could potentially bring a lot together for you. Investments made in the next few weeks could prosper if your personal money cycles are equally strong.

Libra (Sept. 23-Oct. 22): Unless someone is really stubborn, a declaration made now could be very effective and drive both progress and healing.

Scorpio (Oct. 23-Nov. 21): While impulsive decisions around money and spending are seldom a good idea, today's setup might work out well.

Sagittarius (Nov. 22-Dec. 21): Being yourself and being spontaneous both should work well today — a sudden idea could pay off; the Universe should be supporting you.

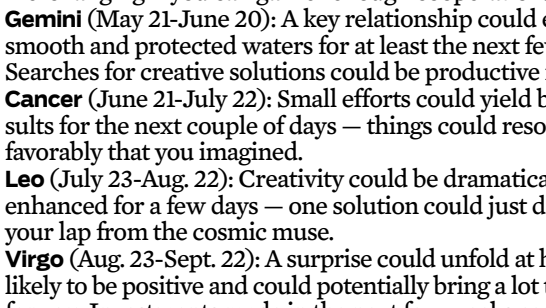
Capricorn (Dec. 22-Jan. 19): Ideas could POP from deep within you that could really make a difference in both outer achievement and inner peace.

Aquarius (Jan. 20-Feb. 18): Even if you don't feel fully secure in your knowledge, the world could need what you have to teach. Stick to what you really know, then dismiss doubts and fears. A friend could bring a needed resource.

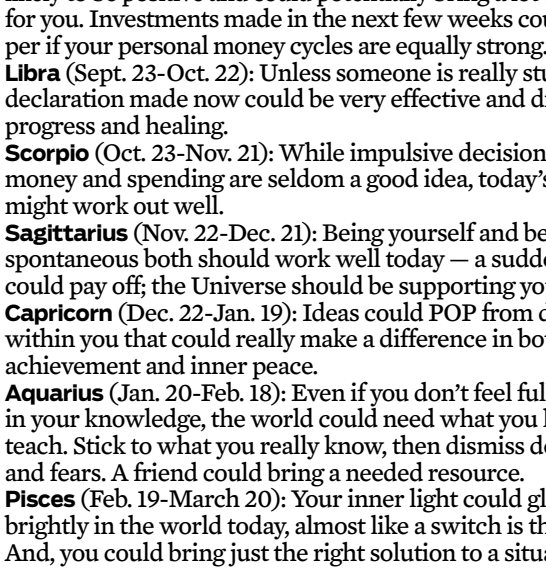
Pisces (Feb. 19-March 20): Your inner light could glow brightly in the world today, almost like a switch is thrown. And, you could bring just the right solution to a situation.

— Magi Helena, Tribune Content Agency

The Argyle Sweater By Scott Hilburn



Bliss By Harry Bliss



"For the last time, where is the other sock?"

Bridge

Both vulnerable, South deals

North
♠ J 10 6 2
♥ 10 6
♦ Q J 8 6 4 2
♣ K

West
♠ A K Q 4 3
♥ Void
♦ 9 7 5
♣ J 10 9 8 6

East
♠ 9 8 5
♥ Q 5 3 2
♦ K 10 3
♣ A 4 3

South
♠ 7
♥ A K J 9 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ Q 7 5 2

Today's deal is from a match between a team from England and a team from the Netherlands. The English South persevered to four hearts, as would we all, after the East-West interference. East showed an odd number of spades on the opening lead and West continued with the king of spades. South ruffed and led a club to dummy's king and East's ace. East shifted to a low trump, as he had to in order to prevent two club ruffs in dummy. South decided to play his ace, cash the queen of clubs, and ruff a club in dummy. He led a diamond to the ace and cashed his high trump, but there were only nine tricks and he finished down one. Had he taken the heart finesse at trick four, he could have won with the 10 in dummy and repeated the heart finesse to avoid a heart loser, but he would still only have nine tricks. Can you spot a way to make it?

South can prevail if he lets the heart run to dummy's 10 and ruffs a spade. He can then cash the queen of clubs, ruff a club in dummy, and ruff another spade. That would give him seven tricks. He could exit with his remaining club and he would have to score the ace, king, and jack of trumps. How did you do? The defense would have always succeeded with a club shift at trick two and then a heart from East. Not so easy to find.

The bidding:

South	West	North	East
1♥	2NT*	Pass	3♠
4♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl

All pass

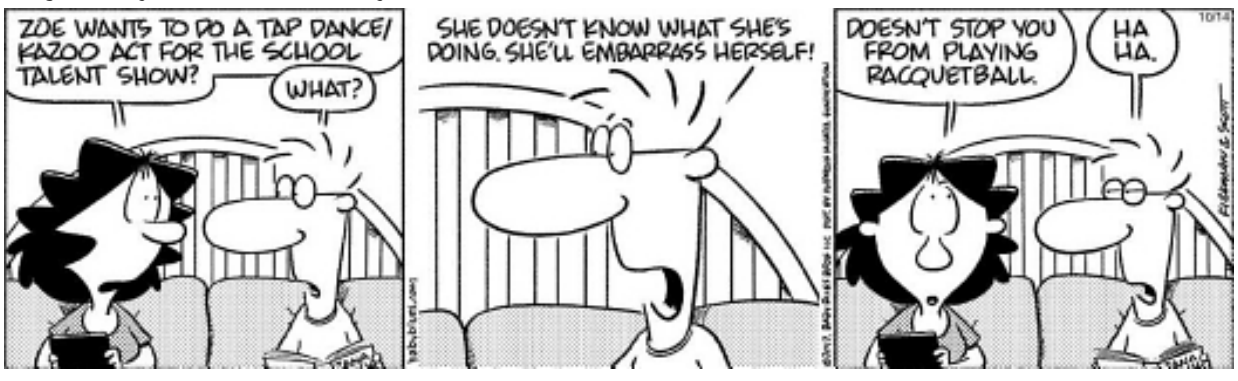
***Spades and clubs**

Opening lead: Ace of ♠

— Bob Jones
Tribune Content Agency

Grand Avenue By Mike Thompson

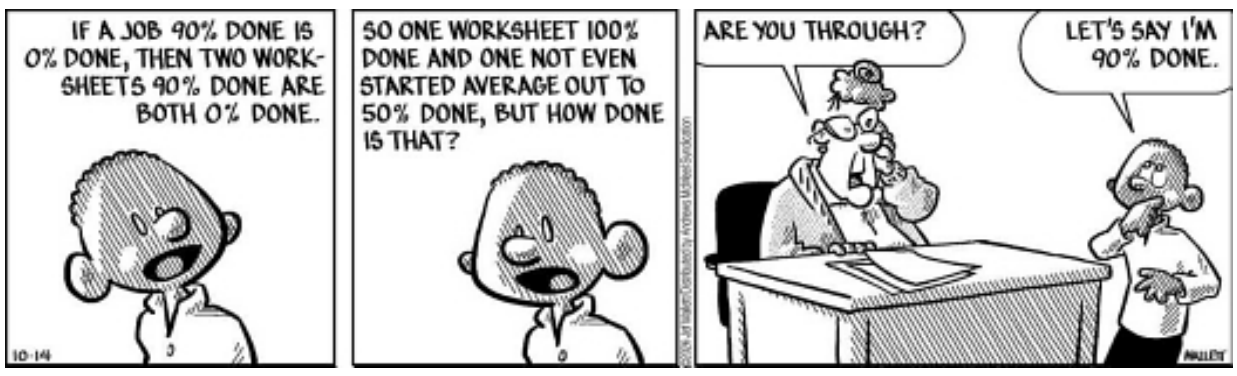
Baby Blues By Rick Kirkman and Jerry Scott



Zits By Jerry Scott and Jim Borgman

Mr. Boffo By Joe Martin

Frazz By Jef Mallett

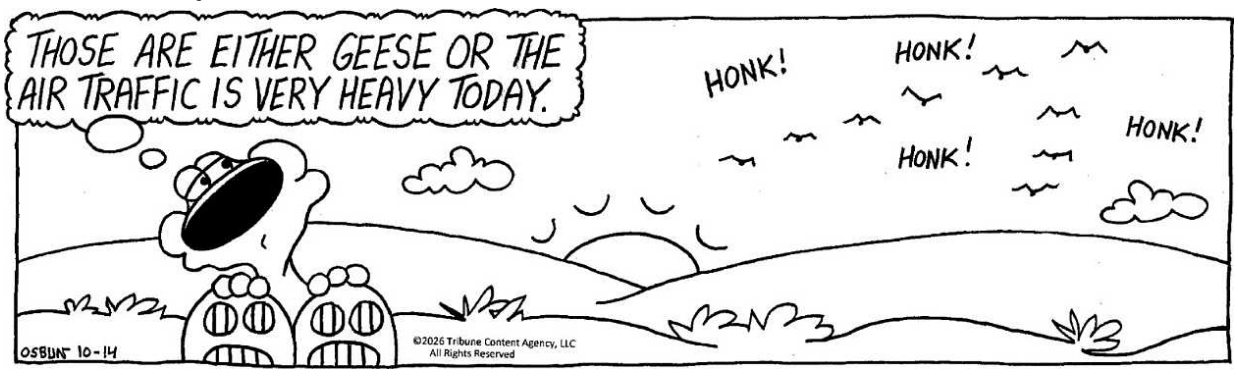


Classic Peanuts By Charles Schulz

Pickles By Brian Crane

Dick Tracy By Charles Ettinger and Mike Curtis

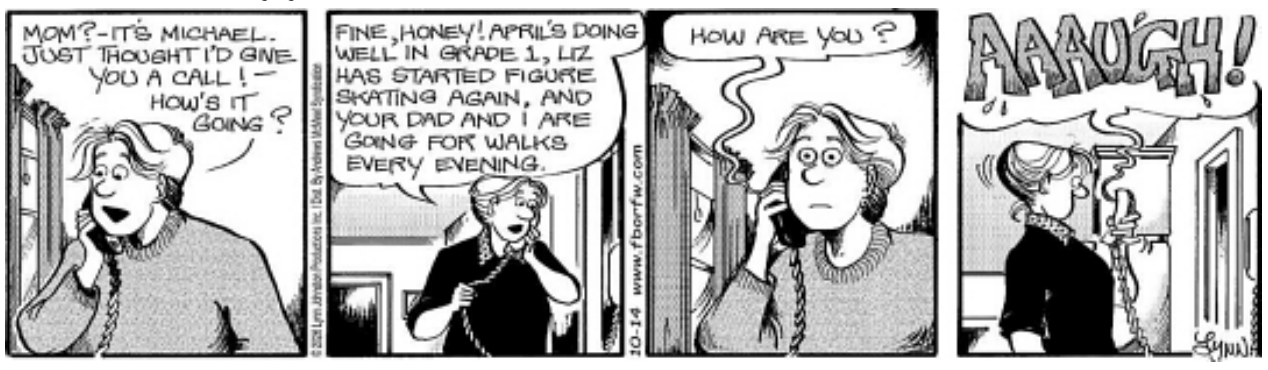
Animal Crackers By Mike Osbun



Prickly City By Marshall Ramsey

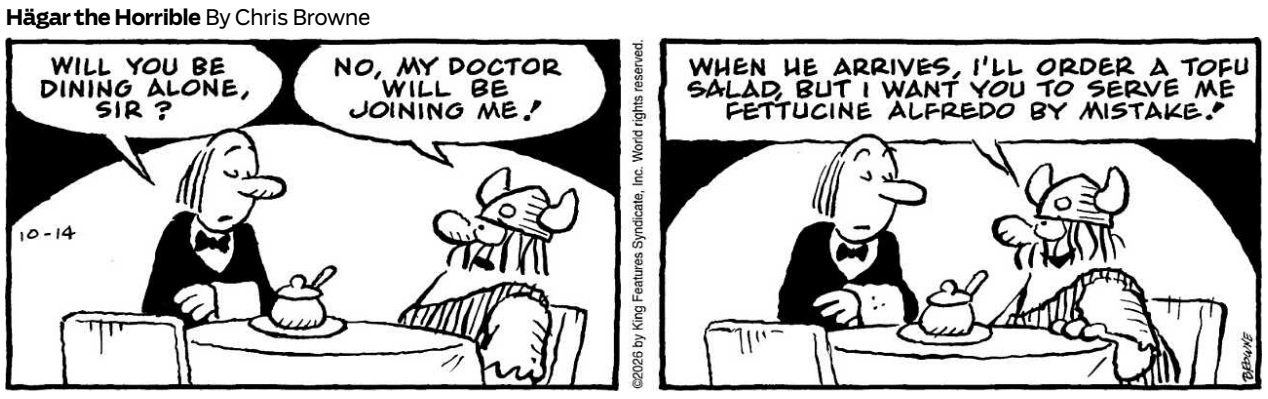
Dustin By Steve Kelley and Jeff Parker

For Better or for Worse By Lynn Johnston



Blondie By Dean Young and John Marshall

Hägar the Horrible By Chris Browne



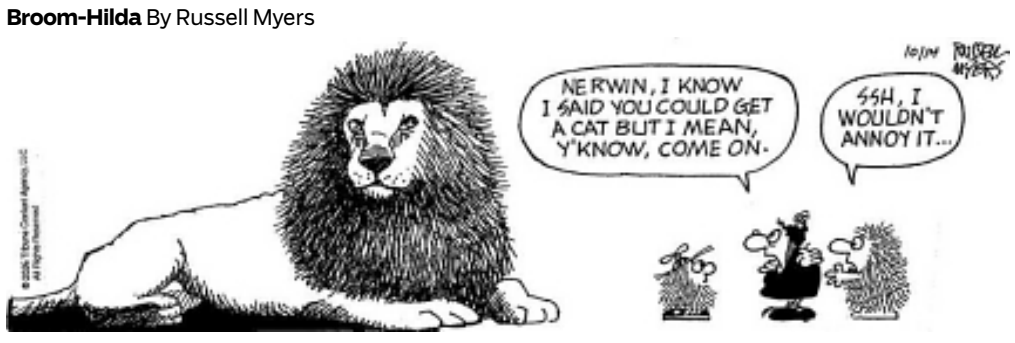
Mutts By Patrick McDonnell

WuMo By Mikael Wulff and Anders Morgenthaler

Sherman's Lagoon By Jim Toomey

Brewster Rockit: Space Guy! By Tim Rickard

Broom-Hilda By Russell Myers



Trivia Bits

What was the name of Drew Barrymore's character in "E.T. the Extra-Terrestrial"?

A) Dolly
B) Gertie
C) Honey
D) Zuzu

Tuesday's answer: East Egg and West Egg are fictional places in "The Great Gatsby."

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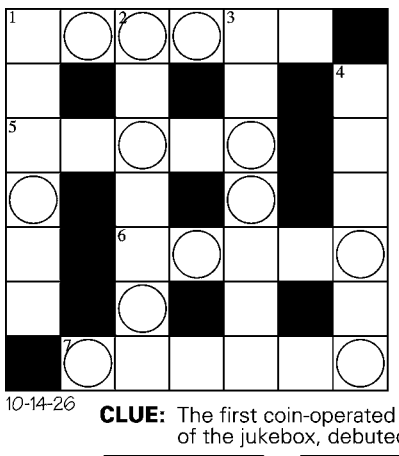
Jumble Crossword



10-14-26

ACROSS

CLUE	ANSWER
1. Annul	LNECAC
5. Swiss ___	NARCF
6. Go inside	ETRNE
7. Music ___	USIOTD

DOWN

CLUE	ANSWER
1. ___ cup	FEEOCF
2. Tidiest	STTENEA
3. Thrilled	EITCEDX
4. Music system	RTEESO

How to play - Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

CLUE: The first coin-operated phonograph, a forerunner of the jukebox, debuted in ____ ____ in 1889.

BONUS

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ANSWERS: 1A-Cancel 5A-Franc 6A-Enter 7A-Studio 1D-Coffee 2D-Neatest 3D-Excited 4D-Stereo BONUS-San Francisco

By David L. Hoyt.

Sudoku 1234

10/14

6				2				1
					3			
	4	7		9				5
		4			2	6		
	8				9		3	
		6	5			8		
				6			1	
			4					
2				5				7

Complete the grid so each row, column and 3-by-3 box in bold borders contains every digit 1 to 9.

4	6	5	8	9	3	1	7	2
3	9	1	7	6	2	5	8	4
8	7	2	4	5	1	9	3	6
5	8	9	2	7	4	3	6	1
2	4	6	1	3	9	7	5	8
7	1	3	6	8	5	4	2	9
9	5	8	3	1	6	2	4	7
1	2	7	5	4	8	6	9	3
6	3	4	9	2	7	8	1	5

Tuesday's solutions

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Jumble

Unscramble the four Jumbles, one letter per square, to form four words. Then arrange the circled letters to form the surprise answer, as suggested by this cartoon.

JYFIF

CEORF

PCAEST

EESCUX

Answer here

" ____ - ____ "

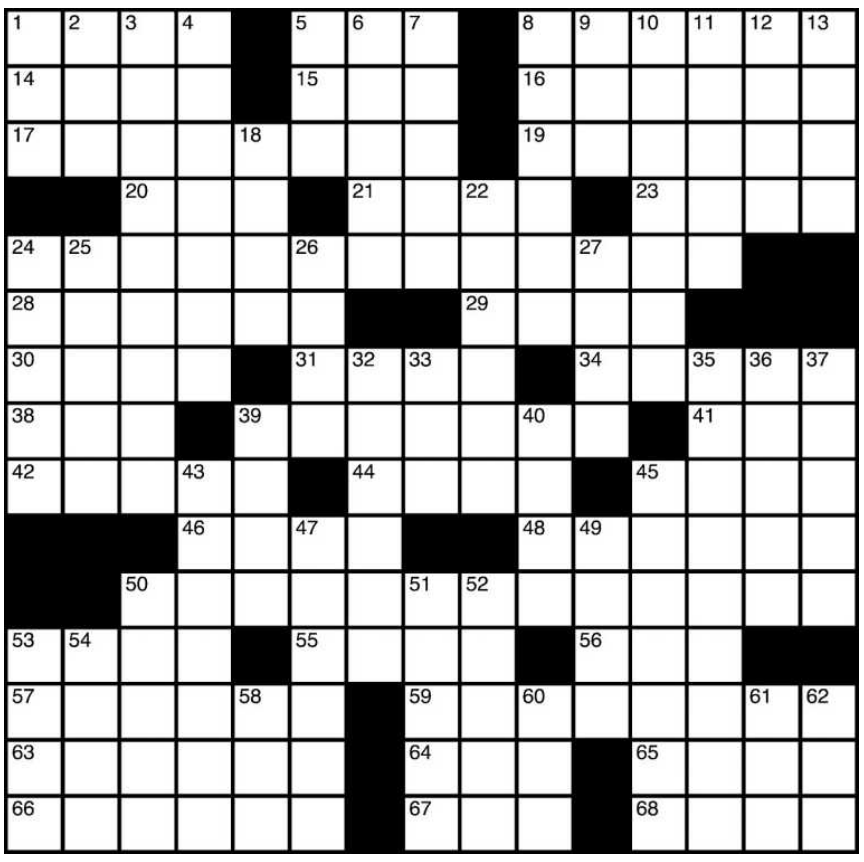
Tuesday's answers

Jumbles: FACET VILLA WALLOP ADRIFT
Answer: The frog's cousin never forgot anything, thanks to his — "TOAD-AL" RECALL

By David L. Hoyt and Jeff Knurek. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC. All rights reserved. PlayJumble.com

Crossword

10/14



Across

1 No-frills supermarket chain
5 Receipt fig.
8 Puzzle
14 Weaver's machine
15 "Pshaw!"
16 Perfect alignment
17 *Black Friday enticement
19 Peak with a name from Koyukon
20 "The Matrix" hero
21 Wee bit
23 Left in a cave, as some cheese
24 *Words with a WWII-era doodle
28 Mardi Gras song originally called "Jock-A-Mo"
29 Fabled race day napper
30 "I'll shake on that!"
31 Berra with a record 10 World Series rings as a player
34 Centipede releaser
38 Family guy
39 *Shout on a playground
41 Pod of whales
42 "Do the Right Thing" actor Davis
44 Stint in office
45 Much Duchamp work
46 Pitch setter
48 Superhot, as wing sauce
50 *Introductory phrase
53 Stepped heavily
55 Grammy winner India.__
56 Sudden flight
57 Demolish
59 Marketing slogans, or what the answers to the starred clues are?
63 Does some tailoring on
64 "Fearless" or "Lover," for Taylor Swift
65 Iditarod terminus city
66 Thrift store transaction
67 Sketch show with celebrity 50-Down, for short
68 Flakes

Down

1 __ too soon
2 Lav
3 Gets off the web
4 Put at risk
5 Pacific tuna
6 Large parrot that forms a pair bond
7 Angle symbol, in geometry
8 Subject of a 49-foot bronze statue in Nara, Japan
9 WSW opposite
10 Mosque tower
11 Utility bill data
12 Foot part
13 "Wednesday" werewolf
18 Chess piece in castling
22 More pale
24 Little buddy
25 Stores with Småland play areas
26 Fluctuate wildly
27 Basic Latin verb
32 Determined to get
33 Test for some srs.
35 Leader of the Greek army during the Trojan War
36 Diameter halves
37 Apple desktops
39 Talk over the clamor
40 "Ms. Marvel" star Vellani
43 Pure Leaf beverage
45 Realms
47 Pass by
49 Starbucks size
50 Members of 67-Across's Five-Timers Club, e.g.
51 Tiny arachnids
52 Pine (for)
53 Type of ski lift
54 Hold the throne
58 Web address
60 Actress Gadot
61 Angsty rock
62 Do some tailoring on

Tuesday's solution

By Joe Rodini. Edited by Patti Varol. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC.

BONUS PUZZLE PAGE

An extra array of word games, search and Jumble. Want more? Play online at ***PlayJumble.com***

Scan QR code to play online.

SUDOKU

			5		8	7		9
						1		8
3	9							
	3			1	9	6		
			2		4			
		4	8				2	
							6	5
5		7						
4		1	3	9				

Level 1 **2** 3 4

Complete the grid so each row, column and 3-by-3 box (in bold borders) contains every digit from 1 to 9. For strategies on solving Sudoku, visit ***sudoku.org.uk.***

2	7	8	5	9	3	1	9	4
1	6	3	2	4	6	7	8	5
5	6	4	7	8	1	3	2	9
7	2	6	3	5	8	4	1	6
3	1	5	4	6	2	6	7	8
4	8	6	6	1	7	5	3	2
6	5	2	1	7	4	8	6	3
8	4	1	6	3	6	2	5	7
6	3	7	8	2	5	6	4	1

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12/28/22

WORD SEARCH

Wordsearch: Places that begin and end the same 1380

Can you find all the words hidden in the grid? Read backwards or forwards, up or down, or diagonally. The words will always be in a straight line. Cross them off the list as you find them.

L I V E R P O O L L O K A Q A Q R E
L R V E W Q G E W J V W D U Q C Q U
B S E Y C H E L L E S X G B J A U M
Z I V E V K W N A J N I C D B F K C
O P O R T O L M Z X T S K A J R U J
O S N E W H A V E N Z W B O L I R A
R C T Z B B D R A T U A Y O V C S C
L O Y E A Q A B A A S N H A R A K C
A H V L S X O M L I N N C O R O I R
N I A L A J N H D P O G N P L U S A
D O X M G L T D A M E R O S A A B D
O O G B H Z A I Y L N M O L B L A A
U D R X Z E R S B R B J K H A B U N
Z D M T V L I N K E B E A K P A S D
S S D K M K O D M A T A R S Z N T O
L Y U G A U S T R A L I A T I I R R
X G O T H E N B U R G T C M A A I R
E N T E B B E D N E W T O W N G A A

ACCRA
ADDIS ABABA
AFRICA
ALABAMA
ALASKA
ALBANIA
ALBERTA
ANDORRA
ANGOLA
ANTIGUA
AQABA
ARUBA
ASIA
AUSTRALIA
AUSTRIA
DORTMUND
ENTEBBE
GOTHENBURG
KURSK
LIVERPOOL
NEW HAVEN
NEWTOWN
OHIO
ONTARIO
OPORTO
ORLANDO
OSLO
OWENSBORO
SEYCHELLES
TIBET

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BOGGLE

Boggle® BrainBusters!

By David L. Hoyt and Jeff Knurek

M L R O
A N C E
I P S T
L U O Y

BUPHWOISGOKEAGLM

INSTRUCTIONS: Find as many words as you can by linking letters up, down, side-to-side and diagonally, writing words on a blank sheet of paper. You may only use each letter box once within a single word. Play with a friend and compare word finds, crossing out common words.

BOGGLE® POINT SCALE	YOUR BOGGLE® RATING
3 letters = 1 point	151+ = Champ
4 letters = 2 points	101-150 = Expert
5 letters = 3 points	61-100 = Pro
6 letters = 4 points	31 - 60 = Gamer
7 letters = 6 points	21 - 30 = Rookie
8 letters = 10 points	11 - 20 = Amateur
9+ letters = 15 points	0 - 10 = Try again

Boggle® BrainBusters Bonus

We put special brain-busting words into the grid of letters. Can you find them?

Find AT LEAST FOUR MOLLUSKS in the grid of letters.

_____

_____

_____

_____

CLAM SNAIL OYSTER OCTOPUS

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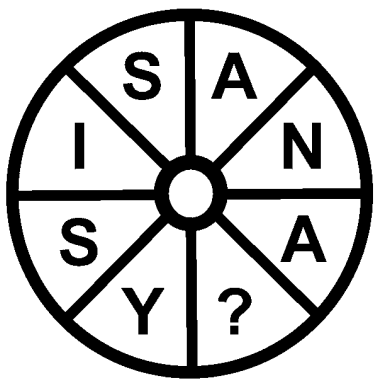
www.bogglebrainbusters.com

WordWheel



Insert the missing letter to complete an eight-letter word reading clockwise or counterclockwise.

ANAL YSIS

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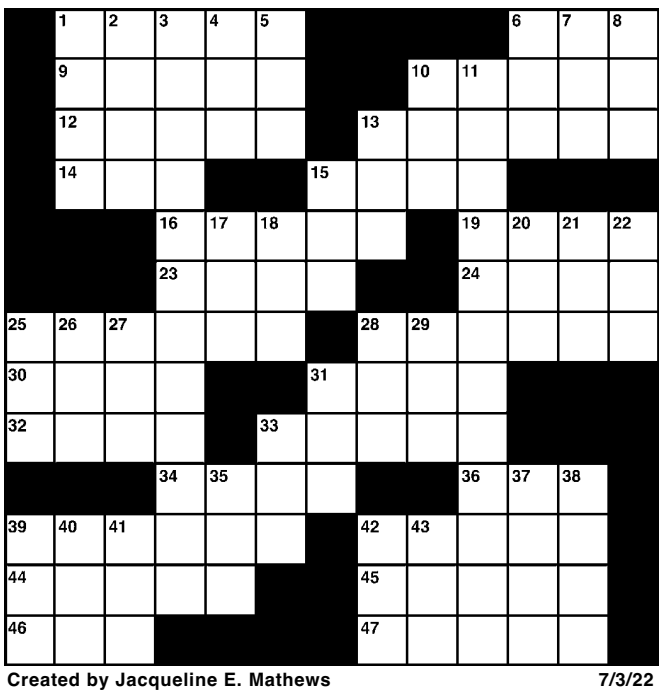
TV CROSSWORD

by Jacqueline E. Mathews



Created by Jacqueline E. Mathews 7/3/22

ACROSS
1 Fonda or Falk
6 "__ About You"
9 Got up
10 __ O'Neil of "The Wonder Years"
12 Exhausted
13 Frasier & Niles
14 Enjoy a winter sport
15 Dad on "Little People, Big World"
16 Actor Ed __
19 Gentile of "The Goldbergs"
23 "High __"; Gary Cooper classic
24 "Beavis and Butt-__"
25 "Little House on the Prairie" actor
28 "__ of S.H.I.E.L.D."
30 __ vera; lotion ingredient
31 One-dish meal
32 Actress Teri
33 France's dollar before the euro
34 Gilbert, for one
36 Letters before an alias
39 Cartoon dog
42 "Suddenly __"
44 Cary or Hugh
45 "Tosca" or "Carmen"
46 Street paver's goop
47 "Bad __ Black Rock"; Spencer Tracy film

DOWN
1 Boone & Sajak
2 Actor Estrada
3 Actress on "NCIS: Hawai'i"
4 Suffix for Nepal or Japan
5 "The __ Skelton Hour"
6 "__ with a Plan"
7 "The Kids __ Alright"
8 Prefix for please or place
10 Mr. Linkletter
11 Recent "Chicago Fire" role
13 "__ 54, Where Are You?"
15 "__ in Trees"
17 Jack __ of "Barney Miller"
18 Prefix for fat or sense
20 Stimpy's housemate
21 Granola bit
22 Football field divisions: abbr.
25 Fail to keep up
26 So. state
27 And not
28 "One Day __ Time"
29 Highest army rank: abbr.
31 Mrs. in Madrid
33 Cook in oil
35 Isn't __ to; probably won't
37 Killmer of "Chicago Fire"
38 Med. school course
39 "__. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band"
40 Gun rights org.
41 Boatman's need
42 Layer of grass
43 "__ Lazy River"

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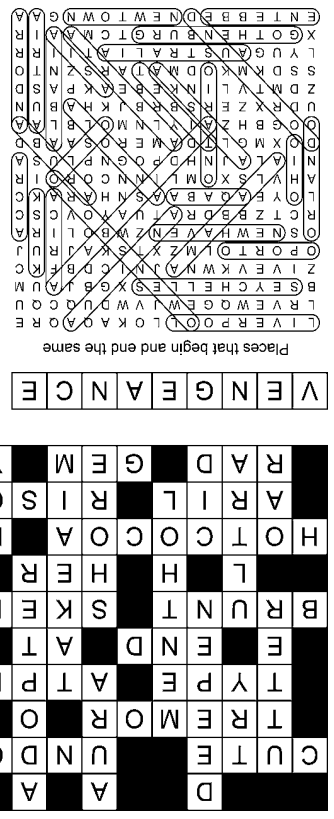

Places that begin and end the same

JUMBLE

JUMBLE

Unscramble these Jumbles, one letter to each square, to form four ordinary words.

SSOLH

SIYDA

TKNITE

WSLIVE

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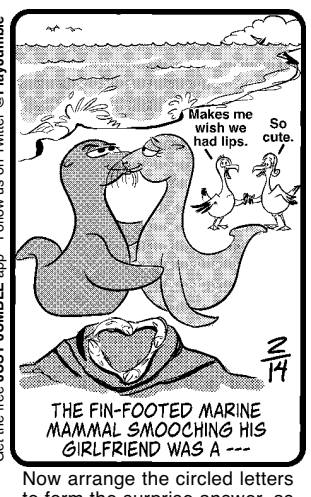
THAT SCRAMBLED WORD GAME
By David L. Hoyt and Jeff Knurek



Get the free JUST JUMBLE app • Follow us on Twitter @PlayJumble

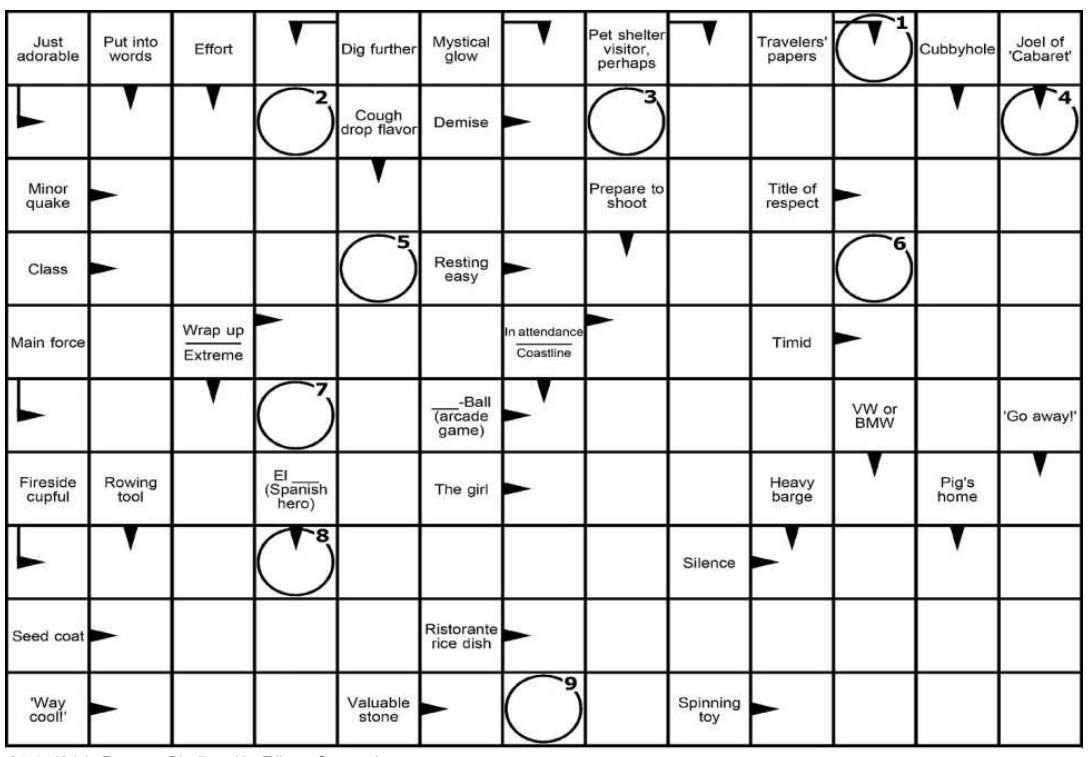
Now arrange the circled letters to form the surprise answer, as suggested by the above cartoon.

____ ____ A ____

Jumbles: SLOSH DAISY KITTEN SWIVEL
Answer: The fin-footed marine mammal smooching his girlfriend was a — SEAL WITH A KISS

ARROW WORDS

Fill in the grid using the clues provided in the direction of the arrows. When complete, unscramble the letters in the circles to reveal a mystery word.



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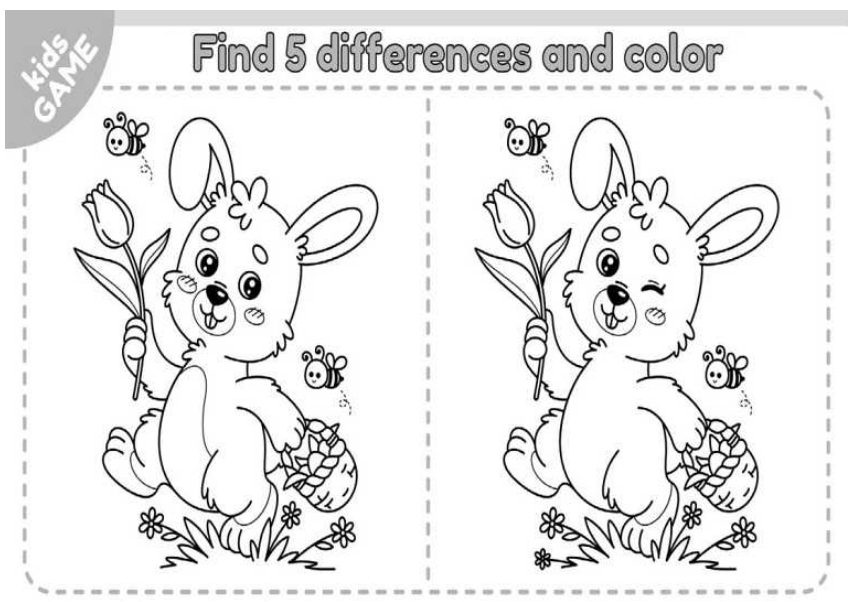
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

KIDNEWS FUN & GAMES



Blackhawks center Connor Bedard warms up for a game against the Penguins at the United Center on Tuesday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

BLACKHAWKS

Quick return for captain

Bedard makes his season debut, 3 months after shoulder surgery

By Kalen Lumpkins
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Star center and captain Connor Bedard joined the Blackhawks lineup Tuesday night to make his 2026-27 debut against the Pittsburgh Penguins after being activated from the injured non-roster list earlier in the day.

Bedard, 21, returned weeks ahead of schedule after initially receiving a four-month recovery timeline when he underwent left shoulder surgery July 8. He was injured when he fell into the boards during an unofficial practice in British Columbia.

UP NEXT
Jets at Blackhawks
7 p.m. Thurs., CHSN

Asked after an optional morning skate Tuesday about making his season debut, Bedard said, "Yeah, I'm pumped."

Bedard missed the first six games of the season while recovering from the surgery. The Hawks are 1-5-0.

"It's crazy it's only been six games," he said. "When you miss camp and you miss preseason, (it) feels a lot longer. Just to be back with the guys and get to do what I love, it's exciting."

Despite the early return, he said he had no concerns about his shoulder.

"If I did, I wouldn't be going," Bedard said. "(I'll) go out there and play normal and play free. If I was hesitant, then I wouldn't want to come back."

In a corresponding move with activating Bedard, the Hawks sent forward Nick Lardis to their AHL affiliate in Rockford.

Fans sported their No. 98 sweaters as they walked into the United Center for Tuesday's game. That included 37-year-olds Mark and Melissa Beyer with their 7-year-old daughter, Sophia, who arrived early

See **BEDARD** on Page C2

BEARS

DE Sweat suspended 2 games for PEDs

By Brad Biggs
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Bears defensive end Montez Sweat waits for the next play in the first quarter Sunday in Green Bay. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

The Bears already faced the prospect of being thin at defensive end for the near future, and now they will be without Montez Sweat for the next two games.

The NFL announced Tuesday that Sweat is suspended for two weeks for violating the league's performance-enhancing substances policy. He's out for Sunday's Week 6 game in Atlanta and the Week 7 game against the New England Patriots on Thursday, Oct. 22, at Soldier Field.

Defensive end Dayo Odeyingbo left Sunday's 31-7 loss in Green Bay with a quadriceps injury, so his availability is in question.

That means the Bears and defensive coordinator Dennis Allen could be short-handed for multiple games after the defense experienced wildly different performances in the first five games. The Bears surrendered 478 yards and 37 points in the season-opening win at Carolina and were torched by the Packers on Sunday as quarterback Jordan Love had one of the best games of his career, completing 25 of 31 passes for 367 yards and two touchdowns.

UP NEXT
Bears at Falcons
Noon Sunday, Fox-32

Defensive end Austin Booker had two of his four sacks this season in Green Bay and is in line

See **SWEAT** on Page C2

BULLS

Bench could provide boost — or challenge

By Julia Poe
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The NBA regular season hasn't even started yet, but the depth of the Bulls roster is already being tested.

Injuries to centers Nic Claxton, Zach Collins and Tobe Awaka threw the entire backcourt into disarray through the first three games of the preseason. A lack of health at the start of the season is never ideal. But this is a welcome test for the Bulls, whose depth will be crucial this season — for their success in the win/loss column and for their greater goals of talent development.

With a week left in the preseason, coach Tiago Splitter isn't letting himself get set in any specific nine- to 11-man rotation. Splitter plans to use the final two games of the preseason to test out his primary rotations for the regular season — but that doesn't mean the looks he plays against Milwaukee and Minnesota will necessarily be maintained throughout the rest of the year.

"It's not nailed down," Splitter said. "The availability of the players is going to change. It's a night-to-night type of thing. Those decisions have to be made right before the game. We're still exploring some things and probably the beginning of the season as well as we figure out what is the best lineup."

UP NEXT
Preseason
Bulls at Bucks
7 p.m. Wed., CHSN

The Bulls need to get minutes to a lot of different players this season. The primary goal is to give Caleb Wilson and Matas Buzelis as much playing time as necessary to develop key aspects of their game — on-ball facilitation, 1-on-1 defense, off-ball movement, spot-up shooting — to further their long-term growth. The Bulls also need to give substantial runway to Josh Giddey, who is entering a make-or-break season to prove whether or not he's a long-term fit for the team's point guard position.

From there, however, the Bulls' depth offers a Tetris-like puzzle that Splitter will spend the rest of the season solving. The backcourt is a good example of this versatility. Claxton is the clear starter with

See **BULLS** on Page C4

Coming up

Team	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
BEARS					**@ATL	** noon	Fox-32
BULLS	**@MIL (exh.) |** 7 p.m.	CHSN		**MIN (exh.) |** 7 p.m.	CHSN		
BLACKHAWKS		**WPG |** 7 p.m.	CHSN		**DAL |** 6 p.m.	CHSN	
FIRE	**PHI |** 7:30 p.m.	Apple TV			**@NE |** 6:30 p.m.	Apple TV	
STARS					**SEA	** 6 p.m.	Roku Sports

BEDARD

from Page C1

to add the "C" patch to their jerseys.

"We live just over the border in Indiana. We go to at least five games a year, usually," Mark Beyer said. "I was like: 'This game sounds good. It's Pittsburgh, always a good matchup. Hey, maybe we'll get lucky.' And I guess we got lucky."

Bedard had been practicing by himself in a noncontact sweater before recently rejoining the team for workouts, donning a normal jersey for practices Sunday and Monday after taking faceoffs Saturday.

His return was welcome news for the Hawks, who struggled to produce offense without Bedard. They were averaging two goals per game entering Tuesday and had converted only 1 of 14 power plays.

Coach Jeff Blashill recognized his team's difficulties without Bedard but doesn't think his captain should have the responsibility of saving the team.

"We're a very young group (in) key positions, center and defense," Blashill said. "Connor's not old, but certainly from an experience level and an ability level, he's a premier player in this league.

"We can't expect him to come and carry us to victory. He's going to be another piece of 20 guys that are playing (Tuesday) to help us win, but he's certainly an important piece."

Not only was it Bedard's season debut, but it was his first time on the ice as the Hawks captain. He was named the franchise's 37th captain on Sept. 15.

"I'm excited it's at home, honestly," Bedard said. "It's a special honor and (I'm) looking forward to that, but also try to treat it as any other game."

Bedard shared the ice with Patrick Kane for the first time as teammates. They had skated on the top line together in practice alongside rookie Roman Kantserov.

Kane, 37, shared his excitement Monday about Bedard's return.

"It's definitely a boost to the whole team," Kane said. "Seeing what he's capable of doing out there just in practice, it's high-level skill — the way he attacks, the way he can make plays off attacking. He's a special player and he's a big part of our team, so it's nice to see him back."

Bedard, meanwhile, called Kantserov "a special player."

"Seeing what he's been able to do and what he's done this whole year, (he and Kane) are going to make the game easy for me," Bedard said.

Unsurprisingly, fans were looking forward to seeing Kane and Bedard together.

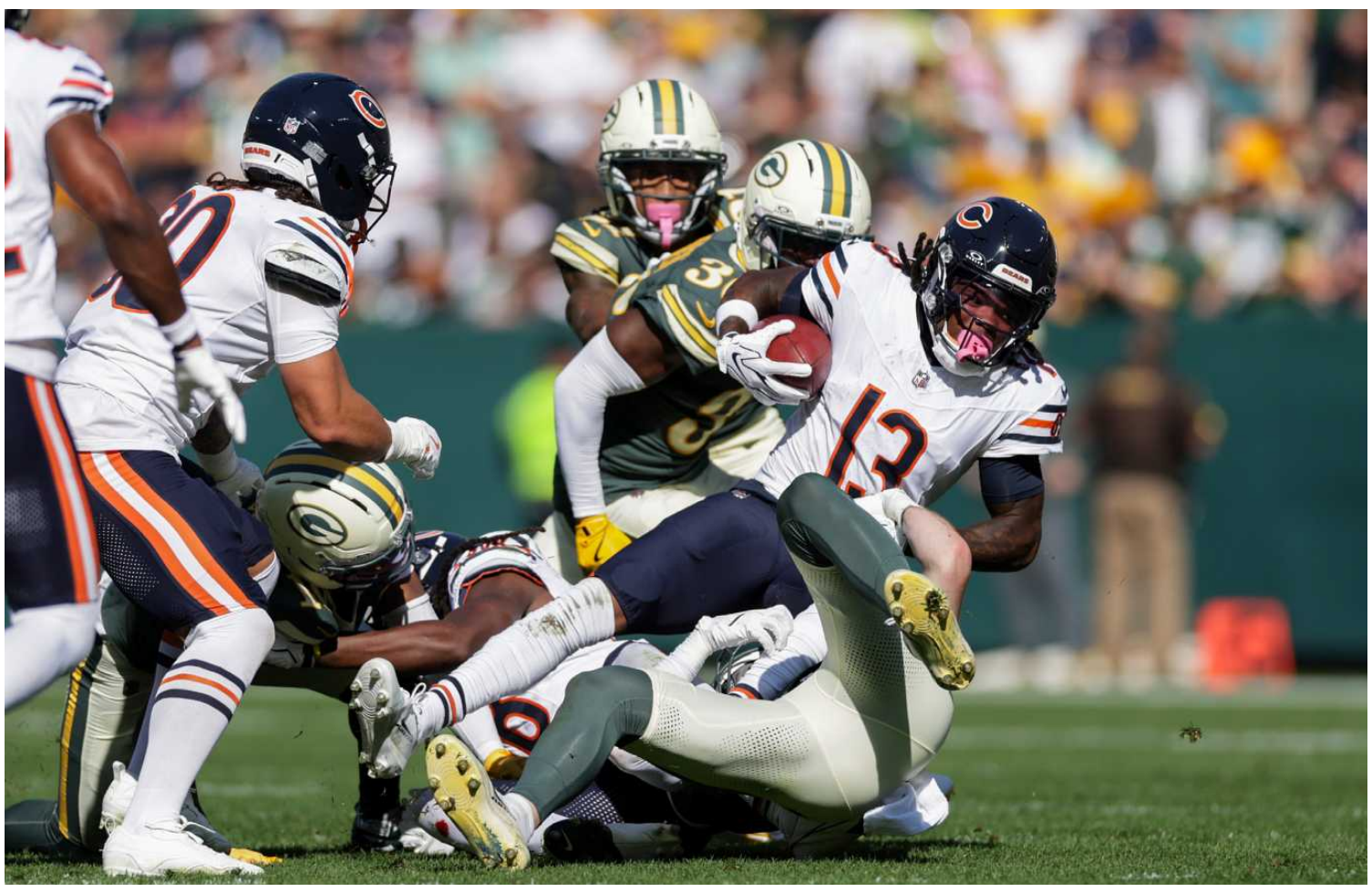
"I haven't been this excited since (Mark) proposed at a game," Melissa Beyer said.

Added Mark Beyer: "Seeing 98 (Bedard) and 88 (Kane) together is going to be exciting enough. We grew up with 88; (Sophia is) growing up with 98. She's gotten to see Patrick Kane highlight reels but not in person, so that'll be great."

This was the third time in his four NHL seasons that Bedard missed extended time because of an injury. His only full season was his second one in 2024-25, and the Hawks are 8-17-2 without him.

The 2023 No. 1 draft pick entered Tuesday with 203 career points (75 goals, 128 assists) in 219 games. Tuesday's game was the second of seven in a row for the Hawks at the United Center.

Blackhawks center Connor Bedard warms up for a game against the Penguins at the United Center on Tuesday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Bears wide receiver Zavion Thomas gets tackled by Packers linebacker Nick Niemann during the third quarter at Lambeau Field on Sunday in Green Bay. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Davenport's sudden release a sign of toll game can take

Brad Biggs
ON THE BEARS

Lions defensive end Marcus Davenport walks to the locker room before a game against the Rams in 2024 in Detroit. **DAVID DERMER/AP**

One of the rituals of summers gone by was catching up with longtime NFL assistant Pete Hoener, who spent one season as the Bears offensive line coach in 2004.

Hoener, 75 and a native of Peoria, went on to work for another 16 seasons as one of the most respected tight ends coaches in the league. Inevitably, I'd always ask, "How much longer are you going to do this?"

"Brother, if I'm thinking about retirement, I've already retired," he'd quip.

Hoener called me after the 2021 season and said he was calling it a career. This is a roundabout way to get into the release of defensive end Marcus Davenport on Oct. 5, a day after he debuted for the Bears and played 12 snaps in the win over the New York Jets.

I'm not going to pretend I knew what Davenport was thinking, but in visiting with him at the start of the season, it seemed like he was at least conflicted about a ninth season. The game can take a physical and mental toll on players. Davenport, 30, sounded like he was battling it on both fronts.

Injuries had made it difficult for him to stay on the field since the 2023 season after playing five seasons for Bears defensive coordinator Dennis Allen in New Orleans as the Saints' 2018 first-round draft pick.

- Multiple ankle injuries limited him to four games for the Minnesota Vikings in 2023, with surgery eventually required after a high ankle sprain in Week 6 against the Bears.
- A torn triceps in 2024 with the Detroit Lions limited him to two games.
- He played in eight games for the Lions last season but battled another pectoral injury and an ankle injury.

Davenport wasn't sure after 2025 if he'd play again.

"At a certain point, I didn't want to deal with it," he told me a few weeks ago. "Then I felt better and did some things and (Allen) called at the perfect time."

Allen reached out to Davenport in August with training camp underway. He was traveling in Japan after a trip to Germany to visit doctors, a journey his wife, Alexandra, arranged.

"I was in pain and my wife, she didn't want me to be in so much pain, so we went to a couple of specialists there and on the last day it worked so good that tears came down," Davenport said. "I felt a lot better."

Where was Davenport's pain before his journey to the clinic in Munich, where he worked with Dr. Kilian Müller-Wohlfahrt?

"It was all over," he said.

Davenport spent a week at the clinic and had a vast array of treatments, including some involving lamb's blood, he said, and hyaluronic acid. He said he received 54 injections over the course of the week. He worked with a chiropractor, massage therapist and personal trainer.

"I wanted to feel better," Davenport said. "I've been trying to stay in good shape and I was still in pain. It was a whole bunch of things for your different nerves to try to balance out your system. I was able to do things before I went, but I felt I had to compensate. I wasn't at an advantage. I was still strong. It wasn't until after I got the shot on the last day, I felt better."

The timing of Allen's call was perfect. Davenport was feeling better, and an old coach can sometimes be persuasive. Davenport wanted to give it a try. At the start of the season, he indicated he was in a good spot as the team gave him time to get in football shape and get ramped up.

"As much as I can look at the negatives," he said, "I can definitely look at my positives and I've been lucky."

Bears coach Ben Johnson said Davenport performed well in practice and the team wanted to see what he could do in a game. He was in the rotation for a game in which the defense was barely on the field — just 32 snaps — and the Bears won with ease.

Afterward, I asked him if it felt good to get back on the field.

"It's a whole mix of emotions," Davenport said in an exuberant locker room. "It's the way of life."

Johnson said Davenport's quick request to be released "was a little bit out of left field."

"If you're not full steam ahead, then you can't cheat your teammates or cheat the game," Johnson said. "It's just not worth it. He just felt like it was time to hang it up. Grateful he was honest."

Hopefully, as Davenport heads into the post-football phase of his life, the pain he dealt with is behind him. Like Hoener used to say, thinking about retirement wasn't an option for him as long as he was coaching. It sure sounded like retirement was an option Davenport mulled before he was an August addition for the Bears.

IN A GAME THAT DIDN'T HAVE A LOT OF POSITIVES, IT WAS GOOD TO SEE ROOKIE RETURN MAN ZAVION THOMAS GET LOOSE.

Special teams coordinator Richard Hightower lamented how the kickoff return unit had performed in recent weeks and highlighted it as a specific area his group was looking to improve. The Bears entered Week 5 ranked 32nd in the league in kickoff return average.

Thomas got out of the gates for a 61-yard return at the start of the fourth quarter. Jack Sanborn and Josh Blackwell had nice blocks at the point of attack, and if Thomas didn't have to cut back to avoid kicker Trey Smack, he probably would have scored. As it was, linebacker Nick Niemann tackled him at the Packers 31-yard line.

"I thought I was outta there," said Thomas, who also had returns of 28 and 30 yards.

He indicated there wasn't anything special he did during the week. He didn't want to press and try to make a big play. It was just trusting how he saw the blocks unfold in front of him and then hitting the gas.

"All 11 just being intentional and doing our part," Thomas said. "That's all it was. Emphasizing our job."

The Bears have been optimistic that Thomas, with his 4.28-second speed in the 40-yard dash at the scouting combine, can be a special returner and a field-position weapon.

"We hadn't been great the past couple games," Blackwell said. "To get one going is good to see. Zavion is great. He is electric. Today, he showed it. Once he can get going, he's tough to stop."

SWEAT

from Page C1

to start now. The Bears have used James Lynch at both tackle and end, and the Bears on Tuesday activated 2025 second-round pick Shemar Turner from the physically unable to perform list. Turner has been recovering from a torn ACL suffered last season.

Jamree Kromah, who has yet to play this season, and special teams mainstay Daniel Hardy are also options at end.

While the league did not disclose which drug Sweat tested positive for, the NFLPA lays out the different levels of suspensions for first-time violations:

- Two games for diuretics or masking agents.
- Four games for anabolic steroids, stimulants or human growth hormone.
- Six games for test manipulation or tampering.

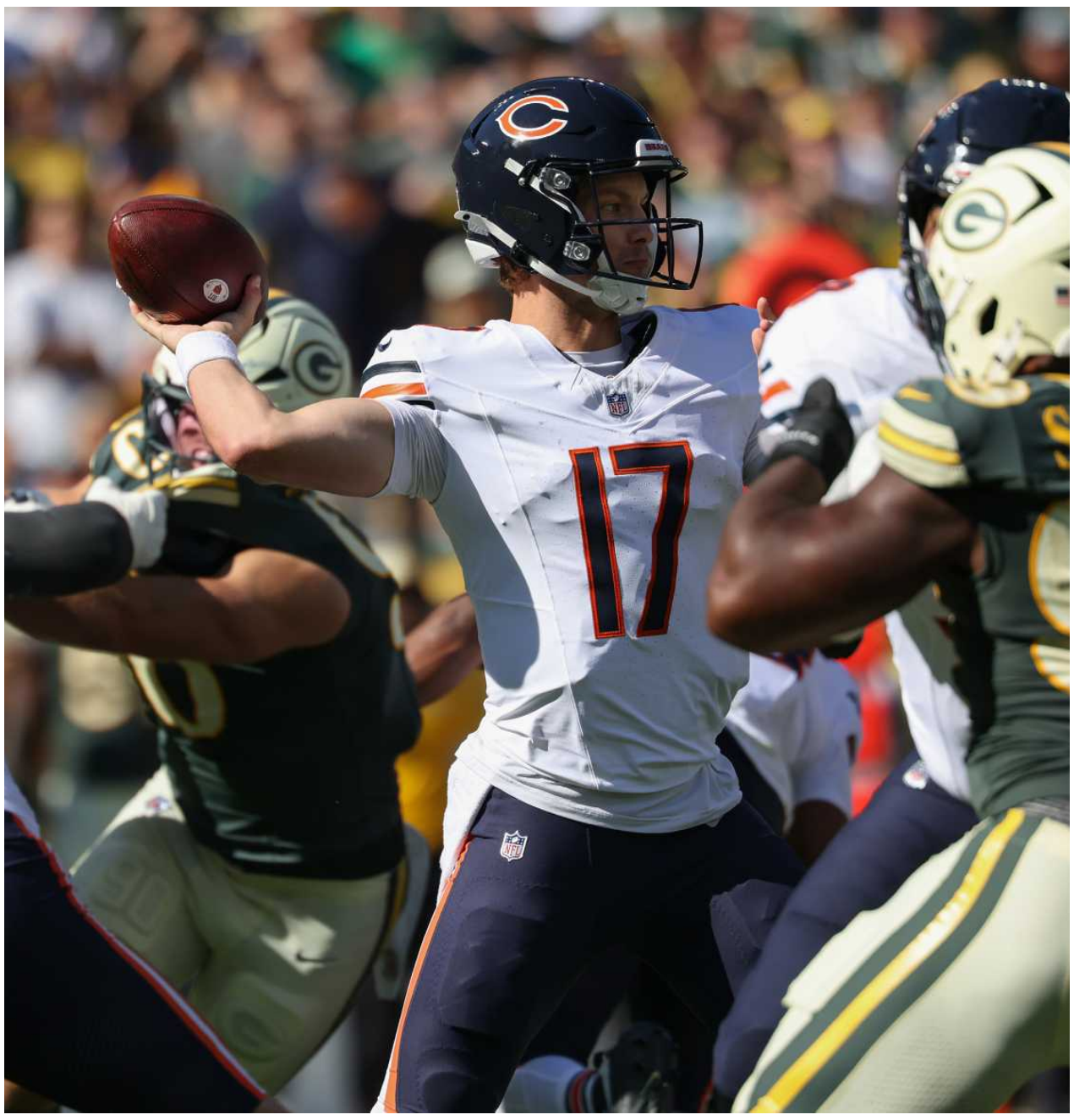
Based on Sweat's $20.9 million base salary this season, the suspension will cost him $2,223,529.

Sweat has two sacks, seven tackles and four quarterback hits this season but hasn't been the dominant force the Bears hoped to see.

Coach Ben Johnson repeatedly praised Sweat during the offseason and again in training camp, saying of the 2025 season, "I would argue it was the best year of his career." Sweat had 10 sacks and 18 QB hits last season, and the vibe was that Johnson was attempting to motivate the 30-year-old to reach another level this season.

That hasn't happened to this point, and now the Bears will have to play two games without Sweat while also facing the prospect of Odeyingbo needing some time to heal.

Sweat has one year remaining on his contract with an $18.9 million base salary, a $100,000 workout bonus and a $2 million roster bonus. A decision on his future will be due early in the offseason as the roster bonus is due on the fifth day of the league year. No guaranteed money remains in the contract.



Bears quarterback Tyson Bagent throws in the second quarter against the Packers on Sunday in Green Bay.
JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

PRESSING QUESTIONS

Who should get nod at QB if Williams can't go?

By Phil Thompson, Brad Biggs and Sean Hammond
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Bears endured a humbling 31-7 loss to the Green Bay Packers at Lambeau Field. What transpired in Week 5 has left them wrestling with questions on both offense and defense.

They'll want to find answers quickly before heading to Atlanta to face the Falcons on Sunday. Over the last three games, the emerging Falcons have put up 103 points to their opponents' 68.

One conundrum: Should Tyson Bagent or Case Keenum start at quarterback in Week 6 if Caleb Williams can't go? The Tribune's Brad Biggs, Sean Hammond and Phil Thompson tackle that and more in this week's pressing questions.

1. USE ONE WORD TO DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED SUNDAY IN GREEN BAY.

Biggs: Drubbing.

Hammond: Reality check. I know, I know, that's two words. I'm already off to a bad start following directions. There was something mythical about the previous two comebacks against the Packers. Sunday brought a reminder that not every game will be like that. Matt LaFleur has won 65% of his regular-season games over eight years for a reason. In retrospect, it should've been more obvious that the Packers would have a response, especially with the Bears playing a backup quarterback. They let their game do the talking.

Thompson: Ambush. Usually the Bears offense has defenses chasing their tails by giving them unscouted looks, but one Bears offensive lineman said the Packers sent some pressure against the run from places they weren't expecting. It's similar to what another lineman said about the Minnesota Vikings defense. Green Bay's early lead and effectiveness against the run made coach Ben Johnson have to lean on the pass. The Packers didn't exactly bring the heat (a Week 5-low 12.8% blitz rate), but they generated enough pressure to post nine quarterback hits, including four sacks. That's in part because the secondary's coverage was so tight, there were few places to throw — and some areas that were traps. Of the Packers' eight passes defensed, three were interceptions.

2. IF CALEB WILLIAMS ISN'T AVAILABLE, WHO SHOULD START AT QUARTERBACK IN WEEK 6 IN ATLANTA: TYSON BAGENT OR CASE KEENUM?

Biggs: Keenum. Based on how Bagent performed in Green Bay, there's not a compelling argument otherwise.

Hammond: I'll hark back to the old cliche that players and coaches like to use: It's a results-based business. Past results don't guarantee future success, but the on-field results sure seem to suggest Keenum gives the Bears a better chance to win. I do think starting Bagent the last two weeks was the right decision, but I also think it's OK to change course if Williams is unavailable this week.

Thompson: You don't want to be overly reactionary to one bad game, but under the circumstances it might be best to go with the seasoned veteran. Bagent was making some risky throws even during the win against the New York Jets, and he had dangerous passes against the Packers beyond the two interceptions. New coach Kevin Stefanski has lit a fire under the Falcons defense, and Keenum's quick game might be better suited to their pressure.

3. AFTER FIVE WEEKS, WHAT DO WE KNOW FOR CERTAIN ABOUT THE BEARS DEFENSE?

Biggs: The gap between the best the unit can show and the worst is wide. No question the defense looked better in games when the offense dominated time of possession. The Bears have allowed 68 points in two road games and 28 in three games at Soldier Field. It's a small sample size and the talent of the opposition varies. But the 2025 defense also had some serious home/road splits in the regular season:

- Points per game: 17.6/30.4
- Yards per carry: 4.6/5.3
- Yards per pass attempt: 6.7/8.3
- Passing touchdowns: 8/24
- Opponent passer rating: 77.1/105.6
- Sacks: 25/10

The Bears were 6-2 at home in 2025 and 5-4 on the road. If they continue allowing 30-plus points away from Soldier Field, it's going to be a challenge to be .500 on the road this season.

Hammond: Good passing attacks can exploit it. The Bears are 31st among 32 teams, allowing 8.3 yards per pass play. Some of their per-game defensive totals are somewhat misleading because of their league-leading time of possession. Week 1 at Carolina and Week 5 at Green Bay both looked bad for the Bears secondary. Weeks 2-4 were a different story, but the Vikings, Eagles and Jets are all in the bottom third of the league in passing yards.

Thompson: I don't have a single quibble with your arguments, Sean. But I'm going to pick on the run defense, because troubling signs have been there all season. The extra depth at defensive tackle and speedier additions such as linebacker Devin Bush and safety Dillon Thieneman were supposed to help in that area, but it's not showing up consistently. I can't recall a more uninspiring NFL backfield than the Packers' MarShawn Lloyd, Kaleb Johnson and Pierre Strong Jr., yet they made impactful runs when needed. Seven of Green Bay's 18 first downs and two of its four touchdowns came via the rush. Now here comes Bijan Robinson. Just like the Bears' offense starts with the run, so should their defense.

4. THE BEARS HAVE STARTED 0-2 IN THE NFC NORTH. WHAT'S YOUR LEVEL OF CONCERN?

Biggs: That's way down the list right now because the Bears don't play their next division game until Thanksgiving, before three straight NFC North matchups to end the season. Credit to the Vikings for their first 5-0 start since 2016. The division appears to be wide open. The other three teams are 3-2, and each one has at least one real flaw. The Bears need to get Williams back healthy, sort out some of the things that aren't clicking in their passing game and find a way not to surrender so many explosive plays to non-terrible offenses. They can worry about the division record later.

Hammond: Minimal. They don't need an outstanding division record to win the division, as last season proved. It usually helps, though. But this team clearly has a lot to clean up on the defensive side. That is cause for concern. The Bears need to focus on getting those issues fixed. It doesn't really matter who the next opponent is, division or not.

Thompson: Moderate concern but nowhere near panic level. The Bears were able to win the NFC North last year despite a 2-4 division record, but any football follower knows that's the exception, not the rule. More often than not, playoff teams have winning (or at least .500) records in their divisions.

5. WHO DO THE BEARS NEED MOST RIGHT NOW: KYLER GORDON, OZZY TRAPILO OR SOMEONE ELSE STEPPING UP?

Biggs: They need their highest-paid players on defense to perform to the level of their contracts. That means defensive end Montez Sweat, who had one quarterback hit and no tackles in Green Bay, and cornerback Jaylon Johnson, who has had a bumpy first five games, need to start performing like upper-level players at their positions. Counting on Gordon, who has missed 19 of the last 22 regular-season games, to be a fix-it guy isn't a bright idea. Maybe he steps up, but his lack of availability makes any sustained production the defense gets from him a bonus. Trapilo is recovering from a major knee injury.

Hammond: Gordon. The secondary could use the help, and it's a big deal that Gordon is an experienced veteran who knows the system. If he's fully healthy, that should be a boost for the entire secondary. He was a difference-maker in the playoffs in January. I'm less concerned about the offensive line. Ben Johnson can find solutions, whether it's Theo Benedet or Trapilo playing left tackle. Obviously, Williams remains the No. 1 most important injured player they need back.

Thompson: Gordon is certainly the answer on defense. On offense, one factor missing from last season is Colston Loveland. I'm all for "buying Luther Burden stock," but Ben Johnson's use of the tight end — Loveland in particular — confounded defenses in the second half of last season. And Loveland exploded in the playoffs. So far, his catch rate has dropped from 70.7% to 56.5% and his yards per reception from 12.3 to 8.5. It feels like he's bottled up.

Ask the Reporter
Brad Biggs

Who is to blame for Colston Loveland's dip in production? Is he not getting open, being asked to block too often, QB play not looking his way? *— jimothy98360*

There's not one person to point a finger at here. It's a layered discussion that would lead everyone, coaches included, to say the Bears need to create more opportunities for Loveland to produce in the offense.

He has 13 catches for 110 yards through five games, and based on how he was flourishing at the end of his rookie season, it was reasonable to believe those would be the kind of numbers he could amass in one big game.

Loveland has been targeted 23 times, which ranks fourth on the team, and he's running 28.4 routes per game, which is up from 23.8 in 2025. So it's not like his numbers are down because he's being asked to stay in and help in pass protection all the time.

Here are the two biggest factors in my mind:

1. Quarterback play has been bumpy. When you go through three starters in a five-game span, that's going to happen. Caleb Williams didn't look Loveland's way much either. Loveland had five targets, one catch and 3 yards in the first two games.

2. Kalif Raymond's addition to the offense has taken targets from Loveland, at least in the first three games. Raymond was getting a lot of action in the middle of the field, and that took away potential throws to tight ends.

Loveland's target share is 14.3%, and that's too low. Indianapolis Colts tight end Tyler Warren is at 21.7%, and Sam LaPorta is at 20.1% for the Detroit Lions. I wouldn't compare Loveland's target share with the Las Vegas Raiders' Brock Bowers (29.6%) or the Arizona Cardinals' Trey McBride (28.1%) because those guys are in offenses that don't have a lot of options on the outside.

The good news is boosting Loveland's target share to the range where Warren and LaPorta are wouldn't require a major correction. The Bears just need to go his way a little more, and that's a combination of maybe a couple more play calls where he's the primary read and the quarterback simply getting to him in the progression a little more. Sometimes that can be simply finding Loveland as a checkdown target after he leaks out.

The Bears didn't get the tight ends involved through the first five games last season. In talking to tight ends coach Jim Dray, there's nothing with Loveland's production (or lack of production) that's concerning from the player's standpoint. He's getting open but he can't throw the ball to himself.

For what it's worth, the Falcons have been in the middle of the pack this season in defending the position. Tight ends are averaging six receptions and 53.8 yards per game against them.

Does the Bears losing in the fashion that they did make it more or less likely for them to acquire another edge? *— @coachq312*

Fair question. I can't imagine they're going to consider the trade market and what additions might make sense for them in the vacuum of one performance. The pass rush wasn't what it needed to be, with the exception of a surge at the end of the first half when Austin Booker sacked Jordan Love twice to give him four for the season. The pass rush wasn't great, or at least consistent enough, through the first four games either.

There's a month to go until the trade deadline, and there will be plenty for general manager Ryan Poles to weigh. It's a little early to launch into deep talk about it. Through five weeks, 17 teams have a winning record, the Carolina Panthers are atop the NFC South at 2-2 and five teams are within a game of .500 at 2-3. That's 23 of the 32 teams. So how many teams will be motivated to sell, and how big will the group of buyers be? That will sort itself out over the next few weeks.

I'd add that I don't think a win in Green Bay would have created a situation where the Bears would have been more apt to be a buyer or sit tight at the deadline. It will require a big-picture look at needs, availability and cost and then weighing all of that with future goals.

Could Jaylon Johnson be a sneaky trade candidate this deadline even if the Bears are in contention? Looking for an extension, not playing up to his contract or pedigree and not a Ben Johnson/Dennis Allen acquired player? *— @soundtalksnfl*

There are a couple of flaws with this idea as I see it. I agree Johnson hasn't played up to his previous level of performance going back to 2022 through 2024. The other 31 teams are aware of that as well. They see the same thing on film, and the Bears wouldn't be able to hoodwink another team because the guy was a pretty darn good performer a couple of years back.

Trade Johnson and then who plays? Rookie Malik Muhammad II can't play more than one spot at a time, and he could be forced into action on the outside with Tyrique Stevenson (hamstring) injured. The Bears haven't even put undersized cornerback Clark Phillips III on the field for defense to this point. He has played 14 snaps on special teams.

I just don't see intriguing replacement options. You're looking at Phillips, Josh Blackwell or practice squad members Nick McCloud and Elijah Jones if you trade Johnson. I don't see the Bears playing Kyler Gordon on the outside either, unless there's an absolute emergency.

Bears tight end Colston Loveland walks off the field after a 31-7 loss to the Packers on Sunday at Lambeau Field in Green Bay. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The 76ers' Jaylen Brown, LeBron James, Joel Embiid, Tyrese Maxey, and VJ Edgecombe pose for photos on Sept. 28 in Camden, N.J.
CHRIS SZAGOLA/AP

NBA

Star-studded roster, like 76ers built, nothing new to James

Tim Reynolds
THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Big Threes have long been part of the NBA.

Bill Russell, Bob Cousy and Tom Heinsohn showed in Boston that having a superstar trio on the same team can work wonders. So, too, did Magic Johnson, Kareem Abdul-Jabbar and James Worthy with the Los Angeles Lakers.

Larry Bird, Kevin McHale and Robert Parish in their Celtics era. Michael Jordan, Scottie Pippen and Dennis Rodman in Chicago. Tim Duncan, Tony Parker and Manu Ginobili in San Antonio. Stephen Curry, Klay Thompson and Kevin Durant with Golden State. There have been plenty of others.

And in Miami, there was Dwyane Wade, Chris Bosh and LeBron James.

They spent four years together with the Heat, went to four NBA Finals, won two championships and were the biggest thing in basketball. Many thought it would be easy. It wasn't. Miami started 9-8 in the trio's first season together, and the road was rocky for much longer than anyone imagined.

"It's a wild ride," Bosh said.

James, as he now gets set to be part of another Big Three — a Big Four, really, alongside fellow superstars Joel Embiid, Tyrese Maxey and Jaylen Brown on the now star-studded Philadelphia 76ers — remembers those early Miami days well. Perhaps that's why he sounded the alarm about what the next few months could be like for these 76ers.

"Everyone wants instant oatmeal," James said. "You just put the oatmeal in the bowl, you put some water and then throw it in the microwave. In a minute and a half, you've got something to eat, you're ready to go.

"If you want to do something special, it takes time. ... In order for us to be great, we have to do things that are just not comfortable."

Translation: Get ready, 76ers.

Such is Big Three or Big Four life.

"You really have to stay solid within the team," said Bosh, who might have sacrificed more stats than anyone during that four-year run in Miami. "At the end of the day, the main stat was the 'W' and putting one in the 'W' column. You can average a bunch of points and be out of the league. You can average a bunch of points and not be competing for a championship. They're going to have to remember the priority.

"And when tough times come — not if, but when — handle it and talk about it, communicate and remember why you're there."

STATS WILL BE SACRIFICED

Statistical sacrifices will have to be made if the 76ers are going to get to where they want to go this season and win the title that has eluded Philly since 1983.

Even with Embiid missing more than half of the 2025-26 season, he topped the 1,000-point mark — as did James (with the Lakers), Brown (with the Celtics), Maxey and the 76ers' star-in-waiting, VJ Edgecombe. There hasn't been a championship team with five 1,000-point scorers on the roster since the 1978-79 Seattle SuperSonics.

Combined, James, Maxey, Embiid, Edgecombe and Brown took 234 shots last season in clutch situations — game margin within five points, five minutes or less on the clock in the fourth quarter. That simply won't happen this season, as most teams don't combine for that many shots in clutch time over a whole season. There will be moments when Philly's star players are used to having the ball in their hands — but now will see teammates in those roles at times.

It's a fine line. The Warriors won a title in 2017 with Curry, Thompson, Durant and Draymond Green all needing to adjust their roles, at least on some level. But as Curry pointed out when that title series was over, that didn't mean any of them could suddenly become passive.

"We all needed to be aggressive and be the players that we are in what we bring to the table every single night," Curry said after that series — against James and the Cleveland Cavaliers. "We can all show up every night and be ourselves and really achieve the potential that we all have together."

ROLES WILL CHANGE AT TIMES

James set the tone for this 76ers team over the summer when he took a pay cut of roughly 92% from last season and agreed to play this season for the bargain price of $3.9 million. He doesn't need more money. The lure of becoming the first player in NBA history to win a championship with four franchises seems to be enough motivation.

And, in fairness, it's also easy for the player who holds the NBA scoring record to say that stats don't matter. Officially, he took only one shot from the field in his preseason debut with the 76ers; he also drew enough fouls to get eight more shots from the line. (He made them all, for what it's worth.)

Nobody knows what'll happen this season, but it seems highly unlikely that James will clamor for more shots. That never has been his style. It would be ideal if everyone in Philly felt the same way.

"My focus is winning," Brown said over the summer. "Other people's focus may be scoring. My focus going into every practice, every meeting, every shootaround, every film session is like, 'How do we win, night in and night out?' Sometimes that may change, sometimes it may look different, but whatever it takes."

It's reasonable to think that Maxey, Embiid, Brown and James all could see their scoring averages drop this season for the greater good. There will be nights when the spotlight won't be on certain individuals. There will be nights when someone gets a ton of shots and someone gets very few. The most successful Big Threes all figured out how to handle such things.

The 76ers will have to do the same.

"We've got the talent. Whatever," Maxey said. "If we're not willing to sacrifice, if we're not willing to put in the work, it ain't going to mean nothing."

BULLS

from Page C1

Collins behind him as a backup. But behind those obvious roles waits a cluttered lineup of smaller backup options, including Awaka, Jalen Smith, Noa Essengue, Leonard Miller and Patrick Williams.

The Bulls similarly have to balance their desire to develop their first- and second-year players with a real need to play more experienced veterans like Isaac Okoro, Buddy Hield and Tre Jones. Younger players like Dailyn Swain are expected to earn minutes in the G League and with the first team — which allows Splitter to manage his rotations based on availability — but striking the right balance is still a challenge.

Miller, for instance, has put pressure on the end of the bench through a strong preseason showing. Splitter values the way the forward can move easily from the 4 to the 5, creating versatility within an already switch-heavy lineup. The Bulls could even play small ball rotations that feature Miller alongside a pair of forwards like Buzelis and Wilson, providing a lengthy, layered challenge on the perimeter for opposing defenses.

"Even the last game, we kind of played him small ball five," Wilson said. "That would be elite in our lineup. With our length and our versatility, I feel like that's definitely a possibility for us."

This depth is a needed strength for the Bulls, who must approach this season with maximum flexibility. The Bulls are not in a position to hone in on a short nine-player rotation. Splitter needs to get a good look at a wide variety of talent, both to develop their skills and to assess their role in future iterations of the Bulls. And if players like Powell or Hield perform to expectations this season, they could be on the move at the February trade deadline — which will open up space for even more players in that rotation.

Roster flexibility is crucial in a rebuild. As the roster currently stands, the Bulls don't have true centerpiece stars. The hope is that Wilson or Buzelis (or, ideally, both) will grow into that role over the next few years. But in the meantime, the only way for Splitter to appropriately manage this team's growth is through a deep roster that can adjust to challenges throughout the length of the season.

"There is a lot of different combinations that we can use," Splitter said. "We are still learning these guys. We're still trying to see what's the best combination of players and schemes for them."

Bulls forward Leonard Miller pulls in a rebound in the second half of a preseason game Sunday in Denver.
DAVID ZALUBOWSKI/AP

BOYS BASKETBALL

Benet senior Stasys commits to Yale, joining his sister

By Matt Le Cren
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Benet's Edvardas Stasys, center, celebrates after hitting a 3-pointer against DePaul Prep during a Class 4A state semifinal at the State Farm Center in Champaign on March 13. BRIAN HILL/DAILY HERALD

When Benet basketball star Edvardas Stasys began taking his official recruiting visits in early September, Yale was his first stop.

The 6-foot-8 senior forward immediately felt at home, and he committed to the Bulldogs on Wednesday.

"Yale was always up there," Edvardas Stasys said. "When I went on my visit, it really felt like I bonded with the guys.

"The campus is beautiful. The people there are amazing. It is definitely a place where I feel I could prosper and succeed."

The Bulldogs had one advantage over Edvardas Stasys' other suitors, including Illinois. His older sister, Gabriele Stasys, is a sophomore on the women's volleyball team at Yale.

"I've talked to her about how the school is," Stasys said. "She just absolutely loves it there. Even over the summer, she wanted to go back there because she really loves the community, the environment.

"My parents go over there fairly often to watch her play. I've gone over there a couple times to watch her games."

The Stasys siblings have played in a combined five state finals for Benet. Gabriele Stasys, a 6-0 middle, helped the girls volleyball team finish second in Class 4A three times, and Edvardas Stasys has played in the past two Class 4A state championship games, helping the Redwings win their first state title in boys basketball in 2025.

They will be reunited at the same Ivy League school.

"It's kind of crazy," Gabriele Stasys said. "I was excited about it because I feel Yale is a very special place, and he got to see that when he came here.

"Yale is a very tight-knit community, kind of like Benet. We're really close with the basketball team too. You don't really get that in many places."

It's rare to see two siblings compete in different sports at the same Division I school. Many athletes say they want to be at a school that feels like home, and that will literally be true for Edvardas and Gabriele Stasys.

"Yale is like one big family, so now an actual family member will be here," Gabriele Stasys said. "So really not much will change, but it will be really fun."

Benet coach Gene Heidkamp was impressed with how Edvardas Stasys dealt with the stress of recruiting.

"I'm happy for him," Heidkamp said. "I know it was a long process for him, and he was very thorough in his process. Obviously, the education speaks for itself, but he was very impressed with their basketball program."

That was the decisive piece for Edvardas Stasys.

"Academics are an important part for me, but it's not the only part," he said. "I'm biased now, but their basketball is, I'd say, at the top of the Ivy League.

"I also thought Yale is the school where I'll have the best chance of making the tournament, so hopefully we'll be able to make it there together and focus on getting as far as possible."

Edvardas Stasys aspires to play in the NBA, as well, and there's precedent for that. Naperville resident John Poulakidas, who starred at Neuqua Valley, played for Yale and made his NBA debut last season for the Dallas Mavericks.

"I definitely have watched him play," Edvardas Stasys said. "He actually texted me during my recruitment just to talk a little bit. I had some questions for him, and he also helped guide me a little bit."

Poulakidas improved tremendously during his four-year career at Yale. Like him, Edvardas Stasys is known for his work ethic.

"He works so, so hard," Gabriele Stasys said. "I remember coming back home last year and coming to a high school game, and I was like, 'Wow.' I barely recognized him. He was so strong, so fit. He trains so hard."

That's true even outside of high school and travel basketball.

"At home, we have a shooting machine," Gabriele Stasys said. "He will set it up in the morning and go shoot. He'll go to Acceleration.

"It's no days off for him, and it has definitely shown. He's improved so much. Basketball is such a tough sport because the competition is crazy and it is so good, so the fact that he's pushing himself and competing at this high level is just really impressive."

Edvardas Stasys is impressed with Yale.

"Yale is a great place to go," he said. "If you want to keep pursuing basketball after it, that's 100% possible. You can go as far as the NBA. It's the best of both worlds."

Matt Le Cren is a freelance reporter.

SCOREBOARD

NHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

ATLANTIC DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Ottawa	7	5	2	0	10	21	19
Tampa Bay	6	4	2	0	8	17	16
Boston	6	4	2	0	8	20	13
Florida	7	3	2	2	8	19	20
Montreal	6	3	2	1	7	19	22
Toronto	6	3	2	1	7	20	18
Buffalo	7	3	3	1	7	19	26
Detroit	6	1	3	2	4	14	20

METROPOLITAN DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Carolina	8	6	1	1	13	31	19
N.Y. Rangers	8	6	2	0	12	27	14
Pittsburgh	6	3	2	1	7	22	17
Washington	6	3	3	0	6	19	18
New Jersey	6	3	3	0	6	16	22
Columbus	5	2	3	0	4	16	21
N.Y. Islanders	5	2	3	0	4	16	13
Philadelphia	8	0	5	3	3	10	31

WESTERN CONFERENCE

CENTRAL DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Minnesota	6	4	1	1	9	19	11
Utah	6	4	2	0	8	22	15
Winnipeg	5	3	1	1	7	13	15
St. Louis	6	3	2	1	7	21	18
Colorado	5	3	2	0	6	26	17
Nashville	5	2	1	2	6	14	14
Dallas	5	2	2	1	5	11	8
Chicago	6	1	5	0	2	12	26

PACIFIC DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Seattle	7	5	2	0	10	29	19
Vegas	7	5	2	0	10	25	18
Edmonton	5	4	0	1	9	25	17
Anaheim	5	4	1	0	8	18	13
San Jose	5	3	2	0	6	13	17
Vancouver	7	2	5	0	4	24	35
Los Angeles	4	0	2	2	2	10	17
Calgary	5	0	5	0	0	8	27

Tuesday's results
New Jersey 5, Detroit 4 (OT)
Florida 7, Columbus 3
Montreal 4, Buffalo 3 (SO)
Carolina 4, Washington 2
Seattle 3, Philadelphia 2 (SO)
N.Y. Rangers 4, Tampa Bay 1
St. Louis 7, Ottawa 2
Vancouver at N.Y. Islanders, late
Pittsburgh at Chicago, late
Minnesota at Winnipeg, late
Colorado at Dallas, late
Vegas at Nashville, late
Toronto at Utah, late
Calgary at Anaheim, late
Edmonton at Los Angeles, late
Boston at San Jose, late

Wednesday's games
Montreal at Washington, 6:30 p.m.
Dallas at Colorado, 7:30 p.m.

Monday's results
Buffalo 5, Florida 3
Ottawa 4, New Jersey 1
Minnesota 4, Vegas 2

Soccer

MLS

Eastern	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Nashville	19	3	6	63	59	22
Miami	13	5	10	49	68	50
Chicago	14	8	6	48	51	40
N. England	14	10	4	46	45	39
Charlotte	13	8	7	46	50	40
Philadelphia	12	10	6	42	56	45
Orlando	11	13	4	37	51	66
NY Red Bulls	10	12	6	36	38	52
Cincinnati	9	9	9	36	58	65
NYCFC	8	11	9	33	42	38
Toronto	7	10	11	32	41	52
D.C. United	6	9	12	30	34	46
Columbus	8	15	5	29	41	46
Atlanta	7	15	6	27	33	48
Montréal	6	16	6	24	35	56
Western	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pts**	**GF**	**GA**
Vancouver	15	7	6	51	61	30
St Louis City	14	6	8	50	54	38
Dallas	13	7	8	47	52	45
San Jose	13	8	7	46	50	40
Houston	13	9	6	45	36	34
LA	11	9	9	42	44	31
Seattle	11	9	8	41	38	35
Colorado	11	13	4	37	39	39
LA Galaxy	9	11	9	36	39	50
Portland	9	13	6	33	51	54
Salt Lake	9	14	5	32	41	46
San Diego	8	12	8	32	48	51
Austin	7	11	10	31	36	51
Minnesota	7	12	9	30	42	51
Kansas City	6	18	4	22	35	68

Three points for win, one point for tie.

Wednesday's matches
New England at Cincinnati, 6:30 p.m.
Charlotte FC at Columbus, 6:30 p.m.
N.Y. Red Bulls at D.C. United, 6:30 p.m.
New York City FC at Miami, 6:30 p.m.
Atlanta at CF Montréal, 6:30 p.m.
Orlando City at Toronto FC, 6:30 p.m.
Philadelphia at Chicago, 7:30 p.m.
Seattle at FC Dallas, 7:30 p.m.
Sporting KC at Nashville, 7:30 p.m.
Vancouver at St Louis City, 7:30 p.m.
Minnesota at Colorado, 8:30 p.m.
San Jose at Real Salt Lake, 8:30 p.m.
Portland at LA Galaxy, 9:30 p.m.
Austin FC at Los Angeles FC, 9:30 p.m.
Houston at San Diego FC, 9:30 p.m.

NWSL

Club	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Gotham	16	4	7	55	35	21
San Diego	16	8	3	51	40	28
Washington	15	8	4	49	39	26
Utah	14	9	4	46	44	35
Kansas City	13	9	5	44	48	38
Angel City	12	8	7	43	45	29
Portland	12	8	7	43	45	39
N. Carolina	13	11	3	42	50	39
Seattle	12	11	4	40	33	32
Denver	10	9	8	38	45	37
Orlando	10	14	3	33	36	43
Houston	8	13	6	30	34	39
Boston	8	14	5	29	36	46
Bay	7	15	5	26	28	42
Louisville	7	17	3	24	36	52
Chicago	5	20	2	17	15	63

Three points for win, one point for tie.

FRIDAY'S MATCH
Louisville at Boston Legacy FC, 7 p.m.

SATURDAY'S MATCHES
Gotham FC at Washington, 11:30 a.m.
Kansas City at Utah Royals FC, 5:30 p.m.
San Diego at North Carolina, 6 p.m.
Angel City at Denver FC, 7:45 p.m.

ENGLISH PREMIER LEAGUE

Club	GP	W	D	L	GF	GA	Pts
Man City	6	6	0	0	16	5	18
Arsenal	6	5	0	1	10	5	15
Brighton	6	4	1	1	18	5	13
Brentford	6	2	4	0	12	6	10
Everton	6	2	4	0	8	5	10
Chelsea	6	3	1	2	15	13	10
Leeds	6	2	3	1	8	5	9
Hull	6	2	3	1	8	6	9
Liverpool	6	2	3	1	7	7	9
Ipswich	6	3	0	3	9	12	9
Newcastle	6	2	2	2	10	13	8
Crystal Palace	6	2	1	3	9	12	7
Man United	6	1	3	2	9	9	6
Coventry	6	2	0	4	5	11	6
Notting. Forest	6	1	2	3	5	8	5
Aston Villa	6	1	2	3	6	11	5
Sunderland	6	1	1	4	6	12	4
Bournemouth	6	0	3	3	7	13	3
Tottenham	6	0	3	3	3	9	3
Fulham	6	0	2	4	6	10	2

SATURDAY'S MATCHES
Everton vs. Chelsea, 6:30 a.m.
Brentford vs. Liverpool, 9 a.m.
Fulham vs. Hull, 9 a.m.
Man City vs. Ipswich, 9 a.m.
Newcastle vs. Aston Villa, 11:30 a.m.

SUNDAY'S MATCHES
Bournemouth vs. Sunderland, 8 a.m.
Brighton vs. Crystal Palace, 8 a.m.
Leeds vs. Man United, 8 a.m.
Notting. Forest vs. Arsenal, 10:30 a.m.

U.S. WOMEN'S SCHEDULE

Tuesday: U.S. 2, Spain 2
Friday, Nov. 27: vs. El Salvador, 7:30 p.m.

WNBA Playoffs

WNBA FINALS

*(Best-of-7; *-if necessary)*
#2 GOLDEN STATE vs. #4 ATLANTA
Saturday: Game 1 at Golden State, 2:30 p.m.
Monday: at Golden State, 7 p.m.
Wednesday, Oct. 21: at Atlanta, 7 p.m.
Saturday, Oct. 24: at Atlanta, noon
x-Mon., Oct. 26: at Golden State, 7 p.m.
x-Thursday, Oct. 29: at Atlanta, 7 p.m.
x-Sat., Oct. 31: at Golden State, 7 p.m.

KIM PERROT SPORTSMANSHIP AWARD

2026 VOTING	(Team)	Votes
Nneka Ogwumike	**(Los Angeles)**	**38**
Rebecca Allen	(New York)	7
Kelsey Mitchell	(Indiana)	6
Veronica Burton	(Golden State)	4
Michaela Onyenwere	(Washington)	4
Alysha Clark	(Dallas)	3
Maya Caldwell	(Minnesota)	2
Natisha Hiedeman	(Seattle)	2
Karlie Samuelson	(Portland)	2
Brittney Sykes	(Toronto)	2
Elizabeth Williams	(Chicago)	2
Naz Hillmon	(Atlanta)	1
Charlisse Leger-Walker	(Connecticut)	1

NBA

EXHIBITION SCHEDULE

TUESDAY'S RESULTS
Orlando 132, Cleveland 116
Toronto 148, New York 98
Indiana at Oklahoma City, late
Golden State vs. L.A. Lakers, late
Portland at Sacramento, late

MONDAY'S RESULTS
Portland 119, London 66
Atlanta 113, Oklahoma City 110
Brooklyn 131, Washington 122
Minnesota 122, New York 104
Utah 119, San Antonio 109

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES
Brooklyn at Miami, 6:30 p.m.
Charlotte at Boston, 6:30 p.m.
Chicago at Milwaukee, 7 p.m.
Detroit at Minnesota, 7 p.m.
New Orleans at Dallas, 7 p.m.
Phoenix at San Antonio, 7 p.m.
Denver at L.A. Clippers, 9:30 p.m.

NFL

AMERICAN CONFERENCE

East	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA
Buffalo	4	1	0	.800	164	141
New England	3	2	0	.600	110	94
N.Y. Jets	2	3	0	.400	93	96
Miami	0	5	0	.000	70	132
South	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pct**	**PF**	**PA**
Jacksonville	4	1	0	.800	123	70
Indianapolis	2	3	0	.400	124	138
Houston	1	4	0	.200	110	112
Tennessee	0	5	0	.000	58	109
North	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pct**	**PF**	**PA**
Baltimore	4	1	0	.800	146	119
Cleveland	3	2	0	.600	93	112
Pittsburgh	3	2	0	.600	111	109
Cincinnati	3	2	0	.600	128	109
West	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pct**	**PF**	**PA**
Kansas City	4	0	0	100	118	77
Denver	3	2	0	.600	97	111
Las Vegas	3	2	0	.600	132	129
L.A. Chargers	0	5	0	.000	84	129

NATIONAL CONFERENCE

East	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA
N.Y. Giants	3	1	1	.700	109	106
Philadelphia	2	3	0	.400	92	112
Dallas	2	3	0	.400	138	136
Washington	1	3	1	.300	115	149
South	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pct**	**PF**	**PA**
Carolina	2	2	0	.500	121	109
Atlanta	2	3	0	.400	119	122
Tampa Bay	1	4	0	.200	100	112
New Orleans	1	4	0	.200	118	151
North	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pct**	**PF**	**PA**
Minnesota	5	0	0	100	109	64
Green Bay	3	2	0	.600	104	112
Detroit	3	2	0	.600	164	148
Chicago	3	2	0	.600	119	96
West	**W**	**L**	**T**	**Pct**	**PF**	**PA**
San Francisco	5	0	0	100	154	93
Seattle	3	2	0	.600	134	105
L.A. Rams	2	3	0	.400	119	120
Arizona	1	4	0	.200	108	162

WEEK 6

THURSDAY'S GAME
Seattle at Denver, 7:15 p.m.

SUNDAY'S GAMES
Houston vs Jacksonville in London, UK, 8:30 a.m.
Baltimore at Cleveland, noon
Carolina at Philadelphia, noon
Chicago at Atlanta, noon
N.Y. Jets at New England, noon
New Orleans at N.Y. Giants, noon
Pittsburgh at Tampa Bay, noon
Tennessee at Indianapolis, noon
Arizona at L.A. Rams, 3:05 p.m.
Buffalo at Las Vegas, 3:25 p.m.
L.A. Chargers at Kansas City, 3:25 p.m.
Dallas at Green Bay, 7:20 p.m.

MONDAY'S GAME
Washington at San Francisco, 7:15 p.m.
Off: Cincinnati, Miami, Detroit, Minnesota

Late Monday: Bills 37, Rams 34, OT

Buffalo	**6**	**7**	**6**	**15**	**—37**
L.A. Rams	**0**	**7**	**7**	**20**	**—34**

First quarter
BUF — FG Bass 49, 13:23.
BUF — FG Bass 23, :10.

Second quarter
LAR — Adams 4 pass from Stafford (Mevis kick), 8:00.
BUF — Cook 17 run (Bass kick), 5:09.

Third quarter
LAR — Corum 1 run (Mevis kick), 10:11.
BUF — Coleman 7 pass from J.Allen (kick failed), 2:45.

Fourth quarter
LAR — Nacua 2 pass from Stafford (pass failed), 14:16.
BUF — J.Allen 1 run (Kincaid pass from J.Allen), 11:28.
LAR — Adams 5 pass from Stafford (Mevis kick), 7:14.
BUF — Cook 5 run (Bass kick), 1:39.
LAR — K.Williams 1 run (Mevis kick), :05.

Overtime
BUF — FG Bass 45, 1:55.

Category	BUF	LAR
First downs	25	33
Third down eff	2-7	7-14
Fourth down eff	0-0	2-2
Total net yards	436	454
Total plays	57	78
Avg gain	7.6	5.8
Rushes-yards	37-234	23-77
Passing	202	377
Punt returns	1-14	0-0
Kickoff returns	7-219	7-194
Interceptions ret	0-0	1-3
Comp-att-int	12-19-1	40-54-0
Sacked-Yards Lost	1-8	1-6
Punts	1-52.0	2-46.5
Fumbles-lost	2-1	0-0
Penalties-yards	13-112	11-84
Time of poss	30:08	37:57

INDIVIDUAL STATS

Rushing — Buffalo, J.Allen 10-121, Cook 25-111, Davis 2-2. L.A. Rams, Williams 16-49, Corum 5-19, Nacua 2-9.

Passing — Buffalo, J.Allen 12-19-1-210. L.A. Rams, Stafford 40-54-0-383.

Receiving — Buffalo, T.Johnson 4-72, Shakir 3-80, Davis 1-31, Coleman 1-7, Cook 1-7, Kincaid 1-7, Knox 1-6. L.A. Rams, Nacua 17-138, Williams 6-27, Higbee 5-83, Adams 5-51, Corum 3-53, Allen 2-24, Atwell 1-4, Parkinson 1-3.

Punt returns — Buffalo, Dortch 1-14. L.A. Rams, None.

Kickoff returns — Buffalo, Davis 3-114, Dortch 4-105. L.A. Rams, Whittington 5-139, Bachman 2-55.

Interceptions — Buffalo, None. L.A. Rams, Watson 1-3.

Missed field goals — L.A. Rams, Mevis 50, Mevis 48.

MLB Playoffs

TODAY'S PITCHERS

NL Championship Series

Pitchers	Time	W-L	ERA	Rec	2025 vs Opp W-L	2025 vs Opp IP	2025 vs Opp ERA	Last 3 starts W-L	Last 3 starts IP	Last 3 starts ERA
Mil Gasser (L)		0-0	2.25	1-0	0-2	10.2	5.91	1-0	17.0	1.06
LAD Snell (L)	7p	0-0	2.46	0-1	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	8.2	2.08

TEAM REC: Team's record in games started by today's pitcher.
VS OPP: Pitcher's record versus this opponent.

LEAGUE CHAMPIONSHIP SERIES

(Best-of-7; x-if necessary)

AMERICAN LEAGUE

CLEVELAND 1, TAMPA BAY 0
Mon., Oct. 12: at Game 1, Cleveland 7-3.
Tuesday: at Tampa Bay late
Thursday: at Cleveland, 5 p.m.
Friday: at Cleveland, 5 p.m.
x-Saturday: at Cleveland, 7 p.m.
x-Monday: at Tampa Bay, 4 p.m.
x-Tue., Oct. 20: at Tampa Bay, 7 p.m.

NATIONAL LEAGUE

MILWAUKEE 2, L.A. DODGERS 0
Sun., Oct. 11: Game 1 at Milwaukee 2-1.
Mon., Oct. 12: Game 2 at Milwaukee 7-4.
Wednesday: Game 3 at Los Angeles, 7 p.m.
Thuursday: Game 4 at Los Angeles, 8 p.m.
x-Friday: Game 5 at Los Angeles, 8 p.m.
x-Sunday: Game 6 at Milwaukee, 7 p.m.

Late Monday: Guardians 7, Rays 3

Cleveland	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Kwan lf-cf	5	0	1	0	0	1	.200
Ramírez 3b	5	2	3	1	0	1	.600
DeLauter rf	4	3	3	1	1	0	.750
Adell dh	5	0	1	2	0	1	.200
Lowe 1b	5	0	2	2	0	0	.400
Bazzana 2b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.250
Genao 2b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Bailey c	4	1	2	1	0	2	.500
Halpin cf	2	0	0	0	0	1	.000
a-Martínez ph-lf	2	1	1	0	0	1	.500
Rocchio ss	4	0	0	0	0	3	.000
Totals	**40**	**7**	**14**	**7**	**1**	**10**	
Tampa Bay	**AB**	**R**	**H**	**BI**	**BB**	**SO**	**Avg**
Díaz dh	5	1	2	0	0	1	.400
Aranda 1b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Caminero 3b	4	1	1	1	0	2	.250
Vilade lf	2	0	0	0	1	1	.000
1-Mullins pr-cf	1	1	1	1	0	0	1.000
Mesa rf	4	0	1	0	0	2	.250
DeLuca cf-lf	4	0	2	1	0	0	.500
Williamson 2b	2	0	0	0	1	0	.000
Walls ss	3	0	0	0	0	1	.000
c-Simpson ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Fortes c	2	0	0	0	0	0	.000
b-Hicks ph-c	2	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Totals	**33**	**3**	**7**	**3**	**2**	**8**	

CLE	**000**	**001**	**123**	**—**	**7**	**14**	**0**
TB	**200**	**000**	**010**	**—**	**3**	**7**	**0**

a-SO, Halpin in the 7th. b-lined out for Fortes in the 7th. c-GO, Walls in the 9th. 1-ran for Vilade in the 6th.

LOB: Cleveland 7, Tampa Bay 7; **2B:** DeLauter (1), Adell (1), Díaz (1); **HR:** DeLauter (1), off Rasmussen. Bailey (1), off Rasmussen. Mullins (1), off Sabrowski; **RBI:** DeLauter (1), Bailey (1), Lowe 2 (2), Ramírez (1), Adell 2 (2), Caminero (1), DeLuca (1), Mullins (1); **SB:** DeLuca (1), Bazzana (1), Mullins (1); **CS:** Ramírez (1); **S:** Aranda.

Runners left in scoring position: Cleveland 4 (Lowe, Adell, Halpin, Rocchio). Tampa Bay 3 (Walls 3); **RISP:** Cleveland 3 for 12. Tampa Bay 2 for 4.

Runners moved up: DeLauter.

Cleveland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Griffin	4	5	2	2	0	3	63	4.50
Espino	1	0	0	0	0	3	14	0.00
Cantillo	1	0	0	0	2	0	17	0.00
Gaddis	1	1	0	0	0	1	13	0.00
Sabrowski	1	1	1	1	0	1	14	9.00
Smith	1	0	0	0	0	0	6	0.00
Tampa Bay	**IP**	**H**	**R**	**ER**	**BB**	**SO**	**NP**	**ERA**
Rasmussen	6	8	2	2	0	7	91	3.00
Booser	1	0	0	0	0	1	8	0.00
Wells	⅓	2	2	2	0	0	6	54.00
Seymour	⅔	1	0	0	0	1	9	0.00
Sulser	⅔	2	3	3	1	1	27	40.50
Kelly	⅓	1	0	0	0	0	5	0.00

W: Gaddis 1-0; **L:** Wells 0-1.

Inherited runners-scored: Seymour 2-2, Kelly 2-2; **HBP:** Griffin (Williamson); **WP:** Sulser.

ABS Challenge: Seymour (Ball-Overturned to Strike), Sabrowski (Ball-Confirmed), Kwan (Strike-Overturned to Ball).

Umpires: Home, Nestor Ceja. First, Bill Miller. Second, Mark Ripperger. Third, Jordan Baker. Right, Adam Hamari. Left, Chad Fairchild.

T: 2:57; **A:** 35,361 (25,025).

Late Monday: Brewers 7, Dodgers 4

Los Angeles	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Betts ss	3	1	1	0	1	1	.250
Freeman 1b	3	0	0	1	0	1	.250
T.Hernández lf	3	0	0	1	0	1	.500
Ohtani dh	4	0	0	0	0	2	.333
Smith c	4	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Muncy 3b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.250
a-Rojas ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Pages cf	2	0	0	0	1	1	.250
Tucker rf	3	1	1	0	0	0	.000
Edman 2b	2	2	1	0	0	0	.000
Totals	**28**	**4**	**3**	**2**	**2**	**9**	
Milwaukee	**AB**	**R**	**H**	**BI**	**BB**	**SO**	**Avg**
Chourio lf	5	0	0	0	0	2	.222
Turang 2b	3	3	2	1	2	1	.600
Contreras c	4	1	3	3	1	0	.429
Bauers 1b	4	0	1	1	1	2	.286
Yelich dh	5	0	2	2	0	1	.400
Mitchell cf	4	0	0	0	1	3	.000
Pratt ss	4	0	2	0	0	0	.333
Frelick rf	3	0	0	0	1	1	.000
Hamilton 3b	3	3	2	0	0	0	.667
Totals	**35**	**7**	**12**	**7**	**6**	**10**	

LAD	**101**	**020**	**000**	**—**	**4**	**3**	**2**
MIL	**102**	**011**	**02x**	**—**	**7**	**12**	**2**

a-struck out for Muncy in the 9th.

E: Freeman (0), Pages (0), Henderson 2 (2); **LOB:** Los Angeles 2, Milwaukee 11; **2B:** Tucker (1), Turang (1); **HR:** Contreras (1), off Bubic; **RBI:** T.Hernández (0), Freeman (0), Contreras 3 (3), Yelich 2 (2), Turang (2), Bauers (1); **SB:** Hamilton 2 (2); **CS:** Pratt (1); **SF:** T.Hernández, Freeman; **S:** Edman.

Runners left in scoring position: Los Angeles 1 (Ohtani). Milwaukee 5 (Mitchell 2, Yelich, Frelick 2); **RISP:** Los Angeles 0 for 4. Milwaukee 6 for 15. Runners moved up: Freeman 2, Betts, Chourio 2.

Los Angeles	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Yamamoto	2⅔	4	3	3	2	1	75	10.12
Vesia	⅓	0	0	0	0	1	4	0.00
Sasaki	1	0	0	0	1	1	14	0.00
Bubic	⅔	2	1	1	1	2	22	13.50
Stewart	⅔	2	1	1	1	1	12	13.50
Scott	1	0	0	0	0	3	13	0.00
Henriquez	1	3	2	2	1	0	21	18.00
Wrobleski	⅔	1	0	0	0	1	11	0.00
Milwaukee	**IP**	**H**	**R**	**ER**	**BB**	**SO**	**NP**	**ERA**
Henderson	4	3	4	2	2	2	64	4.50
May	1	0	0	0	0	1	14	0.00
Romero	1	0	0	0	0	2	13	0.00
Uribe	1⅓	0	0	0	0	2	13	0.00
Ashby	1⅔	0	0	0	0	2	21	0.00

W: Romero 1-0; **L:** Stewart 0-1; **SV:** Ashby 1-1

Inherited runners-scored: Vesia 2-0, Stewart 2-0, Scott 2-0, Wrobleski 2-1, May 1-1; **IBB:** off Stewart (Turang); **HBP:** Stewart (Hamilton); **WP:** Henderson.

ABS Challenge: Henderson (Ball-Overturned to Strike), Henderson (Ball-Overturned to Strike), May (Ball-Confirmed), Tucker (Strike-Overturned to Ball).

Pitch timer violations: Stewart (pitcher).

Umpires: HP, Chris Segal. 1B, Ryan Additon. 2B, Alan Porter. 3B, David Rackley. RF, Edwin Moscoso. LF, John Tumpane.

T: 3:21; **A:** 42,516 (41,700).

Odds

MLB Playoffs		Wednesday
Favorite	**Line**	**Underdog**
NL Championship Series		
at LA Dodgers	-180/+147	Milwaukee
NHL		**Wednesday**
Favorite	**Line**	**Underdog**
at Washington	-136/+114	Montreal
at Colorado	-155/+129	Dallas
NFL		
Favorite	**Line (O/U)**	**Underdog**
Seattle	2½ (40½)	at Denver
at Jacksonville	2½ (42½)	Houston
Baltimore	4½ (41½)	at Cleveland
at Indianapolis	7 (44)	Tennessee
at New England	7½ (43½)	NY Jets
Pittsburgh	2½ (40½)	at Tampa Bay
New Orleans	1½ (45½)	at NY Giants
at Philadelphia	1½ (40½)	Carolina
Chicago	3½ (49½)	at Atlanta
at LA Rams	12½ (52½)	Arizona
Buffalo	4½ (53½)	at Las Vegas
at Kansas City	8½ (42½)	LA Chargers
at Green Bay	1½ (53½)	Dallas
at San Fran.	7½ (50½)	Washington
College Football		
Favorite	**Line**	**Underdog**
		Wednesday
Kennesaw St	3 (52½)	at Missouri St
W Kentucky	1½ (53½)	at Sam Hou.
		Thursday
Georgia S	3½ (47½)	at Old Dominion
E Carolina	4½ (47½)	at UAB
at Texas St	14½ (70½)	Colorado St
		Friday
Memphis	7 (55½)	at Tulane
at Purdue	3½ (52½)	Washington
Appalachian St	1½ (49½)	at Co Carolina
		Saturday
at SMU	8½ (52½)	Virginia
N'western	7½ (49½)	at Michigan St
at Army	2½ (55½)	Florida Atl
Ohio St	3½ (51)	at Indiana
at W Virginia	1½ (63½)	Cincinnati
at Ja. Madison	12½ (58½)	Georgia St
at LSU	14 (58½)	Mississippi St
at Bowl. Green	6½ (47½)	Ball State
at Clemson	41½ (56½)	Charleston So.
at Texas	10½ (52½)	Florida
at Kansas St	4½ (55½)	Kansas
Pittsburgh	6½ (43½)	at Boston Col
at Maryland	5½ (57½)	Rutgers
at Texas A&M	45½ (56½)	Citadel
at Temple	21½ (47½)	Charlotte
at Buffalo	6½ (41½)	UMass
W Michigan	6½ (43)	at C Michigan
Toledo	6½ (53½)	at E Michigan
at Georgia	20½ (49½)	Auburn
at Michigan	6½ (42½)	Penn St
UNLV	1½ (48½)	at Air Force
at Wyoming	8½ (40½)	N Illinois
at Texas Tech	14½ (48½)	Arizona St
at Duke	3 (47½)	N Carolina
at Miami (OH)	9½ (46½)	Akron
at Mississippi	6 (58½)	Missouri
Alabama	8½ (51½)	at Tennessee
at Virginia Tech	10 (57½)	Georgia Tech
Tulsa	4½ (46½)	at Rice
at Louisiana	4½ (49½)	Troy
at Oregon St	17½ (52½)	Wash. St
at N Dakota St	14½ (42½)	Nevada
at Vander

NATIONAL SPORTS REPORT

Shorts

ALLEN, BLOCKED FG HELP BILLS OUTLAST RAMS

Josh Allen realized that his extraordinary efforts throughout this frenetic game might all amount to nothing Monday night when the Bills fumbled deep in Rams territory early in overtime. The Bills' defense — and Greg Rousseau's outstretched hand — somehow gave him one more chance, and Allen again did everything necessary to get Tyler Bass in position to kick the field goal that ended a memorable evening. Allen accounted for 331 total yards and two TDs, Bass made a 45-yard field goal with 1:55 left in OT shortly after Rousseau blocked a field-goal attempt, and the Bills outlasted the Rams for a 37-34 road win. "That's the beautiful thing about football: You get another drive," Allen said. "All you can do is keep moving forward. You're hoping someone on defense or special teams can make a play, and that's what happened. Greg Rousseau made a play." Allen passed for 210 yards and rushed for 121 more for the Bills (4-1), who rallied to win a back-and-forth thriller befitting the teams with the NFL's last two MVPs at quarterback. The Bills are off to a 4-1 start under rookie head coach Joe Brady. Matthew Stafford passed for 383 yards and three TDs in the loss. On Tuesday, the NFL suspended Rams left tackle Alaric Jackson for two games without pay for punching Bills linebacker Bradley Chubb after the game.

INFANTINO GOT UNDISCLOSED $1.7M WC PAYMENT

Embattled FIFA president Gianni Infantino received a previously undisclosed $1.72 million payment from the business entity in charge of this past summer's World Cup in North America, ESPN reported on Tuesday. The lack of transparency surrounding the compensation is a potential violation of FIFA statutes. Infantino received the compensation in 2024 from FWC2026, the U.S.-based organization set up by FIFA to manage and operate the 2026 World Cup, according to IRS records. This compensation was on top of Infantino's salary and benefits from FIFA for 2024 that totaled $4.9 million. The additional money wasn't disclosed in FIFA's 2024 annual report. According to FIFA's own statutes, "The individual compensation of the FIFA President, the members of the Council and the FIFA Secretary General shall be made public." A FIFA spokesperson said the organization "strongly rejects any suggestion there has been a violation" of the statutes. It's the latest controversy surrounding Infantino, who has been in office since 2016 and is running for reelection. Earlier this year, he came under fire for a since-aborted plan to sell a 20% stake in the World Cup to private investors.

F1 RETURNING TO AFRICA WITH RACE IN RWANDA

Rwanda will host a Formula 1 race from "the early 2030s" when the series returns to Africa after about 40 years. The African Grand Prix will have a 10-year contract and take place at a track in Bugesera, southeast of the capital Kigali, F1 said on Tuesday. The purpose-built track will be ready "early in the next decade." "This partnership is long overdue," Rwandan President Paul Kagame said at a launch event in Kigali. "But it is a success and a milestone for the entire continent, especially for the African fans. Ultimately, what we want is for the African Grand Prix to pave the way for other races to be hosted on the continent." Racing in Africa will fulfill a long-held ambition for seven-time world champ Lewis Hamilton, the only Black driver in F1. The 41-year-old Brit has said he has been "fighting in the background" for years to have a race in Africa. The last time F1 raced there was the South African Grand Prix in 1993. "Today is a landmark moment for Formula 1," F1 President and chief executive Stefano Domenicali said. "With Rwanda joining the calendar from the next decade our sport will race in every inhabited continent." Rwanda has faced accusations from the United Nations that it has backed rebels in neighboring Congo, and Congolese officials have condemned its soccer sponsorships. *— News services*

WNBA

Naz Hillmon, center, Angel Reese, left, and Rhyne Howard celebrate Friday after the Dream clinched a WNBA Finals berth with a sweep of the Liberty. The Dream will face the Valkyries for the title, starting Saturday. **ISHIKA SAMANT/GETTY**

Stuff they're made of

With 'patience,' deals, bold bet, Dream back in finals for 1st time since '13

By Doug Feinberg
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WNBA Commissioner Cathy Engelbert in 2021 awards Dan Padover his second straight Executive of the Year award when he was general manager of the Aces. Padover then left for the Dream, adding a third honor in 2025. **DAVID BECKER/AP**

General manager Dan Padover built the Dream into a title contender through shrewd trades, a little bit of luck and patience from the team's ownership group.

All that has paid off as the Dream are headed to the WNBA Finals for the first time since 2013 when they play the Valkyries in the best-of-seven championship series that begins Saturday.

"I give the ownership group a lot of credit for having the patience to have this thing get where it is today," Padover said in a phone interview. "A lot of times in sports, teams get broken up too early. Letting them grow together gives a continuity that is a huge competitive advantage. You're seeing it now."

Putting this team together started soon after Padover came to the franchise in 2021 from the Aces.

"We never got lottery luck or many free agents really, so we had to do it through trades," said Padover, who was with the Aces when they drafted Jackie Young with the No. 1 overall pick. "That's definitely the hardest way to build a franchise."

ESPN analyst Rebecca Lobo has been impressed with what Padover has done with the Dream.

"They put everything together. If they don't have Angel (Reese) they aren't in the finals. They got the gift of DeWanna Bonner at end of season. They picked her up for nothing. I think it's twofold: a GM who has done an extraordinary job finding the right pieces and a team that's come together at the right time."

STARTS WITH THE DRAFT

The three-time WNBA Executive of the Year's first big move was acquiring the No. 1 pick from the Mystics in 2022 to draft Rhyne Howard and then taking Naz Hillmon 15th that year through another traded draft pick.

"None of it gets off the ground without Rhyne and Naz," he said. "They had a belief in each other and that we could try to build something here."

DEALS DO THE TRICK

The next season Padover traded for Allisha Gray for two draft picks, giving the Dream a solid foundation with Gray, Howard and Hillmon.

"Got to give credit to Lish," Padover said. "She was on trade market, but she circled this as a place she wanted to go to. It worked out for all parties involved."

The team was lacking a true point guard though, so Padover went out and got Jordin Canada from the Sparks in 2024.

The biggest move though came this last year. After being upset by the Fever in the first round of the playoffs last season, Padover knew they need Angel Reese to contend for a title. A few months later, Padover made the move.

"I think she was looking at a few different places, but given our group, given our organization, our market, we were a natural fit for her," he said.

FREE AGENCY FILLS IT IN

The final piece to the puzzle involved signing DeWanna Bonner right at the end of the regular season when the Mercury let her go to make one more run at a championship.

"It happened that Phoenix and her worked out a deal to allow her to make a run in the postseason and that turned into a mini-free agency with a bunch of teams that went after her," Padover said. "We were fortunate we had made a run at her the last few free agencies. She has a great relationship with our players."

RIGHT COACH

Padover decided after the 2024 season that it was time to move on from coach Tanisha Wright after she had led the team to consecutive playoff appearances. The Dream hired a search firm and the biggest thing that the franchise wanted was a basketball purist who aligned with the core values of the organization. The answer was longtime Florida Gulf Coast coach Karl Smesko.

"Karl was born to be a coach. He's extremely humble and hard-working and a phenomenal basketball mind," Padover said. "To be in his second year in this league that is ultra competitive. To have 30 wins his first two years and then make the finals in Year 2, puts him up there in elite, elite company."

BRINGING THEM BACK

With the condensed free agency period this offseason because of the new collective bargaining agreement, Padover had little time to re-sign Howard, Gray, Canada, Hillmon and the others.

In the span of two days he was able to get them to all want to come back.

"To lock up five players in 48 hours is crazy, usually you don't lock up one that quickly," Padover said. "It's a two-week process in a normal year."

Padover said the work began well before he was able to talk to them.

"It was so important to have done your work earlier and them knowing who you are and that you care," he said. "We knew speed was important because people were out there making them good offers. We made them feel whole as quickly as possible and showed them how much we wanted them."

ON THE FRINGE

LIV golfers face major decision on future of careers

By Doug Ferguson | ASSOCIATED PRESS

For the second time in nine months, players who took the Saudi riches of LIV Golf are facing a tight deadline on their future. The first was a lot easier to ignore.

Brooks Koepka in January became the first LIV player to return to the PGA Tour under financial penalties that included no access to equity grants for five years. CEO Brian Rolapp then offered the same deal to fellow major winners Jon Rahm, Bryson DeChambeau and Cameron Smith.

They had three weeks to decide and none took it. Why should they?

The United States was not at war with Iran. Saudi Arabia's sovereign wealth fund was still pumping cash — more than $5 billion and counting — into the LIV Golf League. They were rich and getting richer.

The deadline set by the European tour this week is far more daunting.

As LIV is trying to emerge from bankruptcy without Saudi funding, European tour CEO Guy Kinnings delivered a "take it or leave it" ultimatum to anyone seeking a home on his circuit — take up membership, but only if they leave the new version of LIV Golf.

"Players need to make a choice," Kinnings said. "We have rules and regulations which are there to protect our tour and which our members must all abide by. Players who are not willing to comply with our rules and regulations should not be seeking to join our tour."

They have three weeks to decide.

European tour membership is the best alternative because the PGA Tour bans players for one year dating to their last LIV event. Those who want European membership have to disclose where they plan to play in 2027, and if that includes LIV 2.0, there's no need to apply.

For European-born players — Tyrrell Hatton of England, Thomas Detry of Belgium and Spaniards David Puig and Josele Ballester come to mind — no membership means no chance at playing in the Ryder Cup.

Rahm already has made clear he is leaving LIV after reviewing the proposed terms of LIV 2.0. The prize funds are no longer $20 million. The schedule is 10 tournaments, leaving plenty of weeks to play elsewhere, except that the PGA Tour and now the European tour are not options.

Maybe they still have their MENA Tour cards.

Scott O'Neil, the CEO at LIV Golf, has been preaching "complete, not compete," as a way of saying tours around the world should all work together. This is a different message his predecessor, Greg Norman, had in 2022 when LIV Golf launched by spending more than $1 billion to lure away stars who couldn't ignore the money.

"This is an opportunity to start a movement that will change the course of history by bringing new and open competition to the sport we all love," Norman said.

Saudi-backed LIV was a threat that thrived on disruption. Bankruptcy LIV wants cooperation.

BC Partners Credit has pledged $300 million for LIV 2.0 to move forward. The amended restructuring support agreement has moved the deadline to Oct. 25 to secure a "critical mass of players sufficient to operate a bona fide professional golf league."

That's up to BC Partners to decide how many players — and who they are — can satisfy the requirement. And it can extend the deadline so it can move on with restructuring.

But it's a bleak future, certainly not as appealing as it was when LIV was burning through Saudi cash to tempt players to leave. Now the carrot is equity ownership in a league coming out of bankruptcy amid concerns everyone might jump ship.

And then where do they swim? The European tour made its position clear. Rolapp, meanwhile, said in January there was no guarantee the program that brought Koepka back would be available again. He is guided by what's best for the PGA Tour. He also answers to a membership that stayed put when so many others were chasing generational wealth.

"There are 225 guys with tour cards," Xander Schauffele said last week in Japan. "And if you sat down and interviewed all of them, you're going to get probably three or four boxes of how guys feel. Some guys don't care, some guys are really ticked off, some guys want them to have a huge fine, some guys would let them back tomorrow."

Rolapp said in August the tour is built on players earning their place, it's a membership organization that has rules and rules only matter if they're enforced.

The PGA Tour, trying to sort out final details of the new competition model for 2028 (where and when to play and who's going to pay for it), also has to consider a path back for the stars it lost who undoubtedly would make the tour better.

O'Neil and Ted Goldthorpe, partner and head of BC Partners Credit, remain bullish on their path out of bankruptcy and into a future that appears as clear as haar on the East Lothian coast of Scotland.

Goldthorpe was at the Sportico Invest London conference last week when he spoke to the financial sustainability of LIV 2.0.

"A lot of the money that was spent created the ecosystem and infrastructure that exists today," he said. "We think we can run this in a financially sustainable way because much of that spending went to getting the players, and the players are here."

But are they staying? The clock is ticking.

Voting has begun in the 40th annual Tribune Holiday Cookie Contest

By Kayla Samoy
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Your recipes are in, and now it's time to vote in the Tribune's 40th annual Holiday Cookie Contest.

Readers can vote once per day at chicagotribune.com/cookiecontest for the recipe they want to see advance to the final round. Voting closes at 11:59 p.m. on Oct. 23.

Tribune staffers will then bake the 12 recipes that receive the most votes, though the food team can select a 13th finalist with the "Joe Gray Save," named after a former dining editor, if we see a worthy recipe that should move on.

Remember, first place wins $250 cash; second place, $150; third place, $50; so get your votes in! We'll publish the three winning recipes in print and online Dec. 2.

The Tribune's annual Cookie Contest is celebrating its 40th year. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Chef Christian Hunter plates a dish at Hooligan in Logan Square on Oct. 8. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

RESTAURANT NEWS

Hooligan opens in Chicago

A 'neo-Midwestern bistro' from Christian Hunter, a Michelin-award winning chef

By Louisa Kung Liu Chu
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Michelin award-winning chef Christian Hunter just opened his highly anticipated new restaurant in Chicago. Hooligan debuted in the Logan Square neighborhood on Oct. 1. Hunter describes the cuisine as "third coast contemporary," featuring Great Lakes ingredients and classic French technique.

"The concept of Hooligan is definitely my brainchild," said the chef, who calls the Black-owned business a "neo-Midwestern bistro." He was previously executive chef and business partner at Michelin-starred Atelier in Lincoln Square, which closed in May. "The meaning behind Hooligan touches on a few things."

It speaks to people who are seeking out dining experiences that have a little bit of easy elegance, maybe less pretentiousness, said Hunter.

"It also speaks to a bit of my own professional career in which I'm a kid from the South," he said, "Specifically Kentucky and Tennessee."

The food he came from and loved, and had always considered fine dining, was not appreciated professionally, said the chef.

Chicken liver parfait snack with hot water cornbread hush puppies, pimento cheese and seasonal jam.

"There weren't a lot of African American chefs in my time coming up," said Hunter. "I was always kind of feeling like a hooligan, like an outcast."

The chef co-owns the restaurant with managing partner Tyrone Redic Jr.

"Our menu is fairly slim, but as far as favorites go, we have a really cool dish that I wasn't sure was going to work out," said Hunter. "We are making hush puppies out of hot water cornbread batter, which is a direct tie to my childhood."

They're served with the chicken liver parfait snack alongside pimento cheese made from Wisconsin cheddar, and a seasonal jam made with aronia berries, also known as chokeberries for their astringency.

"This dish screams to me what the soul of Hooligan is," said the chef. "Everything on that plate is saying, 'Hey, we're from here.'"

They're using cornmeal from Janie's Mill in downstate Ashkum and chicken livers from Crazy Cluckers Farm in Missouri.

"Then we have really fun profiteroles on the menu," he added about the French cream puffs. "And we're using Cahokia rice to make toasted rice and butter pecan ice cream."

The grains are grown in southern Illinois.

"We finish it with what I'm calling liquid chocolate," said the chef about the dessert. "And a little bit more praline pecan."

It's classic bistro, but the butter pecan has a historical flavor and reason behind it.

"I think a lot of African Americans grew up with butter pecan in their household," said Hunter, who's also the pastry chef. "It's a little bit of a nod."

Head bartender Aaron Michael Wells created The Hooligan cocktail.

"He said it's like this really sexy kind of love child between

See **HOOLIGAN** on Page E4

Students from Bancroft Elementary School in Washington and assistant White House chef Sam Kass weigh lettuce they harvested with first lady Michelle Obama from the White House Kitchen Garden on the South Lawn on June 16, 2009. **ALEX BRANDON/AP**

Sam Kass wins the Julia Child Award

Former Obama family personal chef and policy adviser says Chicago 'made me'

By Zareen Syed
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Sam Kass, former Obama family personal chef and executive director of first lady Michelle Obama's Let's Move! initiative, was honored Friday with the prestigious Julia Child Award at the Obama Presidential Center, recognizing his lifelong dedication to fostering equitable food systems.

Kass, a Chicago native who worked at several notable city restaurants and kitchens early in his culinary career, said the award is a true full-circle moment.

"Chicago is the city that formed me, that shaped me, that made me who I am, and I take the city with me everywhere I go," Kass told the Tribune ahead of Friday's ceremony. "To receive this award in Chicago at the Obama Presidential Center is quite meaningful. I was very lucky to have been on the journey with them."

Kass's relationship with the Obamas predates their White House tenure by several decades. He originally met Michelle Obama through community circles in Chicago's Hyde Park neighborhood. Kass officially became the family's personal chef in 2005 following Barack Obama's election to the U.S. Senate. But before moving to Washington, D.C., his culinary path in Chicago included positions at 312 and Avec, along with training in Vienna under renowned Austrian chef Christian Domschitz.

The annual honor given by The Julia Child Foundation for Gastronomy and the Culinary Arts celebrates individuals or teams who make a profound difference

See **AWARD** on Page E3

You can make an award-winning pot of beef and bean chili for parties, tailgates and dinner any night. **CHRISTOPHER TESTANI/THE NEW YORK TIMES PHOTOS**

A POT OF GOLD

The secret ingredient every chili needs is probably in your pantry

By Ali Slagle | THE NEW YORK TIMES

Tana Harter knows what she wants in her chili: creamy heartiness, a glisten and glow, melt-in-your-mouth meat and consistent spiciness. But half an hour before judging began at the 2018 International Chili Society World Championship Chili Cook-Off in St. Louis, her pot wasn't meeting her personal criteria. She stirred in the one ingredient she knew would fix it.

Harter, a life coach from Leesburg, Virginia, won the traditional red category that year by adding two teaspoons of apple cider vinegar. "It was a crutch for me for a while," she said.

She has competed in six to 10 chili cook-offs a year for more than a decade, and can't deny that vinegar is a winning secret ingredient. "I won $25,000 using apple cider vinegar. You got to look at the facts, and that is the fact."

While adding a final dash of vinegar or another acidic ingredient isn't especially common on the cook-off circuit, it's a handy trick for home cooks. It enhances overall flavor and balances richness, making a good pot even better. If a batch is too sweet, salty or bitter, it evens everything out.

This trick also works for other hearty braises, like beef stew. Meat and other fatty ingredients have a tendency to muffle other flavors. Tasting chili after stirring in vinegar is like taking off noise-canceling headphones. Only then can you fully experience the dish's distinct heat, smoke and spices.

A final hit of acid can also make a speedy version taste like it simmered for hours. Lisa Fain, a seventh-generation Texan, adds two tablespoons of fresh lime juice to the one-hour Texas chili in her "Homesick Texan Cookbook." The idea came from her mother, who finishes every hearty or savory dish, including chili or a pot of beans, with a splash of brine from a jar of pickled jalapeños. (Brine is mostly vinegar.) Fain uses brine as well but likes the freshness of lime. "It just brightens up the dish," she said.

Try it out by making a batch of your favorite chili and giving it a taste. Then stir in a half teaspoon of apple cider vinegar or lime juice. (You can also use red wine vinegar, but it can be more discernible.) Taste again and repeat with another half teaspoon. If the flavors aren't yet as intense as you want them, crank it up with another half teaspoon.

You don't need much — enough to amplify but not enough to detect. Harter's triumphant recipe included just two teaspoons for a batch using three pounds of diced tri-tip.

Chili classicists might consider this finishing touch unnecessary, but consider how garnishes of pickled jalapeños, pickled onions and hot sauce similarly contribute a jolt of acidity to rich bowls. Stirring vinegar into the pot guarantees that sharp contrast makes it into every bite.

When Fain published her lime-spiked chili, readers grumbled. Lime juice? In Texas chili? "It works," Fain said. "I'll defend it."

CHILI

This is a spicy, smoky and hearty pot of chili. To create a rich and thick sauce, simmer aromatics, chili powder and cocoa powder with a small quantity of tomato sauce and a big quantity of ground beef. Use meat with ample fat (at least 20%) because it deepens the flavor of those aromatics. If you like the meat in your chili to be so soft it nearly crumbles, simmer your batch longer; if you prefer your chili without beans, just leave them out. Just don't forget the toppings.

Makes: 6 to 8 servings
Total time: 1 ½ hours
2 tablespoons neutral oil, such as grapeseed
2 pounds ground beef, preferably 20% fat
Salt and pepper
1 large yellow onion, coarsely chopped
4 garlic cloves, finely chopped or grated
1 tablespoon ground cumin
1 tablespoon store-bought or homemade chili powder, plus more if needed
1 chipotle pepper in adobo plus 1 teaspoon sauce (or 1 additional tablespoon chili powder)
1 (15-ounce) can tomato sauce
1 tablespoon unsweetened cocoa powder
2 (15-ounce) cans beans (such as pinto, black or any bean you like in chili), with their liquid
1 ½ teaspoons apple cider vinegar, plus more if needed
Grated sharp cheddar, sour cream, hot sauce, sliced scallions, chopped white onion, cilantro leaves, crushed tortilla or corn chips, for serving (optional)

1. Heat the oil in a large pot or Dutch oven over medium-high. Working in batches if necessary to avoid crowding the pot, use your hands to break the beef into small chunks (about 2 inches each) and add a single layer to the pot. Season with salt and pepper, then cook, flipping once, until browned on two sides, 4 to 6 minutes. (Meat won't be cooked through.) Transfer to a bowl, leaving the fat in the pot.

2. Reduce heat to medium, add the onion and season with salt and pepper. Cook until softened, 3 to 4 minutes. Add the garlic, cumin and chili powder, and stir until fragrant, 1 to 2 minutes.

3. Add the chipotle pepper and adobo sauce, plus the beef and any juices in the bowl. Use a spoon or potato masher to break up the beef into small pieces. Stir in the tomato sauce and cocoa powder.

4. Cover, reduce heat to low and cook, stirring frequently to avoid scorching, until the beef is tender and the sauce is flavorful, 25 to 30 minutes.

5. Add the beans, including their liquid, and cook, uncovered, stirring often, until liquid is slightly thickened and beans are warm, 10 to 15 minutes. Let sit for 5 minutes, then stir in the apple cider vinegar. Taste and add salt until chili is rich and loudly spiced. Eat with desired toppings.

If you're lucky enough to find Italian plums, make a crumble

By Gretchen McKay
PITTSBURGH POST-GAZETTE

When it comes to desserts, nothing is easier than a crumble made with fresh, seasonal fruit.

In fall, that means one thing: plump and juicy Italian prune plums.

I love them for their flavor — a high sugar level makes the flesh incredibly sweet and jammy when cooked.

But unlike clingstone fruits such as peaches, which never seem to want to come apart without a struggle, plums are easy to cut and quarter thanks to their freestone pits.

My challenge this year has been finding the deep-purple, egg-shaped fruit at local markets. I either get to farm stands after the plums have sold out, or the farmers don't have them at all. If I was a classic cartoon, you'd see steam coming out of my ears.

Thankfully I found a one-pint box of Italian plums tucked among containers of pears and apples at a local farm stand.

"Get them now," the saleswoman urged me when I pondered whether to buy on a Saturday since I wouldn't be headed home until Monday. "They'll be gone in an hour."

I took her advice and on Tuesday, I made this crumble. Anticipation was such that when it came out of the oven, I couldn't wait for it to cool and scooped it into a bowl, piping hot.

When buying plums, look for fruit that feels slightly soft but not mushy. Avoid any with deep-brown skin blemishes. Don't worry if it's covered in a whitish, cloudy bloom — that's a natural protective barrier that helps keep bugs at bay and the fruit from drying out.

A quick rinse under cool water is all you need to clean them. Pat them dry with a clean paper towel.

To make the crumble a crisp, add old-fashioned rolled oats.

PLUM CRUMBLE

Makes: 6 servings
For the filling:
4 cups sliced Italian plums
1/4 cup brown sugar
1 cup grated Granny Smith or other tart apple (about 1 apple)
2 tablespoons cornstarch
1 teaspoon cinnamon
Pinch of salt
For the topping:
½ cup all-purpose flour
⅓ cup granulated sugar or brown sugar (I like to a do 3 tablespoons of each)
4 tablespoons salted butter, cubed
½ teaspoon ground cinnamon, optional
Vanilla ice cream for serving, optional

1. Heat oven to 375 degrees.

2. Prepare filling: Place sliced plums, brown sugar, grated apple, cornstarch, cinnamon and a pinch of salt in a large bowl. Using your hands, toss gently to combine.

3. Prepare topping: In a medium bowl, combine flour and sugar. Add cinnamon, if desired.

4. Add butter cubes and mix with your fingers until large clumps form. Do not over-mix (you do not want this to become like a dough).

5. Pour filling into a buttered 8- or 9-inch pie pan. Scatter crumble topping over the top.

6. Bake in a 375-degree oven until top is golden brown and fruit is bubbling in center, 40-50 minutes. If top is browning too quickly, tent the top of the crumble loosely with a sheet of aluminum foil and continue to bake.

7. Serve warm, spooned into bowls. If desired, top with a scoop of vanilla ice cream.

A plum crumble comes together quickly, making it a perfect dessert for midweek. **GRETCHEN MCKAY/PITTSBURGH POST-GAZETTE**

AWARD

from Page E1

in how America cooks, eats and drinks. Previous award recipients include Jacques Pépin, Alice Waters, Rick Bayless and José Andrés.

Child, who died in 2004 at age 91, left behind a legacy of culinary art and education. She was a chef, author and groundbreaking television personality who revolutionized American cooking and presented an accessible version of sophisticated French cuisine to audiences for over four decades.

"From reshaping how a generation of American children eat, to backing the entrepreneurs rebuilding our food systems, to sounding the alarm on the fragility of our food supply, Sam has spent his career asking the same question Julia asked every day: How do we make people's lives better through food?" Eric W. Spivey, chairman of the Julia Child Foundation, said in a statement.

As executive director of the Let's Move! campaign and senior policy adviser for nutrition in the Obama White House, Kass helped establish the first major White House vegetable garden since Eleanor Roosevelt's victory garden. Roosevelt's garden in 1943 was meant to encourage Americans to grow their own food during World War II, while Obama's garden on the lower South Lawn in 2009 promoted healthy eating and represented a fight against childhood obesity.

Kass said planting that garden was a defining moment of his career and one that ignited a series of policy shifts around nutrition regulation, including a complete overhaul of federal nutrition standards for school meals for the first time in 15 years and a push for more transparent nutritional labeling on packaged foods.

"It really was a symbol to the country about what we valued and what we thought was important to value for our kids," he said. "When we got to the White House, food and health was something that mainstream America was not focused on, and I think now you see a lot of focus on it. That is — although many people don't understand or would certainly not acknowledge — entirely underpinned by the work that we did."

The award also comes with a $50,000 grant from the Julia Child Foundation that the winner can give to a food-focused nonprofit. Kass decided to divide his grant among three organizations: Urban Growers Collective, a Chicago-based, Black- and women-led nonprofit farm that builds economic opportunity for BIPOC urban growers; God's Love We Deliver, an organization that delivers free, medically tailored meals and nutritional counseling to individuals managing severe illnesses; and American Farmland Trust, which works to protect America's farmland and support farmers and ranchers through advocacy, research and hands-on programs.

Former White House chef Sam Kass arrives for the James Beard Awards at the Civic Opera House in Chicago on May 4, 2015. **NUCCIO DINUZZO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Though Kass left the White House two years before the Obamas did, he has remained engaged in driving transformation within food systems. He works as a partner at Acre Venture Partners, investing in and advising early-stage companies focused on health, food systems and sustainability, and recently published the book "The Last Supper: How to Overcome the Coming Food Crisis," focusing on threats to the global food supply.

Kass said the Trump administration's "complete attack" on the Environmental Protection Agency and rollback of Obama-era and Biden-era agriculture and environmental regulations threaten to undo years of progress on clean air, climate resilience and sustainable agriculture.

"I think what's happening right now in Washington is a travesty on every level," Kass said. "More than just our food, but the people who are making food policy right now are not serious people and the damage that they're doing to this country with conspiracy theories, bunk science, and an absolute deregulation agenda is literally causing people to die."

For instance, over the summer, a diarrheal parasite wreaked havoc across the country within a year of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention scaling back its FoodNet program, which reduced the number of monitored pathogens from eight to just two. That change made federal reporting for the parasite cyclospora and five other pathogens optional. Health experts nationwide had long warned that the loss of centralized data would make it significantly harder to spot multistate trends or identify contaminated food sources quickly.

"You can destroy something much easier than you can build something," he said. "It's going to take many, many years — decades probably — to rebuild what has been destroyed over these past four. But hopefully, we can rebuild things in a way that is better and stronger than they were before."

Kass, who lives in New York City, stressed that food is at the center of some of the biggest issues around public health and climate change. The crux of his mission centers on how best to change the culture and technology of how we get healthy food, how it's grown and most importantly, how to make access to it easier.

"(The award) is truly a humbling honor, one that there's many people who are deserving of, but I am proud to receive it," he said. "And the work continues."

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Food transporting consumers to forest

Menu items tweaked with botanical flavors such as spruce, pine

By Kim Severson
THE NEW YORK TIMES

Pine, clockwise from top right, lavender and juniper are a few of the trendy flavors making waves. **GETTY PHOTOS**

Forget protein-loading and fibermaxxing. Maybe what America really needs is the edible equivalent of a nice walk in the woods.

Order a Smoky Mountain Latte at K Brew in Knoxville, Tennessee, and a barista will steam sage and juniper into your milk. Craft soda fans can choose between Forest Water's Alpine and Meadow flavors. Miles from any wilderness, at the elegant restaurant 425 Park in Manhattan, $28 will buy you a Forest Old Fashioned made with pine liqueur, spruce tips and alpine bitters.

And Torani syrup's flavor of the year? Forest Pine.

The word "foraged" has landed on menus at Sweetgreen and other chain restaurants. Research and development teams at the biggest food companies are keeping a close eye on the forestification of the American palate and going deep on nature-derived ingredients.

Although PepsiCo has no immediate plans to sell Americans Lay's potato chips with the wild mushroom flavors popular in parts of Europe and Asia, don't count it out. "Across markets, we're seeing consumers show more interest in outdoor-inspired, botanical and earthy flavors," said Ashley Doolin, a product development scientist at the company.

America's walk into the woods follows an era dominated by international flavors and tropical tastes like dragonfruit, the warm bakery vibe of Generation Z's "little treats" culture and the sweet-spicy mashup that birthed a thousand hot honey pizzas.

"Now we're starting to see increased interest in flavors that might be about the place, the origin, the landscape or even craftsmanship," said Sally Lyons Wyatt, head of consumer goods and food service at Circana, a global market research and data analytics firm. "Consumers increasingly want flavors that evoke nature, foraging and the outdoors."

American pop-food culture is essentially a game of Chutes and Ladders. What makes one flavor a star and another tank is a roll of the dice. Catching the cultural wave at just the right moment is key. When Starbucks introduced a juniper latte in 2018 — before COVID-19, when the economy was strong and the term "techlash" was just becoming popular — it sank like a rock.

The national mood has since darkened. "Underneath this is a profound anxiety and a lack of trust," said Eve Turow-Paul, a demographer who studies the emotional and cultural factors behind food trends, most recently in her 2020 book, "Hungry: Avocado Toast, Instagram Influencers, and Our Search for Connection and Meaning."

Humans are hard-wired to be physically rewarded by contact with soil and plant life, she said. Flavors from the natural world tap into that, offering an antidote to unsettling digital transformation, climate change and global political conflict. A summer of food recalls and, she added, the rise of the Make America Healthy Again movement with its emphasis on natural remedies also fuel the attraction.

"Part of this is about control and safety and the loss of control over food sources," Turow-Paul said. "People don't trust corporations and they don't trust the government. They're saying, 'I need to return the locus of control to myself. Lavender and sage and pine and juniper just seem natural. Nature seems safer. It seems less likely I am being duped.'"

Stephanie Mattucci, principal food and drink strategist for the global food research firm Mintel, sees parallels to the Industrial Revolution and the Gilded Age, when Swiss author Johanna Spyri published "Heidi." The story of a young girl who escapes city life to seek solace living in the mountains with her grandfather was a bestseller in the United States, and remains a classic.

"In this moment of great change and technological revolution, how can we ground ourselves?" Mattucci said. "People are attracted to alpine flavors as a way to step away from overstimulation and into the therapeutic benefit of the forest and the trees and mountains."

To create its Forest Pine syrup, Torani looked at the growing popularity of astringent flavors like juniper, rosemary and other botanical ingredients. Mentions of lavender, for instance, increased 34% on menus between 2021 and 2025, according to research from Datassential.

Andrea Ramirez, Torani's trends and insight manager, said the company took note of the growing popularity of kombucha, matcha and the bitter undertones of an Aperol spritz, as well as Nordic influences like the Danish comfort concept called hygge and an increase in travel to the Alps.

The piney syrup was infused with ginger and sage so it wouldn't remind anyone of a cleaning product, Ramirez said. The idea was to offer a trip to the forest in a cup.

"If you live in the middle of the city," she said, "you might not have access to clean forests of pine trees."

A high-end chef is often looming somewhere in the back story of any big food trend. Parisian pastry chef Pierre Hermé put salted caramel from Brittany in a macaron in the late 1990s, and a decade later Starbucks began selling salted caramel hot chocolate. David Chang opened Korean restaurant Momofuku in New York in 2004, and by 2021 Shake Shack was selling gochujang-glazed fried chicken sandwiches.

The forest trend may not be for everyone.

In July, Dunkin released a Blueberry Breeze Refresher with juniper berry, which prompted one reviewer to confess, "I have no idea what juniper berry is." Poppi prebiotic soda got into the game in March 2025 with its caffeinated Alpine Blast, which tastes more like Mountain Dew than like the actual mountains. It has yet to reach the ranks of Poppi's most popular flavors, and sales for the overall brand dipped early this year after PepsiCo bought the company for nearly $2 billion.

All the trend-spotter talk of "mushroom-adjacent flavors" and "alpine cues" is only partly about taking refuge from societal mayhem in the cool forest. It's also about marketing and the nature of the American consumer.

"Part of it, to be sure, is the relentless pursuit of novelty," said Helen Zoe Veit, a professor of history at Michigan State University who has written two books about the nation's food. "And then there is just copying other people for no other reason than everyone else is drinking green matcha or a pine-flavored soda, so I might as well have one, too."

HOOLIGAN

from Page E1

Left to right: The Hooligan cocktail at Hooligan, created by head bartender Aaron Michael Wells; Ember & Orchard nonalcoholic drink; Profiteroles dessert with toasted rice butter pecan ice cream and warm chocolate sauce at Hooligan.. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

a Manhattan and Old Fashioned," said Hunter.

The drink is mixed with brown butter-washed rye whiskey, burnt honey and tarragon.

"You have a little bit of sweet, a little bit of bitter, a little bit herbaceous," said the chef. "It's very much me. I'm a little sweet, a little bitter, a little herbaceous."

The nonalcoholic Ember & Orchard drink has also emerged as an early favorite menu item with deep flavors of roasted apple, black tea, ginger and smoke.

Hooligan is housed in a dramatic black building. The space seats about 50 with deep green velvet banquettes and only eight at the bar. Music pulls from a playlist that was the early '90s soundtrack to Hunter's childhood.

"I wanted it to be a very sensual experience," he said.

General manager Marcus Brewer will most likely greet you, said Hunter, and interior designer Ariana Halimi helped bring the chef's design of the space to life.

Diners will receive an amuse-bouche, a complimentary seasonal bite, recently a radish top gazpacho, or a burnt carrot and beet Caesar.

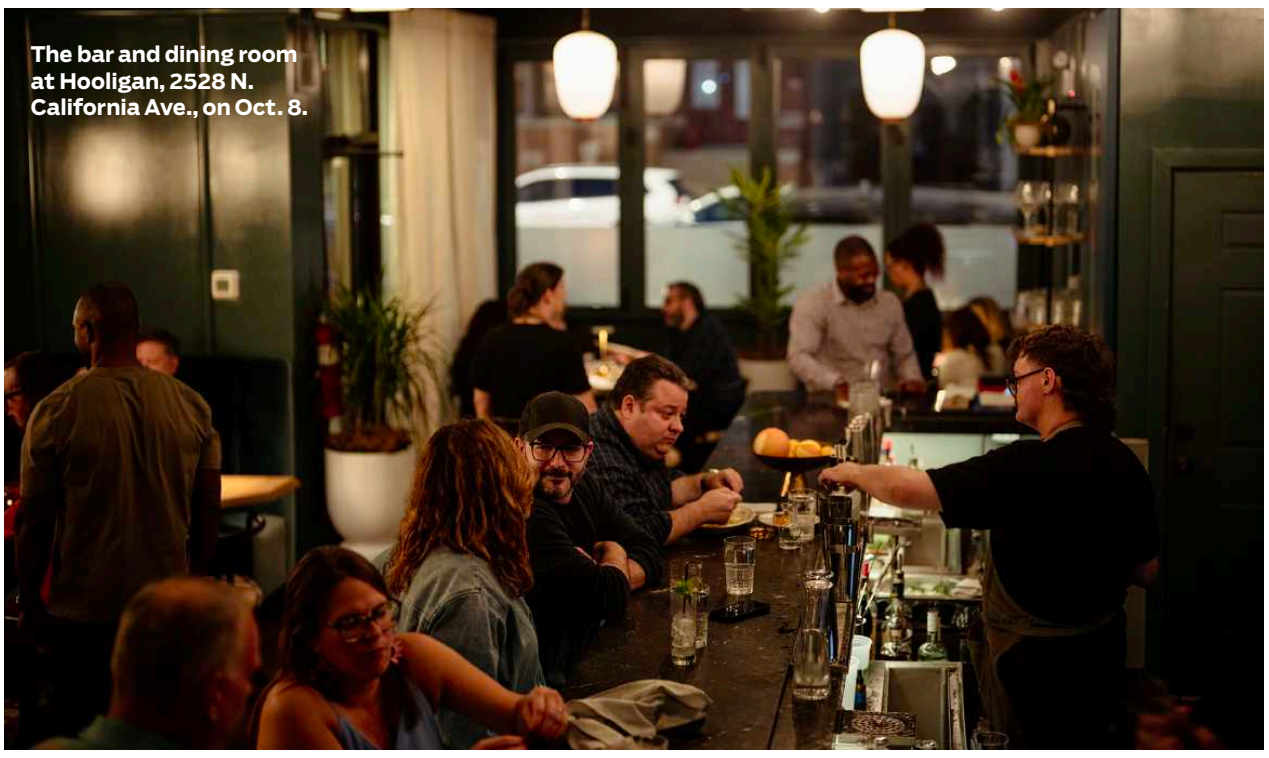
The Hooligan for two at $199 includes two oysters, your choice of two small plates, one large plate, half pours of wine and a shared dessert.

"It's kind of a choose your own journey," said Hunter.

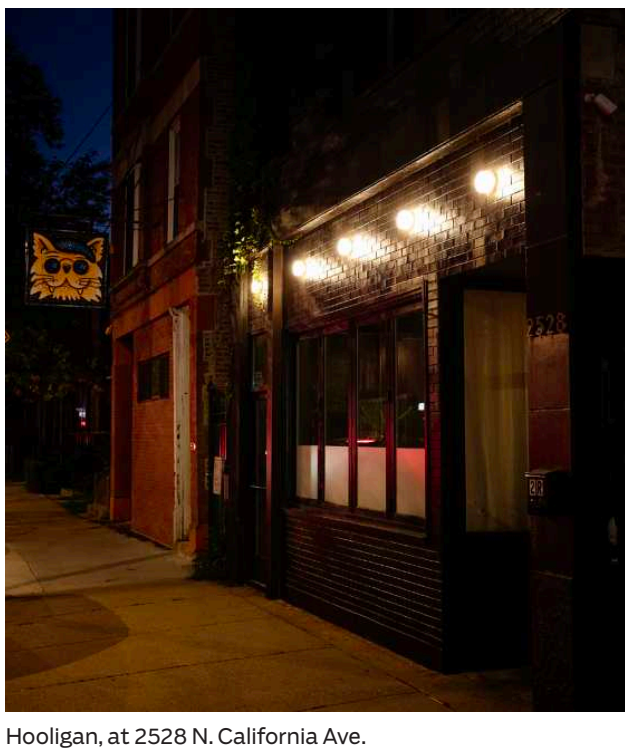
Oysters can be substituted, but they're always served dressed, currently with rutabaga mayo, barbecue spice and crispy potatoes.

"If I'm going to eat an oyster, I want a really luxurious bite that has all the textures in it," said the chef. "That also gives you a little bit more joy."

2528 N. California Ave., hooliganchicago.com



The bar and dining room at Hooligan, 2528 N. California Ave., on Oct. 8.



Hooligan, at 2528 N. California Ave.

MORE NEW OPENINGS

Dewey's Cafe: Chef Riley Brown (Oriole) and sommelier Hannah Grossman (Monteverde) have created a calm neighborhood spot focused on seasonal produce. Dewey's Cafe, named after their rescue dog, opened in Roscoe Village on Sept. 2. The small and thoughtful menu features a pakora and cucumber sandwich, with the vegetable fritter in ciabatta; a celery and nori salad with yuba tofu ribbons; and an iced melon matcha with fruit from Nichols Farm.
2036 W. Roscoe St., 773-360-7086, deweyscafe.com

Little Betty Smokehouse: Pitmaster and chef Dominique Leach is dropping some barbecue knowledge at college with her wife and business partner Tanisha Leach. Little Betty Smokehouse started smoking at the University of Chicago in Hyde Park on Sept. 28. Open to the public, the food hall stall offers their flagship Lexington Betty Smokehouse signature wagyu dogs plus a new Betty taco, a Betty beef and more.
1133 E. 57th St. (Hutchinson Commons), dining.uchicago.edu

Taan: Thai American Chicagoan chef Chanita Chayaluk just opened her own restaurant and wine bar after a career in education and mental health. Taan began serving in Humboldt Park on Sept. 1. Look for whole deep-fried fish with fish sauce caramel and kohlrabi salad; and a bone marrow beef cheek fried rice, with a vegan option available.
2759 W. Augusta Blvd., 773-360-1292, taanchicago.com

IN RE-OPENING NEWS

Hackney's on Harms: The former suburban speakeasy founded in 1939, beloved for their Hackneyburgers on dark rye bread and french fried onions by the loaf, fully reopened indoors and out after renovations in Glenview on Sept. 23.
1241 Harms Road, Glenview; 847-724-5577; hackneys.net

IN MEMORIAM

Shonya "Chef Royce" Williams: Executive chef and owner of Soul Prime, who went viral after a visit by TikTok food critic Keith Lee in 2023, and recently moved her restaurant to West Town and reopened on Aug. 21, died suddenly, according to an announcement on her social media accounts on Oct. 5, with no cause of death disclosed. Homegoing services will be held at Progressive Life Giving Word Cathedral in Hillside on Oct. 19.

Do you have notable restaurant news in the Chicago area? Email restaurant critic Louisa Kung Liu Chu at lchu@chicagotribune.com.

Skillet showcases all the flavors of fall

By JeanMarie Brownson
TRIBUNE CONTENT AGENCY

The trouble with being an accomplished cook is that friends expect a fuss. Even at fall tailgate parties or after a day biking through the colors together.

Best not to disappoint. Preparedness is always the solution. Make condiments in advance and stock the fridge with ready-to-warm side dishes and fast-cooking, high-flavor proteins, such as sausage.

Fully-cooked sausages prove to be a meal maker, ready in no time. Uncooked sausages are nearly as speedy, requiring just 20 minutes on the stove or over a grill.

Bratwurst pleases most sausage fans. Typically made from pork (and sometimes veal), these German-style sausages have a mild, somewhat sweet flavor, typically from nutmeg.

Every butcher shop perfects its own seasoning blend for its homemade recipe.

Choose raw brats when you crave texture and juiciness, and cook them thoroughly.

Fully-cooked white bratwursts, also known as Weisswurst, tend to be less chunky and mildly flavored, with a texture similar to a traditional hot dog. Fully-cooked brats just need to be thoroughly warmed.

Look for smoked bratwurst (reddish in color) when craving a smoky flavor.

Sauteing bacon with onions and red cabbage makes a great side for mild brats. A little apple and balsamic vinegar render the dish a bit sweet, which pairs nicely with the sausage.

Make the recipe here and pile it over a cooked brat tucked into a sausage bun.

Alternatively, crisp up some browned potatoes and add them to the skillet full of cabbage and cooked bratwurst.

When we're tailgating, I cook the cabbage mixture a few days in advance. Either warm it on a portable stove or heat it at home and pack it into an insulated container.

Stock the freezer with small balls of ready-to-bake cookie dough. Set the balls on a lined baking sheet while the oven heats. The house will fill with aromas while you warm up dinner.

Eating at a tailgate? Pack the freezer with containers of homemade cookies or individually wrapped chunky brownies. Let the sweets thaw in the tailgate picnic basket.

All the flavors of the fall in one skillet: sausage, bacon, potatoes, cabbage and apples. Let the games begin.

Sauteing bacon with onions and red cabbage makes a great side for mild brats. **JEANMARIE BROWNSON/TNS**

BRATWURST AND RED CABBAGE SKILLET DINNER

Makes: 4 servings
1 recipe warm cabbage and sweet onion saute (see recipe)
3 medium-sized yellow potatoes, about 1 pound total, scrubbed clean, peeled, if desired
⅓ cup water
¼ cup vegetable oil
4 fully-cooked smoked bratwurst, 12 ounces total
Chopped parsley, chives (or green onion tops)
1. Make warm cabbage recipe.
2. Cut potatoes into ¾-inch pieces. Put into a microwave-safe bowl. Add ⅓ cup water and cover bowl with lid or plastic wrap vented at one corner. Microwave on high (100% power), stirring once or twice until potatoes are tender, 5 to 6 minutes. Let stand covered.
3. Heat oil in large nonstick or cast-iron skillet over medium heat until hot but not smoking. Drain potatoes and pat dry, then add to oil. Use a splatter guard to prevent mess. Cook, stirring often, until potatoes are golden and crisp, about 10 minutes.
4. Move potatoes to edges of pan. Add bratwurst and cook to brown both sides, about 3 minutes. Stir in warm cabbage and heat through, if necessary. Serve garnished with parsley and chives.

WARM CABBAGE AND SWEET ONION SAUTE

Makes: 4 to 6 servings
3 slices smoky bacon, diced
1 medium-sized (10 ounces) sweet onion, halved, thinly sliced into wedges
1 package (8 ounces) shredded red cabbage, 3 to 4 cups
2 cloves garlic, crushed
½ small apple, peeled, chopped into ¼-inch pieces
½ cup chicken broth
2 tablespoons balsamic vinegar
¼ to ½ teaspoon chopped fresh or dried thyme
Salt, freshly ground black pepper to taste
1. Cook bacon in large nonstick or well-seasoned cast-iron skillet over medium heat, stirring often, until bacon starts to crisp, about 4 minutes. Add onion. Cook and stir until onions are golden browns, about 5 minutes.
2. Stir in cabbage. Cook and stir until cabbage softens, about 5 minutes. Add garlic and cook 1 minute. Stir in apple, broth, balsamic and thyme. Simmer until most of the liquid has been absorbed, 2 to 3 minutes.
3. Season to taste with salt and pepper. Serve warm.

BRATWURST AND RED CABBAGE SANDWICHES

Makes: 5 servings
1 recipe warm cabbage and sweet onion saute (see recipe)
5 links uncooked bratwurst, about 19 ounces total
½ cup water, mild beer or chicken broth (or a combination)
5 sausage buns or hot dog buns
Grainy Dijon mustard
Mayonnaise
1. Make warm cabbage recipe.
2. Put water into a 10-inch skillet over medium heat. Add bratwurst in a single, uncrowded layer. Reduce heat to low. Cover the pan and simmer, turning sausage once, for 10 minutes.
3. Uncover pan and tip off any remaining liquid. Return pan with sausages to medium-low heat. Cook, turning sausages a couple of times, until lightly browned on both sides, about 10 minutes.
4. Smear inside of buns with mayonnaise and mustard. Top with a hot bratwurst, then pile on the warm cabbage.

Crostini with seasonal fruit, ricotta and honey is featured in the cookbook "Stuzzichini" by Stef Ferrari. **VORACIOUS**

Seasonal fruit crostini calls for improvisation

By Stef Ferrari | VORACIOUS

Like so many preparations in the cookbook "Stuzzichini," and in Italian food in general, it's almost impossible to call this a recipe. Instead, it's an act of trust: You must trust that whatever fruit you choose for this crostini will pair perfectly with fresh ricotta, good-quality honey and your choice of crunchy bits and/or herbs and/or spices, as long as it's done with intention and care.

You must trust nature and your intuition.

Some of my favorite seasonal fruits to use include rotund red cherries, juicy figs, buttery pears and tart peaches. But keep an eye out at the market and an open mind, and I have faith the formula will always deliver.

I use the following as a good starting point per slice: 1 to 2 tablespoons ricotta, 2 teaspoons honey and ¼ cup fruit.

CROSTINI DI FRUTTA DI STAGIONE, RICOTTA AND MIELE (CROSTINI WITH SEASONAL FRUIT, RICOTTA AND HONEY)

Baguette, sliced on a bias
Extra-virgin olive oil
Whole-milk ricotta
Seasonal fruit (cherries, pears, peaches, apples, figs, oranges) cleaned and pitted, cut to your preference
Honey
Nuts, fresh-cracked black pepper, fresh herbs, grated citrus zest, prosciutto (optional)
1. Brush the baguette slices with oil and toast on a sheet pan in a 375-degree oven for 10 to 12 minutes. Allow to cool completely.
2. Spread the ricotta evenly across the slices. Arrange the fruit on each slice and drizzle with honey. Add any optional toppings and serve.

SERIOUSLY SIMPLE

Vibrant salad with squash, bacon brings autumn's best to your home

By Diane Rossen Worthington
TRIBUNE CONTENT AGENCY

Peppery arugula, crisp Belgian endive, roasted winter squash, and smoky bacon make this autumn salad both colorful and deeply flavorful. A honey-mustard sherry vinaigrette ties together the sweet squash, salty bacon and pleasantly bitter greens with just enough brightness.

The salad is easy to assemble, and much of it can be prepared ahead. Roast the squash and cook the bacon up to four hours in advance, then let both come to room temperature; if you prefer, the squash may also be served warm. When tossing, lightly coat the greens and pass any remaining vinaigrette at the table. The dressing is versatile enough to use on other simple green salads as well.

I like to serve this vibrant salad as a first course for dinner, but it is satisfying enough to become a light main course with focaccia or a French baguette. It also pairs beautifully with a simple soup, such as potato leek or mushroom.

This salad will go beautifully with a simple soup. **DIANE ROSSEN WORTHINGTON/TNS**

ARUGULA AND BELGIAN ENDIVE SALAD WITH WINTER SQUASH AND BACON

Makes: 6 servings
For the vinaigrette:
3 tablespoons sherry vinegar
1 tablespoon lemon juice
1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
1 teaspoon honey
½ cup olive oil
Salt and freshly ground black pepper
For the salad:
⅓ pound applewood cured sliced bacon (about 5 to 6 slices)
1 ½ pounds peeled butternut squash, cut into 1 ½-inch cubes
2 tablespoons olive oil
1 tablespoon maple syrup
1 teaspoon seasoning salt
7 ounces arugula leaves
3 Belgian endives, sliced on the vertical
1. Whisk the vinaigrette ingredients well in a mixing bowl. Taste for seasoning. Reserve.
2. In a medium skillet, cook the bacon on medium heat for about 8 to 10 minutes, turning once with tongs, or until brown and crisp. Drain on paper towels. Cool and break into small pieces. Reserve.
3. Heat the oven to 425 degrees. Place the squash on a parchment-lined sheet pan. Add the oil, syrup and seasoning salt and toss to evenly coat the squash. Roast for about 30 to 40 minutes, turning the squash once, or until lightly browned. Cool and reserve.
4. When ready to serve, combine the arugula, Belgian endives, squash and bacon in a salad bowl. Spoon the vinaigrette over all and toss to mix well. Serve immediately. Serve any remaining vinaigrette on the side
Advance preparation: The salad may be prepared through Step 3 up to four hours ahead and kept at room temperature, loosely covered.

Cubed stew beef combines with fall vegetables and apple cider to create a simple and slightly sweet meal even kids will love. **GRETCHEN MCKAY/PITTSBURGH POST-GAZETTE PHOTOS**

CORE APPEAL

Enjoy apple cider without drinking it

By Gretchen McKay | PITTSBURGH POST-GAZETTE

Apple cider is perhaps the most quintessential of cold fall drinks, whether it comes in a plastic jug from your local apple farmer or has been fermented into the hard stuff.

It's also wonderful when heated up on the stove and mulled with warm spices, such as cinnamon, cloves and allspice and a hint of citrus.

Yet, there is so much more you can do with the opaque (and unsweetened) seasonal beverage made with fresh apples than drinking it.

We get it: Nothing screams "fall" louder than a glass of cider. We just want to remind you that it can be a good culinary pal, too.

Its tart, slightly tangy flavor can add a wonderful splash of spicy sweetness to any number of sweet and savory dishes, including stews and soups, meaty main dishes and all different kinds of baked goods — everything from cookies and cakes to doughnuts and sweet breads.

Above: This tender and moist apple cider cake uses a lot of apple cider — 4 cups that are reduced by half on the stove with warming spices — but the recipe is fairly simple.

Left: Cider-glazed root vegetables with apples and tarragon speak to the season.

APPLE CIDER BEEF STEW

2 pounds beef stew meat, cut into 1-inch cubes
2 tablespoons canola oil
3 cups apple cider or juice
1 can (14 ½ ounces) reduced-sodium beef broth
2 tablespoons cider vinegar
1 ½ teaspoons salt
½ teaspoon dried thyme
¼ teaspoon pepper
3 medium potatoes, peeled and cubed
4 medium carrots, peeled and cut into ¾-inch pieces
3 celery ribs, cut into ¾-inch pieces
2 medium onions, cut into wedges
¼ cup all-purpose flour
¼ cup water
Fresh thyme sprigs, optional

1. In a Dutch oven, brown the beef on all sides in oil over medium-high heat and drain. Add the cider, broth, vinegar, salt, thyme and pepper.

2. Bring to a boil. Reduce heat; cover and simmer for 1 ¼ hours.

3. Add the potatoes, carrots, celery and onions; return to a boil. Reduce heat; cover and simmer for 30 to 35 minutes or until the beef and vegetables are tender.

4. Combine the flour and water until smooth; stir into the stew. Bring to a boil; cook and stir for 2 minutes or until thickened. If desired, serve the stew with the fresh thyme.

— Recipe adapted from tasteofhome.com

CIDER-GLAZED ROOT VEGETABLES WITH APPLE AND TARRAGON

Root vegetables are a home cook's best friend in fall because they're so widely available. An array of carrots, parsnips and turnips are caramelized in butter and then deglazed in hard cider.

Makes: 8 servings
4 tablespoons unsalted butter, divided
1 pound carrots, peeled and cut into chunks
12 ounces parsnips, peeled and cut into chunks
12 ounces turnips, peeled and cut into chunks
3 shallots, peeled and halved
2 ½ cups hard cider
3 tablespoons sugar
1 ½ teaspoons table salt
1 Granny Smith apple, cored and cut into chunks
2 tablespoons chopped fresh tarragon
2 teaspoons cider vinegar

1. Melt 1 tablespoon butter in 12-inch skillet over medium-high heat. Add carrots, parsnips, turnips and shallots and cook until lightly browned, about 5 minutes.

2. Add cider, sugar, salt and remaining 3 tablespoons butter and bring to boil. Reduce heat to medium-low, cover and cook until vegetables are just tender, stirring occasionally, 7 to 10 minutes,

3. Uncover, increase heat to medium and cook until vegetables are fully tender, stirring occasionally, about 13 minutes. Stir in apple and continue to cook until cider is syrupy and apple is just tender, about 2 minutes longer. Off heat, stir in tarragon and vinegar.

4. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Transfer to serving dish, pour any remaining glaze over vegetables and serve.

— Recipe from "The Complete Autumn & Winter Cookbook" by America's Test Kitchen

GLAZED APPLE CIDER CAKE

4 cups fresh apple cider
2 teaspoons ground cinnamon
¼ teaspoon ground cloves
¼ teaspoon ground allspice
¼ teaspoon ground ginger
2 cups all-purpose flour
1 ½ teaspoons baking soda
1 teaspoon kosher salt
½ cup neutral-flavored oil
1 cup light brown sugar
1 tablespoon cider vinegar
1 cup powdered sugar

1. Prepare spiced cider reduction: In a large saucepan, heat apple cider with cinnamon, cloves, allspice and ginger over medium-high heat, simmering until it reduces to 2 cups, around 30 minutes. Stir occasionally.

2. Make the batter: Heat your oven to 350 degrees. Line the bottom of a 9-inch round or 8-inch square cake pan with parchment paper and coat the sides with nonstick cooking spray.

3. In a large bowl, combine flour, baking soda and kosher salt. Make a well in the middle and pour in oil, brown sugar, cider vinegar and 1 ¾ cups of the reduced cider (reserving the remaining ¼ cup for the glaze). Whisk to combine until no lumps remain. Pour into the prepared pan.

4. Bake for 30 to 35 minutes, or until the top is springy and a toothpick inserted in the center comes out with just a few sticky crumbs.

5. Cool the cake in the pan on a wire rack for 10 minutes, then cut around it with a knife to ensure it is loosened and flip it onto a plate.

6. Finish the cake: Place powdered sugar in a medium bowl and stir in 3 tablespoons of the remaining spiced apple cider reduction, whisking until a thick glaze forms.

7. Add some or all of the remaining 1 tablespoon reduction, if needed, to get your desired consistency. Pour glaze over center of cake and use a spatula to gently trickle it down the sides.

— Recipe from smittenkitchen.com

Yogurt marinade pulls double duty in skewers inspired by souvlaki

By Christopher Kimball
FOR ASSOCIATED PRESS

In Greece, skewers of garlicky meat called souvlaki are sold on street corners, in restaurants and at the beach, served hot off the grill to be enjoyed while out and about.

Though a yogurt marinade isn't traditional for pork souvlaki, in this recipe from our cookbook "Milk Street 365: The All-Purpose Cookbook for Every Day of the Year," we take advantage of the tenderizing effects the cultured dairy has on meat.

The combination of lactic acid and calcium loosens the structure of the proteins, tenderizing the meat. Flavored with red wine vinegar, oregano, garlic and salt and pepper, the yogurt pulls double duty as a creamy, tangy sauce.

Easy-to-source pork tenderloin is trimmed of its silver skin, halved lengthwise and cut into chucks before being tossed with the yogurt mixture. After marinating, the pork is threaded onto skewers with sweet-tart Campari or cocktail tomatoes. Zucchini cut into chunks works nicely, too — or even a combination. Rather than grilling, we move the cooking indoors and broil the skewers until the vegetables blister and the meat chars.

Enjoy right off the skewer, over a bed of rice or orzo pilaf, or stuffed into warmed pita. Serve with the yogurt sauce and lemon wedges.

Instead of grilling, the pork skewers are broiled in the oven until the vegetables blister and the meat chars. Serve them with yogurt sauce and lemon wedges. **MILK STREET**

SOUVLAKI-INSPIRED PORK SKEWERS

Makes: 4 servings
Total time: 30 minutes
¾ cup plain whole-milk Greek yogurt
2 tablespoons red wine vinegar
2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
1 tablespoon chopped fresh oregano
3 medium garlic cloves, finely grated
Kosher salt and ground black pepper
Lemon wedges for garnish (optional)
1¼-pound pork tenderloin, trimmed of silver skin, halved lengthwise and cut into 1-inch chunks
8 Campari or cocktail tomatoes (about 1½ inches) or 1 medium zucchini, halved lengthwise and cut into ½-inch pieces or a combination

1. Set a wire rack in a broiler-safe rimmed baking sheet and mist it with cooking spray. In a medium bowl, stir together the yogurt, vinegar, oil, oregano, garlic and 1 teaspoon each salt and pepper. Measure ¼ cup of the mixture into a small bowl and stir in 1 tablespoon water; set aside for serving.

2. Add the pork to the medium bowl and mix until evenly coated. Thread the pork, alternating with the tomatoes, onto four 8- to 10-inch metal skewers. Place the skewers on the prepared rack, spacing them evenly apart. Let stand at room temperature while the broiler heats.

3. Heat the broiler with a rack about 4 inches from the element. Broil the skewers until lightly charred, 4 to 6 minutes. Remove from the oven, flip and broil until charred on the second sides, another 4 to 6 minutes. Serve with the yogurt sauce.

Visionary races against the clock

Surgeon's wait for transplant lays bare challenges of system he spent decades trying to fix

Robert Montgomery, a transplant surgeon at NYU Langone Health, operates April 30 in New York. **ANGELINA KATSANIS/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

By Roni Caryn Rabin
THE NEW YORK TIMES

The first time he went into cardiac arrest and died, briefly, Robert Montgomery was hiking in South America's Patagonia. He felt his heart racing as he lagged behind his son John and their guide. Then he collapsed, face down into the snow.

Seconds passed before a medical device implanted in his chest delivered a shock that restored his heartbeat and saved his life.

It was 2010, and Montgomery, then 50, recovered quickly. But it was becoming painfully clear that he needed a new heart: The one he was born with was failing.

The odds of him getting a heart transplant were grim. Some 50,000 organs are transplanted in the United States each year, but hearts are so rare that patients often can't even get on the waiting list for one until they are close to death.

Montgomery knew this because he was a transplant surgeon himself.

At the time of his Argentina trip, Montgomery was leading one of the nation's premier organ transplant centers at Johns Hopkins Medicine.

As a child, Montgomery wanted to be a veterinarian. It was only when, at age 14, his father developed symptoms of dilated cardiomyopathy that he reconsidered. The rare disease causes the heart's chambers to stretch and enlarge, and can lead to heart failure, irregular heart beats or arrhythmias, cardiac arrest and sudden death.

His father became increasingly debilitated, and eventually needed a feeding tube after suffering brain damage from a cardiac arrest.

By the time his father died in 1976, Montgomery, then 16, had decided to become a doctor.

Eleven years later, he had just started a surgical residency at Johns Hopkins Medicine when he got the worst phone call of his life. His brother Rich, 35, a father of two, had died that morning.

Pathologists discovered that Rich Montgomery also had dilated cardiomyopathy, likely caused by a genetic mutation. Robert Montgomery was evaluated and learned he had the condition, too.

Suddenly, his career was in doubt. Surgical training was grueling, and a cardiac arrest or fainting episode could endanger patients.

When medication failed to keep his arrhythmia in check, Montgomery opted for a new medical device called an implantable cardioverter-defibrillator, or ICD, that could shock the heart back into a normal rhythm.

Unsure if he could complete his residency, Montgomery and his wife at the time moved to England so he could study immunology. He decided to pursue a doctorate, just in case surgery didn't work out.

Montgomery returned to Johns Hopkins in 1992. He wanted to specialize in transplant surgery. His own illness was a tremendous motivator.

"I didn't think I would live a normal life span — I knew I would need a heart transplant or I would die — so I was in a hurry, and I was hyperfocused," he said.

Emily Sammartano, who gave birth a few months earlier while on dialysis, shares a baby photo with Montgomery before receiving a kidney transplant April 30 at NYU Langone Health. **ANGELINA KATSANIS/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

Montgomery holds fish he caught during a fishing trip to Alaska with his son in 2023. **ROBERT MONTGOMERY**

So few heart transplants were done in the early 1990s that becoming a full-time heart transplant surgeon wasn't an option. Montgomery focused on kidneys, the most commonly transplanted organ. At Hopkins, he helped develop a minimally invasive surgical technique for retrieving kidneys from healthy living donors, which doctors hoped would lead more people to donate a kidney. It did, and children in need were the first beneficiaries. Over the next few years, "we transplanted all the kids on our pediatric list," Montgomery said.

In 2001, realizing he could increase the number of patients who got an organ if kidneys were swapped between incompatible, donor-recipient pairs, Montgomery started a program to do just that. Soon, he and his team were doing domino donations. An altruistic donor gave a kidney to a stranger, whose nonmatching donor gave a kidney to a second recipient and so on.

"He was seen as a bit of a cowboy," said Brigitte Sullivan, the transplant administrator whom Montgomery described as his "fellow visionary."

He went on to help develop a new approach to reduce organ rejection in patients at high risk of failed transplants and supported an initiative to use kidneys recovered from organ donors with HIV, transplanting them in HIV-positive patients instead of throwing them out. Federal law had to be changed, but this is now standard care.

In 2016, NYU Langone Health recruited Montgomery to build a world-class organ transplant program, and he moved to Manhattan in New York City with his wife, opera singer Denyce Graves, and their daughter. (Montgomery also has three children from previous relationships; his first marriage ended in divorce.). He had met Graves on a flight to Paris. By the time the plane landed, she had invited him to hear her sing, and he had invited her to watch him operate.

Despite his earlier near-death experience in Patagonia, Montgomery returned to the same spot in 2017. He wanted to spend time with his sons John and Max, but he went into cardiac arrest again. The closest hospital was nearly an hour away, and John did chest compressions on him in a Jeep as they raced to it.

When he emerged from a medically induced coma more than a month later in New York, where he had been flown, Montgomery had to learn to walk, talk and eat again.

"As I was having more of these near-death experiences, it became really clear to me that the likelihood of me getting a heart transplant was less than of me dying before I got on the list," he said.

A few months later, his heart stopped in the middle of the Broadway show "School of Rock." He received CPR in the aisle. At a medical conference in Italy, in September 2018, he experienced four cardiac arrests, one after another.

The upside, he realized, was that he was now so sick that he could finally join the waiting list for a heart. And he knew he would almost certainly be put at the very top.

He was admitted to the intensive care unit at NYU Langone and started the wait for an organ. His doctor warned that it could be months, even a year.

Just before dawn Sept. 20, he got a call that a heart was available — if he wanted it. The donor, who had died of a heroin overdose, was infected with hepatitis C.

There was reason for pause: The hospital's heart transplant program was brand-new; Montgomery had started it less than a year earlier. And transplants with hepatitis C-positive hearts were so novel that he would be part of a clinical trial if he received one.

"A lot of my colleagues thought I was crazy," Montgomery recalled. But he believed in the program, and had encouraged his own patients to consider organs with hepatitis C, which could be cured with medication. "So why not me?" he said.

After a six-hour surgery, Montgomery had a new heart.

Most heart transplant patients are so sick by the time they get an organ that they are disabled; only about 30% return to work. But two days after the operation, Montgomery was sitting up in bed, reviewing cases.

After his experience, Montgomery began to see all the work he had done to find more viable organs as insufficient.

"It's never going to be able to provide enough organs for people with organ failure," he said.

It was time for a radical move. Experiments had proved that organs from genetically modified pigs could be transplanted into monkeys. The next step was to build a case for transplants to humans. Montgomery decided to try it first in a patient who was brain-dead, something that had never been attempted.

In fall 2021, Montgomery announced that he had for the first time transplanted a kidney from a genetically modified pig into a human. Scientists at United Therapeutics, which produced the pig, had knocked out a gene involved in an aggressive organ rejection response. (The brain-dead patient was an organ donor, and the family consented to the experiment.)

Not only was the kidney not rejected, but it functioned, making urine and excreting waste for 54 hours, the limit set by a hospital ethics panel.

Over the next few years, Montgomery's team and others in Maryland and Boston transplanted pig kidneys and hearts into a small number of living patients who were terminally ill and had exhausted other treatment options.

The patients died of underlying conditions within months, but none of them mounted the kind of devastating immune rejection that destroys an organ — a major accomplishment that showed that pig organs could be transplanted safely and function properly in humans.

Last year, the Food and Drug Administration gave a green light to clinical trials of pig organ transplants in very ill patients who aren't likely to get a kidney any other way. Montgomery is leading two of them.

Since his surgery, he has gone salmon fishing in Alaska with his son John; traveled to Africa with Graves to celebrate her retirement; and assisted kidney surgeons in Ukraine.

Every morning, to protect his new heart, he walks 2 miles to work. He sets out before 6 a.m., to make it in time for patient rounds.

PEOPLE'S PHARMACY PRESCRIPTIONS AND HOME REMEDIES

Negative reactions to ingesting specific foods vary considerably

By Joe Graedon, M.S. and Teresa Graedon, Ph.D.
KING FEATURES SYNDICATE

People can be quite sensitive to raisins because they are high in fiber and sugar. **DREAMSTIME**

Q: Many years ago, my boyfriend at the time was fired from his job. The reason? His co-workers couldn't stand the flatulence! (Possibly, it would be illegal to fire him for that today.)

The reason he passed so much gas is that he ate raisins every morning at breakfast. When he stopped eating raisins, the problem went away. To me, this seems to be evidence that raisins have a strong influence on the GI tract.

A: When most people are quizzed about gassy foods, their answers refer to beans, onions, bran, lentils and vegetables like broccoli, Brussels sprouts, cabbage and cauliflower. Raisins are rarely mentioned. And yet some people can be quite sensitive to raisins because they are high in fiber and sugar. We discovered a reference to raisins causing flatulence in the American Journal of Digestive Diseases (May 1972).

Other people react to apples or apple cider. In addition, radishes, cucumbers, tomatoes, strawberries and peanuts may cause discomfort. Our conclusion is that people differ significantly in their reactions to foods. This might reflect wide variations in the gut microbiome.

We suggest that if a person is having trouble with flatulence, they keep a diary of foods eaten and symptoms experienced.

Q: I suffered with heinous cramps in my toes every single night for a very long time. When I read about putting soap under my sheets, I tried it since I had nothing to lose.

Starting with day one, I never had cramps in my toes again. Recently, I started getting cramps in my thighs at night, so I put a second bar of soap under the sheets at knee level, and it worked, too.

I use lavender because I like the smell, but I suspect any soap will probably do.

A: We suspect that the soap needs to be scented. People tell us that Irish Spring and Ivory have worked for them in this remedy. Lavender soap is what we use ourselves.

We have a hypothesis on how this remedy might work. Olfactory receptors are associated with the nose, where they are abundant. But there are also olfactory receptors throughout the body, for example, in hair follicles (Journal of Dermatological Science, November 2023). These receptors can detect odorant molecules.

Perhaps they act somewhat like the transient receptor potential (TRP) channels in nerve cells that can detect heat and hot peppers or cold and menthol. When activated, these TRP channels trigger nerves to send a signal overriding the inappropriate muscle stimulation causing the cramp.

Q: My dad is a good man. He is also an alcoholic. He has been in recovery for seven years. Today, he admitted to my family that he has been getting drunk on Listerine.

A: We have heard from more than 100 readers about the dangers of drinking high-alcohol-content mouthwash. Some brands, like Listerine, contain as much as 26.9% alcohol. That's about twice as much as wine.

Readers have described loved ones who died from liver and kidney damage after consuming large amounts of alcohol-containing mouthwash. This problem can affect people of all ages.

One reader wrote: "My elderly mother was drinking Listerine. She had me and my sisters all getting it for her, and none of us was the wiser for a while. Now we have figured it out, so I told her I will no longer get it for her. She is going blind, and I am wondering if this is what caused her loss of eyesight. She has drunk Listerine all her life and now she's 94."

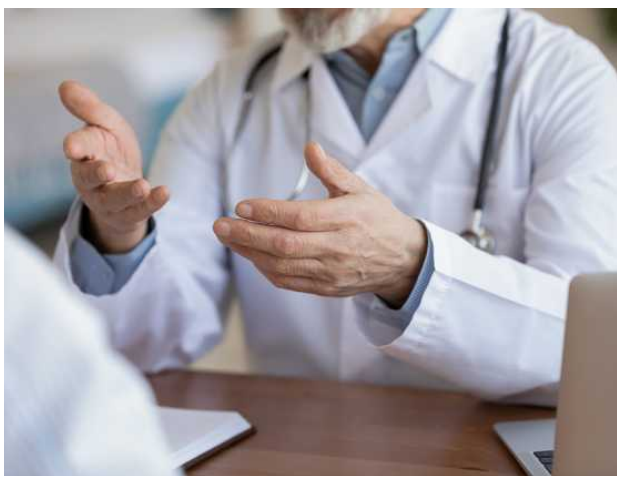
Regardless of the source, alcohol can damage multiple organs. Medications such as naltrexone or acamprosate may be helpful in overcoming the addiction, along with counseling or AA.

In their column, Joe and Teresa Graedon answer letters from readers. Send questions to them via www.peoplespharmacy.com.

Q&A

What are prostate cancer symptoms?

MAYO CLINIC



DREAMSTIME

Q: I know prostate cancer is common, but I'm not sure who is most at risk or whether there are symptoms to watch for. When should men consider screening? And if cancer is found, what treatments are available?

A: About 1 in 8 men will be diagnosed with prostate cancer during their lifetime, making it one of the most diagnosed cancers in men. The good news is that most cases are found early, and patients often do well with treatment.

Prostate cancer develops when cells in the prostate gland grow out of control. Several factors can increase the risk of developing the disease, including age and family history. Your risk increases as you get older and also may be higher if a father, brother or grandparent has been diagnosed. Black men have a higher risk of developing prostate cancer and are more likely to develop aggressive disease. Genetics also can play a role.

Knowing these factors is important because many early prostate cancers cause no symptoms. Urinary problems, such as trouble urinating, may raise concerns, but they are often caused by an enlarged prostate, which is common as men age. Blood in the urine or semen, unexplained weight loss or bone pain can occur with aggressive or advanced disease; however, the goal is to find the cancer before symptoms develop.

SCREENING

Screening generally begins around age 50, while men at higher risk may consider starting earlier, closer to 40 or 45. Your overall health, life expectancy and personal preferences also can help you and your healthcare team decide whether screening makes sense.

One of the main screening tools is a prostate-specific antigen, or PSA, blood test. PSA is a substance made by the prostate that can be measured in the blood. A high level can signal a problem, but it does not always mean cancer is present. Because PSA levels rise and fall, the test may be repeated to confirm the result. Additional testing may include other PSA measurements, biomarker tests or a prostate MRI. A digital rectal exam also may be recommended.

If a biopsy is needed, small tissue samples are taken from the prostate and examined. The results show whether cancer is present and whether it is low grade, high grade or somewhere in between. That information helps determine what comes next. A diagnosis does not always mean you need treatment right away. Many low-risk cancers and even some intermediate-risk cancers can be safely watched through active surveillance.

TREATMENTS

When treatment is needed, options include surgery to remove the prostate or radiation. Radiation can be delivered by a machine that directs it at the prostate or through small radioactive seeds, called brachytherapy. Focal therapy is a newer option for some patients. It targets cancer in one area while leaving the rest of the prostate alone.

Each option has different potential downsides to consider. Surgery and radiation, for example, can have similar results for controlling cancer but different side effects. Urinary leakage and erectile dysfunction are two common concerns, while radiation also can cause rectal or bowel irritation.

For advanced disease, treatment may include therapies that work throughout the body, including hormone deprivation therapy and some chemotherapies. Surgical techniques and radiation also have become more precise and less invasive, which can lead to faster recovery. Advances in managing side effects also help patients maintain a good quality of life after treatment.

When found early, prostate cancer is highly treatable and often curable. Because many men have no symptoms in the early stages, ask your healthcare team whether screening makes sense for you.

— Adam R. Miller, M.D., Urology, Mayo Clinic, Rochester, Minnesota

Mayo Clinic Q&A is an educational resource and doesn't replace medical care. Email a question to MayoClinicQ&A@mayo.edu.

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